CATALYSTS OF WORLD EVANGELIZATION

By

Luis Keith Bush

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ABSTRACT

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This dissertation identifies catalysts of world evangelization. My thesis is that certain recurring impulses provide catalytic impetus to world evangelization. These impulses are exemplified by such indicators as renewals, global conferences, and adequately motivated leaders which represent the means, structures, and agents of world evangelization. The problem addressed in the dissertation is knowing where to from here in world evangelization.

While looking through the lenses of the Scriptures, theology, missiologists, church history, global mission conferences, Christian leadership, and the AD2000 and Beyond Movement (AD2000), it soon became clear that the focus of the dissertation would more appropriately be on informing the question than seeking to provide answers. In the process I observed that certain catalytic impulses of world evangelization are constant including a God-given purpose, renewal as means, conferences leading to structures and human leaders as agents.

The study of catalytic antecedents of today's mission, the review of AD2000 as an institutional and contextual framework of mission prepares for the final section which anticipates future mission by means of an inquiry process. The Evangelizing Our World

Inquiry compresses the reflective process into a practical instrument. It seeks to become a tool for listening to voices that can help construct a missiology capable of empowering the global church for participation in God's mission for the twenty-first century. As we listen one another and seek God through his Word to hear "what the Spirit is saying to the church," we can expect a fresh missiology to emerge that both deepens and extends our witness through the gospel.

Mentor: Wilbert R. Shenk 255 words

DEDICATION

Pleasant places were measured out for me;
fair to me indeed is my inheritance. Psalm 16:4

Doris Anne Bush, co-heir of the gift of life on the highway of holiness, my companion, helper, the mother of my children, Jeannine, Stephanie, Naomi and Daniel; grandmother of my grandchildren, Gabriella Korea, Sophia Himalaya and Clara-Bella; co-participant in ministry and sharer of the same purpose in life.

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This doctoral journey would not have been possible were it not for certain people that, in God's goodness, were there for me at just the right time with just the right word. My accountability group of more than fifteen years, John Kyle, Paul McKaughan, Derk Van Konynenburg and Milan Telian encouraged me to take a time to reflect and write on lessons learned from the active years in the AD2000. My colleague Milan came to visit every three months during this process to brainstorm and encourage me on.

My doctoral committee provided timely, necessary advice and guidance throughout the entire process. My mentor, Wilbert Shenk, gave himself to this project as though it were the only one he was overseeing. In the course of the calendar year 2001 he interchanged more than eighty e-mail communications, met with me on numerous occasions, provided insights into the subject matter, noted important precedent literature, read through the manuscript on several occasions, graciously made needed correctives in thought and content and coached me throughout the entire process. At crucial intervals Charles Van Engen provided important instruction regarding the doctoral and dissertation process itself, offered vital insights in the methodological approach and organization of the material along with continual encouragement. Sherwood Lingenfelter invested bursts of energy in meeting as needed to review crucial elements of the dissertation and

especially the chapters on the Evangelizing Our World Inquiry and the AD2000 case study.

The School of World Mission faculty was a continuous source of inspiration through their writings, their witness around campus and friendliness. The staff provided consistent joyful and efficient support. Bobby Clinton's incorporation of the cognitive, affective, volitional, and experiential learning domains in private and public interchange challenged me, especially in reflecting and including a chapter on the lessons learned in catalytic leadership from the life of John R. Mott.

The day after deciding to do the doctoral study in November 1998 Walter Hansen offered support and graciously provided the financial resources together with prayer and encouragement to be able to complete the research project in a timely manner.

My three daughters Jeannine, Stephanie, Naomi and their husbands Mike Clinton, Stephen Kopalchick and Garrett Nates and my son Daniel sustained a high degree of enthusiasm for the project. My brothers John, Diego and Gerald were a continual source of support and encouragement from the beginning to the end of the project as well as my parents Keith and Sheila, my mother-in-law Caty Keeton and Doris' sisters Betty and Lillian and their families.

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

ABSTRACT ii

DEDICATION iv

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS v

TABLE OF CONTENTS vii

LIST OF TABLES xiii

LIST OF FIGURES xiv

LIST OF MAPS xvi

LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS xvii

CHAPTER 1 INTRODUCTORY CONSIDERATIONS 1

- Introduction 1
- Thesis Statement 2
- Chapter-by-Chapter Development of Thesis 2
- Clarification of Concepts 4
  - World Evangelization 4
  - Twenty-First Century 6
  - Catalyst 6
- Rationale 7
- Research Questions and Methodology 11
- Delimitations 12
- Conclusion 13

CHAPTER 2 THE CATALYTIC AIM—THE GLORY OF GOD 15

- The Historical Affirmation of God's Glory as a Mission Paradigm 16
- The Biblical Assertion of God's Glory as a Motif for Mission 18
  - God's Mission through Israel 19
  - God's Mission among the Nations 20
  - God's Mission through Jesus the Christ 20

God's Mission through the Church....21
The Significance of the Word "Glory" as Used in the Scriptures....21
The Word "Glory" in the Old Testament....22
The New Testament and the Word "Glory"....23
The Meaning of the Phrase "the Glory of the Lord Filling the Earth"....24
Summary of the Biblical Significance of "the Glory of God"....24
The Glory of God as the Integrating Idea/Meta-Theme for Mission....25
The Glory of God as *Missio Dei*....27
Personal Implications of a Paradigm of God's Glory....29
Conclusion....31

CHAPTER 3 THE CATALYTIC MEANS—RENEWAL....33

A Theoretical Framework....34
The Biblical and Theological Basis....41
The Pentecostal and Charismatic Renewal....44
The Historical Evidence to 1950....46
An Assessment of the Division of History by Latourette....47
A Proposal for Epochs Based on the Renewal-Mission Connection....49
The Great Beginning—0 to 500 A.D.....49
The Great Recession—500 to 950 A.D.....50
The Great Resurgence (with Great Corruption)—950 to 1500 A.D.....51
The Great Reformation and the Great Schism—1500 to 1800 A.D.....52
The Great Century—1800 to 1900 A.D.....54
Great Vigor in the Great Storm—1900 to 1950 A.D.....55
The Four Major Pulsations from Pentecost to the Present....56
The Contemporary Evidence....58
The Peoples of the Earth Evangelized....58
The Two-Thirds World Church Emerges as a Full Partner in Mission....60
Conclusion....63

CHAPTER 4 THE CATALYTIC LEADER—MOTT....65

Highlights from Mott's Leadership Qualities....67
Personal Ethics....68
Use of Effective Methodologies in Decision-Making....69
Faith in the God of the Impossible to Do the Impossible....70
Mission Mobilizer *par Excellence*....71
Exemplification of the Essence of Christian Leadership....73
Living a Focused Life....74
Pursuing a Life Purpose....75
Mechanisms Mott Developed to Carry Out His Vision....76

Conferences....76
Organizations....77
Mentoring Individual Leaders....78
Bridge Building....80
Summary Thoughts on Mott as a Leader....81

CHAPTER 5 THE CATALYTIC STRUCTURES—CONFERENCES....82

Introduction....82
Historical Overview....83
Two Global Mission Conferences with Major Impact....91
Edinburgh 1910....92
Communication....92
Continuation Committee....93
The International Missionary Council....94
Faith and Order/Life and Work....95
Lausanne '74....96
A Covenant....97
A Continuation Committee....98
A Catalyst....99
Observations Regarding Global Mission Conferences....101
Relational Impact of Conferences....103
Conferences Debate the Nature of Evangelism....105
The Development of a Theology of Mission....110
What Kind of Impact Do Conferences Have?....121
Assessing Global Impact of Conferences on World Evangelization....122
Inspiring for World Evangelization....122
Transforming Mission Theology....123
Deepening Analysis of Mission Contexts....123
Conclusions: The Lessons Learned....125

CHAPTER 6 A CATALYTIC CASE STUDY—THE AD2000 MOVEMENT....128

An Introduction to AD2000....129
The Birth of AD2000....129
The Setting: A Key Moment in History....130
The Shaking of the Nations....130
Secularist Sees a Decline of the Age of Unbelief in the 1990s....131
Futurists Predict Spiritual Awakening for the 1990s....131
Maturing Church in the Developing World....132
The Great Commission Methodological Framework....134
The Catalytic Aim—The AD2000 Vision and the Glory of God Theme....135
A Vision-Driven Movement....136
Motivating for the Great Commission....137
The Focus on the 10/40 Window....138

Spreading the Vision....140
Sharpening the Vision—Joshua Project 2000....141
The Catalytic Structure—AD2000 Organization and Conferences....143
Resource Networks....146
Global-Multiplier Effect of Networking....149
Seeing Disagreements as Opportunity for Increasing Understanding....149
Countrywide Initiatives....151
Two Distinct Phases in Structure....153
Catalytic Partnerships....154
A Catalytic Coordinating Office....156
Conferences....158
Prayer....159
Reconciliation....161
The Catalytic Leader—AD2000 Participants....164
Selecting and Recruiting Leaders....165
Leadership Selection Basic Assumptions....166
Leadership Selection Guidelines....166
Problems in Leadership Selection....167
A Volunteer Army....168
The Catalytic Virtues of Voluntarism....168
The Challenges of Voluntarism....169
New Leadership Emergence....170
The Catalytic Means—Renewal and Prayer....173
Renewal and the Pentecostal and Charismatic Stream....173
Prayer....175
AD2000 United Prayer Track....176
Praying through the Window....176
Case Study of United Prayer Impact: Calcutta....178
New Approaches to Prayer Encouraged and Disputed....180
Conclusion—An Assessment of AD2000 as a Catalyst....181
Results of Vision of a Church for Every People and the Gospel for Every Person by the Year 2000....181
Built-In Tensions....183
Strengths....184
Summary Comments....187
A Final Question....188

CHAPTER 7 A CATALYTIC MECHANISM—THE INQUIRY....190

Why the Inquiry?....191
Because the Conversation Illuminates the Purpose of God....191
Because Focus Group Inquiries Are Biblical....192
Because There is a Need to Hear Intentionally and Primarily from Christian Leaders in Africa, Asia, and Latin America....193

Because of the Catalytic Nature of the Inquiry Process 195
Because of the Unfinished Task of World Evangelization 197
Because of the Need to Define the New Paradigms of Mission 198
Because of the Tectonic Changes in the Context of Mission 200
Because of the Historical Precedence of the William Carey Inquiry which Launched the Modern Era of Missions 201
What is the Evangelizing Our World Inquiry? 201
Where? The Kinds of Locations 203
What for? The Inquiry Purpose 203
How? The Inquiry Approach 204
The Interactive Methodological Approach 205
Quantitative and Qualitative Methodology 208
The Spirit of the Inquiry 209
How Long? The Time-Frame Envisioned 209
Wherefore? The Results Anticipated 210
Who? The Roles Involved 211
Advisor 211
Consultative Group 211
Evangelizing Our World Inquiry Participants 212
Leadership Group Ideal Composition 212
Criteria for Selection of Group Participants 213
What Are the Limitations? 213
Things that Did Not Work Out 213
Problems with Design 214
Limitations to Sampling 215
Biased Questions 216
Concluding Interpretation and Recommendations 216

CHAPTER 8 OBSERVATIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS 218

Observations 218
What I Have Learned from This Study 220
Recommendations to Think about in the Future 222
The Practical Implications 223
Fresh Terminology 225
Conclusion 226

APPENDIX A INTEGRATIVE METHODLOGICAL FRAMEWORK 228

APPENDIX B INTERPRETIVE CONCERNS ABOUT *MISSIO DEI* 242

APPENDIX C PAUL E. PIERSON: DISTINGUISHING MARKS OF SPIRITUAL RENEWAL 245

APPENDIX D KEY TERMS ANALYSIS 247

APPENDIX E THE GREAT COMMISSION MANIFESTO SINGAPORE, JANUARY 1989 251

APPENDIX F THE GREAT COMMISSION AS A MISSIOLOGICAL FRAMEWORK....252

APPENDIX G DESCRIPTION OF THE AD2000 RESOURCE NETWORKS 258

APPENDIX H INFORMATION DISSEMINATION AS A CATALYTIC ELEMENT....264

APPENDIX I DENOMINATIONAL SUMMIT DECLARATION 272

APPENDIX J QUANTITATIVE INQUIRY SURVEY....276

APPENDIX K EVANGELIZING OUR WORLD QUALITATIVE INQUIRY FOR FOCUS GROUPS....282

REFERENCES CITED....291

INDEX....305

VITA....312

LIST OF TABLES

TABLE 1 BIBLICAL MODELS OF CYCLICAL RENEWAL 37

TABLE 2 JONATHAN EDWARDS' DISTINGUISHING MARKS AND THE DYNAMICS OF SPIRITUAL RENEWAL AND RESULTING ACTION 39

TABLE 3 A PERSPECTIVE ON THE HISTORICAL DEVELOPMENT OF THE CHRISTIAN MOVEMENT 50

TABLE 4 THEME AND SPONSORSHIP OF EVANGELICAL CONFERENCES 89

TABLE 5 PURPOSE AND LEGACY OF EVANGELICAL CONFERENCES 90

TABLE 6 COMPARISON OF THE ECUMENICAL AND EVANGELICAL UNDERSTANDING OF MISSION 120

TABLE 7 PROGRESS TOWARDS CHURCH PLANTING 1990-2000 181

TABLE 8 TOP-DOWN VERSUS INTERACTIVE APPROACH 207

TABLE 9 WORKING GRID OF MISSION 239

TABLE 10 *JOSHUA PROJECT 2000* BREAKDOWN OF 12,000 PEOPLES 267

LIST OF FIGURES

FIGURE 1 THE CHURCH FOR EVERY PEOPLE 61

FIGURE 2 WHAT IS A CHRISTIAN LEADER? 74

FIGURE 3 ORGANIZATIONS INFLUENCED BY MOTT 79

FIGURE 4 OVERVIEW OF CHRISTIAN TWENTIETH CENTURY CONFERENCES 87

FIGURE 5 AD2000 RESOURCE NETWORK STRUCTURE 148

FIGURE 6 THE RAISING UP OF RESOURCES THROUGH COUNTRYWIDE INITIATIVES 152

FIGURE 7 CATALYTIC COORDINATING OFFICE 157

FIGURE 8 PRIME CATALYTIC ELEMENTS 174

FIGURE 9 THE GOSPEL FOR EVERY PERSON BY THE YEAR 2000 183

FIGURE 10 INQUIRY PROCESS 196

FIGURE 11 THE TOP-DOWN METHODOLOGICAL APPROACH 204

FIGURE 12 THE INTERACTIVE METHODOLOGICAL APPROACH 206

FIGURE 13 THREE DOMAINS OF MISSIOLOGY 230

FIGURE 14 PERSONAL EXPERIENCE: THE FOUR DOMAINS 232

FIGURE 15 FOUR DOMAINS AND THE INTEGRATING IDEA 234

FIGURE 16 THE HOLY SPIRIT AND PRAYER IN MISSION 235

FIGURE 17 HISTORY OF MISSIONAL ACTION 236

FIGURE 18 HISTORY OF MISSIONAL ACTION AND THEORY 237

FIGURE 19 THE HEART OF MISSION IN *MISSIO DEI* 238

FIGURE 20 MISSIONAL ACTION.....240

LIST OF MAPS

MAP 1 THE 10/40 WINDOW 139

LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

AD2000	AD2000 and Beyond Movement
AEA	Association of Evangelicals in Africa
AFE	American Festival of Evangelism 1981
AICOME	All-India Congress on Mission and Evangelization (Devlali, India 1977)
ALCOE	Asian Leadership Conference on Evangelism
ANI	African National Initiatives
BGA	Billy Graham Association
CBI	CB International (formerly Conservative Baptist Foreign Mission Society)
CCC	Campus Crusade for Christ
CCOWE	Chinese Congress on World Evangelization (Hong Kong 1976)
COMIBAM ‘87	Conference on World Missions for the Ibero-American Church
CONECAR ‘84	Congress on the Evangelization of the Caribbean (Kingston, Jamaica 1984)
CONELA	Consultation of Evangelicals in Latin America (Panama City, Panama 1982)
COWE	Consultation on World Evangelization (Pattaya, Thailand 1980)
Edinburgh 1910	Edinburgh 1910 World Mission Conference
EFMA	Evangelical Foreign Missions Association
GCOWE ‘89	Global Consultation on World Evangelization by the Year 2000 and Beyond (Singapore)

GCOWE ‘95	Global Consultation on World Evangelization by the Year 2000 and Beyond (Seoul, Korea)
GCOWE ‘97	Global Consultation on World Evangelization by the Year 2000 and Beyond (Pretoria, South Africa)
ICOWE	International Congress on World Evangelization (Lausanne 1974)
IMC	International Missionary Council
LATFRICASIA	Latin America, Africa, and Asia, or World, Majority World, Third World, Non-western World
LCWE	Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization
NT	New Testament of the Bible
PCUSA	Presbyterian Churches in the United States of America
PIN	Peoples Information Network
ROPAL	Registry of Peoples and Languages
SVM	Student Volunteer Movement
UN	United Nations
USCWM	United States Center for World Missions
WCC	World Council of Churches
WCL	William Carey Library
WEF	World Evangelical Fellowship
WHO	World Health Organization
WSCF	World Student Christian Federation

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTORY CONSIDERATIONS

The purpose of this dissertation is to show the links that provide catalytic impetus to world evangelization and use this to propose appropriate next steps. Each chapter describes the connection between an impetus and world evangelization.

Introduction

This dissertation fits in to the overall doctoral program as the final product of an intensive process of methods and tutorial studies. It is concerned with the mission of the church in the world.

Since its inception in 1989 and for its duration I have been an active participant in the AD2000 and Beyond Movement (AD2000). Prior to its mandated disbandment in early 2001 I have not made a deliberate effort to step back and reflect on it. At the encouragement of the AD2000 board I began the research, continue to do so right now and plan to after completion of the doctoral program. The issue I am addressing is what can be learned about catalysts of world evangelization from reflecting on what caused AD2000 to be catalytic that might inform mission in the twenty-first century. I am trying to be objective and self-critical. My concern in this dissertation is not to justify AD2000. In the process of asking what were the factors that catalyzed world evangelization, I was

seeking to answer the question where to from here in world evangelization in a changed environment of the twenty-first century. In my doctoral work I have sought answers to that question. However, by the time I was half way through the doctoral program, it became clear to me, and the majority of the members of my doctoral committee, that the focus of the dissertation would more appropriately be on informing the question rather than seeking to provide a set of answers.

In the process I have observed that certain things are constant as catalytic impulses for world evangelization. These are goal, renewal, conference and agents. This is still true in a changed contextual environment. I have learned more about what the mission is, who does it, how people are motivated, and what the means are and how to work together.

Thesis Statement

My thesis is that certain recurring impulses provide catalytic impetus to world evangelization. These recurring impulses are exemplified by such indicators as renewals, global conferences, and adequately motivated leaders which represent the means, structures, and agents of world evangelization. The title, catalysts of world evangelization, expresses the thesis statement in four words.

Chapter-by-Chapter Development of Thesis

Chapter 2 develops the glory of God theme as founded in the Scriptures and identified by leading missiologists as not only the ultimate catalytic aim of mission but also the ultimate motivation for mission. In reflecting on this paradigm of mission, the

biblical and theological bases will be examined as well as the historical evidence to demonstrate that having the glory of God as the goal in world evangelization is catalytic. In Chapter 3, the inherent link between renewal and world evangelization will be established by an overview of the historical record to show the catalytic means of world evangelization. Chapter 4 will affirm the importance of Christian leaders as God's catalytic agents for influencing God's people to engage in God's missional purposes. In Chapter 5, a study of global mission conferences linked to structures and giving catalytic impetus toward mission work will underscore the importance of these kinds of conferences. The catalytic nature of the AD2000 Movement, as a contextual and institutional platform for a vibrant world evangelization effort during the final decade of the second millennium will be developed in Chapter 6 with sections based on catalytic aim, catalytic means, catalytic leaders and catalytic structures. Chapter 7 proposes a catalytic mechanism of a global inquiry to involve Christian leaders by listening to them by means of a quantitative and qualitative instrument. The Inquiry incorporates the primary catalytic impulses including ultimate aim, structures, means and agency.

Chapters 2 through 5 of the dissertation examine the antecedents to today's missions. Chapter 6 evaluates the recent state of mission and Chapter 7 identifies questions that will help us move in the direction God would have us go. The three primary questions addressed are: (1) What did we learn? (2) How do we assess missions of the last decade? and (3) Where do we go now to complete the task of world evangelization? Informed from the past and learning from the present, Chapter 7 will comprise an inquiry for contemporary Christian leaders that looks toward the future. The

inquiry chapter serves a distilling function in the dissertation, compressing the reflective process into a practical instrument. All three sections enhance the ability to listen more effectively. It is an invitation to God's servants to come on the journey of the listening mode. It all gets us into a posture to listen to what the Spirit is saying to the church. "You cannot turn people loose listening to the Spirit and come up empty" (Shenk 2001d).

Clarification of Concepts

There are three dominant concepts prevalent throughout the dissertation. World evangelization answers the question "what," twenty-first century addresses the question of when and catalyst answers the question "how."

World Evangelization

The expression "world evangelization" describes the evangelizing mission of the church in the world. Often the term "mission" is used in place of world evangelization, even though it is actually broader.[1] The meaning of both mission and world evangelization are dynamic rather than static. They also mean different things to different people. Even among the various major streams of Christianity, there is little agreement

[1] When we talk about the church being "sent into the world," we are talking about its mission, for that is what the word means. And what is the church's mission in the world? Evangelism yes, but not that alone. For God sends his people out to be his servants and his witnesses. Not one or the other, but both. Jesus came to serve (Mk. 10:45) and he came to witness (Jn. 18:37). The same two activities constitute the church's mission. They are elaborated later in the Lausanne Covenant, evangelism in paragraph 4 and Christian social responsibility in paragraph 5. Meanwhile, the objectives of the church's mission are outlined as the extension of his kingdom (which Jesus talked about so much, e.g., Mt. 6:10, 33; 13:31-32), the building up of Christ's body (which Paul wrote about, e.g., Eph. 4:11-16) and the glory of his name (which is not only the ultimate aim of mission but also "the chief end of man," cf., Ps. 115:1; Eph. 1:6, 12, 14) (Stott 1996:11).

with regard to the meaning of these terms.[2] Whenever the term evangelization is utilized in the dissertation, the meaning has been selected on the two-fold basis of acceptability to Christian leadership worldwide and to my own convictions. The following definition, taken from the Lausanne Covenant in paragraph 4, was endorsed at the Consultation on the Relationship between Evangelism and Social Responsibility co-sponsored by the Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization (LCWE) and World Evangelical Fellowship (WEF) in 1982:[3]

> To evangelize is to spread the good news that Jesus Christ died for our sins and was raised from the dead according to the Scriptures and that as the reigning Lord he now offers the forgiveness of sins and the liberating gift of the Spirit to all who repent and believe. Our Christian presence in the world is indispensable to evangelism and so is that kind of dialogue whose purpose is to listen sensitively in order to understand. But evangelism itself is the proclamation of the historical biblical Christ as Savior and Lord with a view of persuading people to come to him personally and so be reconciled to God. In issuing the gospel invitation we have no liberty to conceal the cost of discipleship. Jesus still calls all who would follow him to deny themselves, take up their cross and identify themselves with his new community. The results of evangelism include obedience to Christ, incorporation into his Church and responsible service in the world (Ford 1985:33).

The Lausanne Covenant in paragraph 6 adds: "World evangelization requires the whole church to take the whole Gospel to the whole world" (1985:33).

One of the questions addressed in the focus group qualitative survey of the Evangelizing Our World Inquiry in Chapter 8 of the dissertation is how Christian leaders

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[2] After reviewing perspectives on missiology from the various Christian streams in New Directions 2, James Scherer, one of the editors of the collection of theological perspectives on mission, pursues an agreed-on understanding of what mission is. He establishes the need for a definition of missiology because of the "current indecision, or at least a divergence of opinion, about what mission fundamentally is" (Scherer and Bevans 1994:175).

[3] Effective January 1, 2002, the World Evangelical Fellowship changed its name to the World Evangelical Alliance.

throughout the world understand the phrase world evangelization at this present time. Undoubtedly it means different things to different leaders.

Twenty-First Century

The creative ongoing missional activity of the Holy Spirit since Pentecost provides hope for the complex world of the twenty-first century. The rise of the floodwaters of modernity carry along with them the debris of social systems once embedded, decision-making authority traditions and the separation of time and space from their comfortable moorings. In reflecting on the condition of postmodernity, David Harvey argues that there has already been a rite of passage from modernity to postmodernity in contemporary culture. He suggests that what was the flood of modernity has now become a sea-change called postmodernity. "There has been a sea-change in cultural as well as in political-economic practices since around 1982. This sea-change is bound up with the emergence of new dominant ways in which we experience space and time" (1990:vii). The defining values of postmodern cultural pluralism and holism provide greater latitude toward religion while at the same time presenting a new challenge to crossing over the boundary between faith in Jesus Christ and its absence with word and deed.

Catalyst

The term "catalyst" is defined in the *American Heritage Dictionary of the English Language* (1998) first within the semantic field of chemistry, as a "substance, usually used in small amounts relative to the reactants, that modifies and increases the rate of a

reaction without being consumed in the process." In the more generic sense, it is defined as "one that precipitates a process or event" (*American Heritage Dictionary* 1998).

After considering the meaning of the terms used in the title, the broader question of why one should deal with catalysts of evangelization is twofold. First, I have been interested and involved in world evangelization for more than two decades and second, this study can help construct a missiology capable of empowering the global church for participation in God's mission for the twenty-first century.

Rationale

At the dawn of the new millennium, Christians recognize we are entering a new missionary era, "a new epoch in Christian mission is unfolding," states Wilbert R. Shenk in his book *Changing Frontiers of Mission* (1999:186). "We can expect a fresh missiology to emerge—indeed it is already well on the way—that deepens and extends the witness to liberation through the gospel" (1999:190).

International Christians gathered in different conferences during the final months of the second millennium to wrestle with the question, "Where do we go from here in world evangelization?" At the First International Consultation on Discipleship, held September 1999, in Eastbourne, England, John R. W. Stott summed up the sentiment of participants when he said, "the Christian situation is 'Strange, tragic, and possessing a disturbing paradox. In some places the church is growing strongly, but even there the problem is that of growth without depth. In short, the Church lacks proper discipleship." A joint statement crafted during the consultation acknowledges that "our zeal to go wider has not been matched by a commitment to go deeper" (Oosterhoff 1999:1).

In a representative Global Evangelism Roundtable, the World Evangelical Fellowship (WEF), the AD2000 and Beyond Movement (AD2000), the Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization (LCWE) and the Billy Graham Association (BGA) met March 21-25, 1999, in Hurdal, Norway, seeking a basis for understanding moving into the twenty-first century. North American evangelical seminary deans met in Phoenix in February 2000. They reflected on the question, AD2000—Where do we go from here with the Great Commission? At Amsterdam 2000, held from July 29 to August 6, 2000, more than five hundred strategists considered the unfinished task, the obstacles therein, and the way forward in evangelization.

From the recurring focus over the eighteen months leading up to August 2000 of the theme, Where Do We Go From Here in World Evangelization?, it is clear that the issue has become a priority concern for many of God's people. My interest in this study stems in part from the fact that over the past twelve years I have been asked to address the topic "Where Do We Go From Here in World Evangelization?" in diverse conference settings, such as at Lausanne II in 1989, the Evangelical Mission Society of North America gatherings on two occasions, the annual gathering of deans of North American evangelical seminaries, regional and national consultations and seminars in different countries around the world, in Amsterdam 2000, and for the North American *Handbook of Missions*. The U.S. Board of the AD2000 Movement encouraged me to take time for doctoral study after the chartered disbanding of the AD2000 Movement to reflect and write about the lessons learned. This led me to Fuller Theological Seminary, School of World Mission, and to wrestling with the question of catalytic impetus to world

evangelization in the twenty-first century, based on lessons learned in AD2000 and from further study.

In reflecting on this topic in these gatherings, it became clear to me that there is not currently a consensus among God's people. Christian leaders are asking where they can get help to construct a unifying and compelling mission vision capable of empowering the global church for participation in God's mission for the twenty-first century:

> I don't know of any time in my 35 years of mission experience that I have seen or felt mission executives more ready and willing to change and adapt. At the same time, I also don't know of any period in my career that there is less certainty about what changes to make. The future is uncertain. We know it will be greatly different but are not sure in which ways it will be different. We know that the patterns of the past are showing "wear" and are in need of repair. In many ways the fit between our strategies and way of thinking do not fit our present reality well. We know that they probably won't move us into the future God has for us. Yet the new paradigms that help us interpret and organize our strategies for the future have not become clear. We seem to be in a time of parenthesis between what God blessed in the past and what He has not yet made clear for the future (McKaughan 2000).

We are living in a time when there exists an accelerating pace of change in so many areas of life. This adds complexity to world evangelization:

> Apart from some marginalized pockets, the pace of change is increasing across the board—demographic, technological, economic, political, and social. This leads to uncertainty, information overload, hesitancy to make long-term commitments, and difficulty in making plans (Woodberry 2000).

There are dramatic new realities for world mission emerging as a result of the September 11, 2001, bombing of the World Trade Center in New York City. The comments of the Pulitzer Prize-winning author of *War in a Time of Peace,* David Halberstam, underscore several realities: "Something quite dramatic has changed. The

world is shrinking. The idea has been bought that they [the world] are poor because the U.S. is rich. We [the United States] binged on self-absorption. Can you limit the effect [of this] in the Islamic World?"[4]

The church in the United States has carried the major burden of providing the resources to world evangelization in the twentieth century. A recent survey of church and mission leaders prior to September 11 revealed some significant trends that suggest that there may be some changes forthcoming.

> The winds of change are swirling with great intensity around the Christian missionary enterprise. The world is changing radically: economically, politically and religiously. Where does the evangelical mission community in the United States find itself in the midst of this change? (McKaughan, O'Brien, and O'Brien 1998:1).

A delegation of mission leaders traveled to different cities around the country in 1998, meeting with a variety of church and mission leaders. Their observations on the current mission scene in the U.S. took on a pattern summarized by the following statements (McKaughan, O'Brien, and O'Brien 1998:1):

1. When did missions change from being vision-driven to budget-driven?

2. Today's generation does not respond to a command structure, nor to guilt trips.

3. (Mission) headquarters are afraid of decentralization.

4. Most churches are interested in survival, not missions.

5. The U.S. church is compassion-depleted.

6. The church in America just will not listen to the church around the world.

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[4] David Halberstam made these comments when interviewed by Aaron Brown of CNN on November 6, 2001.

My own desire to conduct this study came not only out of the need to describe the state of world evangelization, but also from my own involvement in world evangelization entities. I served global mission efforts from the country of El Salvador, with the World Evangelical Fellowship (WEF) Mission Commission, as a member of the Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization, as International Coordinator for the Conference on Missions for the Ibero-American Church (COMIBAM '87), as President of Partners International, and as International Director of the AD2000 Movement.

Research Questions and Methodology

The purpose of this study is to learn lessons by looking through the lenses of the Scriptures, theology, missiologists, church history, global mission conferences, Christian leadership, AD2000, and methodological frameworks. These varied perspectives can provide hints of where we go from here in world evangelization.

The review of existing methodologies and the presentation of new provided an integrative framework for approaching the question of how to advance the global Christian movement over the next twenty-five years (Appendix A). This framework goes beyond managerial missiology. It adheres to a dynamic process in which reflection informs action and action informs reflection. The methodological process applied considers the Scriptures (Chapter 2), the church's reflection (Chapter 2), the world context (Chapter 1), personal experience (Chapter 1), an integrating theme of mission (Chapter 2), the history of missional action (Chapter 3), Christian leadership (Chapter 4), the development of mission theory (Chapter 5), the heart of mission in *missio Dei*

(Chapter 5), and missional action from the last decade via the AD2000 Movement (Chapter 6).

In gaining insights from different disciplines, what kinds of answers emerge that relate to the question, "Where do we go from here in world evangelization?" While learning from scientific technique and from the craft of research, my intent is to remain open to God's direction through his people. My purpose is to discern what God is placing on the heart of his people; therefore, I am seeking answers to the question, "What are God's people burdened about as we move into the new century?" Informed by the multi-disciplinary study of the question, a quantitative and qualitative survey instrument will serve as an inquiry to be made among thousands of God's servants around the world over the next eighteen months (Chapter 7 of this study).

Delimitations

The task of world evangelization is a vast topic.[5] The scope of this study encompasses all of these areas to some degree. Yet, due to the breadth of the topic, the depth of the research is limited, and the study is partial. Only those works which were available through Fuller Theological Seminary Library were used. The use of interviews

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[5] World evangelization involves multi-disciplinary research. Charles E. Van Engen describes six major areas of missiology as follows:

1. *missio Dei* (the mission of God),
2. *mission hominum* (the mission of humans),
3. *mission ecclesiarum* (the mission of the church),
4. *missio politica oecumenica* (mission as it draws from and impacts human civilization),
5. *mission futurem* (mission as it relates to the "predictable issues of God's mission as they work out in human history"), and,
6. *mission adventus* ("the in-breaking (the advent) of God, of Jesus Christ in the Incarnation, of the Holy Spirit at Pentecost, of the Holy Spirit and in and through the Church" (Van Engen 1996:27-29).

was minimal; there could have been more. Limitations of time and space did not allow for a more exhaustive review of the precedent literature.

Conclusion

The twenty-first century context for Christian mission provides some unique challenges. We are living in a pluralistic globalizing world, with new ways to view issues, such as time, space and the privatization of belief in contemporary culture. Dramatic and accelerating multi-dimensional change presents a complex backdrop to the church as God's agent for mission.

The past decades have seen tremendous advances in the kingdom. We have witnessed the moving of God. The growth of the church in the Two-Thirds world has been nothing short of exponential. A new spirit of cooperation and partnership permeates God's people.[6] Yet, the missional patterns of the past are showing wear, and God's servants are seeking biblically consistent and contextually relevant ways to advance the gospel.

As God's people begin this twenty-first century the question on the hearts of many is, "Where do we go from here in world evangelization?" The answer to the question lies in understanding and releasing those things that provide catalytic impetus to world evangelization. This dissertation will seek to explore and analyze the evidence of

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[6] There are many terms that express the concept of the geographical block of countries including the continents of Asia, Africa and Latin America: developing countries, Third World, Two-Thirds-World, Non-western World, LATFRICASIA, AAA, AALA and the Majority World. Each has its own advantages and disadvantages, though no term has won the allegiance of the global community. For the sake of this paper I will use the expression "two-thirds-world."

links to world evangelization as well as the methodology and a specific instrument that can be applied to advance the gospel in word and deed in a new and living way.

CHAPTER 2

THE CATALYTIC AIM—THE GLORY OF GOD

Foundational to answering the question, "What is the ultimate aim in world evangelization?" are the Scriptures. The perennial, singular, seminal force is the Word of God (Shenk 1999:186-190). The answer proposed in this dissertation is: "We go to fill the earth with the glory of God as the waters cover the sea." My thesis in this chapter is that the ultimate catalytic aim in world evangelization is filling the earth with God's glory; that is, filling the whole world with the power, the presence, and the peace of God.

There are four overlapping domains in which the glory of stands the test an emerging paradigm of mission for the twenty-first century—the Word of God, the world of the twenty-first century, the church of God, and personal pilgrimage. In each major era of biblical history, the leaders among the people embraced the vision of the glory of God. When secular humanism reaches the peak of its own glory, "the glory of God" paradigm becomes the vision that addresses contemporary culture at its very core. Throughout church history, Christian leaders in different periods committed themselves to this meta-mission of God. In the history of mission there have been some who have highlighted the glory of God as the ultimate aim of mission such as Gisbertus Voetius and Johan H. Bavinck. But it has been underemphasized.

The Historical Affirmation of God's Glory as a Mission Paradigm

Across the span of church history, some historians have recognized the centrality of the glory-theme of mission. "The history of the church is the rise and progress of the kingdom of heaven upon earth, for the glory of God and the salvation of the world" (Schaff 1997).

The first Protestant to develop a theology of mission, Voetius (1588-1676), was a Dutchman who emerged as a strategic thinker and theologian during the seventeenth century. Voetius viewed mission as flowing from the very heart of God. He was one of the first proponents of what was to become known as *missio Dei*. David Bosch suggests that his views on mission were at once hopelessly outdated and yet surprisingly modern. His own conviction is that Voetius's threefold goal of mission became "widely known and is still unparalleled" (1997:256-257).

To Voetius, the meta-theme of mission is the glory of God demonstrated in the world. In his guidelines for a theology of mission, he notes that God himself is the true and effective ground of mission, and he executes his work through the church:

> As regards the aim of mission, Voetius distinguishes three facets. The immediate aim is *conversio gentilium*, the conversion of pagans. This aim is, however, subordinate to a more distant goal, *plantatio ecclesiae*, the planting of the Church. The supreme and ultimate goal of mission is *gloria et manifestatio gratiae divinae*, the glorification and manifestation of divine grace (Bosch 1980:126-127).

In describing the overarching paradigm of mission as the display of the glory of God in the world, Voetius incorporates in his understanding of mission, not only the conversion of the pagans and the planting of new churches which were primary, but additionally considers the display of the glory of God. This includes: (1) renewal of

churches who had retrogressed theologically; (2) encouraging churches oppressed by persecution; (3) supporting impoverished churches; and, (4) cultivating unity among the local churches (Bosch 1997:257).

Among the best-known books on the theology of mission is Johan H. Bavinck's *An Introduction to the Science of Missions*. With regard to the aim of mission, Bavinck affirms that the priority is God's glory: "The glory of God is repeatedly referred to in Scripture as the ultimate purpose" (1960:156). Bavinck draws mainly from Voetius without making any excuses because, he argues, the threefold purpose of mission, "the conversion of the heathen, the establishment of the church, and the glorification and manifestation of divine grace," speak to us in succeeding generations. "There is something in this description that directly speaks to us and we have no objection to borrowing it" (1960:155). Building on Voetius's thought, Bavinck writes:

> There are not three separate purposes, but one great exalted purpose, that is disclosed to us in three blessings, of which the glorification of God is undoubtedly foremost, the establishment of his church second, and the conversion of the heathen third (1960:155).

What about the enlightenment era and the glory of God? Modernism has been defined as "any attempt by modern men and women to become subjects as well as objects of modernization, to get a grip on the modern world and make themselves at home in it" (Berman 1982:5). In modernity, man becomes the subject, rather than God, and similarly, initiative switches from God to man. "A central creed of the Enlightenment, therefore, was faith in humankind. . . . The dominant characteristic of the modern era is its radical anthropocentrism. . . . In a thoroughly anthropocentric world there was no room left for

God. . . . [R]eason became supremely important also in Christian theology" (Bosch 1997:267-269).

The motif of the glory of God prevails during the period of the awakenings, but begins to be wedded to other motifs such as compassion, and gradually moves to a silent background motif throughout the eighteenth century. But the Enlightenment had moved homo sapiens to center stage. "Even in Christian circles, human needs and aspirations, although originally couched in purely religious terms, began to take precedence over God's glory" (Bosch 1997:286).

Still the manifestation of God's glory as a motif for mission continues and begins to rise up once again in the early twentieth century. From the time of the Reformation, when the first theologically renewed Christian thinkers concern themselves with the theology of mission, up to the present day, God's glory as a mission meta-theme has prevailed, and has been given more missiological prominence in some periods than others.

The Biblical Assertion of God's Glory as a Motif for Mission

Prominent among Scriptural themes related to the mission of God through his people is the glory of God. Through each phase of God's mission in biblical history, the meta-theme of God's glory emerges again and again. In *Announcing the Kingdom,* Arthur F. Glasser and his colleagues describe the story of God's mission throughout the Scriptures in six parts, each representing a biblical era: God's mission in the beginning, then through the Patriarchs, through Israel, among the Nations, through Jesus Christ, and through the Holy Spirit by the church (Glasser, Van Engen, Gilliland, and Redford

2001:5-8). Since these are helpful divisions of biblical history, they will also be addressed here, but in a different order. The word "glory" appears more than eighty times in *Announcing the Kingdom,* appropriately reminding the reader that God's mission is always linked to God's glory.

God's Mission through Israel

The first occurrence in the Bible of the word "glory" appears in Exodus 14:4. By this time the redemption of God's people has been secured. The glory of the Lord is hinted at in the metaphorical and supernatural childbirth of the people of God. Supernatural growth has taken place in the womb of their mother, growing from seventy souls to more than one million people over 430 years. It requires supernatural preservation followed by supernatural travail in that there is a reluctant mother—Egypt—resisting delivery. Following the final birth pang, the first overt mention of the glory of the Lord occurs in relation to the supernatural protection of a naked child in the grips of a merciless mother, who wants to destroy him (Ex. 14:4). Indeed, the glory of the Lord is displayed in the miraculous passage through the birth canal of the Red Sea. Glory, shaped as a luminous cloud, leads the people through the wilderness (Ex. 16:7, 10). The cloud rests on Mt. Sinai, where Moses sees God's glory (Ex. 24:15-18). Even the Israelites cannot look steadily at the face of Moses for a while, because of the glory of his countenance after he came down from the mountain (2 Co. 3:7).

The glory of the Lord fills the tabernacle (Ex. 40:34-35) and appears especially at the hour of sacrifice (Lev. 9:6, 23). After the temple of Solomon was built, the priests cannot perform their service because of the cloud, for the glory of the Lord fills his

temple (1 Kg. 9:11). The historical books of the Bible tell of the temple becoming the place where the glory of the Lord was to be located (2 Ch. 7:1-3). There is nothing in the ark except the two stone tablets that Moses had placed there at Horeb, where the Lord made a covenant with the Israelites after they came out of Egypt. The glory was the presence and the power of the character of God being manifested. God's specifically articulated mission through the nation Israel is that they "declare his glory among the nations, his marvelous deeds among all peoples" (1 Ch. 16:24 and again in Ps. 96:3).

God's Mission among the Nations

Even in other nations, the glory of the Lord is revealed, as it is time and again to Ezekiel beside the River Kebar while in exile (Eze. 3:23). God makes clear that his mission is to display his glory among the nations (Eze. 39:21). God would even gain glory within Sidon (Eze. 28:22). The mission of God among the nations is clearly announced to be the declaration of his glory among all peoples (1 Ch. 16:24; Ps. 96:3).

God's Mission through Jesus the Christ

Nowhere is the reality and the splendor of God's presence and his character seen as in his Son. "We beheld his glory, the glory as of the only Son of the Father, full of grace and truth" (Jn. 1:14). Through him and through his presence, God's glory is to fill the earth. The glory of God is seen by the shepherds at the birth of Christ (Lk. 2:9). During his incarnate life, it is revealed in his miracles (Jn. 2:11), at his transfiguration (Mt. 17:1-8; Mk. 9:2-8; Lk. 9:28-36), and at the cross (Jn. 17:4).

God's Mission through the Church

The glory of God in the face of Jesus Christ is seen and reflected by the church (2 Co. 4:3-6). It is the glory of the new covenant (2 Co. 3:7-11), and it is shared both now (1 Pe. 4:14) and hereafter (Rom. 8:18) by those who suffer with Christ. The object of the church is to see that the world acknowledges the glory which is God's (Rom. 15:9) and is shown in his disciples (1 Co. 6:20).

God's mission is consistent throughout biblical history from the time of his redeeming his people from Egypt. God demonstrates his glory among his people, so that they might demonstrate and declare his glory among all the peoples of the earth, telling of the wonderful deeds he has done.

The Significance of the Word "Glory" as Used in the Scriptures

Though many have written on δοξα, an authoritative history still appears to be wanting. "In English, glory is one of the few words that can stand for all that the word heaven represents" (Ramm 1963:9). The English word "gravity" approximates the semantic range of the Hebrew *kavod,* signifying both weight and importance, but is missing the dimension of splendor. For the Greek word, I submit that there is an interchangeability with the name Jesus Christ, for all of Christ is in δοξα and all of δοξα is in Christ.

The word glory appears 295 times in the *New International Version of the Bible* (NIV), 165 times in the Old Testament and 130 times in the New Testament. The phrase "the glory of the Lord" appears thirty-six times in the NIV. The phrase "the glory of God" appears fifteen times. The word "glory" and its Hebraic derivatives appear in the

Scriptures in six clusters of concentration, four in the Old Testament and two in the New Testament. It is especially prominent in Psalms (forty-three for the English word "glory" in sixty-four occurrences in Hebraic forms) and Isaiah (thirty-two in English and sixty-three in Hebrew), as well as in Exodus (thirteen in English, thirty-three in Hebrew), and Ezekiel (twenty-one in English and twenty-five in Hebrew). In the 130 English usages in the New Testament, the English word appears 100 times in two clusters, in the Gospels forty-two times, and in Paul's Epistles fifty-eight times.

The Word "Glory" in the Old Testament

This root with its derivatives occurs 376 times in the Hebrew Bible. The root is a common Semitic one. The basic meaning is "to be heavy, weighty," a meaning which is rarely used literally, as in 1 Samuel 4:18, "Eli was heavy," and 2 Samuel 14:26, "Absalom's hair was heavy." From the frequent figurative usage, it is an easy step to the concept of a "weighty" person in society, someone who is honorable, impressive, worthy of respect. This latter usage is prevalent in more than one-half of the occurrences (Harris, Archer, and Waltke 1980).

The most frequent Hebrew word from which the English word "glory" translates is *kavod*, denoting glory, honor. It literally means weight, hence Paul's mention of the "eternal weight of glory" (in 2 Co. 4:17) (Vine 1981). It has the root sense of something weighty which gives importance, as for example, wealth (Gen. 13:2, 31:1) or honor (Gen. 45:13). In relation to God, *kavod* denotes that which makes God impressive. Since God is invisible, it necessarily carries a reference to his self-manifestation. This may be in natural phenomena, such as thunder (Ex. 20:18, 1 Sa. 7:10); lightning (Ex. 19:16, 2 Sa.

22:15, Eze. 1:13-14). Psalm 19 makes it plain that God's *kavod* belongs to the higher regions of heaven. Yet, if God dwells in heaven, he comes down to the tent of meeting. Thus, in Exodus 40:34, a cloud covers the tent and God's *kavod* fills its interior as a kind of radiant substance from which emanates the fire that consumes the sacrifice. In Exodus 24:15, God's *kavod* is also like a devouring fire on the mountain, and Moses' face is radiant after speaking with God (Kittel and Friedrich 1985).

Charles A. Driver and Samuel L. Briggs emphasize the Old Testament usage in historic theophanies: "to Moses; the sacred tent was sanctified by the Glory; when the ark was captured, the Glory went into exile from Israel." The glory of God would appear:

> Yahweh's name is a name of glory; his eyes of glory; in the temple his glory is seen. . . . His glory will be revealed in a march through the wilderness to the holy land; the land will see it, shine with it, and it will dwell in the land; it will be to the reward of Israel; it will arise and be seen upon Jerusalem; Yahweh will be the glory in the midst of her; the temple will be filled with it; the earth will be filled with a knowledge of it, and with it; it will be declared among the nations and all will see it and people and kings revere it (Whitaker 1997).

The New Testament and the Word "Glory"

In the New Testament, the word "glory," translated from the Greek word δοξα, for the most part denotes divine and heavenly radiance, the loftiness and majesty of God (Kittel and Friedrich 1985). In the *Greek-English Lexicon of the New Testament,* the authors (Bauer, Gingrich, and Danker 1979) suggest three distinct, yet related, nuances with the semantic range of the noun δοξα. The first is brightness*,* splendor, radiance as in Acts 22:11: "I could not see because of the brightness (δοξα) . . . of the light." The

second meaning of δοξα is magnificence, anything that catches the eye of a king (Mt. 6:29). The third usage is fame, renown, honor or good reputation (as in 1 Th. 2:20).

The Meaning of the Phrase "the Glory of the Lord Filling the Earth"

On the one hand, those who speak of God's glory filling the earth refer to that reputation for greatness which God alone deserves, not only because of his natural power position as king, but because of his unsurpassed power activity as deliverer of the Savior. However, it is not merely God's reputation which fills the earth, but it is the very reality of his presence. And his desire is that all persons may gladly recognize and experience this, resulting in peace in all its fullness. His first step toward the achievement of these goals was to fill the tabernacle with his presence and then the temple (Harris, Archer, and Waltke 1980). Repeatedly, the Scriptures reiterate the vision, mission, and anticipation of when the whole world is filled with the power, the presence, and the peace of the Lord.

Summary of the Biblical Significance of "the Glory of God"

In summary, the biblical phrase "glory of God" signifies his self-revealed being and character, as for example, Exodus 33:17-23 and Isaiah 6:3, with emphasis on the power, presence, and peace (Shalom-Salaam) of God. In the six biblical clusters of usage of the term "glory" and its Hebrew derivatives, the term draws attention to the meteorological phenomenon, as in the Psalmic cluster, drawing attention to his awesome and unstoppable power. In the glory clusters in Exodus, Ezekiel and the gospels, glory spotlights his presence, as for example, Ezekiel 1:28 and 11:23 and in the tabernacular

occurrences of Exodus, following the appearances in the cloud over Mt. Sinai. The rabbinical expression *shekinah glory* emphasizes the presence of God in the midst of his people. "The *shekinah* was the visible majesty of the divine presence, especially when dwelling between the Cherubim in the tabernacle and Temple in the midst of God's people" (Ramm 1963:13). The most explicit presential glory passages occur in and around the person of Jesus Christ and the focal moments of his incarnational journey. The Pauline glory cluster emphasizes the peace through glorification in the life of believers, not as a peace devoid of conflict, but peace as harmony with themselves and their surroundings, pointing toward the harmony of life in a glorified creation.

The Glory of God as the Integrating Idea/ Meta-Theme for Mission

While missiologists may disagree on many issues related to mission, there is one point upon which they do agree, and that is the need for a unifying idea. An integrating idea may, however, be either too broad or too narrow. "In selecting only certain themes as threads out of both the biblical tapestry and the contextual worldview, we may narrow the gospel too much" (Van Engen 2001b:107). According to many respected missiologists, Jesus Christ is the integrating idea. "Jesus Christ must be at the center of all the domains of missiology, because the church's mission is the mission of Jesus Christ" (2001a).

We have looked at the glory of God as a unifying paradigm for mission and world evangelization, and now we see that Christ and δοξα are inextricably intertwined. All the New Testament authors connect Christ with δοξα. Δοξα is found *In Christi* and *In*

Christi is found δοξα. Justifiably, Carey Newman, following a number of New Testament exegetes concludes that δοξα is a Christological term (1992:6).

Jesus Christ possesses a pre-incarnate glory (Jn. 17:5). At the time of his incarnation, he is the radiance of the glory of God (Heb. 1:3). Christ reveals the glory of God in his earthly life. Jesus comes to earth full of grace and truth. People like John behold his glory (Jn. 1:14). His first miracle at Cana is the first display of his glory (Jn. 2:11). His complete dedication to glorifying God is seen in the healing of the woman bent over for eighteen years. All the people rejoice in the glorious things done by him (Lk. 13:17). Peter and John witness the Messianic glory in the transfiguration (Mt. 16:27-17:8). The cross is the special hour for the glorification of Christ (Jn. 12:27). At the resurrection of Christ his body is changed into a glorious body (Phil. 3:21). The glory of Christ is visible in his ascension (1 Ti. 3:16). He is coming back in glory (Rev. 1:7). He possesses eternal glory in ages to come (Jn. 17:5, 24; Rev. 5:9, 13).

Paul refers to Christ as "the Lord of Glory" (1 Co. 2:8). Jesus reveals and mediates glory. The knowledge of glory is discovered in Jesus (2 Co. 4:6). The saving deeds of Jesus make known the mystery of glory (Rom. 9:23). After studying the semantic references to glory in Paul, Newman concludes that δοξα is a semantic substitute for Christ (1992:163).

It is safe to conclude that in identifying the glory of God as an integrating idea, the centrality of Jesus Christ is retained as the unifying principle. We can now contemplate tripartite doxological unity of purpose—in Scripture, in history, and in mission.

The Glory of God as Missio Dei

Charles E. Van Engen summarizes the relationships within the missio-cluster set of Latin missiological terms. It includes the following:

> So one finds mission theologians asking about God's mission (*missio Dei)*, mission as it occurs among humans and utilizes human instrumentality (*missio hominum*), missions as they take many forms through the endeavors of the churches (*missiones ecclesiarum*), and mission as it draws from and impacts global human civilization (*missio politica oecumenica*) (1996:27).

Because of the foundational role in this paradigm-set of *missio Dei*, there are important insights to be learned from its meaning and history. Because mission has its origin in the heart of God, understanding *missio Dei* helps to understand the heart of God for the world. Mission exists because God exists. God's love for man results in *missio Dei*. "Mission has its origin in the fatherly heart of God. He is the fountain of sending love" (Bosch 1980:240). Recognition of *missio Dei* has opened the way to studies of mission motifs in Scripture which establish biblical foundations for mission that do not depend merely on the Great Commission passages but on the thrust of Scripture as a whole. These studies have led to reflect on the glory of God as *missio Dei*.

The phrase *missio Dei* was introduced at the Fifth International Missionary Council, held in Willingen, Germany, in July 1952, to underscore the fact that the missionary movement has its source in the Triune God.[1] The concept of *missio Dei* was developed in relation to the motive for mission and popularized by George Vicedom (Scherer and Bevans 1992:86). We include observations made by Vicedom, as follows:

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[1] "God is the Lord, the One who gives the orders, the Owner, the One Who takes care of things. He is the Protagonist in the mission" (Vicedom 1965:5). In this sense the whole of "redemptive history"

> The mission is not only obedience to a word of the Lord, it is not only the commitment to the gathering of the congregation; it is participation in the sending of the Son, in the *missio Dei*, with the inclusive aim of establishing the lordship of Christ over the whole redeemed creation (1965:5).

"It follows then that the goal of *missio Dei* is to incorporate people into the Kingdom of God and to involve them in his mission. Because the Father is the Sender, Jesus Christ the One who is sent, and the Holy Spirit the Revealer, it follows that noninvolvement in mission on the part of the Church is to be deplored" (Glasser, Van Engen, Gilliland, and Redford 2001:365). Every Christian believer is called to become an active participant in *missio Dei*. This calling is described as follows:

> As the new people of God, the church continues that unfulfilled commission which once had been given to Israel, the people of God's covenant, after their liberation out of the Egyptian bondage; they are called to be a "kingdom of priests and a holy nation" (Exod 19:6; 1 Pet 2:9). To become a member of this new elected people means to receive a share in God's eschatological heritage and to be joined in a vital fellowship with the heavenly head of his church through the Holy Spirit. It also makes us participants in the ongoing *missio Dei,* in which the Father sends his Son, then the Holy Spirit and the spirit-filled church. Christians are the chosen race (1 Pet 2:9). As witnesses we are called to declare "the wonderful deeds of him who called them out of darkness into his marvelous light" (Beyerhaus 1996).[2]

Vicedom (1965) engaged in the first major study of the concept of *missio Dei* since Gustav Warneck's (1965:vii). He observed some of the major implications of *missio Dei*. "The mission is work that belongs to the Lord . . . God is the Lord, the One who gives. God is not only the Sender but, at the same time, He is the one who is sent"

(Heilsgeschichte) is a history of *missio Dei*—God's redemptive purpose for the nations (Glasser, Van Engen, Gilliland, and Redford 2001:365).

[2] This article is a slightly edited version of the colloquium address on religious pluralism that Beyerhaus gave at Trinity Evangelical Divinity School in June of 1996.

(1965:7). Third, "the privilege, full authority, commission, and obligation of the mission always flows from the activity of the triune God Himself" (1965:11). However, there were serious interpretive concerns about using *missio Dei* that are treated in Appendix B.

Personal Implications of a Paradigm of God's Glory

The Scriptures make clear that the God of glory fully intends to share that glory with his children. The pathway for a child of God is to go from total corruption to total glorification. Every human being has fallen short of the glory of God (Rom. 3:23). "The god of this age has blinded the minds of unbelievers, so that they cannot see the light of the gospel of the glory of Christ" (2 Co. 4:4).

In his goodness God makes the riches of his glory known to the objects of his mercy from the nations of the world. These people he prepares in advance for glory (Rom. 9:23). God "made his light shine in our hearts to give us the light of the knowledge of the glory of God in the face of Christ" (2 Co. 4:6). God calls people "into his kingdom and glory" (1 Th. 2:12).

In and through Christ, God brings "many sons to glory" (He. 2:10). Incorporation into Christ transfers glory to the believer. In salvation, God calls the believer to glory (1 Th. 2:12). Paul defines the goal of salvation as obtaining the glory of the exalted Christ. "Those he justified he also glorified" (Rom. 8:30).

"Now if we are children, then we are heirs—heirs of God and co-heirs with Christ" (Rom. 8:17). Peter writes as one "who also will share in the glory to be revealed (1 Pe. 5:1). But sharing in Christ's glory is conditional. We are "co-heirs with Christ if

indeed we share in his sufferings in order that we may also share in his glory" (Rom. 8:17). The journey to glory inevitably includes suffering. However, when held in the balance, the suffering does not compare to the future glory that will be revealed in God's people (Rom. 8:18). And so Peter makes clear when he writes that the God of all grace calls "you to his eternal glory in Christ, after you have suffered a little while" (1 Pe. 5:10). Our present troubles are comparatively minor and short-lived when we realize that they "are achieving for us an eternal glory that far outweighs them all" (2 Co. 4:17). Glory and eternal life await those who seek God's glory (Rom. 2:7-10). We "will appear with him in glory" (Co. 3:3).

God's children are designed to be like him. We are being transformed into his likeness with ever-increasing glory. Paul characterizes the pneumatic life of transformation in the resurrection likeness of Christ as a metamorphosis of glory. We are called to reflect the Lord's glory (2 Co. 3:18). God enables and sustains transformational progress by the glory of Christ (Eph. 3:16). Then at the coming of Jesus, God will culminate our transformation by conforming the believer's earthly body to Christ's resurrection body of glory. He will "transform our lowly bodies so that they will be like his glorious body" (Phil. 3:21).

Our mission then is to do everything for the glory of God (1 Co. 10:31). Yet, even this doing is from him, for it is Christ in you that is the hope of glory (Co. 1:27). We are to fill the world with the glory of God "so that the grace that is reaching more and more people may cause thanksgiving to overflow to the glory of God" (2 Co. 4:15). And so it

will be that "the crown in which we will glory in the presence of our Lord Jesus when he comes? Is it not you? Indeed, you are our glory and joy" (1 Th. 2:19-20).

Then one day we, the church, as the bride of Christ, dressed in fine linen, which are the righteous acts in our mission, will say: "Let us rejoice and be glad and give him glory! For the wedding of the Lamb has come, and his bride has made herself ready" (Rev. 19:7-9).

Conclusion

Looking through the lenses of church history, theologians and missiologists, biblical, theological, lexical, biblical leaders, personal implications, and, a unifying idea or theme emerges. On the basis of this process, the unifying paradigm of the glory of God can be established.

However, many questions remain for further and fuller reflection. How is God's glory reflected in and promoted by mission? How does the missionary paradigm of God's glory impact, not only the motif of mission, but also the motives for doing mission? Is it God's glory to gather and enfold people, embracing them in his love? Is it God's glory to send messengers?

We believe that all of these questions may be answered positively and that biblical support for doing so is readily available. However, time and space limitations preclude further expansion of this reflection at this time.

Other questions of greater complexity may be fruitful subjects for future research and consideration. What are the practical missiological implications of the glory of God in a mission paradigm? What are the principles that can be identified from Scripture, and

particularly the book of Ezekiel, as they relate to the transformation of the city and the glory of God motif as a model for urban mission in the twenty-first century? How does the unifying paradigm of the glory of God stand up against the conceptual frameworks of (a) Christ's Great Commission mandates of mission, (b) missiologically conceived paradigms of mission related to each era of human history, (c) the mission-cluster framework, and (d) the integrative ongoing reflective framework? How does the mission meta-theme of the glory of God fit in the twenty-first century post-modernizing world? What are Christian leaders from around the world saying about the primary issues in their countries and about a unifying paradigm that would fit their context? How does the rapidly growing Pentecostal and Charismatic stream of the church think regarding future mission (see Appendix D)?

CHAPTER 3

THE CATALYTIC MEANS—RENEWAL

We live in a world of seemingly boundless turmoil as a result of globalization and the rapid transition from modernity to postmodernity at the outset of the twenty-first century. One reason for hope in the face of so many shifting geopolitical realities lies in the ongoing stream of the Holy Spirit at work through God's people in cities and cultures all over the world. This personal and corporate work of the Spirit is the catalytic means to world evangelization. Every major advance in world evangelization traces its roots to a spiritual awakening. (Because of the similarity of meaning, the terms "renewal," "revival," "awakening," and "evangelical awakening" are used interchangeably in this paper). To the degree that this missional principle—authentic mission from genuine renewal—is discerned, the realization of the need to surrender completely to the Holy Spirit in seeking to be renewed, both as individuals and corporately, and then stepping out boldly to engage in mission will be enhanced.

The purpose of this chapter is to understand and demonstrate the catalytic impetus for world evangelization that comes from an authentic movement of renewal as the means. This chapter introduces the proposition that the means for the advance of the Christian movement across cultural, social, racial and geographic barriers proceeds from authentic renewal and that a primary result of major renewal is increased mission and

social action. Renewal always comes toward the glory of God (Chapter 2). It displays the peace, the power and the presence of God.

As Jonathan Edwards indicates in his *A History of the Work of Redemption* (1839), God's kingdom is like an expanding circle of light in the world's darkness, alternately drawing inward in periods of decline and pulsing outward in an increasing circumference. Each of the successfully larger outward pulses is accompanied by a new outpouring of the Holy Spirit (Lovelace 1979:69). The potential, should there be a collective "aha" of God's people in renewal worldwide, is for a global wave of Christian advance, with the whole church taking the whole gospel to the whole world.

A Theoretical Framework

Renewal is the work of God that will result in a fresh outburst of Christian movements and new vitality and expansion in the church. "Authentic renewal will combine a return to the theological roots of the church in Scripture with missionary engagement of its culture" (Shenk 1997:154). Sometimes there appear to be logical causes underlying a fresh outburst of vitality. But many times it is inexplicable—except to say that God works in the heart of some key individual through whose influence renewal springs forth (Pierson 2001).

The surges of the Christian movement at and since Pentecost have been directly associated with times of spiritual refreshing and awakening in the church. Conversely, the long gaps in the advance of the Christian movement can be traced to spiritually stagnant periods. Symptoms of stagnation and decline of the Christian movement in the West

today, become alarming, not so much because of declining membership and sagging contributions, but rather, as Shenk observes:

> Genuine renewal is concerned with something more fundamental: Renewal becomes a priority concern when the church has ceased to engage its culture missionally so that its presence in society no longer incites people into a reconciled relationship with God or witnesses against injustice and unrighteousness (1997:154).

Genuine spiritual renewal looks beyond self to God and his purposes, which will include mission to the world. Out of the renewal experience, the church should hear the call of God asking, "Whom shall I send? And who will go for us?" as Isaiah did, and spontaneously respond, "Here am I. Send me!" (Isa. 6:8). Isaiah 6 depicts the classic order of renewal movements. As men and woman go deeper in their life with God they realize who they are and they begin to hear the voice of God sending them out into the world. Particularly, they will become aware of the unfinished nature of the task assigned by Jesus to his followers as his last instructions on earth (Mt. 28).

Richard F. Lovelace seeks to identify the main streams of spiritual vitality that have flowed through the church's history to determine the principles which govern renewal (1979:11-12). He follows the Pietists and Edwards closely in his book on the dynamics of spiritual life, in which he emphasizes the primary importance of interior spiritual development that rightfully leads to responsible engagement with society and culture (1979:17). He describes the elements of exterior spiritual development and responsible engagement with society and culture as secondary, which I take to refer to the sequential causative result of renewal (see Table 1).

Further, in his reflection on interior spiritual development throughout the history of church renewal, Lovelace sees that the essential elements of renewal are inextricably linked with the realization of a believer's union with Christ. Lovelace asserts that the primary elements of renewal flow directly out of our union with Christ. There are two results of our union with Christ in his death and resurrection, which stand immediately as critically important elements in the history of the church renewal: justification and sanctification. We have seen that most of the major historical awakenings have involved among their central catalysts a balanced proclamation of justification by faith and the necessity of progressive sanctification (1979:74).

As a result of our union with Christ, in addition to the benefits of (1) justification: you are accepted and (2) sanctification: you are free from the bondage of sin, Lovelace adds two more primary elements of renewal, (3) the indwelling Spirit: you are not alone, and (4) authority in spiritual conflict: you have authority. Beyond the primary elements of renewal, Lovelace identifies and develops the secondary elements of renewal as well as preconditions for renewal, as in Table 1.

Lovelace relates renewal to mission as the fifth element following justification, sanctification, the indwelling Spirit, and authority in spiritual conflict. He distinguishes the first elements of renewal as depth presentation of the gospel and the secondary elements of renewal as the outworking of the gospel in church life. However, in relegating mission to a category called secondary elements of renewal, he risks being misunderstood in suggesting that the former is more important than the latter. In my view, he is making the point that renewal needs to happen within the believers before it

can work itself out in action. Thus, he emphasizes the sequence, but not the significance, of the mission in his categorization of the characteristics of renewal.

TABLE 1

BIBLICAL MODELS OF CYCLICAL RENEWAL
(Lovelace 1979:75)

I. Preconditions of Renewal: Preparation for the Gospel

A. Awareness of the holiness of God—his justice; his love
B. Awareness of the depth of sin—in your own life; in your own community

II. Primary Elements of Renewal: Depth Presentation of the Gospel

A Justification: You are accepted—in Christ
B. Sanctification: You are free from bondage to sin—in Christ
C. The Indwelling Spirit: You are not alone—in Christ
D. Authority in Spiritual Conflict: You have authority—in Christ

III. Secondary Elements of Renewal: Outworking of the Gospel in the Church's Life

A. Mission: following Christ into the world presenting the gospel—in proclamation; in social demonstration
B. Prayer: expressing dependence on the power of his Spirit—individually; corporately
C. Community: being in union with his Body—in microcommunities; in macrocommunities
D. Disenculturation: being freed from cultural binds—destructive and protective
E. Theological integration: having the mind of Christ—toward revealed truth; toward your culture

John David Tanner (2000) demonstrates the inherent linkage between renewal and mission to the world. He identifies the primary characteristics of revival as follows:

1. Phenomena of the Day of Pentecost

2. Results of outpouring of the Holy Spirit, new life produced
3. Focus on the church, brings the church back to life
4. Christians discover new dimensions of reality in their walk with God
5. As the church experiences new life, it has great impact on the world through prayer, preaching, and witnessing
6. A revived church has social impact, society is transformed, the helpless and oppressed are liberated. There are visible works of mercy
7. The church is empowered to reach across the world

"Jonathan Edwards's criteria on renewal remain the classical treatment and are still the best for identifying genuine movement of renewal" (Packer 1990:37). According to Edwards, an authentic spiritual awakening does the following:

1. Exalts Jesus Christ
2. Attacks the kingdom of darkness
3. Honors the Scriptures
4. Promotes sound doctrine
5. Results in an outpouring of love to God and persons expressed in practical ways (Houston 1996:xviii)

With regard to Edwards's item number 2, "attacks the kingdom of darkness," Lovelace elaborates: "There is another agency battling the light, and spiritual warfare is part of the ebb and flow of the church's experience" (1979:69).

These distinguishing marks of revival can be seen in Table 2. It illustrates the dynamics between spiritual renewal and the affective and cognitive human capacities resulting in missional action:

TABLE 2

JONATHAN EDWARDS' DISTINGUISHING MARKS AND THE DYNAMICS OF SPIRITUAL RENEWAL AND RESULTING ACTION

(Derived from a class handout entitled "Distinguishing Marks of a Campus Revival" [Pierson 2001]).

Revival/Renewal	Affective Feelings/Emotions	Cognitive Knowledge	Behavior Action
Testify to deeper love for God	Experience God's presence more strongly	Understand more about God	Fellowship more with God
Testify to exaltation of Christ	Experience a deeper love for Jesus	Understand more about Jesus	Exalt Christ in worship and life
Evidence more love for others	Feel a deeper love for brothers and sisters in Christ	Decide to build more Christian relationships	Work on building relationships with others
Evidence more love for the Bible/ truth	Experience a deeper love for the truth of the Bible	Decide to study the Bible more	Spend more time in the Bible and walking in the truth
Evidence less love for the world	Feel less desire for worldly pleasure	Decide to stop activities that do not honor Jesus Christ	Reach out in compassionate mission

From the time of Edwards people have struggled to interpret revivals. There has been a concern about excesses and lack of theological depth. Lovelace developed Edwards fivefold criteria as one measure. William G. McLoughlin, a leading historian of modern revival movements, from Charles Finney to Billy Graham, observes that history has not been fair in treating the topic of American revivals because of the bias of writers toward the bizarre (1959:v). The essence of a national revival involves the reformulation of the cultural ethos of society which contains four basic elements: (1) theological

reorientation within the churches; (2) an ecclesiastical conflict associated with this reorientation in which personalities play a large part; (3) a sense of social an spiritual cleavage both within the churches and between the churches and the surrounding world; and, 4) a feeling on the part of those outside the churches that Christianity has a particular relevance to their contemporary culture (1959:7).

McLoughlin's perspective on national revival, especially his fourth point, is affirmed in *The Fourth Great Awakening and the Future of Egalitarianism* (Fogel 2000). The New York Times review asserted: "When a man of Jewish descent and probably an atheist and an economist to boot starts speaking of a maldistribution of spiritual goods and praises Christian churches for their good works, we should pay great attention to his arguments" (NYTBR 2000). The author, Robert W. Fogel, was the winner of the 1993 Nobel Prize in economics. According to Fogel, the United States is in the midst of a consistent cycle of economic, religious, and political movements that have occurred throughout the history of the United States, named Great Awakenings by historians:

> The First Great Awakening, which began in 1730, laid the ideological foundation for the American Revolution. The second, starting in 1800, introduced many daring reforms, including the abolition of slavery. The Third Great Awakening, from 1890 to 1930, emphasized social injustice and launched the welfare state. America's new awakening, which began in the late 1950's, promotes a zealous new movement focused on spiritual rather than material reforms (2000:10).

In essence Fogel corroborates the thesis of this chapter and the understanding of McLoughlin that authentic renewal catalyzes mission. He looks to the nation's past to discover the strong link between cycles of awakenings in American history and attitudes towards poverty, education and social equality. Specifically, he attributes the evangelical awakenings to the evangelical Protestant churches.

Edith Blumhofer, like McLoughlin, is another serious writer on revival. In her introduction to a volume of studies of revivals from different eras and geographical locations, Blumhofer observes that the single essential characteristic of revival emerging from these studies is "that it assumes some sort of decline, whether real or imagined, out of which the faithful are called to new heights of spiritual ardor and commitment" (Blumhofer and Balmer 1993:xii).

Building on the work of J. Edwin Orr, Paul E. Pierson distils seventeen theses on renewal (see Appendix C). The sixteenth thesis is the basic premise for this chapter: "They lead to mission beyond their own social, cultural, and geographical contexts" (Pierson 2001).

The Biblical and Theological Basis

Orr, Lovelace, D. Martyn Lloyd-Jones and Tanner all agree that the events which occurred on the Day of Pentecost were prototypical of the characteristics of revival. To different degrees they suggest that more than merely prototypical these characteristics are normative of renewal:

> Revival is an outpouring of the Spirit of God. It is a kind of repetition of Pentecost. It is the Spirit descending on the people. This needs to be emphasized. We have been told that everyone at regeneration receives the baptism of the Spirit. All he has to do is surrender to what he already has. But revival does not come as a result of surrendering to what he already has. It is the Spirit being poured out on him, descending on him, as happened on the day of Pentecost (Pierson 2001).

According to Orr, the major marks of an evangelical awakening are always some repetition of the phenomena of the Acts of the Apostles (Pierson 2001). He lists the

following eight components from the Day of Pentecost which may be traced through many subsequent revivals:

1. Blessing predicted and soon fulfilled (Ac. 1:8)
2. Extraordinary praying (Upper Room)
3. People filled with the Spirit
4. Preaching with power, accompanied by prophesying, dreams, and visions
5. Mighty conviction when people were "drummed to the earth"
6. Public confession of faith (in baptism)
7. Apostolic teaching, fellowship, communion, prayer
8. No hostile power able to hinder them (Pierson 2001)

Clearly, the revival at Pentecost launched the expansion of the Christian movement into mission engagement in the cultures of the day with abandon, and in doing so establishes an important biblical precedent for the inherent linkage of mission-from-revival.

One of the most convincing evidences of the link between authentic spiritual renewal and mission is the theological matter of the Person of God, the Holy Spirit himself, both his nature and action. Forty-five of the ninety-four references to the Holy Spirit in the Bible—almost fifty percent—are from the Book of Acts. The cited scholars of revival view Pentecost and the Book of Acts as the standard for measuring authentic revival. In the Book of Acts, the Holy Spirit is sent by the Father and the Son to awaken, renew, and revive the church (Ac. 1:2, 5, 8, 16, 2:4, 33, 38, 4:8, 25, 31, 5:3, 32, 6:5, 7:51, 55, 8:15-17, 19, 9:17, 31, 10:38, 44-45, 47, 11:15-16, 24, 13:2, 4, 9, 52, 15:8, 28, 16:2, 19:2, 6, 20:23, 28, 21:11, 28:25).

This internal combustion engine of renewal cannot remain internalized. The Spirit launches the church outward literally to the ends of the earth, as in Acts 1:8: "But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit comes on you; and you will be my witnesses in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the ends of the earth":

> The Holy Spirit, sent by both the Father and the Son, empowers the disciples to proclaim the message by both word and deed (Mark 16:20) and accompanies the church as she discharges her missionary calling. And when the church refuses to heed Christ's command and neglects his orders, it is the work of the Spirit which for a time is thus being frustrated and sabotaged" (Verkuyl 1978:112).

This establishes the theological consistency of the thesis: an inherent linkage exists between renewal and mission because it is the same Holy Spirit. This fuels the renewal engine that expresses itself in outward action.

Beyond the action of the Holy Spirit, the fact that renewal leads to mission occurs because of the very nature of the Holy Spirit. "The general doctrine of the Scriptures on this subject is that the Spirit is the executive of the Godhead. Whatever God does, He does by the Spirit" (Hodge 1997). As God is committed to mission so the Holy Spirit is committed to mission on the basis of the very essence of his being. "The Holy Spirit is the primary agent of mission, and human beings are secondary" (Glasser, Van Engen, and Gililland 2001:389). Since the Holy Spirit serves as the executive of the triune God, he cannot fail in his mission, and since the Holy Spirit by his very nature is the primary agent of mission, rather than the human being, believers in God should yield themselves to God's purposes as his human instruments of mission.

Jonathan Edwards's and the Puritans' understanding about revival is considered by scholars, such as J. I. Packer and church historians such as Pierson, as the classic and

the best treatment. One reason may have been their realization of the role of the Holy Spirit. "Further light on the Puritan revival would come from a study of Puritan theology, in particular its unprecedented interest in and concentration on the ministry of the Holy Spirit" (Packer 1990:48). However, it was the later Pentecostal movement that emphasized most definitively the role of the Holy Spirit.

The Pentecostal and Charismatic Renewal

Pentecostalism is distinguished by its emphasis on an immediate and personal experience of the Holy Spirit and by the urgency of evangelization (see Appendix D). The starting point is not rational discourse about the person and work of the Spirit, but direct personal encounter with the Holy Spirit and the release of the charismata of the Spirit in the life of the believer.

"Pentecostals, for the most part, don't know their own strength. In the last five percent of Christian history, they have become a major global force in Christendom" (Dempster, Klaus, and Petersen 1999:vii). As a Catholic, Edward L. Cleary provides a useful outsider view of Pentecostalism. He pays tribute to Pentecostalism in the process with regard to its impact in Latin America. "In rural areas Pentecostal Christians, who have developed the greatest following among evangelicals in Guatemala and throughout most of Latin America, were quietly and effectively working" (Cleary and Stewart-Gambino 1992:179). The emphasis of Pentecostals on experience and a desire to see the experiences of the first Christians reproduced today has resulted in vigorous missionary activism among Pentecostals (Shenk 2001b).

In a milestone event Pentecostal scholars conferenced in 1996 in San Jose, Costa Rica to hear from one another. The globalization of Pentecostalism emerged as the reflective consensus and a book was published with the presentations of the speakers by that name:

> Although the participants in the movement at the time of its inception at the turn of this century were on the margins of society, the expansion of charismatic experience has now pervaded all parts of world Christianity. Rippling like waves into the various sectors of mainstream Protestant, Roman Catholic and Orthodox faith confessions, the Pentecostal experience of the Spirit has prompted the birth of a neo-Pentecostal movement, a Charismatic Renewal movement, and a Third Wave movement, forming what Karla Poewe has identified as 'a global culture' (Dempster, Klaus, and Petersen 1999:xiii).

The emerging Charismatic movement (see Appendix D) shares notable comparisons to the Puritan spiritual renewal movement, in the following characteristics: (1) sensitivity to the Holy Spirit; (2) pervades all structural forms of the Church without becoming a separate denominational stream; and, (3) results in a powerful new missionary impulse (see Appendix D). It also shares similar experiences with the Pentecostal movement which claims the role of predecessor. Charismatic Christians view themselves as "global culture":

> It is a global culture because it transcends national, ethnic, racial, and class boundaries, but it does not transcend, or rarely transcends, other world religions. It cannot do so because at the core of this global culture is the story of Pentecost: of Jesus, the Christ, who upon his death and resurrection sent his faithful followers the Holy Spirit to comfort, inspire, and empower them (Poewe 1994:xii).

Pentecostalism spills outside the traditional boundaries of evangelicalism in the African Initiated Churches.[1] Their growth to more than fifty-four million in Africa in the year 2000 from 42,000 in 1900 only partially tells the story of their influence as a spiritual force in Africa.

In the last twenty-five years of the century a reshaping of the church has begun to take place as a result of renewal within the worldwide church. This has been due mainly to the rapidly expanding influence of the Pentecostal and Charismatic movement as well as the internationalization of the church with new vision, empowered and vitalized to launch a new global thrust in mission.

The Historical Evidence to 1950

Surges of the Christian movement have been called by different names, but all conceptualize around the idea of a divinely initiated spiritual impulse that renews God's people to reach the world. Church historian Kenneth S. Latourette calls significant advances "pulsations." He writes of "resurgences" of Christianity, while he refers to the periods of stagnation and decline as "recessions." He repeatedly uses the term "recrudescence" in describing a renewed vitality in the Christian movement. "Pulses" involve mission expansion initiatives, birthing from a context of struggle, and eventually gaining acceptance in a flourishing period which scholars call a "renaissance." These resurgences are often followed by recessions, and can be described as follows:

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[1] Various names have been used to describe these movements including African Independent Churches and African Indigenous Churches. See Allan H. Anderson, "Types and Butterflies: African Initiated Churches and European Typologies."

> The pattern of expansion, [Latourette] suggested, had been like seven successive waves of an incoming tide. The crest of each wave was higher than the crest that had preceded it, and the trough of each wave receded less than the one before it. . . . Each advance has carried it further than the one before it. Of the alternating recessions, each has been briefer and less marked than the one which preceded it (Bosch 1997:334).

Consequently, for each of the major pulsations of the Christian movement worldwide, we should be able to recognize a preceding renewal. This demonstrates one more time the inherent flow of mission-from-renewal.

An Assessment of the Division of History by Latourette

Latourette uses certain criteria for discerning the pulsations in the life of Christianity, as reflected in its vigor and its influence on the ongoing history of the race. His threefold criteria for identifying these pulsations are as follows: "the expansion . . . of territory in which Christians are to be found, the new movements issuing from Christianity, and the effect of Christianity as judged from the perspective of mankind as a whole" (1975:xxi). For Latourette, the first pulsation embraced roughly the initial five centuries in which "Christianity won the professed allegiance of the large majority of the population of the Roman Empire." The second epoch, a decline, lasted from 500 to 950 A.D. in which "Christianity suffered the greatest losses which it has ever encountered. Its very existence was threatened" (1975:xxii). Latourette considers 950 to 1350 A.D. to be four centuries of advance (1975:xxiii). But these were the years of the Crusades, which, in my view, should by no means be considered an advance, even based on Latourette's own criteria which include "the effect of Christianity as judged from the perspective of mankind as a whole." Even if the other two criteria of territorial expansion and the

issuing of new Christian movements are true in this horrific epoch, the disgrace of the Crusades must outweigh the other two. The fourth pulsation in Latourette's division of history was one of decline, in which much territory was lost and corruption appeared in the churches (1975:xxiii). Then comes what he calls an "amazing epoch" from 1500 to 1750 A.D., in which a series of awakenings revitalized Christianity (1975:xxiii). The sixth pulsation, from 1750 to 1815, presented a threat to the established church while ushering in new life to Christianity. According to Latourette, the seventh pulsation from 1815 to 1914 constituted the Great Century, in which Christianity spread all over the world (1975:xxiv). Latourette describes the final chapter of his historical review of Christianity from 1914 to 1952 as "vigor amidst the storm" (1975:xxiv).

Philip Schaff introduces his exhaustive survey of Christian history with a helpful consideration on the nature of history, presenting a humanly cumulative, but divinely-oriented view. He sees all human advance as crescendoing towards the general judgment of God:

> History has two sides, a divine and a human. On the part of God, it is his revelation in the order of time (as the creation is his revelation in the order of space), and the successive unfolding of a plan of infinite wisdom, justice, and mercy, looking to his glory and the eternal happiness of mankind. On the part of man, history is the biography of the human race, and the gradual development, both normal and abnormal, of all its physical, intellectual, and moral forces to the final consummation at the general judgment, with its eternal rewards and punishments. The idea of universal history presupposes the Christian idea of the unity of God, and the unity and common destiny of men, and was unknown to ancient Greece and Rome. A view of history which overlooks or undervalues the divine factor starts from deism and consistently runs into atheism; while the opposite view, which overlooks the free agency of man and his moral responsibility and guilt, is essentially fatalistic and pantheistic (1997).

A Proposal for Epochs Based on the Renewal-Mission Connection

My time-line chart which follows shows the development of the Christian movement and draws from both Pierson (2000, 2001) and Latourette (1953, 1975, 1986). It is based on the identifiable surges and resulting epochs of the Christian movement associated with spiritual awakenings and expansions.

As can be observed in Table 3, movements of spiritual awakening precede surges in Christian movements. A drive for a deeper, more authentic Christian life, usually on the part of a small group, leads to spiritual renewal and a broader concern for changing society. A brief review of the first six epochs establishes unequivocally the thesis that the renewal of the church and its subsequent expansion are interlinked.

The Great Beginning—0 to 500 A.D.

This period involved the Roman world. With the coming of the Holy Spirit at Pentecost, the church was born amidst birth pangs of both Jewish and Roman opposition. The spiritual renewal in the Book of Acts became a standard by which all future renewals would be measured. Jesus brought the gospel to the Jews and the world as light breaking through darkness. Stephen's martyrdom impacted the Jews, especially one standing nearby by the name of Saul. Saul became Paul and took the gospel to the Hellenistic Jews and the Gentiles. Later in the period, early monastics sought to live consistent with the gospel, seeking personal renewal. Some became missionaries, like Anthony who went to Egypt, and Patrick, who impacted Ireland.

TABLE 3

A PERSPECTIVE ON THE HISTORICAL DEVELOPMENT OF THE CHRISTIAN MOVEMENT

EPOCHS	HISTORICAL CONTEXT	WORLD EVENTS	CHRISTIAN MOVEMENT	PERSPECTIVE
I. 0 to 500 A.D. Birth pangs—growth	The Roman Empire	70 AD Jerusalem Destroyed 10 Persecutions	Early Church Monasticism Celtic	The Great Beginning
II. 500 to 950 Decline	Barbarian rule Feudalism Muslim Conquest	Vikings	Nestorian Cluny Waldensian Lollards	The Great Recession
III. 950 to 1500 Decline	Emerging Middle Class Nation states Renaissance	Crusades Inquisition	Protestant Catholic Radical Reformations	The Great Ruthless Resurgence, Territorial Advance, Abuse, Corruption
IV. 1500 to 1800 Rebirth and resurgence	Colonialism Rationalism	1517 95 Theses Modern Democracy	Puritanism Pietism Moravianism Methodism	The Great Reformation, Schism, and Expansion
V. 1800 to 1900 Expansion	Technological Progress	Education	Modern Missionary Movement	The Great Century
VI. 1914 to 1950 Vigor	World War I and II	1906 Azusa 1910 Edinburgh	Pentecostal Ecumenical	Great Vigor in the Great Storm
VII. 1950-	Accelerated Change Globalization	Lausanne 74 GCOWE 95	World	Non-Western Church Initiative

The Great Recession—500 to 950 A.D.

The rapid expansion of the church since the time of the early apostles via the Celtic and Nestorian efforts had largely ceased by the end of the first millennium. These

were the darkest years for Christianity. It appeared as if the light of the gospel might be snuffed out. First, Barbarian invasions killed one-third of the clergy. Later, Muslim invaders conquered one-half of the so-called Christian Roman lands in a mere fifty-year period. “The morale of Christian communities declined to their lowest ebb” (Latourette 1975:xxii).

The Great Resurgence (with Great Corruption)—
950 to 1500 A.D.

During this period, papal power reaches its pinnacle. For 200 of these years, crusaders, primarily restless youth called out of the emerging middle class, participated in seven ruthless and violent crusades, expanding the so-called Christian territories, but from that time forward utterly destroying the testimony of Christian compassion. The unquestioned impeccability of the Pope and indulgences and corruption eventually led to the papal captivity, with three people naming themselves the legitimate Pope. But on the periphery of the corrupt institutional church, renewal movements arose, including Clunyite movement which brought reform to monasticism.

In the thirteenth and early fourteenth centuries, like leafy shoots suckering from the earth around a sick parent tree, a number of renewal movements grew up outside the Roman church. Members of these offendingly alive sects were often outlawed and martyred by the established church. Accompanied by Bible reading and memorization, the Waldensians went out as itinerant missionaries disguised as merchants. The Lollards, banned from the official church as early as 1300, experienced renewal in personal salvation, interpreted the Bible through God’s illumination and grace given directly to the

laity, and saw every believer as gifted and empowered to understand the Bible. This personal renewal was again the engine of mission, as they went out two by two. Dipping into the spiritual stream from which the Lollards drank, and in the process defending John Wycliffe, was the Czech, John Huss. Huss refused to bow to the infallibility of a corrupt Pope, as established at the Council of Constance, with the words, "I shall die with joy today in the faith of the gospel which I have preached." He was burned at the stake leaving a trail of believers called Hussites (Schaff 1997).

The Great Reformation and the Great Schism—
1500 to 1800 A.D.

This period involved a global territorial advance. "The Reformation of the sixteenth century is, next to the introduction of Christianity, the greatest event in history" (Schaff 1997). The secular *Time-Life* media consortium ranked the event they titled "Luther Knocks Down the Door" as the third most significant event of the last millennium (*Life* 2000). On October 31, 1517, Martin Luther nailed the *Ninety-Five Theses* to the door of the All Saints Church in Wittenberg, Germany, stressing the inward, spiritual character of the Christian faith and denouncing the various papal policies of selling of forgiveness, salvation, and the like. When asked by the Vatican to recant Luther did not. The profound spiritual awakening of justification by faith alone launched a culturally engaged mission movement that can be traced even now to the remotest corners of the globe at the beginning of this twenty-first century.

Protestant spiritual reform movements following Luther, John Calvin, Huldrych Zwingli, and John Knox advanced the gospel in northern Europe. Meanwhile, leading a

counter-reformation, Ignatius Loyola and the Popes sought to expand, following moral and administrative reform of their institutions, and Jesuits, such as Francis Xavier and Matthew Ricci, advanced the Catholic Christian movement to India, China, and Japan. During this time, Roman Catholic missionaries, with the sword in one hand, and the cross in the other, accompanied Europeans in pursuit of lands to plunder and peoples to conquer, once again spread a corrupted Christianity, this time to the new world, which later became what we know today as Latin America.

In the eighteenth century, the seedbed of the renewal movements of Puritanism, Pietism, Moravianism, and Methodism spawned the modern era of missions. Each of these movements stressed the need for personal conversion, used the Scriptures in personal devotions, and cultivated spiritual renewal in small groups, all of which practices gave a greater role to the laity. The Puritans integrated faith and life, thus improving the quality of family life. The Pietists developed "committed communities" and engaged social need as pioneers of education for the poor, and practical assistance for widows and orphans. The German Moravians sought balance of the Spirit and the Word. Again renewal led to mission overseas. One Moravian missionary shared the gospel with a young Englishman, John Wesley, who was then soundly converted. His personal transformation launched serious renewal disciplines and mission that not only engaged the culture of his day, but ultimately transformed it. Religious freedom, educational institutions, and modern democracy were all fruits of the four creative and related mission-from-renewal movements: Puritanism, Pietism, Moravianism, and Methodism.

The Great Century—1800 to 1900 A.D.

During this hundred-year period, Christianity finally reached around the globe. Following the lead of William Carey, the dawning of the nineteenth century brought an explosion of mission agencies committed to glorify God through evangelism and social work. The first wave of modern missions breached the coastlines of the continents of Africa and Asia. Then, in the second half of the nineteenth century, the faith missions movement began with J. Hudson Taylor and the China Inland Mission, gaining great momentum and peaking in the 1890s. This second wave of modern missions pushed into the interiors of the continents.

But this Great Expansion would not have happened were it not for the Great Awakenings that preceded and energized it. The Great Awakenings of this century took place out of the Puritan spiritual streams which have been described in four phases of approximately thirty years each. George Whitfield, Wesley, and Edwards led the first Great Awakening (1726-1756). The Second Awakening (1776-1810) erupted in camp meetings and on college campuses in North America. The third phase (1813-1846) was led by revivalist evangelists, principally, Charles Finney. The fourth phase (1857-1895) brought global ecumenical and lay prayer revival, with D. L. Moody playing a prime role (Cairns 1986:20-21). Sometimes these awakenings did not give birth immediately to missionary activities but inevitably laid the foundations for them (Bosch 1997:278).

In a classic example of mission stemming from revival, toward the end of the century, Moody joined with his colleague A. T. Pierson to advocate finishing the task by 1900. "I wish by voice and by the aid of the press to set forth a practicable business proposition, namely, that before the year 1900, the gospel shall be preached to every

living soul." By 1885, Moody, A. T. Pierson, and other evangelists, pastors, and missionaries penned a joint declaration, "An Appeal to Disciples Everywhere," in which they announced their strategy. "If but ten millions, out of four hundred millions of nominal Christians, would undertake such systematic labors as such that each one of that number should, in the course of the next fifteen years, reach one hundred other souls with the gospel message, the whole present population of the globe would have heard the good tidings by the year 1900!" (Johnson 1988:15). One of the most serious proposals was offered by Taylor for the country of China, which, by 1900, hosted nearly 1,000 missionaries diffused throughout its regions (1998:36).

Great Vigor in the Great Storm—
1900 to 1950 A.D.

By the end of the first decade of the twentieth century, under the extensive ministry of John R. Mott, "world evangelization in this generation" became a central theme and expectation. This rose to a peak in the great Edinburgh Conference of 1910.

Meanwhile, at a house on Azusa Street in Los Angeles, the poor, disenfranchised, and immigrant met for prayer meetings. On April 9, 1906, several experienced speaking in tongues. Soon they were forced to move to a stable to accommodate the large crowds arriving nightly. This went on virtually every night for three years, led by William Seymour, a black holiness preacher. Out of this spiritual renewal, the Pentecostal Movement exploded with new leaders, including women, empowered by the gifts of the Holy Spirit. These embraced literal Biblicism and an experiential Christianity with a missionary urgency, which during the next century would sweep throughout the world.

However, the drive and optimism of the fifty years leading up to World War I died under a crushing loss of hope as a result of the war. The Great War, as it was known, shattered the illusion that Western culture was Christian, and effectively eliminated the church's witness to the watching world. The resulting emphasis on the social gospel and theological liberalism focused more on social transformation than evangelism.

The Four Major Pulsations from Pentecost to the Present

The huge macro spiritual impulses leading to mission advance, as established in the criteria of Latourette (1953, 1986) from Pentecost to the present, also demonstrate an inherent linkage between authentic spiritual renewal and expansion of the Christian movement. The first, and perhaps the greatest, symbiotically connected mission-from-renewal phase occurred in the first chapter of Christian history from 0 to 500 A.D. The renewal of Pentecost launched the territorial expansion that encompassed the entire Roman world. By the fourth century, Christianity had become the religion of the Empire. Pentecost becomes our prototype for both micro and macro spiritual impulses.

The second macro spiritual impulse in terms of impact occurred when the creative and related renewal movements of Puritanism, Pietism, Moravianism, and Methodism from 1600 to 1800 combined and integrated their distinctive initiatives which became greater than the impact of each of the four movements on their own. Together they became the seedbed for the modern mission movements from 1800 to 1900.

During the eighteenth century, the powerful forces of renewal crossed continents and climaxed in a worldwide evangelical awakening (known in America as the First Great Awakening and the Second Awakening). This great evangelical awakening

launched a perpetual proliferation of missionary societies throughout the church and the world. The stream of mission flowing from Methodism flowed all the way into the twentieth century in Latin America, into a third macro pulsation of mission in what David Martin calls the Methodist/Pentecostal Connection (1990:28). "What Methodism and Pentecostalism clearly share is an emphasis on the availability of grace to all, a millennial hope, and an intense search after 'scriptural holiness'" (1990:28).

The third macro spiritual impulse of mission took place drawing on the spiritual and doctrinal renewal at the beginning of the twentieth century and leading to the Pentecostal/Charismatic global movement. The number of Pentecostals and Charismatics out of this renewal movement at the beginning of the century grew to 524 million worldwide by mid-2000 (Barrett 2001). "Recent historical and sociological studies have advanced the argument that the Pentecostal movement has contributed not only to the redefinition of religion worldwide but also to constructive change in the wider society" (Shenk 2001a). Martin traces the historical genealogy of Puritanism, Methodism, and Pentecostalism. He shows how these religious movements have contributed to the transformation of culture. "As the sacred canopy in Latin America is rent and the all-encompassing system cracks, evangelical Christianity pours in and by its own autonomous native power creates free social space" (1990:280).

The fourth macro spiritual impulse of mission is taking place within the contemporary time-frame. The Two-Thirds world church has emerged as a full partner in mission. Though somewhat early to determine the extent of the impact the contemporary

evidence affirms that this non-Western mission initiative qualifies it to as a macro impulse of mission which is developed in the text that follows.

The Contemporary Evidence

What new forms of renewal/mission have emerged in the last fifty years? Out of the global crises of the Second World War, a new surge in mission took place, with 150 mission agencies formed in just five years, many to provide specialized services to existing general missions through radio, publications, Bible translation, and air travel. In the midst of increasing diversity of issues and movements of church and mission, spiritual renewal advanced as a movement stream, catalyzed from earlier revivalist movements and expressions. This movement fostered a diversity of expressions in mission and the advance of the gospel, and included a massive global prayer movement that crescendoed to the final decade of the millennium. Two significant and fresh spiritual surges emerged, both related to the thesis of mission-from-renewal: the movement to evangelize the distinct ethno-linguistic and cultural peoples of the earth, and the emergence of a Two-Thirds world mission force and influence.

The Peoples of the Earth Evangelized

The modern missionary endeavor may be divided into three phases: the first, directed towards establishing coastal beachheads; the second, permeating the interiors. In the last part of the millennium, a third phase or wave of modern missions emerged focused on the hidden peoples, who had been spiritually bypassed and were yet to be reached with the gospel. The necessity of reaching these peoples was established by the

Great Commission's insistence on all peoples, as well as the Book of Revelation's description of all peoples, languages, and tribes worshipping Christ. The necessity of reaching every distinct ethnic group was recognized to one individual through a personal incident brought the necessity to light.

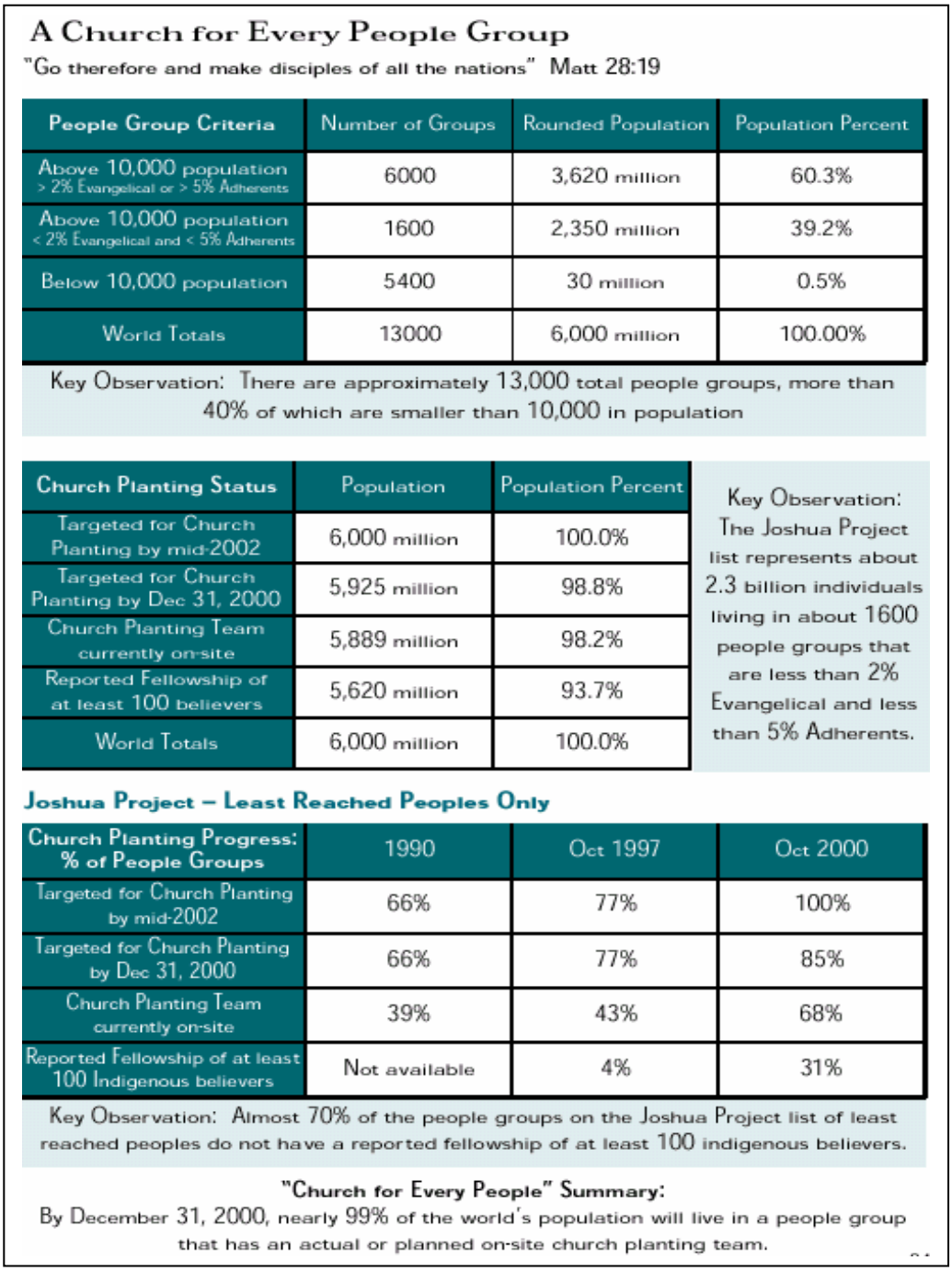
In 1917, William Cameron Townsend was trying to sell Spanish Bibles in Guatemala, when a Cakchiquel-speaking Indian challenged him, saying, "If your God is so smart, why can't he speak our language?" Recognizing the linguistic barrier to the gospel, he answered the Indian's challenge with a Cakchiquel New Testament in 1931. Not long afterwards, Donald A. McGavran, a missionary in India, observed that mass movements to Christ occurred when churches formed and grew within a specific people group. He observed that "most nations are mosaics of distinct people groups, and the great commission requires disciple-making in each piece of the mosaic—*panta ta ethne*." With this concept he pioneered the missiological understanding of unreached peoples, and thus the Church Growth Movement was launched (McGavran 1981:167). It was at the influential International Congress on World Evangelization in Lausanne, Switzerland, in 1974, that Ralph D. Winter argued that, since churches normally grow within the limits of a given ethnic-language group, and that an estimated one-half of the world's population were locked away from the gospel by cultural barriers, the highest priority is cross-cultural evangelism. He became an early proponent for the vision of a church for every people by the year 2000 and popularized the concept in the last twenty-five years of the century. In the final ten years of the century, the AD2000 and Beyond Movement undertook the mission of a church for every people and the gospel for every person by the

year 2000, bringing people together in new coalitions and networks to seek to fulfill that marvelous vision. Significant progress was made in the collection and distribution of information, mobilization of prayer, networking, specific people partnerships, church adoptions of unreached peoples, and subsequent documentation of the results. Figure 1 reflects the progress in the last fifty years and the status of a church for every people.

Where did the spiritual initiative come for this final decadal initiative as given in Mathew 28 and Mark 16? One catalytic structure that contributed significantly was the global symbiotic coalition of churches and missions came together in 1995 from 186 countries of the world at the Global Conference on World Evangelization (GCOWE '95) in Seoul, Korea, in which Patrick Johnstone called "the most global, focused movement for world evangelization that there ever has been . . . the effects will impact the 21st Century" (Johnstone and Mandryk 2001:6). The final statistical compilation of the progress of the gospel towards remaining unreached peoples, as published by AD2000, is reflected in Figure 1.

The Two-Thirds World Church Emerges as a Full Partner in Mission

In the last quarter century of the millennium, evidences of a genuine work of the Spirit of God have been discerned in many parts of the world, especially in Africa, Asia, and Latin America among ethnic peoples in which the gospel entered for the very first time only recently. This world awakening has led to a major embracing of the task of the Great Commission with such enthusiasm from Africa, Asia and Latin America.



A Church for Every People Group

"Go therefore and make disciples of all the nations" Matt 28:19

People Group Criteria	Number of Groups	Rounded Population	Population Percent
Above 10,000 population > 2% Evangelical or > 5% Adherents	6000	3,620 million	60.3%
Above 10,000 population < 2% Evangelical and < 5% Adherents	1600	2,350 million	39.2%
Below 10,000 population	5400	30 million	0.5%
World Totals	13000	6,000 million	100.00%

Key Observation: There are approximately 13,000 total people groups, more than 40% of which are smaller than 10,000 in population

Church Planting Status	Population	Population Percent
Targeted for Church Planting by mid-2002	6,000 million	100.0%
Targeted for Church Planting by Dec 31, 2000	5,925 million	98.8%
Church Planting Team currently on-site	5,889 million	98.2%
Reported Fellowship of at least 100 believers	5,620 million	93.7%
World Totals	6,000 million	100.0%

Key Observation: The Joshua Project list represents about 2.3 billion individuals living in about 1600 people groups that are less than 2% Evangelical and less than 5% Adherents.

Joshua Project – Least Reached Peoples Only

Church Planting Progress: % of People Groups	1990	Oct 1997	Oct 2000
Targeted for Church Planting by mid-2002	66%	77%	100%
Targeted for Church Planting by Dec 31, 2000	66%	77%	85%
Church Planting Team currently on-site	39%	43%	68%
Reported Fellowship of at least 100 Indigenous believers	Not available	4%	31%

Key Observation: Almost 70% of the people groups on the Joshua Project list of least reached peoples do not have a reported fellowship of at least 100 indigenous believers.

"Church for Every People" Summary:

By December 31, 2000, nearly 99% of the world's population will live in a people group that has an actual or planned on-site church planting team.

FIGURE 1

THE CHURCH FOR EVERY PEOPLE
(Scribner 2000:34-35)

More missionaries are sent today from among the peoples of the Two-Thirds world than from among Western peoples. Never have so many people from so many cultures gone to so many different contexts.

In the most recent decade, birthed out of the spiritual harvest in Asia, Africa, and Latin America, a global evangelical coalition resulted in the expansion of the Christian movement into most of the largest linguistically distinct peoples throughout the earth. From a regional church based almost exclusively in Western Europe and the United States in the year 1900, the last fifty years of the century saw the transformation of the church to a global church. In 1942, Temple said: "The great new fact of our time is the church in every country of the world." By 1973, Winter commented on the great new phenomenon of the emerging Two-Thirds world mission drive. By the end of the year 2000, the internationalization of world missions had seen the churches of Asia, Africa, and Latin America sending out tens of thousands of missionaries, by many accounts actually outnumbering missionaries from the West. The locus of Christian initiative shifted from North to South and West to East.

Lausanne I in 1974 set the stage for hearing the voice of the Two-Thirds world church, providing a new platform for Non-western Christian leaders. "Recent surveys of mission theology reveal the continued domination of Western voices, coupled with no discernible shift during the 1990s" (Kirk 2000 in Shenk 2001a:98):

> In light of the fact that the Christian majority is now to be found outside the West and missionary initiatives from the churches of Asia, Africa, and Latin America are at the cutting-edge of the Christian world mission, we must ask: What kind of theology of mission will best serve the global Christian mission in the future? What fresh theological resources can be brought to bear on this new phase of the Christian mission? It is time to

> listen to voices from the non-Western world that can help construct a theology capable of empowering the global church for participation in the *Missio Dei* (Shenk 2001a:98).

Shenk links mission theology to mission engagement. He suggests that the one flows out of the other: "Vital theology of mission flows from missionary engagement," there is a need to hear what God is saying through his servants in Africa, Asia, and Latin America today.

Global mission initiative has been taken up by the world in the last decade through the AD2000 Movement. In the lead article of *Mission Frontiers* entitled "The Third World takes the Lead," the managing editor writes: "The AD2000 And Beyond Movement, led by third world leaders . . . is raising up international leadership from dozens of countries" (R. Wood 1992).

Imagine the global advance in mission that could take place at the beginning of the twenty-first century if God's people worldwide were to become fully surrendered to God the Holy Spirit, and fully aware of their strategic placement for major mission advance! The challenge in the twenty-first century will be enabling creative partnership to share resources between the Two-Thirds world with its fresh initiative of mission, and the West, with its experience and knowledge.

Conclusion

As we look back at 2000 years of Christian mission, we can see throughout that there exists an inherent linkage between renewal and fresh mission growth initiatives. In establishing this paradigm of mission, I have developed a theoretical framework, looked at the biblical and theological basis from Pentecost in the Book of Acts, Chapter 2,

examined the historical evidence from Pentecost to 1950, considered four major developments from 1950 to 2000 and suggested some practical implications in the form of questions.

Our mission then is a participation in Christ's mission. God's mission takes place in the power of the Holy Spirit expressed by *missio Spiritus Sancti*—God's mission through the Holy Spirit. The main function of the Holy Spirit in mission is to point to Jesus Christ. Though largely hidden, the Holy Spirit is the primary mobilizer and means of the church in mission.

Several questions remain in seeking to advance the Christian movement in the twenty-first century to the glory of God. Some of these include the following:

1. How can the global Christian movement be encouraged to launch a fresh wave of mission flowing out of the fresh authentic evangelical awakening?

2. How can the people of God be encouraged to discover and define new frontiers for the sake of the gospel without neglecting the need for nurture within the church?

3. How can the global missionary movement discover and then move across the remaining cultural, racial, social, and geographic barriers?

4. How are leaders to be selected, trained and encouraged to finish well to lead the twenty-first century movement?

5. How can the whole church be encouraged and mobilized in mission?

6. How can the body of Christ build and maintain the existing effective structures, while at the same time encouraging the creativity of the Holy Spirit through men and women on the periphery in the reshaping of the church for mission, both local and global?

7. How can we further understand the relationship between the gospel and culture in which to engage in mission in a pluralistic and postmodern world?

CHAPTER 4

THE CATALYTIC LEADER—MOTT

Leaders of the Christian missionary enterprise learn about being world evangelization catalysts from mission statesman, John R. Mott. Mott was one person who contributed immeasurably to Christian mission in the twentieth century and left us an example to follow, as we seek to engage in God's mission in the twenty-first century. The human agency in God's mission is *missio hominum*, who is nevertheless sinful, with mixed motivations, means, and goals. Yet he would be the first to admit that he was nevertheless sinful. What Mott was after was the glory of God (Chapter 2). He was concerned about the presence, power and peace of God in society. That is why he won the peace prize. Princeton Theological Seminary President John A. Mackay said of Mott: "I believe [him] to be the greatest Christian statesman of our century" (Fisher 1952:77). Latourette went so far as to call him more instrumental than any other person since the Apostle Paul to spreading the gospel: "No one since the days of St. Paul has done so much to spread the Gospel of Jesus Christ as Dr. Mott" (Mackie 1965:Back Cover). "A layman, he traveled widely across the world, first as an evangelist and an organizer among students and later as an outstanding leader in Protestant missions and what came to be known as the Ecumenical Movement" (Latourette 1953:1257-1258). Although no one disputes the greatness and significance of Mott, some conservative evangelicals in

the twentieth century were reluctant to claim Mott given his ecumenical connections and for other reasons.

The definitive work by C. Howard Hopkins, *John R. Mott, 1865-1955: A Biography* (1979), reveals a ninety-year-long life of enormous influence. Despite the humble beginnings of this third son of John S. and Elmira Mott born on their farm in Sullivan County, New York, on May 25, 1865 (Mathews 1934:4).

Mott's leadership not only included the Christian world but the secular world as well. His impact on those from his generation carried forward to succeeding generations. In summarizing his legacy to the world, it was said of Mott:

> Mott was unique. He is remembered as evangelist, man of prayer, leader, advocate of comity, builder of organizations, friend, chief, chairman, speaker, coach, executive, author, editor, fundraiser, traveler. His influence lives not only in world bodies such as the W.C.C. and the World's Alliance of YMCAs, but in the profound effect he exerted upon individuals of several generations who volunteered their contributions to the evangelization, the betterment, the unity of the world in their time (Hopkins 1994:83).

In Johannes Verkuyl's monumental work, his respect for the place of Mott and his influence is demonstrated by the way he divides the epochs of mission. He includes Mott in the outline in Part 3, "The Theology of Mission Through the Ages, From John Eliot to John Mott" (1978:ii).

Many accomplishments of Mott's leadership are measurable. In the years following the release of his 1900 book calling for the evangelization of the world, it catalyzed more than 20,000 missionaries who were motivated to go out in pursuit of the vision it articulated.

The Bible encourages us to study the lives of godly leaders and discover meaningful lessons from how they lived. “Remember your leaders, who spoke the word of God to you. Consider the outcome of their way of life and imitate their faith” (He. 13:7). What can we learn about leadership from Mott that can contribute to the leadership development of a new generation of Christian mission leaders who will provide catalytic impetus to world evangelization? This question is made more significant by the fact that we live in a period of great challenge with more Christians in more countries, cultures, and cities ready to engage in God’s mission than ever before. How can these aspiring, emerging leaders be prepared for involvement?

In reviewing the body of affirmation of the leadership of Mott, I can only conjecture that here was a person enabled, beyond any human imagination, to be a choice instrument of God in leadership for his generation, worthy of our examination and emulation as a leader. My purpose in this chapter, therefore, is to present highlights from Mott’s leadership qualities—such as ethics, decision making, focus—and the mechanisms—such as conferences, mentoring—he devised to carry out his visionary ideas.

Highlights from Mott’s Leadership Qualities

Mott made an extensive investment of time in travel to minister to students. Additionally, he practiced prayer and the presence of God while adhering to a strict code of moral and spiritual ethics.

Personal Ethics

Mott's private life and ethics shaped what he was to become in his public life. "At least four other factors molded Mott's viewpoint: the Bible, the practice of prayer, his continent-wide and world-circling travel among the colleges and universities, and his preparation for this by extensive reading" (Hopkins 1994:81).

But these were primarily the activities that shaped him. On a deeper level, though, in the execution of these actions could be found an even more important list that affected every thought. It was a series of questions he would ask of himself, as if standing outside himself and evaluating. From these may be drawn nine principles (Mathews 1934:332-398) of a highly effective leader of influence:

1. Does he do little things well? (the principle of excellence)
2. Has he learned the meaning of priorities? (the principle of focus)
3. How does he use his leisure? (the principle of rest)
4. Has he intensity? (the principle of passion)
5. Has he learned to take advantage of momentum? (the principle of timing)
6. Has he the power of growth? (the principle of a learning posture)
7. What is his attitude toward discouragements? (the principle of resilience)
8. How does he face impossible situations? (the principle of faith)
9. What are his weakest points? (the principle of humility)

Mott not only prayed, but he also practiced the presence of God in his daily life, believing that whatever he was able to accomplish was due to prayer. In spite of his popular image as the great religious entrepreneur, many remember him chiefly as a man of prayer. Possibly, unlike most other contemporary evangelists, as he traveled the world,

he read voraciously for background, not only in current affairs, but in history and culture; as a result, Mott grew from a somewhat provincial American into a citizen of the world and as such was welcomed on campuses from Berkeley to Oxford to Sydney (Hopkins 1994:81).

Mott had a high regard for his wife Leila, as shown in the dedication of his book, *Present Day Summons*, written in 1931: "To my wife through whose comradeship as a fellow traveler across the years and across the world God has communicated the most creative, self-giving, and enduring impulses of my life." Family papers and correspondence not only provided valuable biographical and genealogical information, but they also revealed Mott's role as a devoted son, brother, husband, and father (Smalley 1980). On the occasion of his retirement from the National Council of YMCA in 1928 he said: "What do I not owe to my wife! . . . She has been to me constant incitement to seek and move on the highest levels; she has been a living conscience; she has been a faithful and humbling critic and mentor" (Mathews 1934:99).

Use of Effective Methodologies in Decision-Making

Mott was known for his expeditious and wise decision-making. He wrote to his father explaining how he came to make the decision to accept the intercollegiate secretary position of the Young Men's Christian Association in a letter of April 28, 1888:

> There are two things I hope to convince you of in my life: First—that I do not jump at a decision, but consider it from all sides, getting advice from every reliable source, and then reaching from the conflicting opinions my own decision. Second—that I am not led by others, even by a large majority, unless they happen to be in harmony with my standards of decision. Those standards are:

1. The Holy Spirit, who guides in cooperation with
2. The Scriptures
3. Reason—not feeling
4. Conscience
5. Providential events (Mathews 1934:77).

In 1887, early in his ministry, influenced by an essay by John Foster and seeking to make good decisions in how he used his time from an approach used by Benjamin Franklin, Mott prepared a Scheme of Development. Divided into three sections of physical, mental, and spiritual development, a list of actions and exhortations appeared under the heading "Not I, but Christ." For example, under the physical heading, the first item on the list was "sleep—At least eight hours . . . Go to bed to sleep, not to think" (Mathews 1934:59).

Faith in the God of the Impossible to Do the Impossible

One of the strengths of Mott's leadership was his faith in the God of the impossible to do the impossible. "More and more I have come to see that from the Christian point of view it is easier, not only to undertake, but to accomplish the impossible than it is the possible" (Mott 1914:76). He considered it easier for a Christian to undertake the impossible than it is the easy, and he explained why. "One reason is that the impossible kindles and exercises the imagination. The impossible calls out all of our other latent powers" (1914:76).

The challenge to the next generation of Christians was to believe God for difficult things:

> When a bold young spirit like John R. Mott arose a generation ago and with fiery logic actually proved to the Church that the world could be evangelized in one generation, the Church smiled indulgently at the

> impetuosity of youth, and refused even to take the idea seriously. Yet we have seen what Jesus did. With terrible earnestness he sent forth his disciples to hasten to the ends of the earth with Good News that brooked no delay (Montgomery 1839:70).

Mission Mobilizer *par Excellence*

Mott recognized the importance of cultivating a common vision for the purposes of mobilizing God's people for world evangelization. Although he did not coin the phrase "The Evangelization of the World in this Generation," he understood its significance for his generation at the 1886 student gathering at Mt. Hermon, where he received his own missionary call. Thirty years after the adoption of the watchword, Mott said: "I can truthfully answer that next to the decision to take Christ as the leader and Lord of my life, the watchword has had more influence than all other ideals and objectives combined" (Mathews 1934:215). He reflected on its significance:

1. To widen my horizon and enlarge my conception of the Kingdom of God;
2. To hold me steadfast in the face of criticism, opposition and other obstacles to the great Christ-commanded purpose of seeking first the Kingdom of God;
3. To stimulate my personal preparation for my service to my generation;
4. To deepen my conviction as to the necessity of furthering the more intensive aspects of the missionary enterprises such as educational missions, the building up of strong native Churches, and the raising up of an able indigenous leadership;
5. To recognize and promote the essential strategy involved in establishing an adequate home base, and in Christianizing the impact of the so-called Christian nations on the non-Christian world;
6. To appreciate vividly both the social and the individual aspects of the Christian Gospel and likewise their essential unity; to see the necessity of linking together the Christian students of all lands and races, and of raising up from among them an army of well-furnished, God-called heroic Volunteers;

7. To realize and live under the spell of the great urgency of the task of giving each generation an adequate opportunity to know Christ; and above all;
8. To deepen acquaintance with God and to throw us back on Him for ever-fresh accessions of superhuman wisdom, love and power (1934:216).

As a promoter, Mott used a common vision to catalyze a world mission movement. He mobilized with far-reaching impact. The watchword became a major vision-casting energizer for the involvement of more than 20,000 students who went out as missionaries in the early part of the twentieth century:

> A watchword which has in so brief a time gained a powerful hold on the minds of the future leaders of thought, and which is already beginning to make itself felt in the Church, is manifestly worthy of careful consideration. In such a consideration it is important that we clearly understand at the outset what is meant by the evangelization of the world in this generation. It means to give all men an adequate opportunity to know Jesus Christ as their Saviour and to become His real disciples. This involves such a distribution of missionary agencies as will make the knowledge of the Gospel accessible to all men (1900:2-3).

There were some serious critics of the watchword, including Professor Gustav Warneck, who "attacked it . . . on the ground that it was a naively optimistic and rather man-confident forecast that the world would be won for Christ in that generation" (Stott 1975:39). Some missiologists reflecting on the watchword suggest that it was a product of its time. "More than a mere slogan, the volunteer watchword was symbolic of the optimism and exuberance of the pre-World War I generation" (Robert 1986:140).

Mott rallied to the watchword's defense.[1] "He maintained that 'the evangelization of the world' meant neither its conversion nor its Christianization, that it did not

[1] "The watchword, [Mott] said, means the giving to all men an adequate opportunity of knowing Jesus Christ as their Saviour and of becoming His real disciples. This is what Christ implied in the Great

encourage superficial preaching and that it was not to be understood as a prophecy" (Stott 1975:39). And, "Principal Cairns of Aberdeen has stated that Mott's interpretation and advocacy of this watchword has been one of his most distinctive and vital contributions" (Rouse 1959:6).

Exemplification of the Essence of Christian Leadership

Out of an exhaustive review of the centers of influence of leadership theory development, and the related theories promulgated, J. Robert Clinton emphasizes the centrality of the concept of influence. He defines a Christian leader as follows: "A leader, in the biblical context, is a person, with God-given capacity AND with God-given responsibility TO INFLUENCE a specific group of God's people toward God's purposes for the group" (Clinton 1992:62, emphasis his).

According to Figure 2, the basis for Christian leadership is found in God's purposes for a specific group of his people. Within his purposes for that group, he calls forth a human leader to be the instrument to influence that group of people toward God's purposes for them. The influence of the leader on the group comes from both his God-given responsibility and God-given capacity. Like a hand in a glove the God-given

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Commission. It means preaching the gospel to those who are now living; it does not mean the conversion of the world, according to Mott" (Anderson 1988:101).

Robert Wilder kept a list of the criticisms of the watchword with his own responses:

1. It suggests a hasty, superficial preaching of the Gospel. Answer: We advocate no such thing.
2. That it overlooks other important missionary work. Answer: We emphasize educational, medical, etc.
3. That it stands in service of certain millennial views. Answer: We are loyal to all leading denominations.
4. That it overlooks obstacles in the way. Answer: See Cleveland Convention Report in which so much time given to obstacles.
5. That it is a false prophesy. Answer: We venture no prediction.
6. That it requires too much explanation. Answer: Every watchword has required explanation.
7. It is not a prophecy of what is sure to occur. We can emphasize a duty without venturing a prediction. (Cumming 1988:105)

capacity enables the leader to fulfill his God-given responsibility to influence the group. Mott influenced thousands of Christian young people, leaders, and even secular leaders toward God's purposes.

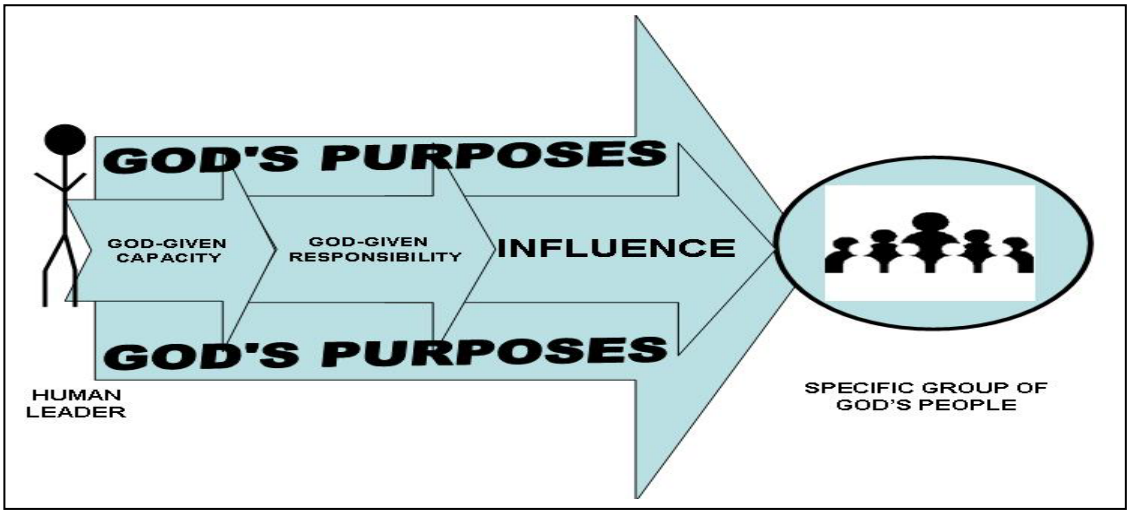


FIGURE 2

WHAT IS A CHRISTIAN LEADER?

Living a Focused Life

Regardless of how one would define the word "focus," one would have to conclude that Mott lived a focused life. One part of focus is the leader's ability to focus all of his faculties on the task or person at hand. For example, on one occasion, when Mott was in his eighties, he was in a train station. He spotted a Christian leader and approached him. Looking deep into his eyes, he asked how it was with him and in his relationship with Christ. Despite the commotion of people and bustle of activity around

them, the leader later said he experienced “a sense of exclusive focus on his person” (Shenk 2001b).

Another aspect of the concept of focus is the leader’s ability to focus on that which is most important, most strategic. From his early twenties, Mott’s life was dedicated to God’s unique purpose for him. “he has dedicated and disciplined every power of body, mind and spirit to incessant battle across the world, through decade after decade, for the Kingdom of God” (Mathews 1934:x). In surveying the seventy-year long ministry, there appears to be a conscientious prioritization of life’s activities around the four major focal issues of his life, that is, his life purpose, major role, unique methodology, and ultimate contribution.

Pursuing a Life Purpose

Mott’s life purpose was to make Jesus Christ known, obeyed, and loved throughout the world (Hopkins 1979:279, 629). “His great aim, repeatedly stated in thousands of speeches around the world, was ‘to make Jesus Christ known, trusted, loved, obeyed, and exemplified in the whole range of individual life and in all human relationships’” (1979:625). In pursuit of this objective, Mott planned, organized, traveled, lectured, wrote, and raised funds tirelessly.

The cornerstone of Mott’s activities was a vision of the Kingdom of God based on individuals transformed by the call of God and moral fortitude. Societal issues such as labor conflict, big money, and imperialism were viewed through the lenses of this vision with a seemingly simplistic confidence, undoubtedly heartening to a large body of the American population (Smalley 1980). In order to achieve his life purpose, Mott

developed early in his life a set of personal purposes which, taken as a whole, acted as a rudder to keep his life balanced and moving towards his central purpose and the fixed, monumental goals proceeding from it.

Mechanisms Mott Developed to Carry Out His Vision

Mott used specific means to carry out his visionary ideas. He devised mechanisms and structures through which he channeled his formidable leadership gifting to fulfill God's purposes as he interpreted them. These mechanisms included conferences, organizations, mentoring, bridge building, and writings.

Conferences

The methodology by which Mott prepared for and conducted conferences overseas proved to be highly effective. The methodology was implemented with unsurpassed thoroughness as chairman of the Edinburgh 1910 Continuation Committee through twenty-one follow-up conferences. A questionnaire was sent out in advance to catalyze the process of discussion, seeking factual, creative and forward-looking results. Great efforts were undertaken to ensure the presence of the leading missionaries and Christian nationals at each provincial gathering. Having both leading nationals and internationals present encouraged different points of view, knowledge which was then used for findings and resolutions. Mott raised the finances for the printing, mailing, and gatherings from sources that did not affect the missionary's field budgets. With the dominant lesson out of Edinburgh 1910 being the need for greater cooperation, the resolutions related to ways of cooperating in each one of the regions. In China, for

example, there were six areas identified, each holding a sectional conference. Typically, the conferences resulted in the establishment, not only of one national body, called a national Christian council, but also a commitment to a whole range of cooperative projects in literature, evangelism, social problems, and education (Mathews 1934:227-228).

Organizations

Mott's platform of global ministry was organizational. He built organizations, developed them, expanded them, and occasionally founded new ones to accommodate the broadening sphere of influence. On one occasion, Mott made a worldwide tour, representing no less than four organizations (Hopkins 1979:633). He was an organization's man. He was either the executive secretary or became an executive chairman.

Mott was unusual in that he not only had the ability to take a fledgling organization, bring stability, and expand its influence but also to start new organizations. He was instrumental in founding a number of organizations. The most noteworthy with regard to recognizing his influence are World Student Christian Federation (WSCF), the International Missionary Council (IMC) and the World Council of Churches (WCC). The historian of the World Student Christian Federation (WSCF) (Hopkins 1979:128) calls Mott "the greatest leader the Y.M.C.A. has ever known" (Rouse 1959:1). And in Smalley we find the following:

He served as administrator and leader of various organizations including the Young Men's Christian Association, Student Volunteer Movement for Foreign Missions,

World Student Christian Federation, Foreign Missions Conference of North America, International Missionary Council, Interchurch World Movement, Institute of Social and Religious Research and the World Council of Churches (Smalley 1980).

The formation of the WSCF in 1895 was Mott's most creative achievement (Hopkins 1979). When he suggested someone else write the history of the Federation, a friend wrote back, "You are the history of the Federation" (Rouse 1959:1). He became convinced that the time had come to establish a worldwide union of Christian students and devoted two years to bringing this about. His rationale was that students are primary instruments to move the world toward God (1959:2).

As Mott transitioned from student work to mission and church work worldwide, the primary organizational platform bearing the influence of his ministry also shifted:

> As he had earlier concentrated on the World's Student Christian Federation, the influence of which was pervasive and universal, in his last active years he gave himself fully to the I.M.C. Through its chairmanship he exerted both a symbolic and a direct influence upon the World Council "in process of formation" (Hopkins 1979:684).

The link between Mott's major role and his life purpose can be traced through the goals of the organizations he founded and to which he gave leadership.

Mentoring Individual Leaders

In his lifetime, Mott was a mentor to many. He had a productive ministry in the lives of individuals, especially those associated with the boards and the organizations in which he served as chairman or secretary. The longevity of his service in these organizations and the faithfulness he demonstrated with respect to their goals would have given leadership to many through a mentorship relationship as pictured by the oval

design in the center of Figure 3. For those in succeeding generations, Mott serves as an excellent historical mentor and as one who showed the true love of Christ and as one who undoubtedly made those around him feel loved and useful.[2]

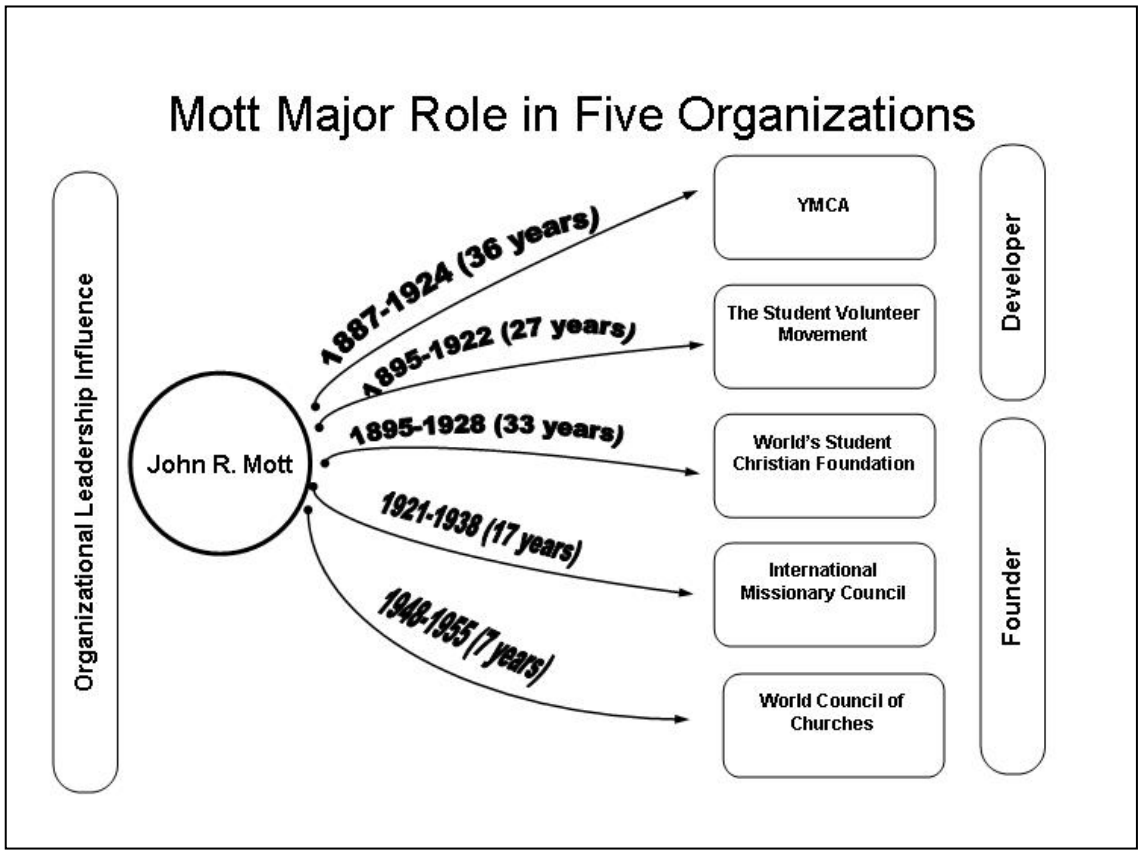


FIGURE 3

ORGANIZATIONS INFLUENCED BY MOTT

[2] Historical mentoring involves learning vicariously from the lives of others who have gone before. Much can be learned in a substitutionary manner through their experiences (Clinton 1995:512).

From the beginning of his ministry, Mott believed that new Christian leaders would experience an expanding scope of influence, just as he himself experienced throughout his life. At the age of twenty-seven, he wrote in one of his first pamphlets on the purpose of the Student Volunteer Movement (SVM): "Not only does the Movement plan to enlist volunteers, but also to guard and develop them until they pass beyond its proper sphere of influence" (Mott 1892:92). Leadership development was an objective, not a mere byproduct of Mott's work, with the many organizations and movements he founded or led.

Bridge Building

There are some people, including the Nobel Peace Prize Committee, who would argue that the single most important legacy of Mott was as a man of peace. Mott invested efforts on multiple occasions to bring together groups between which the friction was greatest; "Britons and Boers: Americans and Spaniards: Chinese and Japanese: Japanese and Russians: English and Indians: American and Filipinos" (Rouse 1959:10). This ability to bring warring factions together related to the compelling nature of his own character. Mott's life ministry flowed out of this highly developed character. "The power in John R. Mott's personality was not simply the natural expression of a continuously flowing stream of personal energy, but was due to a . . . diligently developed technique for the unselfish service of the kingdom of God" (Matthews 1934:x).

Mott's influence was not limited to the Christian world. A friend of several U.S. presidents, he was invited to be the U.S. Ambassador to China and was honored by the governments of the United States, France, Italy, Japan, Poland, Greece, Jerusalem, Siam,

Sweden, China, Czechoslovakia, Norway, Hungary, Estonia, Portugal, and Finland (Smalley 1980). For his work as a leader of peace he received the Nobel Peace Prize in 1946.

Summary Thoughts on Mott as a Leader

All of the copious research and documentation available on Mott's life and ministry reveal a leader who changed the face of history of the church. The wave of missionaries he sent forth, the call he championed, and the concepts of world evangelization he promoted can never be called back. This influence will live on in eternity.

Mott combined simple piety, personal evangelism, social concern, and organizational genius to an extraordinary degree of leadership. "Here was a man early possessed by a sense of destiny and mission" (Di Gangi 1982:96). This man sounds larger than life and someone all would want to know, even those outside the mission world.

Mott played a major role in giving impetus to the world mission movement in the first half of the twentieth century through SVM, the Edinburgh 1910 World Mission Conference, the Continuation Committee follow-up, and the IMC, and with contributions to the world movement through his writings. It was because of Mott that a new spirit of cooperation between non-Roman Catholic Christian groups became increasingly evident in the early twentieth century, leading to the formation of mission-based structures, at first, the IMC, and then, church-based structures with the WCC.

CHAPTER 5

THE CATALYTIC STRUCTURES—CONFERENCES

Mission structures established as a result of mission conferences catalyze world evangelization. This is the record of church history and can be argued convincingly over the last one hundred years. However, not all global conferences and the structures formed because of them have had the same impact on world evangelization. The mere fact of holding a global conference in no way guarantees there will be an advance in the global Christian movement.

Introduction

There are certain characteristics of the conferences which catalyze world evangelization. The purpose of this chapter is to explore the inherent linkage between effective global mission conferences of the twentieth century and their related structures and world evangelization. Each conference had a different perspective in relation to the glory of God as the ultimate aim of mission (Chapter 2).

Mark Noll develops the idea of turning points in the history of Christianity (1997:1).[1] The impact of these and other global conferences as turning points was felt in

[1] Thirteen so-called turning points identified by Noll include the following: the Church pushed out on its own: the fall of Jerusalem (70); Realities of empire: the Council of Nicaea (325); Doctrine, politics, and life in the word: the Council of Chalcedon (451); The monastic rescue of the church: Benedict's rule (530); The culmination of Christendom: the coronation of Charlemagne (800); Division between East and

the spread of Christianity to every country on earth. "In the twentieth century, for the first time, there was in the world a universal religion—the Christian religion" (Neill 1986:472).

The importance of global conferences may even exceed the personal ministry of leading evangelists. In the last twenty-five years, for example, Billy Graham has become known for his evangelistic crusades. However, what in the long run may prove:

> just as important as his evangelistic ministry is the leadership he has given in bringing Christian evangelical leaders together in new forms of cooperation. The conferences which he and his association have convened may prove to be the most important part of a double legacy. Lausanne must certainly be calculated in that mix (Ford 1986:3).

Billy Graham sought to bring cooperation in his evangelistic crusades. This laid the groundwork for the significant conferences of Berlin '66 and Lausanne '74 which led to formation of the structure called the Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization. "The results of the Graham crusades could not be ignored. The strength of united witness, in contrast to the weakness of individual, uncoordinated efforts, became increasingly evident" (Howard 1983:2).

Historical Overview

The first half of the twentieth century saw serious theological debates and struggle between the modernists and the fundamentalists (see Appendix D):

> This struggle became so intense that it produced divisions not only between these two groups but also internally within the evangelical

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West: the Great Schism (1054); The beginnings of Protestantism: the Diet of Worms (1521); A new Europe: the English Act of Supremacy (1534); Catholic reform and worldwide outreach: the founding of the Jesuits (1540); The new piety: the conversion of the Wesleys (1738); Discontents of the modern West: the French Revolution (1789); A faith for all the world: the Edinburgh Missionary Conference (1910); Signal of new era for the Roman Catholic Church: Vatican II (1962-1964) (Noll 1997:96).

> segment of the Church. Separatistic tendencies, fear of contamination and memories of institutions, seminaries, denominations, and missions that had lost their evangelistic thrust became very prevalent. The result was that cooperation in the mission of the church, on a broad scale, became minimal, if not unknown. Tragically, the divisions and struggles within the Western church spilled over and spread into many parts of the world (Howard 1983:1).

The impact on world evangelization occurs in different ways as selected groups of God's servants concerned with mission come together from the different streams of Christianity. In the twentieth century, more than any other, the development of the theology of mission and resulting evangelization outcomes can be traced through the global conferences in the three primary streams of Christianity: the Orthodox, the Roman Catholic, and the Protestant (including both ecumenical and the evangelical streams). The Orthodox had one major conference—the Inter-Orthodox Consultation on Gospel and Cultures held Addis Ababa, Ethiopia in 1996. They only use documents to present their thinking regarding the mission of the church. The Roman Catholics rarely have conferences. They also typically express their theology of mission in written documents. The most dramatic deviation from this pattern was Vatican II, from 1962 to 1965, which marked a turning point in Catholic thinking.[2] The Protestant conferences flowed out of Edinburgh 1910 and punctuated the theology of mission at the time the conference was held.

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[2] Verkuyl notes that in Roman Catholic missiology since Vatican II some Catholic scholars are going the route of emphasizing the coming of God's kingdom in history and are describing in fuller detail its features to which *Ad Gentes* referred. "These theologians are developing an ecclesiology which is connected closely with the kingdom and which calls for humans to participate in the events of history. . . . 'The mission of the Church is genuinely apostolic only when her structure and tradition handed down from the Apostles is geared to communicating the message that in the Kingdom of God lies the world's universal future. As she proclaims this message the Church in every historical situation transcends every boundary and even her own mode of existence'" (1978:83).

The Evangelicals (see Appendix D) used the conference mechanism for advancing world evangelization more effectively than did the other major streams of Christianity in the twentieth century. They typically used strong themes. For example, the Lausanne Covenant was a new kind of thing, which was developed at Lausanne '74.

Conferences are linked together in the various Christian traditions as can be traced in Figure 4. The evangelical stream of major conferences held in the twentieth century are in the right hand column, finding their roots in the great mission event in New York in 1900, where 100,000 participants were involved. The ecumenical stream traces its beginnings to the Edinburgh 1910 conference, then divides into three smaller streams based on the three councils formed as a result of Edinburgh 1910: International Missionary Council (IMC), the Faith and Order Council and the Life and Work Council:

> [Edinburgh 1910] . . . led to the establishment of the International Missionary Conference, and less directly in 1925 to the Life and Work Conference and in 1927 to the Universal Conference on Faith and Order, two organizations that eventually merged in 1948 to create the World Council of Churches. The missionary conference in Edinburgh was, therefore, the beginning of the twentieth-century ecumenical movement (Noll 1997:271).

Edinburgh 1910 also marked the end of an era of optimism prior to World War I. "The Protestant Christian forces of the world would never again assemble in quite such a spirit of high-hearted joy and confidence" (Neill 1986:334). Edinburgh 1910 was the fountain from which a series of significant number of mission events were to come forth in the years ahead:

> From Edinburgh flowed . . . streams of international mission conferences. The first has been called the ecumenical stream. With a growing number of participants from the "younger churches," the International Missionary Council (IMC) sponsored major missionary meetings at Jerusalem (1928);

> Tambaram/Madras (1938); Whitby, Canada (1947); Willingen, Germany (1952); and Accra, Ghana (1958). . . . Following the integration in 1961 of the IMC into the World Council of Churches (WCC) as the latter's mission arm, the tradition of mission conferences has continued: Mexico City (1963); Bangkok (1973); Melbourne, Australia (1980); and San Antonio, Texas (1989), with the 1996 conference to be convened in November, in Salvador, Brazil (Thomas 1996:148).

After 1950 an evangelical stream emerged that held a succession of world mission conferences. Christian leaders in this stream also pointed to Edinburgh 1910 as its inspiration:

> In 1960, the Interdenominational Foreign Mission Association (IFMA) organized a World Missions Conference, held at Moody Church in Chicago. . . . Six years later, [in 1966] meeting at Wheaton College in Wheaton, Illinois, IFMA and the Evangelical Foreign Missions Association (EFMA) jointly sponsored a world missions congress. . . . Five months later, with support from Billy Graham, . . . *Christianity Today* sponsored the Berlin Congress on Evangelism (1966). The International Congress on World Evangelization (ICOWE) was held in Lausanne, Switzerland, in 1974, and then sponsored successive world conferences, of which Pattaya, Thailand (1980), and Lausanne II, Manila (1989), are the most significant. The Global Consultation on World Evangelization by the Year 2000 and Beyond (GCOWE '95) was held in Seoul (1995) (Thomas 1996:148).

The Catholic Conferences and documents are shown on the left side of Figure 4; the main Catholic conference is Vatican II. There was also Medellin (1968) and Puebla (1979). The other dates on the left mark the time of the publication of a major document of the Catholic Church:

> The Second Vatican Council, which met in four separate sessions from 1962 to 1965, signaled a new era for the Roman Catholic Church. . . . The ferment of Vatican II stimulated a profusion of Catholic special interest groups—Charismatic, socially active, modernist, biblical, conservative, ecumenical, and more (Noll 1997:302-303).

"The impetus of Vatican II gave birth to the idea of 'mutuality in mission;' that is, all of the church is to be involved in mission and not simply the church located in so-called mission lands" (Costas 1976:65).

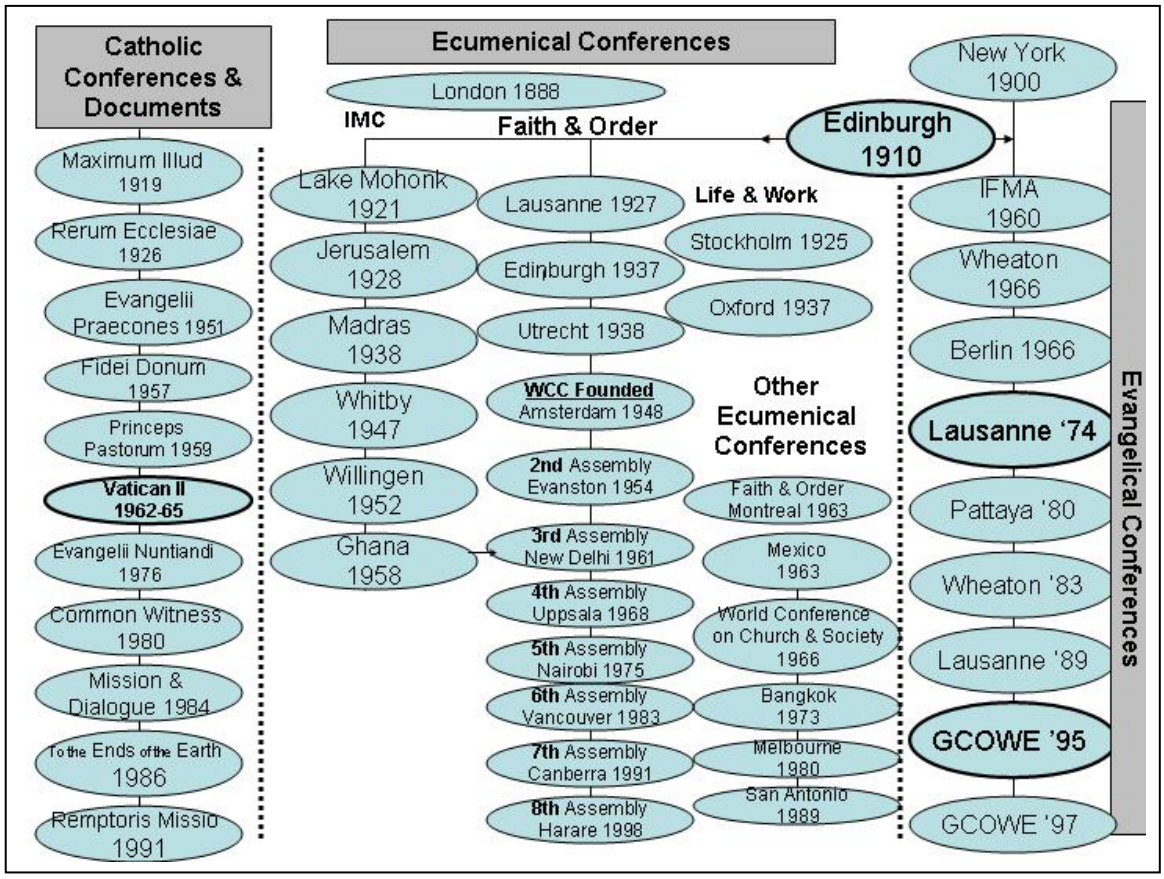


FIGURE 4

OVERVIEW OF CHRISTIAN TWENTIETH CENTURY CONFERENCES

There are four events marked in Figure 4 with bolder print that I interpret as the most significant in twentieth-century Christianity. Of these, Edinburgh 1910 and

Lausanne ‘74 will be treated in greater depth below, as I reflect on their impact on world evangelization. GCOWE ‘95 will be considered in Chapter 6. Edinburgh 1910 is widely regarded as a major turning point in history. “It also represented the high tide of Western missionary expansion, which had gathered strength through the nineteenth century” (Noll 1997:271).

If we ask which conferences demonstrate with greatest clarity the linkage between global mission conferences and world evangelization, ten will stand out. Some of these are from the evangelical stream and some are from the ecumenical stream.

The evangelical theology of mission was fueled by global conferences, beginning in 1960 and, inversely, the global conferences added catalyst to world evangelization efforts, especially following World War II. Ten conferences in the twentieth century, including Edinburgh 1910, had a lasting impact on world evangelization. These are listed in Tables 4 and 5. Table 4 shows the name of each conference, its description and theme, the sponsorship and the number of participants, and the countries represented.

The contrast in geo-political representation between Edinburgh 1910 at the beginning, and GCOWE ‘95 and ‘97 at the end of the twentieth century, reflects the dramatic change of the initiative of mission from West to East and from North to South. At Edinburgh 1910, there were only eighteen out of 1,200 participants, or less than two percent, from the Two-Thirds world (Noll 1997:272). At GCOWE ‘95, held in Seoul, and GCOWE ‘97, held in South Africa, there were two-thirds of the participants and even a higher percentage of the funding and the Congress leadership that came from the

Two -Thirds world. And, "three-quarters of Seoul's financial underwriting and two-thirds of the delegates came from Africa, Asia and Latin America" (Conn 1997:11).

TABLE 4

THEME AND SPONSORSHIP OF EVANGELICAL CONFERENCES

NAME	DESCRIPTION/THEME	SPONSORSHIP	PARTICIPANTS
Edinburgh 1910	World Missionary Conference		1,200 participants
IFMA 1960	Congress on World Missions	Interdenominational Foreign Mission Association (IFMA)	500 participants 400 under IFMA
Wheaton '66	Congress on the Church's Worldwide Mission	Interdenominational Foreign Mission Association (IFMA) & Evangelical Foreign Missions Association (EFMA)	938 delegates 71 countries
Berlin '66	World Congress on Evangelism Theme: One Race, One Gospel, One Task	Christianity Today	1,200 participants 100 nations
Lausanne '74	International Congress on World Evangelization (ICOWE) Theme: Let the Earth Hear His Voice	Billy Graham and others	2,700 participants 150 countries
Pattaya '80	Consultation on World Evangelization (COWE) Theme: How Shall They Hear?	Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization (LCWE)	
Wheaton '83	The Nature and Mission of the Church in the World Theme: I Will Build My Church	World Evangelical Fellowship (WEF)	350 participants 60 countries
Lausanne II Manila '89	Proclaim Christ Until He Comes (ICOWE, 1989) Theme: Calling the Whole Church to Take the Whole Gospel to the Whole World	Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization (LCWE)	4,300 participants 173 countries
GCOWE '95 Seoul	A Church for Every People and the Gospel for Every Person by AD2000	AD2000 Movement	4,000 participants 186 countries
GCOWE '97 Pretoria	A Church for Every People and the Gospel for Every Person by AD2000	AD2000 Movement	4,000 participants 132 countries

TABLE 5

PURPOSE AND LEGACY OF EVANGELICAL CONFERENCES

NAME	PURPOSE	LEGACY
Edinburgh 1910	Seek to achieve the task of world evangelization by integrating and harnessing the evangelical resources of 19th century activities	IMC, Faith & Order, Life & Work
IFMA 1960	A purposeful evangelical unity to present the gospel to the lost around the world	Faced the unfinished task World Survey
Wheaton ‘66	Bring into new focus the biblical mandate to evangelize the world	Wheaton Declaration
Berlin ‘66	Define and reaffirm biblical evangelism Discover the divine strategy of world evangelism Develop the framework of cooperation	Defined evangelicalism
Lausanne ‘74	Proclaim the biblical basis of evangelism Examine our message and methods Share and strengthen our unity and love in Christ Identify those who are as yet unreached	Lausanne Covenant Lausanne Committee
Pattaya ‘80	Seek a fresh vision and power for the task Christ has given Assess the state of world evangelization Complete an extended study on theological and strategic issues Develop specific evangelistic strategies	Occasional papers
Wheaton ‘83	Gain biblical understanding of the nature and mission of the church Bring integration between various aspects of the church	Letter to the churches
Lausanne II Manila ‘89	Motivate and network participants to address the major issues facing the church in its evangelistic intent	Manila Manifesto
GCOWE ‘95 Seoul	Encourage continued momentum building toward the fulfillment of the goal of a church for every people and the gospel for every person by the year 2000	GCOWE ‘95 Declaration
GCOWE ‘97 Pretoria	Advance the initiatives towards the fulfillment of the goal of a church for every people and the gospel for every person by the year 2000	African national initiatives

The faith missions of North America (IFMA) spearheaded the first two events after Edinburgh 1910, with a focus on missions. The participants were mainly North American, with internationals representing those missionaries or nationals working in the fields of mission. The three conferences held between 1966 and 1980 were energized and funded through the efforts of Billy Graham and his association. Lausanne II Manila '89 and Pattaya '80 were sponsored or co-sponsored by the Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization (LCWE), with an increasing number of internationals taking leadership in the conferences. The World Evangelical Fellowship (WEF) was the primary sponsor of Wheaton '83 and had loaned the International Director, David Howard, to serve as Congress Director for Pattaya '80. The Global Conference on World Evangelization (GCOWE), in 1995 and 1997, were sponsored by AD2000.

Each of the ten major conferences of the twentieth century had a purpose related to world evangelization. The first and the last events of the century were the most optimistic in seeking to achieve or fulfill the task of world evangelization in a unifying vision-driven event, using a watchword and harnessing existing resources.

Two Global Mission Conferences with Major Impact

Of all the conferences held throughout the twentieth century, two stand out because of their significance. These are Edinburgh 1910 and Lausanne '74.

Edinburgh 1910

Edinburgh 1910 was a meeting of the home base of missions. At the same time, according to historian Stephen Neill, it was a global conference that surpassed any previous gathering:

> Edinburgh 1910 surpassed all others in the meticulous care with which it had been prepared; in its character as an assembly for careful and scientific thought and not merely for the edification of the faithful and the expression of Christian enthusiasm; and in the steps which it took to secure the permanence of Christian co-operation in the future, to which further reference will have to be made in another context . . . it was an impressive gathering, the like of which had never before been seen in Christian history (1997:32).

Communication

Following the Edinburgh conference, Mott wrote a book describing the situation confronting the missionary forces of Christendom, *The Decisive Hour of Christian Missions,* published the following year. Speaking in 1975 to students at Cambridge University, Stott interpreted for his audience the significance of the Edinburgh conference book that incorporated the material and spirit of the 1910 event and the immediate dampening of the enthusiasm due to two world wars. *The Decisive Hour of Christian Missions*, Stott says, was "written before John R. Mott left Edinburgh and also, of course, before the Edinburgh euphoria had been shattered four years later by World War I" (1975b:36). There was an overwhelming optimism as to the do-ability of the task of world evangelization proceeding from Edinburgh 1910. "In the history of Christianity there has never been such a remarkable conjunction of opportunities and crises on all the principal mission fields and of favoring circumstances and possibilities on the home

field" (Mott 1911:1). The content of his book, *The Decisive Hour of Christian Missions,* was based upon the information furnished by eight commissions working for eighteen months in preparation for Edinburgh 1910, together with discussions and inputs from the conference itself. The book divides into two primary sections. The first describes the conditions of the non-Christian world. The second presents what is required to evoke a missionary response, including (1) an adequate home base, (2) an efficient church on the mission field, and (3) what Mott called the "Superhuman Factor" (1911:2).

Continuation Committee

Following the Conference of Edinburgh 1910, Mott was commissioned by its Continuation Committee, to give, as its chairman, the next two years to visit the countries of the world to spread the vision. The plan was carried out with thoroughness and competence. His biographer correctly noted, "Mott was an important agent in the formation of some thirty national councils of churches in as many countries" (Hopkins 1994:83):

> This journey of 1912-13 was thus epoch-making for Christianity in that it brought into being for the first time not only the framework of world-wide organized relationship between its Churches in their missionary aspect, but created a living fellowship with its roots in the soil, capable of continuous growth (Mathews 1934:227).

Fifty years after Edinburgh 1910, the associated mission structure was established. The appointment by the conference of its Continuation Committee (which became the International Missionary Council (IMC) in 1921) was judged to be a decisive event for the growth of the ecumenical church (Thomas 1996:147).

The International Missionary Council

Eleven years after the conference, in 1921, the Edinburgh 1910 Continuation Committee became the new International Missionary Council (IMC). The council met in Jerusalem in 1928 and in Madras in 1938, affirming Mott as its true chairman and guiding spirit (Mackie 1965:48). One of the most important results of the Edinburgh 1910 conference was that it signaled an alignment of mission agencies for unity. These agencies were drawn together by a primary concern for evangelism and mission, providing the non-Catholic world with its first global structure for international and interconfessional cooperation (Bosch 1997:463).

The IMC gave initial impetus to the ecumenical movement in its quest for unity, yet from the beginning showed weaknesses. One of the objectives of the IMC was to "foster a world-view and to encourage every element of the missionary enterprise to see its task in terms of and related to a total global strategy" (Hogg 1952:362). However, provincialism and ecclesiastical differences hampered international missionary cooperation efforts. Another obstacle was the doctrinal differences of groups represented (1952:363).

The significance of the IMC was that it provided a global structure constituted by a fellowship of mission societies that would catalyze unity for mission. The Edinburgh theme of unity had now found a structural home focused on the mission of the church. It captured the momentum coming out of Edinburgh at which "virtually a new world mission movement began" (Mackie 1965:48).

Faith and Order/Life and Work

There were two other church-based structures which grew out of Edinburgh 1910: the Faith and Order Movement in 1927 and, less directly connected to Edinburgh 1910, the Life and Work Movement which would deal with problems of theology. These two ecclesiastical movements cooperated increasingly, amalgamating their resources, until in 1927, the younger churches, who had come to think of the word "mission" in terms of Western aggression and financial domination, voiced their desire for a World Council of Churches (WCC) which would come into being in 1948. In due course, with substantial difficulty, the IMC amalgamated into the WCC at the third assembly in New Delhi 1961 (Neill 1986:411-412).

The ecumenical spirit emerging from Edinburgh 1910 and embodied in the Continuation Committee, the Faith and Order Movement, the Life and Work Movement, and then the IMC formed the essential components that allowed for the birth of the WCC. Three operating principles were identified as the keys to the WCC's effectiveness: "convening only officially appointed delegates, maintaining broad denominational inclusiveness, and operating cooperatively on essential tasks while neither requiring theological consensus nor compromising any conviction" (Thomas 1996:147). Meanwhile, there were growing concerns from more conservative non-Catholic Christians. The Interdenominational Foreign Mission Association (IFMA) Congress (1960) constituted a challenge to the prevailing philosophy of the WCC.

Lausanne '74

In considering the backdrop to Lausanne '74, Leighton Ford, the long-term chairman of the Continuation Committee, made it clear that there was concern for the politicization of the gospel. Fundamentalists and conservative evangelicals were decrying the ecumenical churches for abandoning the gospel for political involvement (see Appendix D):

> In the 60s a series of events seemed to be blunting the emphasis on evangelism as presenting Christ so that men would accept him as Savior and Lord, and follow him in his church and their daily lives. The absorption of the International Missionary Council into the World Council of Churches framework in 1961 was supposed to integrate evangelism into the churches, but, to many, it seemed to stifle missions and evangelism. The Geneva Conference on Church and Society in 1966 raised alarm with its call for revolutionary change in social and political structures. . . . In spite of the valiant effort made by John Stott, David Hubbard and others to keep classical evangelism clearly in focus, the emphasis was nearly extinguished. Humanization seemed to replace evangelization of the goal of mission. Dialogue was to become more important than proclamation. Conversion was more turning to one's fellow man than to God. A number of evangelicals, including myself, left Uppsala [1968] disillusioned at the politicized, perhaps even secularized atmosphere.
>
> Then, in 1973, a conference called Salvation Today, was held by the World Council's Commission on World Missions and Evangelism at Bangkok. Again, evangelicals were present and were at least heard, but once more salvation seemed to have been assigned a new content, as mission and evangelism had before. God at work through political "saviors" and secular movements was held by some to be equa1ly important, if not more so, than the mission of the church. The line between God's providential work in creation and his saving work in the new creation became very blurred. Calls were being heard for a "moratorium" on missions (Ford 1986:4).

The leading figure in rallying the more conservative non-Catholics was Billy Graham, especially in the preparation and financing of Berlin '66. The influence of Graham was significant also at Lausanne '74. Graham insisted on two things: the Congress was to deal with evangelism and the people who were invited were to be

committed evangelicals (Ford 1986:10). "In his opening address, Graham stated that he would like to see the Congress frame a biblical declaration of evangelism to speak 'with a strong clear voice, one which would challenge the next World Council of Churches Assembly'" (1986:13), and that assembly was set to be held in Nairobi in 1975.

On the other hand, by the early 1960s some evangelicals were in ferment not so much because of the politization of the gospel but that they had given up too much to the fundamentalists (see Appendix D). At Lausanne, Stott, and especially Carl F. Henry, sought to recover classical evangelicalism. They restated in the 1970s an evangelical identity in terms of Babbington's statement in the 1960s (see Appendix D). They were trying to reclaim that which was the evangelical heritage. They sought to recover the full biblical connotation of the term evangelical. To them there was not enough social concern.

The thematic development of Lausanne interwove the concepts of world evangelization, biblical clarity, cultural sensitively and spiritual renewal.[3] "World evangelization, the Spirit seemed to say, calls for a church submissive to biblical authority, sensitive to the cultures of the world in which we live, and renewed together by the power of the Holy Spirit" (Ford 1986:11).

A Covenant

The Lausanne Covenant became an influential legacy of the Lausanne '74 event. Many believed that it was the most important legacy.

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[3] A compendium of Lausanne '74, edited by J. D. Douglas, was published under the title *Let the Earth Hear His Voice.*

> Without a doubt the most lasting and broadly influential result of the Congress was the Lausanne Covenant. This document was drafted over a long process. Months before the Congress an initial draft was sent to a number of advisers, based on the papers that were being submitted by the major speakers. It was then revised on the basis of their comments, and further revised by a drafting committee at the Congress under the leadership of John Stott. All participants then received what was basically a third draft. Comments, proposed changes and additions were then worked over by the drafting committee (Howard 1983:17).

Despite the positive influence of the Lausanne Covenant, there was significant tension in its development and beyond. One of the major points of tension was the relationship between evangelism and social responsibility:

> The Covenant, however, was certainly not the final word on the relationship between evangelism and social responsibility. It had left a number of issues unresolved. In what sense is evangelism "primary"? Is the preaching of the Word always, and in every case, the first thing we do for people? The radical discipleship group at Lausanne had repudiated any attempt to "drive a wedge" between evangelism and responsibility; it labeled such attempts as demonic and a clear repudiation, of the distinction made in the Covenant. On the other hand, more conservative critics felt that the Covenant had so broadened the mission of the church as to lead to a dangerous diversion of mission enterprise from the classical emphasis on soul winning first, to be followed by discipleship, and then by the social impact of individual Christians (Ford 1986:43).

Subsequent gatherings and an exegesis of the covenant by Stott were efforts to continue to clarify the essentials of the nature of mission and evangelization.

A Continuation Committee

Out of Lausanne '74 came a Continuation Committee. There were differing views presented at the conference for follow-up, including the following: those who wanted to hand the committee over to the World Evangelical Fellowship (WEF); those who wanted to set up a permanent organization similar to the World Council of Churches; and those

who pleaded that nothing should be done. Two years prior to Lausanne '74, a study of the effectiveness of Edinburgh 1910 led to the conclusion that it was the ensuring structure—the Continuation Committee, mandated to spread the gospel and work of Edinburgh around the world, that accounted for the conference's long-term impact (Ford 1986:24). It was decided to offer the Lausanne participants four options in a ballot/questionnaire sent out several months prior to the gathering. The options were (1) a link with an existing organization, (2) a new separate organization, (3) a Continuing Committee, and (4) a continuing communications link. Over seventy percent favored an actual Continuation Committee, and ninety percent urged some kind of continuing communication link (1986:27). The Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization (LCWE), consisting of eighty volunteer members, was thus established as a structure to set policy and give direction to the Lausanne movement (Ford 1985:19).

A Catalyst

The catalytic impact of Lausanne, ever since the 1974 congress, has been very significant. Lausanne '74 spawned multiple regionalized events in which Christian leaders met together to pray, reflect, and plan for evangelization in their regions. "It is virtually impossible to ascertain all the evangelistic activities that have been generated as a direct result of Lausanne initiatives. Since the Lausanne Congress, the spirit of Lausanne has become regionalized on every continent.

In Europe alone, it is estimated that within two years after the International Congress on World Evangelization (ICOWE), at least twenty-five new organizations or missions were started. Other results are described by Leighton Ford as follows:

> Christians living in the twentieth century have unique opportunities for world evangelization. Advanced computer and communications technology along with modern methods of transportation make it possible for Christians from around the world to exchange ideas, plan, pray, and work together. While nothing can take the place of unyielding dependence on the Holy Spirit, along with personal commitment and involvement, the developments of this age have made the possibility of world evangelization more realistic for the Christian church.
>
> In some parts of the world, communication just does not happen until people are brought together face-to-face. Fellowship is based on trust, and we have to meet one another to engender trust. Uniting under the umbrellaof the *Lausanne Covenant,* tens of thousands of Christians have had the opportunity to pray, plan, and work together for world evangelization (1985:15).[4]

One of the fruits revealing the catalytic nature of the Lausanne Movement was the AD2000 and Beyond Movement (AD2000), which became known as the functional successor of Lausanne; it was birthed as a new structure, with some difficulty, in connection with the second Lausanne Congress held in Manila in 1989:

> The AD 2000 Movement builds on the thinking of Lausanne in several important ways. The description of the remaining task of world evangelization by focusing on the unreached peoples was introduced to the world in Lausanne I in 1974 and was fostered and developed within Lausanne ever since. It was articulated in the Manila Manifesto under the section entitled AD 2000 and Beyond. . . . The AD2000 has adopted the Lausanne Covenant as its philosophical statement (Bush 1993:8-9).

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[4] In August 1976, over 1,600 Chinese-speaking representatives from six continents gathered in Hong Kong for the Chinese Congress on World Evangelization (CCOWE).

In January 1977, an All-India Congress on Mission and Evangelization (AICOME) was held in Devlali, India, with over 400 Christian leaders present.

In November 1978, 350 Christian leaders from more than 20 Asian countries came to Singapore for the Asian Leadership Conference on Evangelism (ALCOE). The Consultation on World Evangelization (COWE) held in Pattaya, Thailand, in 1980, brought together 650 participants from 87 countries.

In July 1981, more than 8,000 pastors, evangelists, and church leaders gathered from across the United States for the American Festival of Evangelism (AFE), which included addresses by outstanding Christian leaders, and about 200 seminars on evangelism, discipling, and ministry.

In April 1982, some 200 Latin American evangelicals representing 23 countries gathered in Panama City, Panama, for the Consultation of Evangelicals in Latin America (CONELA) and formed a fraternity representing 98 evangelical denominations.

In September 1984, more than 600 pastors, evangelists, educators, and other leaders met in Kingston, Jamaica, for the Congress on the Evangelization of the Caribbean (CONECAR 84).

The relationship between Lausanne, the World Evangelical Fellowship (WEF) and AD2000 was sometimes confusing. It was described by female leaders of the three entities as trains. “The WEF and Lausanne trains have a broader itinerary, stopping at many stations along the way, while AD 2000 resembles an express train—but all are heading for the same destination” (Bush 1993:9). “The AD2000 works closely with WEF. AD 2000 is an associate member of WEF. It has adopted the WEF doctrinal statement as its statement of faith” (1993:9).

Halfway through the ten-year chartered life of the Movement, a mid-decade event was held in Seoul. This event transitioned AD2000 from a vision-casting phase to implementation of its vision of “a church for every people and the gospel for every person by the year 2000.”

Observations Regarding Global Mission Conferences

Global mission conferences do not occur in isolation. They occur in a specific historical context. Global mission conferences influence other conferences, other broader Christian streams. They build ongoing perspective of the mission of the church which impacts world evangelization through the structures they establish to carry forward the vision of the conferences.

The twentieth century began with the full flower of prosperity in the North Atlantic perimeter world, with a sometimes overt assumption of the superiority of western culture. Optimism turned to pessimism at World War I. The ensuing ferment of the twentieth century influenced global conferences and their related impact on world evangelization:

> The first half of the twentieth century witnessed tremendous upheavals in the world in general and missions in particular. World War I with its aftermath of the "Roaring Twenties," the Great Depression of the thirties, World War II in the forties and its aftermath of apathy in the fifties, produced far greater changes than any previous fifty years in the history of the world (Howard 1983:1).

The period from 1947 to 1963 was marked by two worldwide events: the end of World War II, which finished with the world being divided up in new ways, and the beginning of independence for the so-called "mission" countries. These two events caused a crisis for the missionary at that time (Zorn 1999:279-290).

The period from 1947 to 1963 was marked by two worldwide events: the end of World War II, which finished with the world being divided up in new ways, and the beginning of independence for the so-called "mission" countries. These two events caused a crisis for the missionary at that time (Zorn 1999:279-290). Add to these cataclysmic events the more subtle festering socio-political effects of the Industrial Revolution and the evolution of information technology, and the twentieth century historical context begins to emerge:

> These surfaced in a secular, even atheistic response which contributed to the century not only the revolutions in Russia and China, but also the Cold war, the Korean Conflict and Vietnam. The "Second World" of Communism, in west and east posed a competitive challenge to the western nations that, in turn, affected the whole world (Hoekstra 1979:15-16).

The end of the century finds epochal changes taking place in the world. The historical context for mission at century's end stands in sharp contrast to its beginning:

> (1) we now live in a pluricentric, rather than Western-dominated world, despite the fact that the Cold War is now over; (2) structures of oppression and exploitation are today being challenged as never before; (3) a profound feeling of ambiguity exists about the value of western

> technology and development, and the older idea of "progress"; (4) we inhabit a shrinking global village with finite resources, and this calls for growing mutual interdependence; (5) humans are for the first time aware of their capacity to destroy the earth and make it uninhabitable for future generations; (6) societies everywhere now seek their own local cultural identities and reject slavish imitation of Western models; (7) freedom of religion and greater awareness of other faiths force Christians to re-evaluate their own earlier attitudes toward other faiths (Scherer and Bevans 1992:xi).

It is in this kind of world that the global mission conferences were forged. Christian leaders convened them as a way to engage in world evangelization.

Relational Impact of Conferences

There is a kind of interflow and interaction between conferences in different streams and even within streams. Sometimes, there is the building of mission themes; at other times, the borrowing of themes. For example, Lesslie Newbigin influenced Vatican II happenings through his book *The Household of God* (Shenk 2001c). IFMA's Chicago 1960 conference took its theme, "Facing the Unfinished Task," from Neill's *The Unfinished Task,* a book he wrote in 1957 following service on the WCC staff.

The integration debate of the International Missionary Council (IMC) with the WCC, which began about the time of Madras 1938, led to the demise of the IMC. This was an important stimulus to the reactionary emergence of the evangelical stream of conferences which began in 1960 and proliferated throughout the remainder of the century. "[A]s early as 1947 . . . Max Warren had prophesied that it was not 'right beyond the region of possibility that the fundamentalist churches and mission bodies may some time in the next few years try and [sic] constitute an international organization of their own'" (Yates 1994:193). Mott had expressed "grave reservations about a world

body not motivated by missions, and fears that the World Council might swallow the International Missionary Council" (Hopkins 1979:689). Mott's fears were realized, as the IMC did merge with the WCC at the New Delhi Assembly (1961).

Some conferences were convened in a mode defensive toward other conferences or streams. "The convening by evangelicals of the two Congresses on World Evangelization at Berlin in 1966 and at Lausanne in 1974 must unfortunately be understood, at least in part, as a loss of confidence in the World Council of Churches" (Stott 1996:169). David Howard noted that the defensive posture towards the ecumenical movement came out repeatedly. He refers to Eugene Smith, a WCC observer at Wheaton 1966, who "noted that nine of the fifteen major papers carried attacks on the ecumenical movement." Smith also stated that "the distrust of the ecumenical movement within this group has to be experienced to be believed" (Howard 1983:6).

The Lausanne '74 event admittedly sought to impact the next WCC general assembly, as stated in the opening remarks of the event by honorary chairman Billy Graham, who stated that he would like to see the Congress frame a biblical declaration of evangelism in order to speak "with a strong clear voice, one which would challenge the next World Council of Churches Assembly" (Ford 1986:13).

The evangelical stream also borrowed a paradigm from the ecumenical for the Lausanne Movement, "[World Evangelization requires the] whole church taking the whole Gospel to the whole world" (see Appendix D). This comes directly from paragraph six of the Lausanne Covenant. At the Consultation on the Relationship between Evangelism and Social Responsibility, cosponsored by the Lausanne Committee for

World Evangelization (LCWE) and World Evangelical Fellowship (WEF) in 1982, there was a whole-hearted acceptance of this statement. This shared concept was built into an understanding of the essence of what the WCC called ecumenical (see Appendix D).

Conferences Debate the Nature of Evangelism

But perhaps the most debated issue in the twentieth century conference dialogue across all streams was that of the social implications of the gospel. The debate not only took place between the ecumenical and the evangelical streams of Protestantism (see Appendix D), but also within the ecumenical and the evangelical streams themselves.

Within the ecumenical stream, the International Missionary Council (IMC) Jerusalem 1928 conference paid special attention to the relationship between evangelism and social action. An extensive study of social problems was made as it related to missionary work. Issues such as discrimination between human beings were openly debated. "The search for wholeness in mission was evident" (Bassham 1979:21). At the birth of the World Council of Churches (WCC) in 1948, representatives from the six continents discussed the most pressing issues at hand. "The discussion reflected the growing uncertainty about the whole matter of evangelism" (Fey 1970:178). The emphasis within the ecumenical stream on the social implications of the gospel steadily grew with each passing conference until evangelism was eclipsed completely at the fifth general assembly of the WCC in Nairobi in 1975:

> There was no call to evangelism, no recognition that existing efforts of churches are inadequate to evangelize the multitudes yet unreached. The focus was on participation in struggle against injustice. The vision was of a new *oikumene* where peoples of different religions and cultures learn to

> live and work together in a new community where all participate in determining the common good (Hoekstra 1979:126).

Reacting to the ecumenical views, the organizers of Wheaton '66 expressed their concern that the WCC had shifted. They had moved from "direct evangelism toward greater emphasis upon the greater social and economic structures instead of personal regeneration" (Lindsell 1966:3).

Berlin '66 reaffirmed the primacy of evangelism. But the necessary relationship between evangelism and social concern was addressed clearly by Carl F.H. Henry:

> But the Gospel of Jesus Christ . . . upholds the dignity of man by offering a recovery of his squandered destiny through the forgiveness of sins and a new life. The God of the Bible is the God of justice and of justification. The Christian evangelist has a message doubly relevant to the modern scene: he knows that justice is due to all because a just God created mankind in his holy image, and he knows that all men need justification because the Holy Creator sees us as rebellious sinners. The Gospel is good news not simply because it reinforces modern man's lost sense of personal worth and confirms the demand for universal justice on the basis of creation, but also because it offers rebellious men as doomed sinners that justification and redemption without which no man can see God (Howard 1983:9-10).

The organizers of Lausanne '74 hoped that the conference would point out the relationship between evangelism and social responsibility and support witness to the gospel by both word and deed (Ford 1986:13). One of the developments of Lausanne '74 was the broadening of the meaning of the term "mission." This was articulated especially by Stott in his paper on "The Biblical Basis of Evangelism." Stott remarked that his position had changed since Berlin '66 in that he now understood the Great Commission to include social as well as evangelistic responsibility (Stott 1975:23).[5]

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[5] David Howard develops the changing perspective as articulated by John Stott, who was called the theologian-in-residence at Lausanne '74. Stott stated: "Recently . . . the word 'mission' has come to be

Stott was influenced in his thinking by a group of Latin Americans, led by Orlando E. Costas, including C. René Padilla and Samuel Escobar, to affirm at Lausanne '74 the conviction that evangelism and social action are inextricably linked. They succeeded in having this affirmation included in the Lausanne Covenant as Article 5 (Thomas 1998:315).

It was Costas who pioneered the concept of holistic evangelism. Behind this work about an evangelism that is Good News for both the sinner and the sufferer is an evangelist who embodied the integrity of mission. His commitment was radical word and radical deed. Costas' view serves as a "bridge" theological mission perspective somewhere in between the World Council of Churches (WCC) and the Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization (LCWE) main streams. He rightly concludes that the hermeneutical perspective becomes the hinge point of debate. His reflections on the 1980 conferences at Melbourne, sponsored by the WCC, and Pattaya '80, sponsored by the LCWE, illustrate Costas's own bias. In appealing to a primarily social, rather than linguistic, view of mankind, he naturally embraces the need for temporal liberation, the

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used in a wider and more general sense, to include evangelism but not to be identical with it, and I see no reason why we should resist this development. 'Mission' is an activity of God arising out of the very nature of God. The living God of the Bible is a sending God, which is what 'mission' means." Stott goes on to define mission in terms of service, including, but not limited to evangelism. He ties together the Great Commandment with the Great Commission. "The Great Commission neither explains, nor exhausts, nor supersedes the Great Commandment. What it does is to add to the command of neighbor—love and neighbor—service a new and urgent Christian dimension. If we truly love our neighbor we shall without doubt tell him the Good News of Jesus. But equally if we truly love our neighbor we shall not stop there." Stott later expanded this paper in book form, where he stated his own progression in thinking since Berlin '66. Referring to previously held interpretations of the Great Commission as being exclusively related to "preaching, converting, and teaching," he says, "Indeed, I confess that I myself argued this at the World Congress on Evangelism in Berlin in 1966, when attempting to expound the three major versions of the Great Commission. "Today, however, I would express myself differently . . . I now see more clearly that not only the consequences of the commission, but the actual commission itself must be understood to include social as well as evangelistic responsibility, unless we are to be guilty of distorting the words of Jesus" (Stott cited in Howard 1983).

issue of injustice, and the prophetic themes of mission over the need for eternal liberation, the issue of spiritual lostness, and the proclamation theme of mission (Costas 1982:154). As a speaker at Wheaton '83, Costas continued to emphasize the importance of a holistic strategy in the context of the emergence of third-world missions. He argued that a holistic approach was needed because of the complexity of our world, the comprehensive character of the Christian world mission and the diversities of third world missions (1983:227).

The debate within the evangelical stream regarding the nature of evangelism came to a head at Pattaya '80. While the event illustrated the debate between the ecumenical and evangelical streams (see Table 4 in this chapter), it also highlighted the debate within the streams. During the conference, a statement of concerns was circulated, challenging the conference leadership to the fact that Pattaya '80 had retreated from the Lausanne position stated in paragraph 5 of the Lausanne '74 Covenant, which affirmed that "the message of salvation implies also a message of judgment upon every form of alienation, oppression and discrimination and we should not be afraid to denounce evil and injustice wherever they exist." David Bosch further describes this shift in paradigm as follows:

> We thus have two almost entirely contradictory understandings of evangelism. Some (not all) ecumenicals would define it almost exclusively as Christian sociopolitical involvement; some (not all) evangelicals would define it as calling people to a lifestyle where only personal and individual conduct matters (1981:67).

Bosch further expresses his view regarding what he calls "the typical shortcomings in the evangelical understanding of evangelism in the section titled "Shades of Dualism" in a chapter titled, "An Emaciated Gospel." He presents the view that the

evangelicals truncate the gospel, supporting his argument from the documents produced at major conferences. The linkage of service to witness addressed in the course of the conferences became a point of reference in the ongoing debate:

> Efforts have recently been made to link witness and service more closely. Frequently, however, there has been little success, with the result that service remains a secondary element. Both the Wheaton Declaration (1966) and the Lausanne Covenant (1974) reveal this. The problem is that the solution is usually found in that the social dimension and the believer's involvement in the world are added on to evangelism (1980:204).

The consultation on the relationship between evangelism and social responsibility held in Grand Rapids, Michigan, in 1982, was an effort to address the potentially divisive issue raised at Pattaya '80 within the evangelical stream. The eight major papers and responses included in the ensuing book titled *In Word And Deed: Evangelism and Social Responsibility* reflect that there are still diverse perspectives on the issue (Nicholls 1985). At Grand Rapids, the primacy of evangelism continued to be emphasized, yet at the same time, there was new clarification of what evangelism means. In the concluding remarks of the final presentation on the mission of the church, Choongnahm Cho emphasized the importance of maintaining the primacy of evangelism since "the root of the problem in our society lies in the selfish sinful hearts of man" (Nicholls 1985:234). As chairman for the drafting committee of the influential report, *Evangelism and Social Responsibility,* ensuing from the consultation, Stott clarified the meaning of evangelism and its primacy:

> Thus, evangelism and social responsibility, while distinct from one another, are integrally related in our proclamation of and obedience to the Gospel. The partnership is, in reality, a marriage. . . This brings us to the question whether the partnership between evangelism and social responsibility is equal or unequal, that is, whether they are of identical importance or whether one takes precedence over the other. . . . First, evangelism has a certain priority. We are not referring to an invariable

> temporal priority, because in some situations a social ministry will take precedence, but to a logical one. . . . Secondly, evangelism relates to people's eternal destiny, and in bringing them Good News of salvation, Christians are doing what nobody else can do (Stott 1996:182-183).

Wheaton '83 provided a platform for further clarification of the response to human need among evangelicals. In the book containing the presentations made at the "Consultation on the Church in Response to Human Need," edited by the co-presenters of the topic "Evangelism and Social Responsibility" a year earlier, Vinay Samuel and Christopher Sugden, the final document titled "Transformation" is found. It reflects, by its very name, the call for societal transformation (Samuel and Sugden 1987:254-265).

The Development of a Theology of Mission

The link between global mission conferences and world evangelization has substantive connection to the theology of mission. Roger Bassham traced the historical development of mission theology beginning with Edinburgh 1910 and extending to 1975. He defined mission theology as "those theological presuppositions, statements, and principles which critically reflect upon and explicate God's purpose for the church in relation to the world" (1979:7).

James Scherer and Stephen Bevans recognized the continued new directions in mission and evangelization from 1974 to 1991 with a collection of statements on mission from Conciliar Ecumenical, Roman Catholic, Eastern Orthodox and Evangelical Protestant sources. Their *New Directions in Mission and Evangelization 2* reflects the theological foundations of mission from representatives of the one inclusively broad group of Christian sources. They observe, in exploring the theological foundations of

mission, that "those foundations are not yet firmly in place. Today's missiological world is characterized by continuing change and abrupt transition" (Scherer and Bevans 1992:xi, xiii).

At Edinburgh 1910, the conference developed a theological vision that laid the foundation for the ecumenical movement agenda with its broad concept of mission (Bassham 1979:15). The Tambaram (Madras) meeting of 1938 provided continuity to Edinburgh's understanding of mission. It dealt with the relationship of the Christian message to the non-Christian world. "The question of the uniqueness of Christ was handled decisively. He was God's appointed savior intended for the whole world. There was no other Savior" (Hoekstra 1979:32). The 1947 Whitby meeting, calling for worldwide evangelism, also showed continuity in the understanding of the meaning of mission from Edinburgh and Madras.

But after 1947, the definition became more contentious. At Whitby, recognizing this divergence of opinion, the International Missionary Council (IMC) was commissioned to work with the World Council of Churches (WCC) to conduct a survey of mission theology. This led to a project titled, "The Missionary Obligation of the Church," later modified to "The Calling of the Church to Mission and Unity." This document contained widely accepted perspectives on mission within the ecumenical movement but which had not been articulated with such clarity before (Bassham 1979:31). The primary issue addressed was the tension between the inherent call to unity of the ecclesiastical body, in this case the WCC, as contrasted to the priority call of the

mission structure, in this case the IMC, to mission. The principles espoused were influential in shaping the future of the ecumenical movement:

> Missionary obligation and the movement towards unity . . . are "indissolubly connected." Each derives from obedience to God's work in Christ, and each intimately reflects to the other. A united church could give the best and clearest evangelical witness to the world, because mission and unity together comprise the meaning of "ecumenical" (Bassham 1979:32).

In the midst of the debate over connections between unity and mission, an important development in the theology of mission took place at the Conference at Willingen in 1952 when three important new perspectives of mission were brought to the foreground, the first of which was the Trinitarian basis of mission (Bassham 1979:49). The second emphasis was "the notion of *missio Dei*," defined as follows: "as God has sent His son to the world, so now He sends the church throughout the whole world to share in His mission" (1979:167).

These two changes were a promising start in the development of the theology of mission in the period from 1948 to 1960, underscoring the Trinitarian basis and God-centeredness of mission. The third change in perspective of mission in the ecumenical stream, taking place from 1961 to 1975, was a shift in emphasis from the individual to society in regard to sin, salvation and mission. It was a secular theology of mission movement which was anti-church and anti-evangelism, and it shifted the emphasis onto the world.

The dividing line between two distinct foci in the theology of mission of the ecumenical movement is marked by the year 1961. The first change in understanding in the ecumenical mission was a change in sequence of the watchword from "God-Church-

World" to "God-World-Church." From 1948 to 1961, the focus was on the church as the agent of God's mission in the world. From 1961 to 1975, emphasis was placed on the world as the locus for God's *missio,* in which the church participates by its witness in word and deed (Bassham 1979:166).

Another major change took place in 1961 at the Third General Assembly of the WCC in New Delhi. This conference shifted attention and resources away from mission and evangelism and moved them toward socio-political programs. It was a structural change within the ecumenical movement that occurred when the IMC integrated into the WCC as the Division of World Mission:

> The WCC promised that the missionary and evangelistic commitment would now become central to its life and work. The outcome, however, proved otherwise. Integration served at the outset to facilitate the new formulations about mission and later led to actual dismantling of missionary-sending capacity in most member churches . . . What a large door would swing on that small hinge! (Hoekstra 1979:36)

Seven years later, at Uppsala '68, another shift in the theology of mission occurred. Historians had already noted a transitional break at 1945, designating the second half of the twentieth century as the post-war era. Some Christian historians point to a greater sharpness of discontinuity in the decade of the 1960s (Yates 1994:163). This decade was a time of upheaval in fundamental values and traditions, especially in the West. It was J. C. "Hans" Hoekendijk who connected with the students of the day, with the missiologically radical view of a departure from the institutional church as primary agent of mission. He pointed "to the *missio Dei*, God's activity in the world and its structures [functioning] independently of the church." This was a very different

understanding of the notion of *missio Dei* compared to what was conceived at Willingen[6] just eight years earlier (Bassham 1979:168). Catch phrases such as: "the world sets the agenda," "humanization," the church in the "function of apostolate" (the problem of the church in the framework of Kingdom-Gospel-Witness), and the "search for *shalom*" (God-given communal well-being) became part of the ecumenical terminology of mission in use at Uppsala '68 (Yates 1994:196-197). Hoekendijk's views infused the stream of changing attitudes which converged at Uppsala and marked a significant radicalizing of the ecumenical concept (1994:164-165). The evolution of the ecumenical concept of mission led to the reduction of the mission of the church to social and political activism (Hoekstra 1979:111).

This shift did not go unnoted by the evangelical wing. McGavran led the attack on the thrust of the proposals by writing an article that posited the rhetorical question, "Will Uppsala Betray the Two Billion?" (Bassham 1979:79) Despite efforts to the contrary the evangelical voice was not heard at Uppsala (Yates 1994:198). Nonetheless, by the late sixties, a movement among evangelicals was building to recover both the vertical and horizontal dimensions of the gospel. In the face of racism and poverty, it was recognized that a full-orbed gospel was required if evangelization was to be credible.

At Bangkok in 1973, the term humanization became predominant as an interpretation of the mission of the church. The concept evolved into what became known as New Mission in Nairobi in 1975.

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[6] Ecclesio-centric thinking actually started at Madras 1938; by 1952, Hoekendijk is on the attack. He wrote his dissertation on the German mission theory that ultimately was used by some to support the Nazi regime. Hoekendijk was highly incensed over this.

> By participating in this new Mission, the churches are joining with God in his mission of liberation. They are to work together with others from outside the churches as well as those from other churches in this common liberation struggle (Hoekstra 1979:124).

A study was made based on interviews and observations by Harvey Hoekstra. During his participation in 1975 in the WCC Fifth Assembly in Nairobi, he himself an active part of the ecumenical stream, noted:

> A definition of mission has emerged that many feel is too horizontal . . . primarily concerned to work for a better society. . . . Such participation in the social struggle is a worthy objective as long as it does not lead to the eclipse or neglect of the churches' responsibility to win others to faith in Christ (1979:10).

The formation of the International Foreign Mission Association (IFMA) in 1960 marked a beginning of the efforts of evangelicals to seek a well-defined identity. The IFMA was an association of independent North American faith missions. They adopted a theologically conservative stance, which placed them outside of the WCC and the ecumenical movement (Bassham 1979:173). The emphasis of mission at IFMA '60 was obedience to the Great Commission. With the founding of Fuller Theological Seminary's School of World Mission in 1965, church growth became the test of mission and the church growth movement became the most "persuasive and extensive evangelical contribution to mission theology" (Bassham 1979:188, 198).

At Wheaton '66 it was affirmed once again: "church planting has the priority among all other missionary activities" (Bassham 1979:211). During Wheaton '66, longtime North American evangelical leader Clyde Taylor explained the change of the emphasis in the development of the divinely appointed task for the church by the changing of the term missions to mission.

> Moreover, this "mission" includes all united Protestant bodies functioning in their total impact on world society. This involves the Church in economic, social, legislative, administrative, education of youth, welfare, and religious matters. Hence, it can well be said that the mission of the church is not only to get the "uncommitted" in the Church "committed," but its business includes every possible impact that the Church can have in and upon society (Lindsell 1966:143).

Berlin '66 articulated a theology. It established the identity and perspective of the Congress:

> In contrast to other recent ecumenical conferences, such as the Vatican Council, World Council of Churches, assemblies, and the conferences on Faith and Order, and on Church and Society, [this Congress] assumes both the Reformation principle of the final authority of the Bible and the apostolic emphasis on the evangelization of mankind as the primary mission of the church (Bassham 1979:221).

For the first time since World War I, a sense of optimism prevailed at Berlin '66 regarding the completion of the task of world evangelism. "Billy Graham has challenged Christendom to think about World Evangelism in terms of 10 years, rather than 'in our generation.' This is an attainable goal if Christian leaders are willing to harness the vast potential of Literature Evangelism" (Henry and Mooneyham 1967:514). Berlin '66 defined evangelicalism as the prioritization of the spiritual transformation of individuals over the political restructuring of society.

Lausanne '74 took up the task of world evangelization and described this as an agenda, which incorporated all of the concerns embraced by the word "mission" (Bassham 1979:231). Lausanne produced a notable shift in evangelical mission theology. "This occurred through broadening the focus of the Congress from evangelism to mission—a move in which Stott played a decisive role" (1979:231). And "Stott and others in the evangelical world had moved in their understanding of the Great

Commission, which, on Stott's own account, at Berlin '66 had been strictly in terms of evangelism" (Yates 1994:208). The Lausanne Covenant brought together the major streams within evangelicalism and even the more theologically conservative periphery of the liberalizing ecumenical movement. For all intents and purposes it consolidated a theological and missiological consensus (1994:203).

Despite the efforts of the so-called radical discipleship group at Lausanne, Bosch discerned the division between evangelism and social concern, which he called a two-mandate approach and which resurfaced as a fatal dichotomy, as he put it, at Pattaya '80 (1997:405-408). The concern was considered legitimate by the evangelical stream represented by Lausanne, leading to a consultation in Bermuda in 1978 on the "Gospel and Culture." At Bermuda '78 there was the acknowledgement for a mission of holism and that "no theological statement is culture free" (Yates 1994:209).

Pattaya '80 accepted the framework of Christian mission as interpreted in the Lausanne Covenant. It was convened "to seek a fresh vision and power for the task Christ has given to his church until he comes" (Howard 1983:20).

Two global events held in 1980 reflected the different understanding of mission within Protestantism as shown in Table 6. The ecumenical WCC-sponsored Melbourne event and the evangelical Lausanne-sponsored Pattaya event, though only one month apart, promoted two very different understandings of mission:

> But then leaders of the World Council have also been justly critical of many of us evangelicals for our lack of social concern. This polarisation became particularly visible in 1980 when the conference Your Kingdom Come (sponsored by the WCC's Commission on World Mission and Evangelism) was held in Melbourne in May, and the following month the consultation How Shall They Hear? (sponsored by the Lausanne

> Committee) took place at Pattaya, Thailand. Neither group had intended that these meetings should be juxtaposed in this way, although perhaps it served to highlight the continuing tension. A number of evangelicals attended both conferences and found reasons for hope in both. For a perusal of the documents makes it plain that there was much common ground between them. Nevertheless, the emphasis was different. At Melbourne the necessity of proclamation was clearly recognized, but the cries of the poor, the hungry and the oppressed predominated. At Pattaya also the cries of the needy were heard (one mini-consultation focused on refugees, and another on the urban poor), but the call to proclaim the gospel to the unevangelized predominated (Stott 1996:169).

After reviewing perspectives on missiology from the various Christian streams in *New Directions 2*, Scherer, one of the editors of the collection of theological perspectives on mission, pursues an agreed-on understanding of what mission is. He establishes the need for a definition of missiology because of the "current indecision, or at least a divergence of opinion, about what mission fundamentally is" (Scherer and Bevans 1992:175). In his concluding thoughts on the elusive quest for a definition of mission, he admits that it remains obscure: "Missiology, reflecting the status of mission itself, is in a state of flux and ferment. No single definition of 'what missiology is' will satisfy all stripes of missiologist in the absence of prior agreement on 'what mission is'" (1992:175). The quest for understanding mission and missiology continues.

One group that has responded to the challenge of the search for the meaning of mission is the American Society of Missiology, which has come up with a definition helpful for its clarity and brevity. "By mission is meant the effort to effect passage over the boundary between faith in Jesus Christ and its absence" (Shenk 1999:xi). A helpful concept in the pursuit of a meaning for mission is the realization that "[m]ission is synonymous with movement. It stands for purposeful going and doing. Mission implies

challenge to the status quo and invites change" (1999:1). In pursuing the path for the future of the conceptualization of mission as movement, Shenk explores the changing frontiers of mission. Several observations from his reflection help to set the stage for the next phase of the mission enterprise:

1. The modern missionary movement . . . has ended, and a new epoch in Christian mission is unfolding (Shenk 1999:186).

2. Christian faith is inherently expansionist: this expansionist impulse is linked to the goal of history (1999:187).

3. Renewal of faith will be linked to the recovery of a vision of Jesus Christ as God incarnate who became savior and lord; genuine renewal will issue in fresh missionary witness (1999:187).

4. Faithful mission is always in vital relationship with the sociopolitical realm (1999:188).

5. The church of the future will be a minority church in many parts of the world (1999:188).

6. In every age the church must struggle to remain open to the fullness of the gospel (1999:189).

7. The Word is the singular seminal force (1999:189).

8. The greatest integrity and vitality of faith today appears to be found in those churches that have suffered and known martyrdom firsthand (1999:190).

TABLE 6

COMPARISON OF THE ECUMENICAL AND EVANGELICAL UNDERSTANDING OF MISSION
(Adapted from Bosch 1981:65-66)

Melbourne	Pattaya
1. Showed a preference for "Jesus language" of the Gospels.	1. Showed a preference for the language of Paul's epistles.
2. Began with "human's disorder."	2. Began with "God's design."
3. Stressed unity (at the expense of truth?).	3. Stressed truth (at the expense of unity?).
4. Believe that God reveals himself also through contemporary experience.	4. Believe that God reveals himself only through Jesus Christ (and in scripture/the church).
5. Emphasized the deed (orthopraxis).	5. Emphasized the word (orthodoxy).
6. Regarded social involvement as part and parcel (or all?) of the Christian mission.	6. Regarded social involvement as separate from mission, or as a result of conversion.
7. Judged societal ethics to be of prime importance Viewed sin as having a corporate dimension.	7. Judged personal ethics to be of prime importance. Viewed sin as exclusively personal.
8. Tended to equate mission with humanization or social change.	8. Tended to equate mission with a call to conversion or church planting.
9. Viewed proclamation as rendering support to fellowship and service.	9. Viewed proclamation as primary; it gives birth to fellowship and service.
10. Emphasized liberation.	10. Emphasized justification and redemption.
11. Heard the cry of the poor and the oppressed.	11. Heard the cry of the lost.
12. Considered humans from the perspective of Creation.	12. Considered humans from the perspective of the Fall.
13. Judged humanity positively.	13. Judged humanity negatively.
14. Denied the existence of clear boundaries between the church and the world.	14. Affirmed the existence of clear boundaries between the church and the world.
15. Regarded the world as the main arena of God's activity.	15. Regarded the church as the main arena of God's activity.
16. Underscored the church's credibility.	16. Underscored the church's opportunities.
17. Divided the world into rich and poor, oppressor and oppressed.	17. Divided the world into "people groups."
18. Revealed a proclivity towards socialism.	18. Revealed a proclivity towards capitalism.
19. Highlighted Jesus' human nature.	19. Highlighted Jesus' divine nature.
20. Focused attention on the universality of Christ.	20. Focused attention on the uniqueness of Christ.

What Kind of Impact Do Conferences Have?

In his 1996 article titled "World Mission Conferences: What Impact Do They Have?" Norman E. Thomas identifies eight kinds of impact of world conferences related to mission and evangelism as follows: uniting in prayer, broadening koinonia, networking for mission, training for ecumenical leadership, inspiring for world evangelization, transforming mission theology, deepening analysis of mission contexts, and envisioning new wineskins (Thomas 1996:146).

In his reaction to the article by Thomas, Charles Forman observes that the impact of conferences on world evangelization. It tends to fall into two broad categories (Forman 1996:155):

1. Impact on participants within the conference:
    a. Fostering united prayer
    b. Networking for mission
    c. Intensifying fellowship
    d. Training for ecumenical leadership.
2. Impact beyond the conference:
    a. Inspiring for world evangelization
    b. Transforming mission theology
    c. Deepening analysis of mission contexts
    d. Envisioning new wineskins

The effect on participants during a conference may have a major impact on world evangelization outside, and some of these items may be more important than others in terms of the catalytic effect that they have. In either case the assessment is somewhat

subjective. Nonetheless, I agree with the categories that Thomas has identified and Forman has organized. The category that stands out from all the others in my view is transforming mission theology (see 2b above). In reviewing the one hundred years of global conferences and the three Christian streams of Roman Catholic, Orthodox, and Protestant, the impact of world evangelization as a result of the Protestant conferences, both on the home mission sending and supporting constituency, and on the field, greatly exceeds that of the other three streams.

Assessing Global Impact of Conferences on World Evangelization

In assessing the impact on world evangelization, three of the eight kinds identified by Thomas stand out. All three appear in the same broad category described by Forman as having an impact beyond the conference. They are inspiring for world evangelization, transforming mission theology and deepening analysis of mission contexts.

Inspiring for World Evangelization

Those conferences which presented a clarion call were most effective in inspiring world evangelization. “The evangelization of nations, the Christianizing of empires and kingdoms, is the object before us,” Edinburgh declared. “The work has to be done now. It is urgent and must be pressed forward at once” (Thomas 1996:153). The watchword used to rally students for mission in the Student Volunteer Movement was picked up at Wheaton ‘66 and Berlin ‘66. “Our goal is nothing short of the evangelization of the human race in this generation, by every means God has given to the mind and will of men,” the congress declared in its closing statement (Henry and Mooneyham 1967:514).

Lausanne ‘74 declared “Let the Earth Hear His Voice.” The question, “How Shall They Hear?” was addressed at Pattaya ‘80. “Proclaim Christ Till He Comes” was mandated at Lausanne II in Manila ‘89. However, LCWE borrowed from the ecumenical stream of conference reflection and became best known for their call for “the Whole Church Taking the Whole Gospel to the Whole World.” GCOWE ‘95 and ‘97 called for “A Church for Every People and the Gospel for Every Person by the Year 2000.”

Transforming Mission Theology

Throughout the twentieth century, the core theological issue was related to the inspiration, infallibility, and interpretation of the Scriptures. The first sustained applause in the opening address at Lausanne ‘74 given by Billy Graham revealed the importance to the participants when he said: “We are committed to the authority of Scripture; we hold the entire Bible is the infallible word of God” (Ford 1986:11). In 1975, John Stott presented an address on mission to Cambridge University students which he had also presented at Lausanne ‘74. In the opening remarks, Stott acknowledges the core question of a biblical hermeneutic: “Perhaps the greatest need in current ecumenical debate is to find an agreed upon biblical hermeneutic, for without this a broader consensus on the meaning and obligation of ‘mission’ is unlikely ever to be reached (1975b:10).

Deepening Analysis of Mission Contexts

In responding to Thomas’ article on the impact of world conferences, Forman concludes that Edinburgh 1910 and Lausanne ‘74 made the greatest contribution in the deepening analysis of mission contexts. Analysis was carried out in the preparations for

Edinburgh by six commissions, and in the follow-up to the conference, the analysis similarly took place in more than thirty regional and national conferences around the world:

> They proceeded to analyze the mission coverage in each nation and arrange for a more complete and rationalized distribution of mission work. The World Dominion Surveys of the 1930s were an outgrowth of this process, with some twenty volumes published on various countries and areas (Forman 1996:157).

The Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization Strategy Working Group, investigated the unreached peoples of the world and held conferences on the unreached peoples. The most detailed development, assessment, publication and distribution of the unreached peoples was done in relation to GCOWE '95 and '97 by the AD2000 and Beyond Movement. Following GCOWE '97 in South Africa, a Christian leader listed the "Unique Contributions of the AD2000 Movement to World Evangelization," which included the following items:

1. Has empowered an unprecedented global awareness of and commitment to completion of the Great Commission.
2. Has produced an unprecedented, global Third World, non-Western awareness of, commitment to, and involvement in leadership for fulfillment of the Great Commission.
3. Has provided an unprecedented global platform on which mission/church leadership from East/West and North/South have been able to meet for action plans related to fulfillment of the Great Commission.
4. Has provided an unprecedented global awareness of the need for national- and people-group specific strategies for evangelism in contrast to the traditional ad hoc approaches (Butler 1997).

Conclusions: The Lessons Learned

A review of selected conferences in the twentieth century provide some important lessons to be learned which are listed below. Conferences from the evangelical world were more successful than the Catholic or Ecumenical. Several facts emerged in my conversation with Shenk:

> Evangelicals kept up the momentum when WCC and the Catholics have subsided in the last fifteen years. The evangelicals have maintained the confidence of the lay people and managed to raise the funds for the events. Evangelicals have used conferences to create stronger unity (2001c).

There are several reasons that global conferences have a greater impact on world evangelization. Among them are the following:

1. Planners of every international mission conference face a tension in the purpose. "Shall the primary purpose be to inspire and educate for mission? Or shall the purpose be to study thoroughly and reach a new consensus on vital questions of mission thought and action?" The genius of Edinburgh 1910 was that it achieved both goals. The conference was the climax of an essential process of reflection (Thomas 1996:153).

2. A conference is more effective if it is part of a process rather than an end in itself. "The Edinburgh Continuation Committee, through follow-up conferences, stimulated the formation of missionary councils on national and regional bases, which became building blocks of the future ecumenical movement" (Thomas 1996:153).

3. A conference does not stand in isolation. Every mission conference is part of an historic line of events convened for the purposes of enhancing mission. "Any consideration of the future of the missionary movement must take into consideration the factors that originally produced it" (Walls 1996:258). Yet there are times to assess when

a movement has run its course. “The missionary movement is now in its old age. It is not a useless and decrepit old age. There are situations where it provides the most effective . . . means of making any witness to Christ . . . But the conditions that produced a movement have changed” (1996:261).

4. A conference is more effective if it follows up with a continuation committee that carries the conference spirit and essentials around the world. This occurred in relation to Edinburgh 1910, the Lausanne conferences and the GCOWE events.

5. A conference which makes a catalytic impact on world evangelization understands and is able to articulate the significance of the historical context in which it is taking place. For example, at the close of the IFMA ‘60 conference, a world survey overview appealed to the fact that the world’s population had increased seventy-five percent in the preceding fifty years and that most of the increase had been among the underprivileged people (Percy 1981:8). It also emphasized the need of the hour:

> You and I live in a world of turmoil. It is a day of drastic upheaval and unparalleled change. The fifty years which have passed since the Edinburgh Conference in 1910 have been the most revolutionary in man’s history. The technical advance in man’s ingenuity has brought the most remote nations to our doorstep. . . . The speeding up of travel and communications has telescoped centuries into decades, years into months and days into hours (1981:7).

6. A conference needs to address the issue of appropriate structures for mission. Each generation of Christian leaders are to keep an eye on what God is doing in and through the church, and be prepared to reinvent their structures and find the appropriate wineskin to support those divine initiatives. Reflecting on the role missionary societies have played over the past two centuries, Andrew F. Walls observes the values of different

kinds of structures. The voluntary association offers "its instrumental character, its relatively recent origin, and its special structure . . . individuals, churches and congregations freely act together for an object of common interest. It is essentially a pragmatic approach, the design of an instrument for a specific purpose" (1996:242). On the other hand, church structures "could only do what they had always done; a new concept needed a new instrument" (1996:243).

7. A conference needs to watch its mission theology closely. We may well take heed to some of the last written words of Paul to one of his mentorees when he wrote: "Watch your life and doctrine closely. Persevere in them, because if you do, you will save both yourself and your hearers" (1 Ti. 4:16).

What the role of global mission conferences will be in the twenty-first century is yet to be seen:

> Is a new model of international mission conferences possible in the twenty-first century? Will it address needs both for inspiration and collective action—both for global unity and local autonomy? In this information age, new possibilities are emerging. Electronic networking and the sharing of information through the Internet make possible not merely rapid transmission of information before international conferences but also wide and deep discussion of issues before, during, and after them (Thomas 1996:154).

My own conclusion to this discussion is that global mission conferences have had and always will have a far-reaching and lasting impact on world evangelization. Some conferences, however, have much greater impact than others.

CHAPTER 6

A CATALYTIC CASE STUDY—THE AD2000 MOVEMENT

In this chapter, key elements are explored of the AD2000 and Beyond Movement (AD2000) as a catalytic movement for world evangelization. The chapter is organized around the catalysts of world evangelization developed in the preceding chapters. The catalytic nature of the aim (Chapter 2), means (Chapter 3), structures (Chapter 4), and human agency (Chapter 5), in world evangelization can be traced using AD2000 as a case study. AD2000 provides a contextual and institutional platform for demonstrating the constancy of the nature of catalytic impulses that come from conferences, renewal, and unique leaders seeking the glory of God. The AD2000 case study shows that, to the degree that a world evangelization movement draws catalytic impulses from an appropriate goal, structure, leadership and means, is the degree to which the movement itself becomes a servant-catalyst in mission.

The introduction of the chapter describes the birth of AD2000 and the methodological approach for fashioning the aim and vision. The first section deals with visionary goal. The second section develops the structural dimensions of AD2000. The third section describes the leadership. The fourth section reviews the catalytic means utilized in AD2000. The conclusion provides an assessment of AD2000.

An Introduction to AD2000

During the second half of the twentieth century, many Christian leaders and organizations perceived some new moves of God around the world, and called for special prayer and consideration of these moves. From this period of prayer and reflection, AD2000 developed during the late 1980s. Its primary purpose was to encourage existing and new movements to work together across prevailing barriers, in order to advance the cause of Jesus Christ and his Great Commission. The movement grew as more and more individuals and entities worldwide joined the cause in which they would collaborate in the vision of a church for every people and the gospel for every person by the year 2000.

The Birth of AD2000

AD2000—a catalyst with a servant theme—was born to strategize, encourage, network, inspire, research, and disseminate information about what the Holy Spirit is doing through the church globally. Its stated purpose: "in a spirit of servanthood, to encourage, motivate and network men and women church leaders, by inspiring them with the vision of reaching the unreached by the year 2000 through consultations, prayer efforts and communication materials" (Bush 1993:1). The intention was to encourage cooperation among existing churches, movements, and structures to work together towards this same vision (1993:1). "A Church for Every People and the Gospel for Every Person by AD 2000" became the rallying cry.

To what extent did AD2000 serve catalytically to precipitate and increase the rate of reaction of the Great Commission process to advance the Christian movement?

Assessing this and the means and principles it used can only be of great interest to us as we consider the future of the world Christian Movement of the twenty-first century.

The Setting: A Key Moment in History

AD2000 arose for such a time as this. The year 2000 became a magnet for a convergence of trends with related expectations. For example, Health for All 2000 was a World Health Organization (WHO) initiative with its theoretical roots in the Alma Ata Declaration 1978, which focused on physical health for every human being by the end of the year 2000. The three aims were: (1) The development of alliances and networks within the community, (2) the integration and delivery of health promoting activities, and (3) the promotion of the health of primary care staff (Fletcher 2001).

The Shaking of the Nations

The fall of the Berlin Wall in 1989 symbolized a dramatic turning point in human history. The break-up of the former Soviet Union, the movement of some nations toward democracy, the migration of hundreds of thousands of refugees across national borders, the intensification of tribalism and nationalism have altered the geo-political landscape. The dismantling of the old Soviet Empire under the centralized authoritarian regime resulted in a proliferation of nations open to new ideas. One of the consequences is that since 1990, the United Nations (UN), up to this time, had grown twenty-eight percent in number of member nations. It was as though God were shaking the nations, giving access to Christian messengers in a way that had not happened in a hundred years. The contextual conditions surrounding the end of the second millennium served to provide a

suitable platform to launch a global Christian movement. In addition, the year 2000 became a giant magnet for all of mankind.

Secularist Sees a Decline of the Age of Unbelief in the 1990s

Early in the decade, *Time* magazine published a four-page essay entitled*:* "The Year 2000: Is It the End or Just the Beginning?" The author, Henry Grunwald, is a former U.S. ambassador to Austria, and *Time*'s former editor-in-chief. Writing from a secular perspective, Grunwald summarizes his thesis in the introduction by saying, "People feel as if the hand of God were turning a page in human fate. We have a sense of things ending and others beginning" (1992:74). He makes three observations:

> First, of course, we are witnessing the end of communism. Second, we are witnessing the end of nationalism, as we have known it and beginning to look for new international arrangements; and third, we are witnessing the end, or at least the decline, of the age of unbelief and the beginning of what may be a new age of faith (1992:74).

This last point is the major point of his article. "Many people seem to want a faith that is rigorous or demanding, or else more personal. . . . Throughout the Third World, Christian churches especially the Evangelicals are gaining more converts than ever before" (Grunwald 1992:76).

Futurists Predict Spiritual Awakening for the 1990s

Not only secularists, but futurists also predicted a spiritual awakening in the 1990s. In their best-selling book, *Megatrends 20000—Ten New Directions for the 1990's*, John Naisbitt and Patricia Aburdene described the "unmistakable signs of a worldwide

multi-denominational religious revival" (1990:270). "Religious belief is intensifying worldwide under the gravitational pull of the year 2000, the millennium. . . . The bond we share today with the people of past millennial eras is the sense of living in a time of enormous change. . . . When people are buffeted by change, the need for spiritual belief intensifies" (Naisbitt 1995).

Maturing Church in the Developing World

The center of gravity for Christianity worldwide in terms of growth, energy, and vision has been shifting from the North and West to the South and East. What was once commonly viewed as the primary mission field has become the home base of the majority mission force. An increasing number of leaders for this worldwide Christian movement are emerging from the rapidly growing churches of the developing world. The history of western missions can now be seen as a transition: from pioneer to paternalist, from paternalist to partner, and now from partner to servant.

From the Far East, China-born Thomas Wang created the fountainhead of the AD2000 Movement. In May 1987, as International Director for the Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization (LCWE), he posed the question: "The Year 2000: Is God Trying to Tell Us Something?" in an article by this title (1987). In this very article, the seeds of AD2000 germinated.

The emergence of Two-Thirds world missions involved the rise of non-western mission agencies, which could evangelize in countries that reject missions from the west. From a mere 3,000 cross-cultural missionaries from Asia, Africa, and Latin America in 1973, today there are almost 100,000. Some estimate the church in Latin America is

sending more missionaries into the Islamic world than all the rest of the church combined. During the year 2000, it was anticipated that the majority of all Christian missionaries would come from the Two-Thirds world. Never have so many from so many cultures been engaged in taking the gospel to so many different contexts.

Stott noted the potential for the AD2000 and Beyond Movement due to these new missions initiatives emerging in the Two-Thirds world:

> The AD2000 and Beyond Movement has set itself the double goal by the end of the millennium of a church for every people, and the Gospel for every person. It has been statistically demonstrated that world evangelisation in these terms is attainable, not least because of the proliferation of indigenous missions in Africa, Latin America, and the Pacific Rim of East Asia. These may under God not only take the Gospel to the ends of the earth but also revitalize the tired churches of the West (1995:50–55).

Indeed, much of the leadership of AD2000, and a majority of its funding, emerged from this Two-Thirds world missionary movement. The biggest financial challenge in the decade was GCOWE ‘95, held in Seoul, Korea, in May 1995. It brought together approximately 4,000 Christian leaders from 186 countries of the world to consider and strategize regarding the goal of a church for every people and the gospel for every person. The Two-Thirds world Christian church demonstrated its full partnership, if not primary initiative, in the cause of world evangelization. Since each delegate was expected to raise his or her own travel costs, the vision was at a fundamental level, grass rooted. In addition, more than seventy percent of the consultation’s funding came from Africa, Asia, and Latin America. Not only did the Korean church take up the largest share of any country, but they were also the first to financially support and commit to the primary global thrust proceeding from GCOWE ‘95, called Joshua Project 2000. In the same way,

the African church raised more than seventy percent of the funding for the 4,000-participant GCOWE '97, held in Pretoria, South Africa.

The Great Commission Methodological Framework

In the late 1980s the AD2000 Movement (AD2000), drawing from the existing global plans of organizations and country initiatives, intentionally aligned the watchword and purpose with the Great Commission texts, primarily Matthew 28 and Mark 16.

> Its primary purpose was to encourage existing and new movements to work together across prevailing barriers to cooperation, in order to advance the cause of Jesus Christ and his Great Commission. The movement grew as more entities worldwide joined the cause in which they would collaborate, "A church for every people and the gospel for every person by the year 2000" (Bush 2000b).

The vision involved making the gospel available to every person in the world in a language they could understand and to see a saturation church planting movement established in every country of the world by AD 2000. Perhaps going beyond the perimeters of the Great Commission, AD2000 had the goal of seeing Christ become incarnate in the life of a vital congregation within access of every person in every community of every city, town, and village, for every group of people and every class, kind and condition of mankind (Bush 1993:10). At the first global consultation on world evangelization by the year 2000 and beyond (GCOWE '89), held in Singapore with the authors of global evangelization plans up to the year 2000, a Great Commission Manifesto was prepared that unanimously called for cooperation with empowerment for and compassion toward the fulfillment of the Great Commission (see Appendix E).

AD2000 was criticized for gospel reductionism and lack of a holistic gospel by its so-called focus on the Great Commission texts. This was exacerbated further by the year-2000 time target and consequent managerial missiology for reaching the goal of a church for every people and the gospel for every person by AD2000:

> We praise God for the extent to which there is worldwide cooperation in this endeavor stimulated by AD2000. . . . This evangelistic acceleration has a darker side, however—reliance on our powers of reasoning without a wholehearted search for God's wisdom and leading based upon his word, buttressed in prayer, and full recognition of our total reliance on him. Worldliness has entered through reduction of world mission to a manageable enterprise. Samuel Escobar has coined the phrase "managerial missiology to refer to an unduly pragmatic endeavor . . . to reduce reality to an understandable picture, and then to project missionary action as a response to a problem that has been described in quantitative form (Engel 1997:11-12).

Utilizing the Great Commission texts of Scripture as the methodological framework for the vision and mission of AD2000 is not unusual in the course of church history (see Appendix F). In fact it can be argued that this was the dominant framework in the apostolic age as well as in the wake of the Enlightenment (see Appendix F). Regardless there are legitimate concerns for the way it has been used to encourage God's people to mission based on the imperatives of Scripture rather than the compassion and grace of God based on a few texts of Scripture.

The Catalytic Aim—The AD2000 Vision and the Glory of God Theme

AD2000 served as a Great Commission catalyst by remaining tightly focused on its stated purpose. The stated purpose of AD2000 was to motivate and network men and women church leaders by inspiring them with the vision of reaching the unreached by the

year 2000, through consultations, prayer efforts, and communication materials (Bush 1993:1, 44).

A Vision-Driven Movement

The vision of AD2000 operated on the assumption that for God's people to be mobilized, the vision must be owned by the Body of Christ in every continent. Rather than yet another idea imported into the Body of Christ in a country, it must be a vision emerging out of the Body of Christ in a country. Therefore, AD2000 gatherings emphasized listening in prayer, in studying God's word, and in looking for God's movement in history to determine God's voice for the present time regarding adopting the AD2000 vision.

The glory of God theme was taken up in AD2000 as both a foundational undergirding assumption as well as in communicating the vision of AD2000. The very first words in AD2000 Handbook reflect the centrality of the glory of God in its mission "His glory is our ultimate concern" (Bush 1993:Preface). While the glory of God was in the background of the AD2000 Great Commission vision the major texts articulating the vision relating to filling the earth with God's glory (Ha. 2:14). In assessing AD2000 at the end of its timeframe, Robert T. Coote refers to this same passage of Scripture and comments on the worthy heritage: "Old Testament prophets envisioned a day when 'the earth will be full of the knowledge of the Lord as the waters cover the sea' (Isa. 11:9; Hab. 2:14)" (Coote 2000:162).

Motivating for the Great Commission

The two key catalytic words contained in the AD2000 purpose were motivate and network (Bush 1993:44). Men and women were motivated by inspiring them with a compelling vision. Out of the many plans by denominations, mission agencies, global conferences, national movements, and other Christian organizations the vision watchword became "A Church for Every People and the Gospel for Every Person by AD2000."

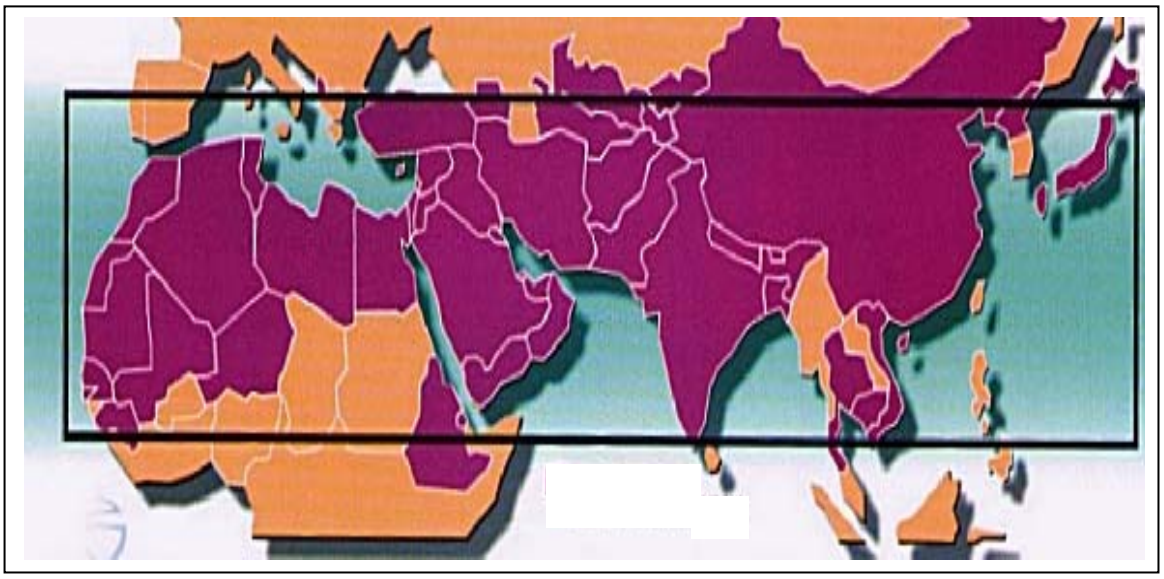
The vision did not change or become diluted during the course of the decade. Aided by the watchword, those involved remained focused on the original vision. While it was sometimes criticized as sloganeering to complete the task or triumphalistic Great Commission countdowns (Engel and Dyrness 1999), nonetheless many churches, missions and movements worldwide pursued the goal. Encouragement came from a wide variety of God's people. Some mainline historic denominations, such as the Presbyterian Churches in the United States of America (PCUSA), affirmed the goal of "A Church for Every People and the Gospel for Every Person by the Year 2000 and Beyond" for their own churches at their 208th General Assembly:

> The 208th General Assembly adopted two goals for evangelism, which have far-reaching implications for Presbyterian Global Mission in the next four years. In the first place the GA called the Presbyterian Church (USA) to join with a worldwide movement of evangelism and mission that is seeking "a church for every people and the gospel for every person by AD 2000 and beyond". By this action the Presbyterian Church (USA) as a denomination became part of the "AD2000 Movement". Secondly, the General Assembly adopted a goal of having Presbyterians or our global partners engage in mission and evangelism among 200 of the world's least-evangelized peoples by the year 2000. By this action the Presbyterian Church (USA) as a denomination committed itself to a "faith-sized" role in the AD2000 Movement (Ritchie 1996).

The Focus on the 10/40 Window

At the first meeting of the international board of AD2000 in July 1990, it became clear to all that if we were serious about providing a valid opportunity for every people to experience the love, truth, and saving power of Jesus Christ, we could not ignore the reality that we must concentrate on the spiritually resistant region of the world (Minutes 1990:ms.). They were referring to what has become widely known as the "10/40 Window."

The priority, but not exclusive, focus of AD2000 became the "10/40 Window," a term coined for the area of the world between ten degrees and forty degrees north latitude, stretching from northern Africa and southern Spain to Japan and the northern Philippines. Critics argued that to focus on the 10/40 Window is to skew the biblical call to the whole world. "Too many expressions of reductionist thinking (over-simplifications of the complex task) have influenced the Evangelical missionary movement for the last fifty years. They include . . . a limited geographic focus" (Taylor 1999). The major concern expressed, even by sympathizers, was the shifting of original parameters by groups and agencies associated with the movement. "[A]s a sympathetic reviewer trying to take the original parameters and descriptions at face value, it was enormously frustrating!" (Coote 2000:165).



MAP 1

THE 10/40 WINDOW
(Bush 1991:3)

But there were compelling reasons for focusing on the 10/40 Window (Bush 1991:1). The 10/40 Window contained most of the least-evangelized peoples and countries of the world: approximating ninety-seven percent of the people living in the fifty-five least evangelized countries in 1989. This is also where about eighty-five percent of the poorest of the poor live. When the world's fifty countries with the lowest quality of life are identified and mapped, they almost entirely fit within this "Window." It is also where the three main non-Christian religious blocks, Islam, Hinduism, and Buddhism, are headquartered.

In his book, *The Church Is Bigger than You Think,* Johnstone deals with the six-fold challenge before us in the twenty-first century: urban, social, people, ideological,

spiritual, and geographic. He suggests that the 10/40 Window represents the primary geographic challenge entering the twenty-first century because it is the geographical location in which each of the previous five challenges are most prominent (1998:212-278). Johnstone's assessment looking back on the decade was as follows:

> The 10/40 Window focus was brilliantly successful. The unusual phrase became a household phrase across the evangelical world. The most neglected part of the world basked in unaccustomed attention, thousands of congregations were mobilized for prayer and action, hundreds of agencies re-formulated strategies and recruitment of workers for the unreached significantly increased. In the authors' own agency, deployment in the 10/40 Window went up from 34% in 1984 to over 70% in 2000. The concept became almost too successful—sometimes in being applied to invalidate any mission activity outside the Window! (2001:6).

Spreading the Vision

The vision-casting element of AD2000 was not only its main distinctive, but also a main method. Through a survey I conducted in preparation for GCOWE '89, it became clear that the consensus among Christian leaders was that the greatest obstacle to world evangelization by the year 2000 was the lack of vision. On one of the questions in the survey, the respondent was asked to rank, in order of importance, the practices necessary for networking in world evangelization. Almost one-hundred percent of the more than 1,000 respondents from sixty countries answered: "Sharing of Vision" (Bush 1989:183).

Vision became central to all methodologies utilized. Vision-carriers would seek to catalyze the global church by communicating the thousands of initiatives focused on the year 2000, particularly as they related to the goal of a church for every people and the gospel for every person. In the process, many new initiatives developed. In India, for example, India church historian, S. D. Ponraj, documented at least 140 separate major

plans in India by the time of GCOWE '95 (1995:28). By the next year, another fifty were added to total 200 major plans in India alone.

Some Christian leaders in India criticized AD2000 for inspiring this kind of planning tool. "Under the influence of the AD2000 movement some Indian leaders have come up with bombastic slogans, militant language and a general demeaning of Indian culture" (D'Souza 1999).

Sharpening the Vision—Joshua Project 2000

The question by mid-decade became how to work together more effectively toward implementation of the overall vision in the final five years of the decade while counting on a growing global prayer initiative. The answer was by sharpening the vision of a church for every people by focusing on a selected list of 2000 least evangelized larger peoples of the world.

As the decade unfolded, two rather distinct phases of AD2000 emerged, with GCOWE '95 serving as the dividing line between the two phases. The first phase was the vision-sharing phase, the second the mobilization or implementation phase. In consultation with the AD2000 network and task force leaders, a document was prepared for national and regional leaders from 186 countries of the world called "Possible Outcomes of GCOWE '95 to Fulfill the Unfinished Task by December 31, 2000." The document was reviewed in a number of sessions at GCOWE '95. Out of the process of consultation, the fact was established that delegates had faith to believe that God would continue to perform miracles to open the hearts of the lost, if the body of Christ would

rise to the challenge. The expected result was the establishment of a mission-minded church planting movement within every ethno-linguistic people by AD 2000. In addition, there was conviction that the turn of the millennium was a unique occasion to reemphasize the urgency of taking the gospel to the ends of the earth.

A proposal directed to AD2000 leaders emerged: to build the next five years of work on two specific efforts, the AD2000 National Initiatives and Joshua Project 2000. These would be empowered through the networks, task forces and ministries related to the movement. So Christian leaders from seventy-seven countries met in a seven-day conference, from November 28 to December 2, 1995, in Colorado Springs, called *The Launch*. Its purpose was to set in motion the five-year, final thrust of AD2000. The backbone would be National AD2000 Initiatives, along with a new project, Joshua Project 2000. Both thrusts would be empowered by the existing and new AD2000 resource networks and task forces. It was the conviction of participants that through Joshua Project 2000 the almost 2000 least evangelized larger peoples of the world would have a church planting movement initiated by the year 2000. The expectation was that through the AD2000 national initiatives, both the Joshua Project 2000 peoples and the unreached peoples less than 10,000 in number would have a church by the year 2000.

It was the conviction of participants at GCOWE ‘95 that a global effort was needed to focus attention and provide tools for implementing the vision for the church for every people by the year 2000 by developing a selected list of unreached peoples. *The Launch* represented the initiation of the implementation phase of AD2000 for the second half of the decade following the vision-casting phase of the first half. In order to work

together toward the vision two approaches were adopted, (1) national initiatives to the year 2000 that would prioritize pioneer church planting among the unreached and, (2) Joshua Project 2000.

Joshua Project 2000 was a global cooperative strategy, focused on the least evangelized peoples of the world, which sought to engage every church, agency, denomination and Christian from every country in the world in an effort to implement the goal of "A Church for Every People and the Gospel for Every Person by AD2000." The goal of Joshua Project 2000 was to establish a pioneer church planting movement within every ethno-linguistic people of over 10,000 individuals within every country of the world by December 31, 2000. "The Joshua Project . . . is the largest strategic mobilization of Christians in history to disciple the people of the world. Support and enthusiasm has come from across a wide spectrum of denominations agencies and countries. In the latter, the involvement has been predominantly non-Western" (Johnstone 1998:107). To inform the vision of the 2000 largest least evangelized peoples an expansive research effort was conducted and the information disseminated.

The Catalytic Structure— AD2000 Organization and Conferences

At the beginning of the decade of the 1990s, more than 2000 individual plans for global evangelism existed, each focusing on the year 2000! One-third of these originated in Africa, Asia, and Latin America, which, until recently, were viewed as the major target of missionary concern. The church planted in those areas was now on the march, reaching out with the same gospel to reproduce itself throughout the whole world. But most of

these plans were operating independently, without any knowledge of areas of overlap, neither of ministry nor geography.

Through the Lausanne II Conference in Manila and the Global Consultation on World Evangelization (GCOWE '89) in early 1989, church leaders became aware that if the world was to be reached for Christ by the year 2000, a concerted, synergistic effort was needed. Evangelical groups needed to work cooperatively, identifying the needs, sharing the vision, and mobilizing personnel and resources, with each group still retaining particular distinctives and autonomy. The Great Commission Manifesto, issued at GCOWE '89, challenged God's people toward the vision of a church for every people and the gospel for every person (see Appendix E). At the Lausanne II conference those people who participated earlier in the year at GCOWE '89 in Singapore gathered to consider whether to launch a new structure. The answer from those who met was overwhelmingly favorable.

One of the distinguishable features of AD2000 was the nature of the organizational structure. Bound together by a common vision with a commitment to unity that all might believe participants in AD2000 associated in functional networks (see Figure 5) and geographically-oriented national evangelization initiatives (see Figure 6).

For large denominational structures that associated with AD2000, the distinctive nature of the structure had to be interpreted to their constituency. Jefferson Ritchie, a leader in the Presbyterian Churches in the United States of America (PCUSA), does this in an article to Presbyterian churches following the decision of the PCUSA General

Assembly to adopt the AD2000 vision of a church for every people and the gospel for every person by the year 2000:

> The new ecumenical movement for evangelism known as the 'AD 2000 Movement' is providing a model of ecumenicism (*sic*) that moves beyond the church bureaucrats or 'official representatives' talking to other officials. The ecumenical reality represented by AD 2000 is much more radical and much less hierarchical than our current ecumenical relations. What binds AD 2000 participants together is a commitment to unity 'that the world might believe.' Within this commitment one is linking networks, partnerships, and other sorts of associations for carrying out the evangelization of a particular people or even an entire nation (Ritchie 1996).

The AD2000 organizational structure was essentially a flat network, fastened somewhat elastically together by common purpose and vision, rather than a hierarchical arrangement. In order to maintain these flexible but essential links, there were two primary requirements for network leadership. First, resource network chairpersons and coordinators were to keep the overall AD2000 purpose statement in the forefront of all network communications, both verbal and written. Second, network leaders were to seek ways in which their own interest groups could contribute to the accomplishment of the overall AD 2000 purpose (Bush 1993:18). Network leader, C. Peter Wagner, noted: "We are all controlled from the bottom up rather than from the top down" (Bush 1993:2). Bong Rin Ro, General Secretary of the World Evangelical Fellowship Theological Commission at the time, emphasized that AD 2000 was "a grass-roots networking structure" (1993:2). William D. Taylor, Executive Director of the World Evangelical Alliance Missions Commission, called it a "grass-roots movement, a network of networks, a fusion of visions" (1993:2). Philip Butler of Interdev observed that

AD 2000 had "focus on catalyzing, mobilizing, multiplying resources, thru [sic] networks" (1993:2).

AD2000 leadership structure was based primarily on relationship not hierarchical structure. This was particularly catalytic in involving those from the Two-Thirds world, because it corresponded with the typical way of relating within these cultures. These relationships were forged through two areas of affinity: common ministry interest in the resource networks[1] or geographical focus in the national initiatives. Leaders clustered and bonded by ministry interest area. Over the course of the existence of AD2000, there were twenty affinity tracks. These were called resource networks in that they sought to resource the area of affinity worldwide.

Resource Networks

The primary building block for the first half of the decade, enabling AD2000 to operate as a grassroots, bottom-up movement, was the resource or functional network. Resource and functional networking introduced in AD2000 provides insight into structural change conducive for operational flexibility while maintaining accountability. In Figure 5, I have tried to illustrate these functional networks by relating size, the largest being the global and the smallest the grass roots. These functioned on up to four geographical levels from the local or statewide, to the national, to the regional, and, finally, to the global level. People representing the network at the grassroots can be

[1] The resource or functional networks—also called affinity tracks—galvanize vision for world evangelization within that interest group, according to their own unique corporate giftedness or mission-specialty by networking Christian leaders for an intensified effort of world evangelization by AD 2000, encouraging cooperative relationships with existing movements, networks, and structures to work together toward the goal of a church for every people and the gospel for every person.

linked together to a national network. The regional networks bring together clusters of national networks. The global networks bring together clusters of regional networks. As Figure 5 depicts, the synergistic relational connectivity took place, not only within the resource networks at the various geographic levels, but also between networks.

The resource network A circle in Figure 5 shows the linkages of five individuals in relation to one another. Resource network B is a parallel network. Supposing in Figure 5, the resource network A represented the unreached peoples network. In that case ideally there would be a network facilitator at the grass-roots level by state. In the example in Figure 5, five states in Nigeria: Edo, Kano, Abia, Ibo, and Oyo each have an unreached peoples network facilitator. An unreached peoples network facilitator for Nigeria would be the hub for connecting these grass-roots facilitators. The regional network of Africa would bring together clusters of national networks, including Nigeria, as shown in the figure. Various means of communication were utilized as shown on the right side of the figure. There was a special track newsletter related to the unreached peoples network that was distributed among network facilitators at the various levels. There was a global electronic conference that reported on network activities of the different AD2000 networks. There were statewide and national meetings in Nigeria to interchange information, perspective and further catalyze the process of reaching the unreached peoples of Nigeria. GCOWE ‘97 was held in South Africa and more than 1,000 leaders came for the African regional assessment of network activity throughout the continent. At GCOWE ‘95 in there were two days in which the unreached people

network met. Through the entire process there was a notable well-documented advance in ensuring that there was a church among every people in Nigeria by the year 2000.

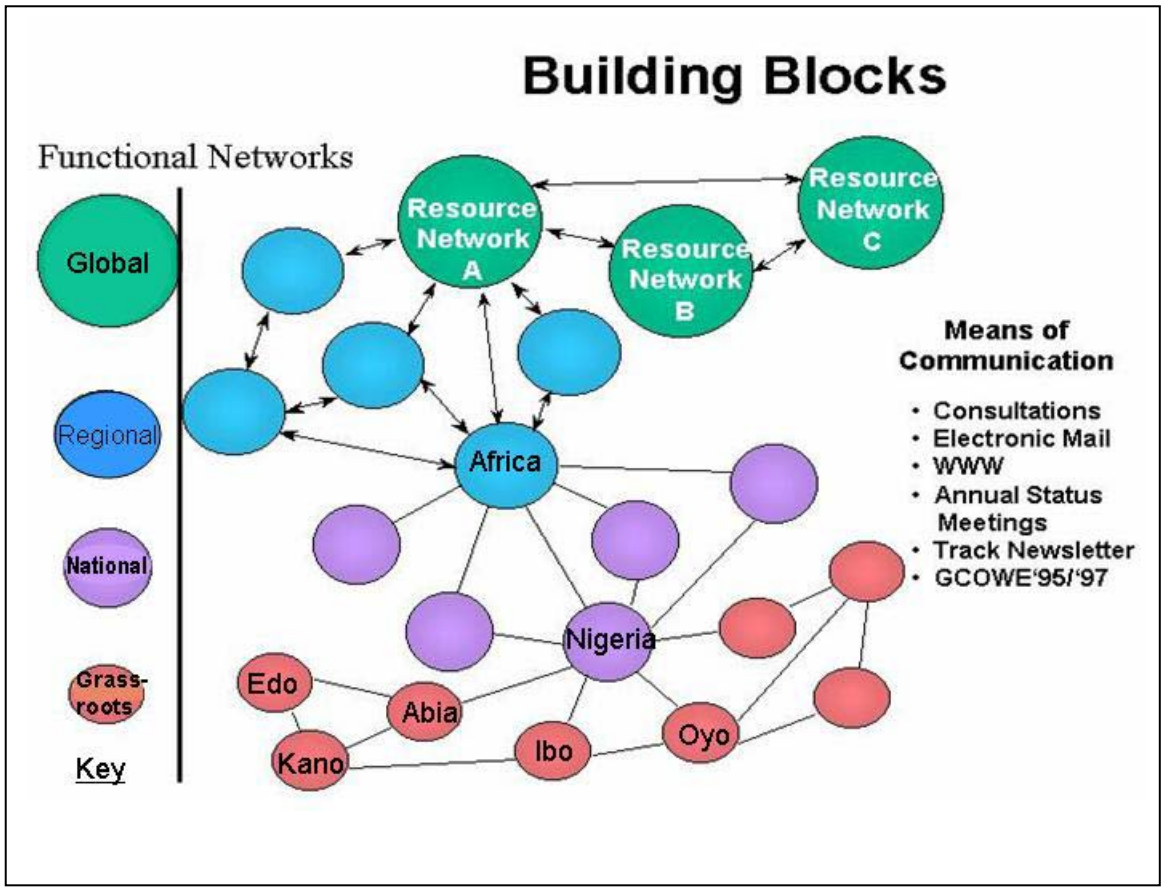


FIGURE 5

AD2000 RESOURCE NETWORK STRUCTURE

The means of communication in both directions took place during network or national or global consultations, through electronic mail, on the Internet (www), at annual status meetings, through track/network newsletters, and at the global events of GCOWE

‘95 and ‘97. This framework allowed for the development of leadership following the model of Jesus Christ as a master multiplier.

Global-Multiplier Effect of Networking

Through functional networks, and within the general purpose of AD2000, there was a global-multiplier, catalytic effect in evidence. Each of the tracks, by design, stood as a semi-autonomous unit, with respective chairpersons and coordinators responsible for the organization, personnel, style, funding, and activities of their track. These specific track objectives were in support of the overall objectives of the movement. The expected result thus reinforced the vision of the presentation of the gospel to every person in every nation and people group, and the establishment of an indigenous church planting movement in every country and people group by the year 2000. Annual meetings with track and task force leaders kept the loose structure from dissolving. Track leaders worked out among themselves the ways and means of helping each other, engaging in joint projects, eliminating unnecessary redundancy and synchronizing their activities. Each track sought ways to support and encourage other tracks.

Seeing Disagreements as Opportunity for Increasing Understanding

It was inevitable that bringing together such a vast arena of different perspectives within the Christian world, different ethnic groups, language groups, political groups, theological groups, economic groups, racial groups, and geographic groups, would produce conflict and disagreement from time to time. How those disagreements were

handled could enhance or dissolve the movement. One such disagreement happened in 1995 at the launch of the Joshua Project, when the delegate from one country took great exception to the way that the people groups from his country were designated in the Joshua Project list.

AD2000 network leaders had been defining the unreached *ethne* Christ called the church to reach primarily in terms of their linguistic distinctive. The same reality of the unfinished task and the imperative of Christ's mandate to make disciples of all *ethne* was looked upon by Christian colleagues from that country as people groups, strictly defined by the anthropological society of the country.

The AD2000 resource networks were already highly focused on their own functional calling. They felt that their way was the right way. The Radio Task Force (World by 2000), for example, identified and tracked the language groups of the world, setting up networking with the national church or other mission agencies in each of these areas and producing broadcasts in each language. They did it logically, language by language.

In contrast, the nationals from that country, seeking to effectively witness in their own communities mentally divided the task on the basis of people group. Language was only one distinctive of the basic people group. Because of this, one participant from that country appeared intent on disrupting the entire go-forward launch of the last five years of the movement. As I spoke with him by phone and with other colleagues from that country, I was distraught thinking about the impact that this could have on a five-year plan that had the broad support of the movement. In my own spirit, I wrestled with the

issue over several weeks prior to the meeting and found myself inclined to consider that this was only a problem of the group from this particular country. However, as we met face to face prior to *The Launch*, alone and with others, to address the issue, I realized that rather than disruption, this view would increase understanding, perspective, and even enhance our approach to the task before us. The leaders from that country, too, eventually learned to appreciate the value of the outsider's perspective, and in the end, both groups, as well as the task itself benefited from the exercise of understanding each other.

Countrywide Initiatives

The vision and direction of a countrywide initiative (also known as national initiative) emerged out of a consultation process of national Christians, together with international resource people to understand their own political, economic, social, religious, and Christian context, and to make plans for the future based on these realities. In AD2000-type national initiatives, facilitators sought to recognize what God was already doing in a nation. Rather than launching a massive new movement or building a huge structure, facilitators affirmed existing structures and cooperative Great Commission initiatives.

A national initiative focused on mobilizing and deploying the national church to penetrate every least-evangelized people within the nation by AD2000, and to be aggressively involved in national saturation church planting. Ultimately the goal was a gathering of Bible-believing Christians within practical and cultural distance of every person in the nation. Thus, as a priority and minimum, the goal was to see a pioneer

church planting movement within every ethno-linguistic people in every nation and every country and mega-city of the world by the end of the year 2000. Beyond that the national initiative goal was the establishment of a saturation church planting movement in every nation by the end of the year 2000.

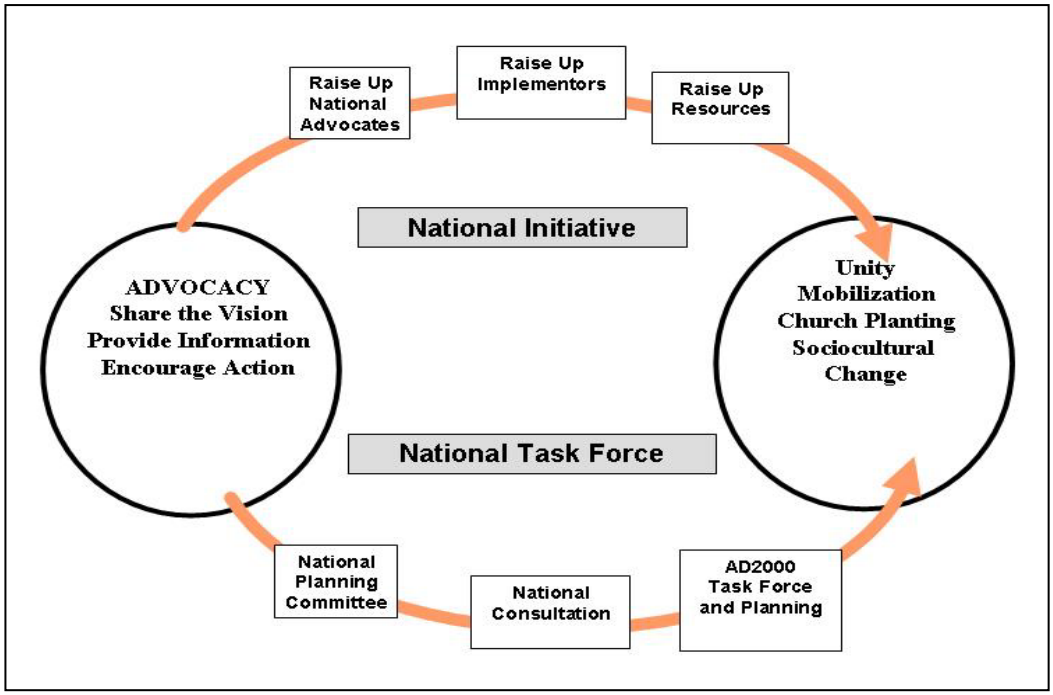


FIGURE 6

THE RAISING UP OF RESOURCES THROUGH COUNTRYWIDE INITIATIVES

As pictured in Figure 6, this process raised up national advocate-implementers, Christian leaders from different groups, denominational structures and ministries. Their unity was forged around the common AD2000 vision and led to church planting and

sometimes socio-cultural change. Typically, during the consultation process, a national task force coalesced and became the primary leadership. This task force had as its objective to mobilize the body of Christ in the nation to complete the unfinished task of evangelization in their own country and to make a contribution to world evangelization.

Two Distinct Phases in Structure

During the course of the AD2000 Movement, the primary emphasis shifted from the conceptual and practically focused resource networks or tracks, to the geographically-oriented regional, countrywide, and sometimes metropolitan initiatives. In his September 6, 1996, President's Annual Report of the newly-formed Global Harvest Ministries, the legal umbrella under which the AD2000 United Prayer Track would function, Wagner perceived accurately two distinct phases of the AD2000 Movement decade, with GCOWE '95 the watershed between the two:

> The most important change, both for the Prayer Track and for A.D. 2000 in general, from phase one to phase two, was a switch in emphasis from what has been called the "vertical" structure of A.D. 2000 to the "horizontal" structure. The vertical structure is the tracks (also called resource networks) plus another ten task forces. The horizontal structure is the development of national A.D. 2000 movements in each of the different nations of the world. This means that the role of the United Prayer Track was more crucial to the overall ministry of A.D. 2000 in the first half of the decade than it is in the second half. It also means that as national organizations get in place over the next few years, many of them could continue indefinitely even after December 31, 2001, particularly if all the unreached people groups are not reached by that time (1996:1-2).

Leading the interactive task force, Pete Holzmann expressed his perspective of the transition. He observed the change to a priority focus on the national initiatives:

> By the time of [the] Handbook's third edition (1993), the AD2000 & Beyond Movement clearly recognized it was fully functioning in two

> arenas. The first, and most visible, was a ministry interest group (or resource network) dimension. Within this view was found a wide variety of whole gospel emphases, from prayer to church planting, Bible translation, urban and youth ministry, mobilization of women, business people and more. The second dimension was a regional/national focus, with national committees developing national strategies for accomplishing the mission task. This two-dimensional view made a significant difference in refining our strategic global thinking. Perhaps most important, we learned that national initiatives take precedence over ministry interests. People in the field have the clearest understanding of needs; they're also the ones who must live with the result of mission efforts. With this understanding, the 'whole world' (the context dimension) was complete, and properly positioned relative to content (1999).

Catalytic Partnerships

Patrick Johnstone, the chairman of the Unreached Peoples track, presented at GCOWE '95 a conceptual model of completing the unfinished task of world evangelization. Johnstone's model identified about 135 people clusters, within which all the peoples of the world could be grouped. Following this model, Philip Butler, coordinator of the Partnership Task Force, developed an intentional strategy to establish a partnership in each of the Gateway Peoples by the year 2000. Gateway clusters are closely related peoples based on a common identity of language and name but sometimes on the basis of culture, religion, economy, or dominance of one group over another.[2]

The goal of each partnership was to coordinate sodality and modality activities in order to utilize available resources in the most effective manner for the Kingdom. These partnerships drew representatives from agencies, churches and organizations all over the

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[2] For example, in the Arab affinity block there are the following gateway people clusters: Arabian Arab, Bedouin-Arabian, Egyptian, Hassaniya, Kabyle Berber, Levant Arab, Libyan Arab, Maghreb Arab, Riff Berber, Saharan Berber, Shawiya Berber, Shuwa, Arab, Sudan Arab, Tamazight, Tashelhayt Berber, Tuareg, and Yemeni Arab.

world, and provided an important forum for communication, prayer and fellowship. To be effective, a partnership had to develop the following characteristics:

1. International: Must draw people and agencies from all continents
2. Inclusive: Must have active participants representative of many different churches and agencies, with more added regularly
3. Integrated: Must integrate church planting, teaching, Bible translation, radio, relief, business development, and water projects into cooperative initiatives
4. Intentional: Must not function as loose network, but as strategic alliances with the partners agreeing to work in a common purpose to achieve clearly defined, obtainable objectives (Tunehag 1997:8).

A partnership needed a facilitator who would communicate the vision, help build the relationships among churches and agencies committed to reach a particular people group or area, and who understood the process and principles that effective partnerships need. This aspect proved to be the most important one of all.

Massive growth continued to happen in the establishment of strategic evangelism/church planting partnerships among the major unreached peoples of the world. As of May 1999, there were forty-five operating Gateway People Cluster partnerships with sixty-two others in development. That left only twenty-five gateway peoples left unengaged. In addition, there continued to be other geographic and functional partnerships operating around the world. At that point, there were approximately 400 international organizations involved in these partnership efforts, with about one third of these being non-western agencies (Partnership Update 1999). A networking and partnership manual, including an adoption guidance program, to inform and instruct in the development of effective networks and partnerships as a structural model for the 1990s provided further catalytic impetus (Bills 1999).

A Catalytic Coordinating Office

The stated overall purpose of the Movement was to encourage, motivate and network men and women church leaders. The international office was established to catalyze, communicate and coordinate the global AD2000 initiatives from a headquarters in Colorado Springs, through convening global planning meetings, managing the information and communication process and carrying the vision throughout the world. In summarizing the impact of AD2000 one periodical noted:

> The AD2000 Movement started out as a small office to disseminate information. Although there was never more than 15 staff working from the home office . . . the catalytic impact of this movement grew far out of proportion to its size (R. Wood 2001).

The primary contribution of the catalytic coordinating office operation towards the overall vision of being a servant-catalyst can be observed in Figure 7. Moved by a compelling vision, the office sought to be a linkage point for ministries interested in working together toward the overall vision. The links between various ministries and the office often reinforced country and regional initiatives. As noted on the left side of Figure 7, multi-ministry organizations or denominations with ministries that had a primary effort aligned with the movement's vision ("compelling vision" on the diagram) typically resulted in a strong connection to the international office. This connection might be expressed in such items as frequency of contact, contribution to office funding, involvement with office activities and staff. Compare this to the example on the right where a large organization has only a secondary effort lining up with the compelling vision of the movement. In the left-hand figure, the greater strength of the ministry's primary focus works in tandem with the movement's parallel focus, bringing more

frequent and closer communication with the international office. In the figure on the right, there is a similar linkage, but also the reality of a strong pull in another direction (the ministry's primary focus), and therefore less frequent and often more impersonal relations with the international office.

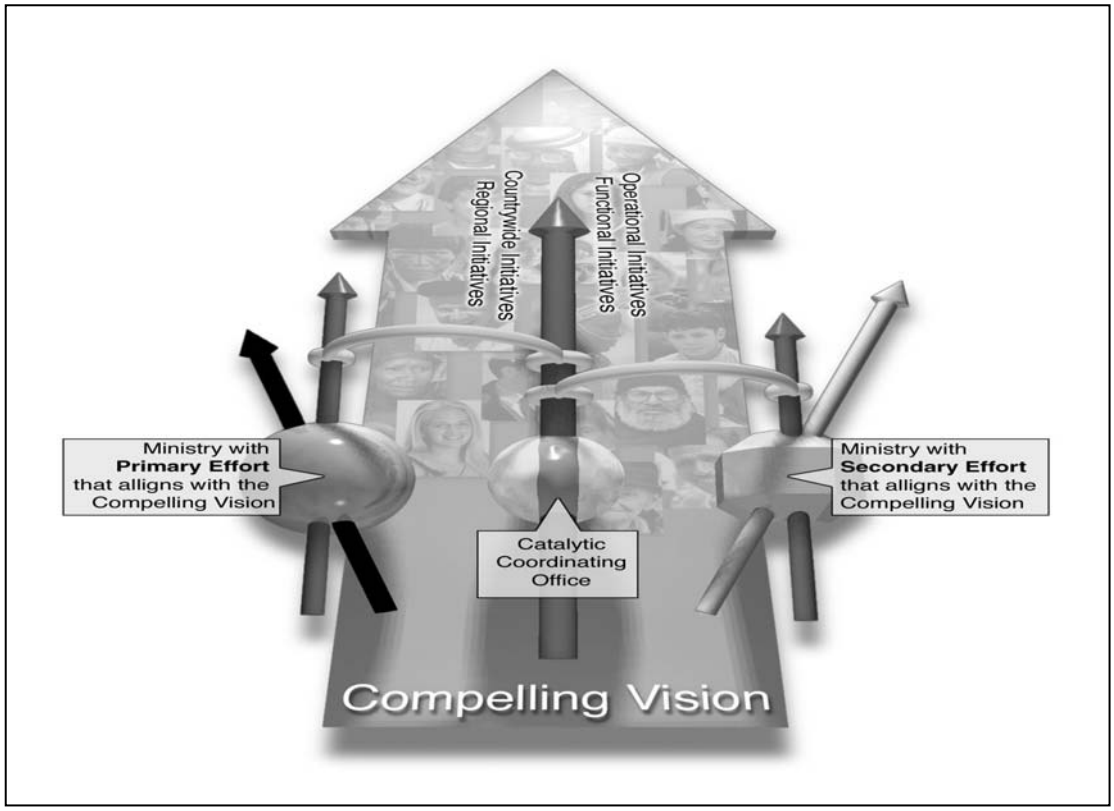


FIGURE 7

CATALYTIC COORDINATING OFFICE

AD2000 leaders remained motivated, not only through consultations and prayer efforts, but also through communications. Communications were generated both formally and informally as a vital part of the process of involving Christian leaders. For significant

events, a few timely, quality press releases were produced and distributed. Reports were generated of what God was doing through national and network initiatives. There was a considerable spread of ownership and contributions.

Newsworthy reports of AD2000-related events, progress, and perspectives were distributed through electronic conferences, via e-mail and, upon approval by the national coordinator, later on the web. (The web was not yet known even as late as GCOWE '95). Due to the public nature of the web, however, on several occasions these web-published reports stirred up opposition by groups opposing Christian witness in their nations. This led to a discussion on appropriate and inappropriate terminology, which in turn led to a consultation on the language of mission.

Conferences

About 4,000 mission leaders from 186 countries gathered in South Korea, in May 1995, to pursue the ways and means to establish a church for every people and the gospel for every person by the year 2000. This was the Global Consultation on World Evangelization by the Year 2000 and Beyond (GCOWE '95). An undergirding assumption was the divine superintending and coalescence of global events, such as the demise of communism and the failure of secular humanism to satisfy the needs of man, so there was a sense of movement from an age of unbelief to an age of faith approaching the year 2000. The explosive growth of the Two-Thirds world church positioned the church around the world for a major evangelistic thrust in the 1990s, along with the growing conviction that genuine partnership was the only way to take advantage of the opportunities presented by the last decade of the millennium.

Prayer, reconciliation, partnerships, strategic planning, empowerment, and mobilization for world evangelization were the hallmark outcomes of the 1995 Global Consultation for World Evangelization (GCOWE '95). The aspects of the consultation appeared to move along a continuum, but each portion overlapped at times. Some of these were planned outcomes, but others, such as empowerment and reconciliation, were planned only on the Holy Spirit's agenda, and happened spontaneously. These spiritual initiatives had far-reaching effects in impacting world evangelization in the years ahead. The founder of Operation Mobilization, George Verwer, characterized GCOWE '95 in the following way: "I believe that GCOWE is a catalytic atomic bomb" (1995:9).

GCOWE '95 was, above all, a spiritual event that created a ripple effect among participants from 186 countries, as well as the more than 30,000 Korean young people who filled the Olympic Stadium as one part of the event. John Amstutz, Assistant to International Director, Foursquare Missions, wrote:

> First and foremost, GCOWE '95 was a spiritually significant event. Seldom has our living Lord been worshipped in so many languages at one time in one place. It was Pentecost revisited and heaven anticipated. Africans, Asians, [Latin Americans], Europeans and North Americans prayed and praised the Lord together. Yes, for many GCOWE '95 was more than an event. It was a life-changing experience (Hargrove and Hargrove 1995).

Prayer

The two primary spiritual dynamics that led to significant impact in world evangelization from GCOWE '95 were prayer and reconciliation. The significant role of prayer in relation to mobilizing Christian leaders for world evangelization was observed and noted (Thomas 1996:151). Prayer was highlighted by the schedule of the plenary

sessions. Sprinkled throughout the minute-by-minute outline was "praying for the unreached peoples in twos and threes," "Korean-style prayer for every country to have a national initiative focused on the unfinished task," "children praying for the nations," "prayer and weeping for the cities," "prayer for mobilization," and so on. Prayer was not only planned but spontaneous as interruptions were permitted to pray whenever the Spirit led during the meetings. Two or more delegates with hands joined, praying in the hallways, was a common sight.

Intercessory prayer "covering" was also seen as key to progress. Over one hundred prayer intercessors paid their own way to Seoul to pray around the clock for GCOWE '95. The Sunday evening worship service was a highlight for many as the delegates were led in a Concert of Prayer. Fifty child intercessors attended GCOWE '95. These children had been identified by Esther Ilnisky, AD2000 Children's Prayer Network, as she traveled internationally, over a period of many months seeking children with an unusual degree of gifting and motivation to pray for the nations of the world. It challenged the hearts of all to see the intense fervor for prayer and world evangelization at such tender ages.

One focus of GCOWE '95 was on Praying Through the Window II. This AD2000 prayer initiative sent teams to pray on site in each of one hundred key cities, designated as "Gateway Cities of the 10/40 Window," primarily during October 1995, while other registered millions prayed from their own homes and churches around the world:

> Seoul 1995 concentrated a special focus on the 1700 least evangelized cities and called for special prayer and evangelism attention to the gateway cities of the World 10/40 Window. No urban concern of similar strength developed twenty-one years before at the Lausanne Congress on

> world Evangelism. . . . Seoul, we suggest, symbolized the growing concern of the world church for the city (Conn 1997:10).

Vonette Bright, co-founder of Campus Crusade for Christ and former Chairperson of the Lausanne Prayer Committee, said: "I have never experienced so much prayer in an international gathering of Christians before" (Hargrove and Hargrove 1995).

Representing the U.S. delegation, Paul Cedar, Chairman of Mission America, signed a spontaneous document seeking forgiveness and reconciliation with Christian leaders of other nations. It read in part:

> [W]e acknowledge and confess our sins of omission and commission, the arrogance expressed in undue national pride, the unjust treatment of minority groups within our own nation, the insensitivity to other nations and cultures, the undue dependence on our own plans and technology, our unteachability, the extravagant appropriation of God's resources for our own use, the conspicuous consumption of global resources, the fragmentation of the Body of Christ, and the imposition upon others of our cultural forms as though they comprised the gospel itself. In sincere humility and in the spirit of reconciliation expressed in 2 Corinthians 5, we ask forgiveness for the negative impact upon others of our sinful attitudes and actions and we express our commitment to the unity of the Body of Christ. Will you forgive us? (Hargrove and Hargrove 1995)

David Bryant, President of Concerts of Prayer, considered the event to be nothing short of a miracle. He wrote:

> [GCOWE '95] was an absolute miracle. There are no other words to use to describe it. It was awesome to see how God, in the face of tremendous human weakness, perfected His power in bringing the conference together, and then in baptizing us with His vision for the coming years and for each of our lives, our nations, and our coalitions (Hargrove and Hargrove1995).

Reconciliation

Prayer prompted reconciliation. The reconciliation between Christian leaders that took place at GCOWE '95 impacted participants deeply, paving the way for working

together in the subsequent national initiatives and resource networks. To a number of participants, reconciliation between Christian leaders was life- and ministry-changing, unleashing a wave of reconciliation among Christian leaders around the world.

The significance of the spiritual dynamic was that it was neither predicted nor orchestrated but a natural outcome of the prayer and bonding, which occurred between individuals, ethnic groups, mission agencies, denominations, and countries. It led to a growing conviction that reconciliation among God's people and world evangelization are inextricably linked. Many of the leaders recognized that they could not hope to evangelize the world without first being reconciled with each other.

Possibly the most extraordinary event of this kind took place in the sanctuary atop of *Prayer Mountain* in Kwang Jo, a few kilometers outside of Seoul. Paul Ariga, a Japanese evangelist, had heard that Isaac and Peter Lee, who run Cornerstone Ministries, an outreach to North Korea, had lost their grandfather after being badly treated by the Japanese, who had occupied the Korean peninsula in the first half of the twentieth century. Kneeling before Isaac Lee, with his brother Peter close by along with other Koreans, Paul Ariga cried out, "I repent before each of you, but especially Brother Lee, whose grandfather was killed by the Japanese. I repent before him and ask for reconciliation through the blood of Jesus that was shed on the cross" (Lee 2001).

> One of the most powerful forces unleashed at the recent Global Consultation on World Evangelization (GCOWE 95) was the power of reconciliation which broke out like a wildfire, spreading from one meeting to another as various groups forgave each other for the past sins of the people or group they represented (R. Wood 1995:18).

Avery Willis, Southern Baptist Foreign Mission Board, Vice-President of Overseas Operations, recognized the need to ask forgiveness form the participants. In a speech to the GCOWE '95 delegates said:

> We want to ask forgiveness from you for thinking we could do that kind of job [reaching the world by the year 2000] without you. We recognize that it's going to take the whole body of Christ to reach the people of this world. Business as usual will not get the job done (R. Wood 1995:18).

The reconciliation between leaders paved the way for meaningful interchange. This led to enhanced networking across many cultural and ministerial boundaries:

> [T]he global evangelization meetings were at their best when Christians talked face-to-face. This was the case for Christians from countries of the former Soviet Union's Central Asian republics. During the conference, these Central Asian Christians met together for the first time ever, explained a Southern Baptist worker who works with an unreached people group in Central Asia. "What we saw happen in this meeting was phenomenal," he said. The Central Asia meeting brought together Christians from Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Tajikstan, Uzbekistan and Turkmenistan. "We had Kazaks, Kyrgyzs, Uzbeks, Turkmen and Western expatriates from different churches. There were Russian Baptists, Pentecostals, charismatics—all sitting down at one time . . . We had Russian Baptists and Pentecostals—who traditionally haven't even believed each other to be real believers—talking together about their common needs in the work," the Baptist worker said. "The change in this meeting was incredible" (Baptist Press News Service 1995).

As a result of the prayer, repentance and reconciliation, a spirit of unity arose. The spiritual combustion flowing from the event made a significant impact on world evangelization. The impact of GCOWE '95 and the AD2000 Movement on world evangelization is summarized in the year 2001 edition of *Operation World 21st Century*:

> The AD2000 and Beyond Movement launched in 1989 proved to be the most global, focused movement for world evangelization that there ever has been. Its ministry came to an end in January 2001 according to its charter, but the effects will impact the 21st Century. It was a coordinating

> network of many of the more activist evangelical bodies around the world (Johnstone and Mandryk 2001:6).

The Catalytic Leader—AD2000 Participants

As a catalyst, AD2000 involved Christian leaders by serving existing structures that shared the same vision. This common purpose multiplied and broadened implementation efforts. The resulting sum total in catalytic relationship was greater than each individual part.

One example of this occurred with the call of Bill Bright. He called for a meeting with the Campus Crusade for Christ (CCC) Directors of Affairs to present the AD2000 vision with the prospect of finding common ground that could mutually enhance the broader initiative of God in both AD2000 and CCC. The resulting cooperative relationship between the two entities enhanced AD2000 while boosting the New Life 2000 project being undertaken by CCC.

Christian leaders responded worldwide from large, medium and small organizations, ministries, churches, denominations and movements. Lay men and women became involved. There were formal and informal relationships established. Involvement included spiritual and operational aspects.

AD2000 was fueled by the distinct giftedness of the leaders and their organizations. As each mission leader considered aligning with the movement, he or she faced the same question, both internally and from others: “Is there enough added value by involving myself and the ministry/organization I represent in the AD2000 process to

merit the cost in terms of time, money, and risk of criticism?" As leaders plunged or waded into the movement, we learned from and grew to respect one another.

Selecting and Recruiting Leaders

In the previous decade of the 1980s, indigenous leaders in Africa, Asia, and Latin America, emerging from the centuries-old mission effort by the west, were at the periphery of the world Christian movement. But it was at this Two-Thirds world periphery that the core AD2000 leadership emerged. The intention of AD2000 was to proactively recruit and involve Christian leaders around the world, in a goal of reaching the unreached by the year 2000:

> In a spirit of servanthood, the AD2000 seeks to encourage, motivate and network men and women church leaders by inspiring them with the vision of reaching the unreached by the year 2000 through consultations, prayer efforts and written materials (Bush 1993:1).

But this process was not without influences working against it. The Christian leaders who became involved in AD2000 came as individuals, yet for the most part, represented ministries with their own callings and ethos, which could have a negative effect on taking up a new set of goals and ethos. There were also no financial promises for getting involved. Money could not be a motivation.

No, the primary motivation for engagement in the AD2000 process was purely one of vision. One of the criteria for participation at the mid-decadal event in Seoul, for instance, was to embrace the vision of "a church for every people and the gospel for every person by the year 2000" and to agree to disseminate the vision in their own constituencies following the event.

Leadership Selection Basic Assumptions

People interested in participating in AD2000 leadership were expected to adhere to some basic assumptions. These were expressed as follows:

1. A commitment to the spirit and content of the "Great Commission Manifesto" produced at the 1989 GCOWE in Singapore (see Appendix E).
2. A commitment to the Lausanne Covenant and the WEF Statement of Faith.
3. The realization that when the whole church is mobilized, there is a much greater probability that the whole world will be reached.
4. Because of its explosive growth throughout the Two-Thirds world in this century, the church is positioned for a major evangelistic thrust in the 90s.
5. Those best equipped to reach a people/nation are the Christians from that group.
6. A commitment to proclaim the Gospel to all people by the year 2000.
7. A commitment to establish a mission-minded church planting movement within every unreached people and city by the year 2000.
8. A need to network Christian leaders with the same vision for world evangelization by AD 2000.
9. A commitment to enhance and strengthen existing movements and organizational structures (Bush 1993:10).

Leadership Selection Guidelines

Guidelines for representatives in resource networks from the different countries, as well as for GCOWE '95 delegates, were posted in the AD2000 handbook. They were as follows:

1. Credibility—An active member of a local church, recognized by the national leaders and respected by the different segments of the church as in good standing in his or her immediate Christian community.
2. Experience—A responsible Christian leader who is recognized in the interest area of the resource network.

3. Bridge builder—Prepared to build bridges between God's people within the country and internationally.
4. Spiritual maturity—Above reproach in his or her testimony; approved by church leadership in the country and with own accountability support structure.
5. Vision—Burden for the church in his/her country and for the evangelization of the country. A person who desires to see a church for every people and the gospel for every person in his/her country and the world.
6. Team player—Works well with others. Can comfortably interact with others who might disagree with him or her while maintaining mutual respect.
7. Leadership qualities with organizational support—Has the support and organizational structure to develop resource networks within the country.
8. A person of faith—Prepared to trust God for finances to travel nationally and internationally (Bush 1993:18).

Problems in Leader Selection

Since leaders became involved in AD2000 first as individuals, rather than as emissaries of their organizations, time and resource pressure resulted in a non-rigorous selection process. Though the results were generally the involvement of high-quality leaders, there were several problems that occurred in the process. Some choice servants of God worldwide did not find a home in AD2000. Some considered the assumptions too narrow and restrictive. Others held a more holistic perspective of the gospel. They were concerned about gospel reductionism. Some became involved temporarily, only to find, in time, that they did not embrace the perspective of others in leadership and either dropped out or felt they were not heard.

Due to the leadership structure's looseness, and that the structure was by nature down-up rather than top-down at the regional and national levels, there were only

minimal efforts to monitor the leadership selections in relation to the guidelines. Where major regional and or national consultations were held, representatives, and even national coordinators, were appointed, without consulting or applying the stated guidelines. This resulted in persons being appointed to leadership position who did not meet guideline qualifications.

A Volunteer Army

One necessary aspect of the AD2000 modus was the necessity of mobilizing leaders to volunteer their time and effort. Leaders seeking to be involved were expected to pay their own way. This included participation in global AD2000-sponsored events and travel costs to attend. In some cases, where costs were astronomical relative to typical national income, scholarships were sought to bring the costs down, but the costs were still substantial compared with income level. In Africa in some cases, a single delegate was funded by many churches, with offerings gathered over many months. Similarly, track leaders and members were expected to develop their own financial resources for administering their resource networks.

The Catalytic Virtues of Voluntarism

The pursuit of the AD2000 vision by a wide variety of volunteers added new insights and ownership to the movement, which often added excitement and ownership back home as well. When the African churches gave sacrificially over a long period of time to send their delegate, they truly sent an emissary of themselves and received him or her back with a spirit of expectancy of hearing from God.

Because AD2000 leaders did not depend on the movement for their livelihood, they participated willingly, not compelled by movement authority or money. Financial dependency did not cripple their freedom to speak frankly in the movement. Even in the international office, the staff raised their own support or were seconded from other organizations, with only a couple of exceptions. This all-volunteer force was frequently energized with fresh insight. Track leaders experimented with new approaches. People thought "outside of the box." There was freedom to pursue new ideas, dream new dreams. It created leadership space for emerging leaders from around the world.

The Challenges of Voluntarism

Despite its many virtues, voluntarism is inherently self-directed and self-sustained. It depends on maintaining an individual participant's motivation. An individual's contribution varies from volunteer to volunteer and from time to time or event to event, based on commitment. In order to be fully utilized, the volunteer needs to shift to a different world. The AD2000 world had its own vision, values, vitality, and culture, which had to be understood and embraced to some extent, if the volunteer was to make a contribution to the process. The volunteer needed to mesh gears with a committed plan already processing. This was no small feat when the AD2000 machinery was already turning rapidly. The volunteer brought his/her own gifts and concerns, and it usually took time and a little experimentation before finding an appropriate fit into the process. Volunteers had to face the realities of geographical distance and different cultural mixes in which to operate.

New Leadership Emergence

Early in the decade of the 1990s, the world missions community hoped and anticipated that AD2000 would create a wave of new Christian leaders to serve the cause of the gospel throughout the world. The cover story of one publication read, "The Incredible Meaning of the AD2000 and Beyond Movement," and inside said, "Thousands of leaders will emerge in AD2000 process . . . raising up international leadership from dozens of countries" (R. Wood 1992). As the decade progressed, this expectation proved true.

The development of new leaders took place through informal rather than formal means. Annual meetings, held among the global network leaders and regional coordinators, provided for the development of insights about the vision and practical approaches to its application, through the reporting and informal networking that took place. Often, the issues, obstacles and advances reported by a representative from one region of the world served to inspire a regional coordinator from another for similar endeavors in his own context. The cross-fertilization of ideas and approaches to the mission within the context of networking encouraged others.

From the beginning of AD2000, the intentional approach to leadership development sought to model Jesus' approach with the twelve disciples. The gospels informed this approach to leadership development, as did *The Training of the Twelve,* by A. B. Bruce and *The Master Plan of Evangelism,* by Robert Coleman:

> Probably the most careful study to date in the master's larger plan of evangelism has been done in reference to the training of the disciples, of which A. B. Bruce's *The Training of the Twelve* is the best . . . this narrative of the disciples' growth in the presence of the master is still unsurpassed for wealth and insights into this subject (Coleman 1993:21).

A. B. Bruce realized the supreme importance Jesus attributed to the training of the twelve. “The careful, painstaking education of the disciples secured that the Teacher’s influence on the world should be permanent” (1976:13). Coleman follows suit: “Jesus devoted most of his remaining life on earth to these few disciples. He literally staked his whole ministry on them” (1993:31).

An adapted approach for involving and developing people in the AD2000 process was based on foundational six steps, described as follows:

> Jesus Christ is not only the Master but also the Master Multiplier. When you stop to consider that almost 2000 years ago he began with but twelve followers and today there are estimated to be more than 1.8 billion who claim to be his followers, it is abundantly clear that the process of discipleship he followed in his brief three year ministry worked. In his ministry of discipleship you can observe at least six basic steps of development of a committed disciple with a vision to reach the world. These same six are the steps that outline the process of involvement in the AD 2000 vision by network. They are identification, selection, recruitment, communication or association, mutual discipleship, and challenge (Bush 1993:5).

The first three steps that global track leaders were encouraged to follow, to incorporate national network leaders for their resource network, were identification, selection, and recruitment. The fourth step was called communication or association. “He appointed twelve—designating them apostles—that they might be with him” (Mk. 3:14). There was an appointment to be in constant association with him that they might observe him in action and hear him as he taught. “Contrary to what one might expect, as the ministry of Christ lengthened into the second and third years he gave increasingly more time to the chosen disciples, not less” (Coleman 1993:43). In AD2000, association was

encouraged through national and regional consultations, the global consultations, and through e-mail and written communication.

Although these six identifiable separate steps were evident in the AD2000 process for developing leaders in the AD2000 vision, the last three steps were not only sequential, but overlapping. They were often congruent.

The fifth step, mutual discipleship, was based on the assumption that all followers of Jesus would continue learning from one another as they grew in their relationship to the Master. In AD2000, mutual discipleship happened as leaders became involved in a network or national initiative. Exemplary of many national consultations were the ones held in Nigeria. The national coordinator, Reuben Ezemadu, set up the consultation so that there would be reports from the different groups engaged in the AD2000 process about their own programs. These would illustrate, model, and stimulate others in the praxis, the principles, and the faith behind such initiatives. While some people found the approach repetitive and even boring, it achieved the desired objective and was very catalytic.

The sixth step, challenge, emerged out of the other five and especially the fifth. This was achieved through the various pairings, partnerings, and cross-pollination of ideas with like-minded Christians from within networks, though from different countries, theological persuasions, or cultures, or, from their own countries, but representing different networks, theological backgrounds, and ministries. The result was mutual challenge to fulfill their own commitments toward specific goal-monitored efforts which

would contribute toward the global and regional vision of a church for every people and the gospel for every person.

The Catalytic Means—Renewal and Prayer

From the beginning of the decade, renewal and prayer were important means for catalyzing world evangelization. As the decade unfolded, two distinct phases of AD2000 emerged, with GCOWE '95 serving as the dividing line between the two. The first phase was the vision-sharing phase, the second the mobilization and implementation phase. Prayer initiatives and efforts grew throughout both phases.

Renewal and the Pentecostal and Charismatic Stream

Approximately half of the active participants in AD2000 were Christian leaders from the Pentecostal and Charismatic movements infusing a pneumatological dimension into the Movement. The impact of the Pentecostal and charismactic movements on the renewal of has been very significant. In Chapter 3, which describes renewal the catalytic means of world evangelization, I describe the role of the Pentecostal and Charismatic movement of the last century and especially its influence in the last quarter century. Notably in the last twenty-five years a reshaping of the church is taking place as a result of the two-fold impact of renewal within the worldwide church due mainly to the rapidly expanding influence of the Pentecostal and Charismatic movement as well as internationalizing nature of the church, especially in Africa, Asia and Latin America infusing the church with new vision, and empowered and vitalized to launch a new global

thrust in mission. Consequentially, a wave of renewal was introduced by the Pentecostal and Charismatic participation into AD2000.

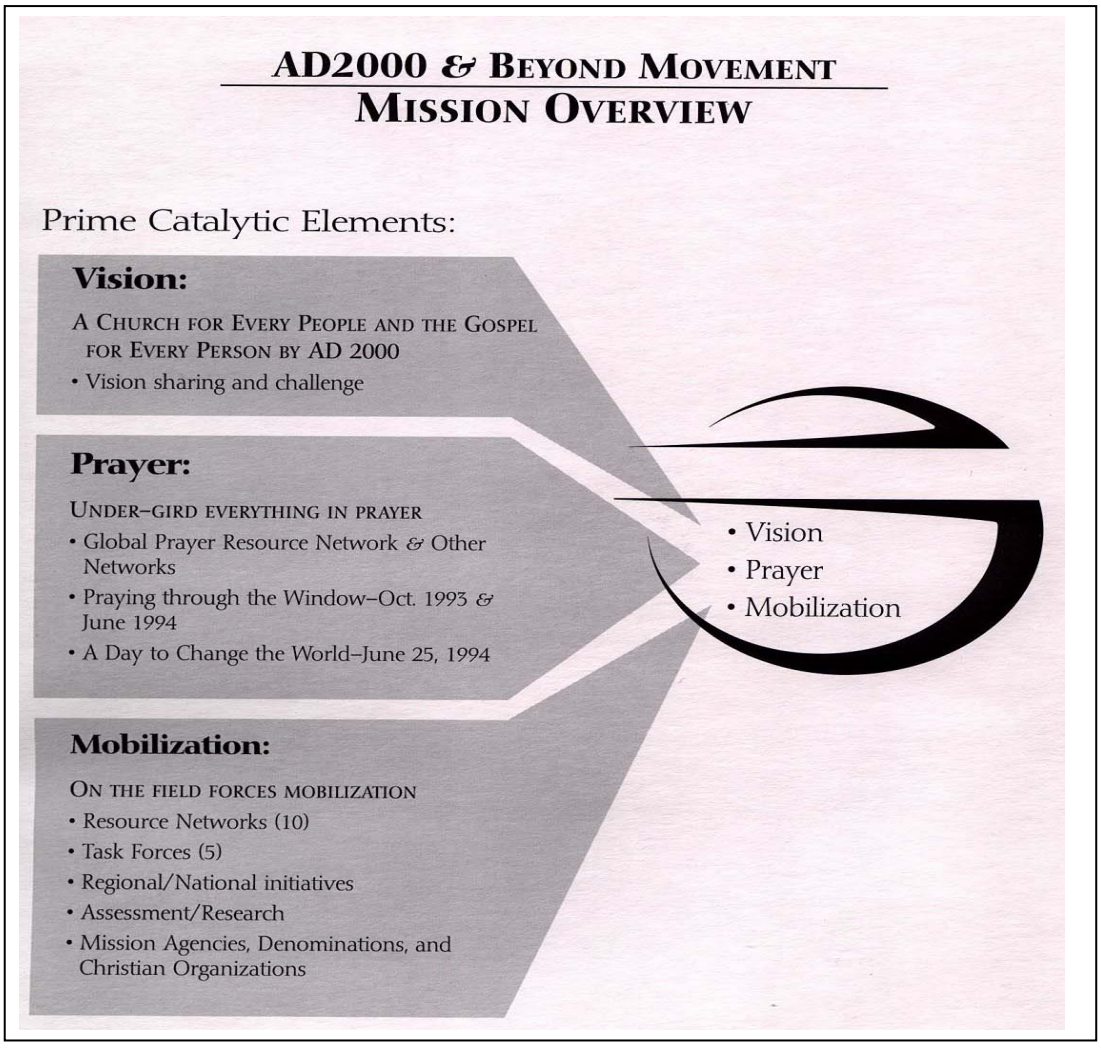


FIGURE 8

PRIME CATALYTIC ELEMENTS
(Bush 1993:75)

Christian leaders associated with the Charismatic movement such as Ted Haggard, Pastor of new Life Church in Colorado Springs, Larry Stockstill, Pastor of Bethany Prayer Fellowship and Ed Roebert, recent senior pastor of Hatfield Christian Church in Pretoria, South Africa along with their churches are examples of those who made a major contribution to AD2000. In the Praying Through the Window efforts, Michael Little, President of CBN chaired the committee. *Charisma* magazine's Steve Strang also served on the committee (Bush and Pegues 1999:228).

Pentecostal leaders from around the world gave leadership within the AD2000 Movement and encouraged their denominations to do the same. Early on in the life of AD2000 denominational leaders of the largest twenty-four denominations were invited to a summit during which a denominational summit declaration was prepared and signed by the leaders. Among them were leaders from major Pentecostal denominations (see Appendix I).

Prayer

Prayer was the major strategy of AD2000. It under-girded every planning meeting, every event, the launch of every initiative. The approach to the meetings followed a pattern. Divide the time equally between the challenges and reports of various AD2000 Christian leaders. Allow time for response from other leaders to those challenges and reports. Initiate a time of seeking God about the things that were shared and discussed.

From AD2000's inception, prayer was a primary mission component. By 1994 the prayer momentum within the movement had become evident to many. The title of an

article written in *Christianity Today* in November of that year raised the question: "Is a Global Great Awakening Just Around the Corner?" The answer was offered in the first paragraph. "With millions of Christian believers holding mass prayer rallies worldwide, scholars and prayer movement leaders are asking whether this development foreshadows church renewal on a global scale." The article cited, as examples, prayer initiatives such as the "Day to Change the World," "Marches for Jesus," and the "October 1993, Praying through the Window" (all in some way related to the AD2000). The article further proclaims that: "A prayer movement that greatly surpasses anything, perhaps in all of Christian history, is rapidly gaining momentum (Tapia 1994:80, 85).

AD2000 United Prayer Track

At the heart of the AD2000-catalyzed global prayer movement was the AD2000 United Prayer Track, led by Peter and Doris Wagner. The track was in reality a network of prayer networks. This network had three departments: Spiritual Mapping, led by George Otis, Jr., Prayer Evangelism, led by Edgardo Silvoso, Reconciliation, led by John Dawson, and the Spiritual Warfare Network, led by Peter Wagner. The centerpiece of the track was Praying Through the 10/40 Window.

Praying through the Window

"Praying through the Window I," a global prayer initiative in October 1993, focused on the countries located within the10/40 Window. "Praying through the Window II," the next initiative, in October 1995, focused prayer on the one hundred Gateway Cities of the 10/40 Window. "Praying through the Window III," in October

1997, focused prayer on the 10/40 Window's 132 unreached people clusters, most of whom have never heard the gospel in their own language in a culturally sensitive way. "Praying through the Window IV," in October 1999, focused once again on the countries of the 10/40 Window with prayer teams assigned to the 1,000 major towns.

We watched in awe as God moved through these prayer initiatives. Beverly Pegues of the Christian Information Network, who coordinated the international prayer efforts of the AD2000 United Prayer Track, recorded and tabulated thousands of prayer journeys and millions of home-based intercessors involved in the "Praying Through the Window" emphases.

After each "Praying through the Window" initiative, Christian Information Network writes to all registered participants and asks them to verify that they in fact prayed. If after sending multiple letters requesting verification registrants still do not respond, we count their involvement as 'one' regardless if they reported larger numbers previously. This applies to churches as well as ministries who do not verify their statistics. For instance, in 1993, we attempted to verify a certain ministry's number of participations, we did not receive their verification by the time we closed the statistics. Therefore, we counted the ministry's number of participants as "one." When we received their report months later, we learned that the ministry had actually rallied 500,000 believers to pray (Bush and Pegues 1999:222).

Upon adding the total number of intercessors in the first three efforts to the forty million recorded in the minutes of the last meeting of the 1999 Praying through Window Steering Committee (chaired by Michael Little, President of CBN and Vonette Bright,

co-founder of Campus Crusade for Christ), the total number praying for the unreached exceeded 120 million (Bush and Pegues 1999:228).

Case Study of United Prayer Impact: Calcutta

Calcutta, India, is a case study in all that can go wrong with a city: unimaginable poverty, hundreds of thousands of homeless people, rampant political corruption, urban infrastructure in collapse, oppressive spiritual darkness. It has earned its title, the Dying City of Calcutta. But, Calcutta is also a case study in how intense, concerted, faithful prayer can touch—and change—a city. In response to the prayers of his people, God has brought signs of new life to a dying city (Bush 1997:8).

In October 1995, the global church was invited to focus fervent prayer on the One-hundred Gateway Cities of the 10/40 Window. Calcutta was one of those cities. For nearly a year, Christian workers in Calcutta had been meeting each month to pray and fast together. Now fellow Christians around the world would join them (1997:8). A group of Calcutta's pastors and Christian workers began a month of systematic prayer for their city. During that month, Christians throughout the city met for eight prayer concerts. More than 600 people attended the concerts, other prayer seminars and prayer walks. Christian leaders in Calcutta divided the city into twenty-five routes for prayer walks. Many of the city's 160 churches adopted one or more of those routes. As they walked, they claimed the territory for the Lord Jesus Christ.

October 18, 1995, was called "One Day to Change Calcutta." An estimated thirty-five million Christians focused their prayers on Calcutta that day. More than one-hundred Christians from thirteen countries gathered there and prayed on-site. A large number of

people gathered for three hours of intensive prayer. Two important things happened during that meeting. People of British descent publicly repented for the sins of their ancestors, the exploitation of the East India Company's rule, and the introduction of Freemasonry to the city. The Bengali Christians then asked forgiveness for their years of hatred and bitterness toward the British. There was much weeping and much healing. Those present felt a heaviness being removed (1997:8).

The month ended with a citywide prayer concert celebration, followed by a prayer summit of Calcutta's church leaders. Out of the month-long prayer campaign sprang a common vision of church leaders in the city, called Mission Calcutta 2000 Network. The Network sought to establish a church in each of the city's ninety-three postal code zones within three years. When the Network was launched, sixty-five of those zones had no Christian witness. On August 13, 1996, less than a year after the month-long prayer emphasis for Calcutta, representatives of all the churches and ministries in the city gathered for a banquet of thanksgiving, praise and renewal. Mr. Raj, chairman of Mission Calcutta 2000, said, "I am certain that the vision of a church for every postal code, a worker for every people and the gospel for every person in Calcutta by the year 2000 will be accomplished." By 1999 house churches had been established in almost every one of the sixty-five unreached zones.

Mission Calcutta's second objective was to present the gospel message to every person in the city by AD2000. Christians throughout the city began to focus on unreached communities. Some even moved into those communities to begin Bible studies. Finally, Mission Calcutta aimed to place at least one Christian worker in each of the sixty-five

different ethno-linguistic people groups within the city. At the beginning of the project, only ten of the groups had been reached. New strategies were initiated, including the publishing of evangelistic literature in several languages and the showing of a Christian film in several areas. Today, Christian workers are in place in most of the sixty-five people groups. The Calcutta experience shows that focused, fervent, united prayer is catalytic to bring new spiritual life to a major city.

New Approaches to Prayer Encouraged and Disputed

As was pointed out in a 1994 article in *Christianity Today*, the mass prayer movement did not take place without controversy. The article describes spiritual warfare as "A highly controversial subject among Christians" (Tapia 1994:80, 85). Prayer-related new expressions began to be used in the prayer track such as "strategic-level spiritual warfare," "spiritual mapping," and "identificational repentance" (Wagner 1996:8). United Prayer Track leader Peter Wagner explained the reason for the emphasis on spiritual warfare:

> I believe that the major reason why more people haven't become believers through the centuries is that the "god of this age" has successfully blinded their minds (see 2 Cor. 4:3-4). Nevertheless, steady progress has been made and today Satan is backed up in what could possibly be seen as his last geographical fortress, the 10/40 Window (not denying, of course, that Satan is also much too malignantly active in virtually every other part of the world as well) (1996:7-8).

Wagner wrote a series of books on being a prayer warrior over the course of the decade, in which he reported to the body of Christ some observations on the prayer movement worldwide and on the spiritual tools being used.

Conclusion—An Assessment of AD2000 as a Catalyst

AD2000 was like a fast moving train. People who were uncomfortable or felt they had gone as far as they needed to in the process, got off while others got on throughout the process. There was no way to bring new arrivals up to speed quickly via some common training period. Often the AD2000 Handbook served as the primary training guide.

Results of Vision of a Church for Every People and the Gospel for Every Person by the Year 2000

In reviewing the decadal activity of AD2000 Johnstone summarizes the practical results of the watchword "A Church for Every People and the Gospel for Every Person by the Year 2000." He reflected on the degree to which the overall goal was accomplished:

> A Church for every people—how far was the goal achieved? The challenge to national and international congregations and agencies to adopt peoples for prayer and ministry gained momentum in the 1990s. Progress was logged for the 1,583 peoples listed in the October 2000 JPL with the following results (2001:6):

TABLE 7

PROGRESS TOWARDS CHURCH PLANTING 1990-2000
(Johnstone 2001:7)

Percent of Peoples	1990	Oct. 1997	Oct. 2000	Achievement
Targeted for church planting by mid-2002	est. 66%	77%	100%	Complete
Targeted for church planting by 2000	est. 66%	77%	85%	Five-sixths
Church planting team currently on site	est. 39%	43%	68%	
Reported Fellowship of at least 100 believers	n.a.	4%	31%	One-third

The gospel for every person. The Mark 16:15 version of the Great Commission exhorts preaching the gospel to every person. The AD2000 and Beyond goal of the 'Gospel for Every Person' is in tune with this. It is harder to measure the impact of multiple means of ministry to the unconverted—personal witness, literature, Scripture translation, Christian video, cassettes, television, radio, the Internet and many other tools God has given us. We can measure potential accessibility by many of these ministries—though the reality may fall far short of this. However, the cumulative effects of multiple layers of ministry increase the likelihood of non-Christians hearing the gospel and the possibility of response. The AD2000 and Beyond Movement brought together major networks of specialist agencies. Here are listed some of the major thrusts of the 1990s: Scripture translation. Through the combined ministry of the Bible Societies and Bible translation agencies, 94% of the world's population has access to a NT in their own language or soon will through existing translation projects. Wycliffe Bible Translators has set the goal of researching the remaining languages of the earth and initiating a Bible translation programme for each one requiring it by 2025. . . .

The World by Radio consortium of Christian broadcasting agencies . . . made a commitment to provide Christian radio programming for every person on earth in a language they could understand. In practical terms, it meant ensuring weekly broadcasts in 372 mega-languages. In the 1990s, 115 languages were added, leaving only 164 with no broadcasts. It is estimated that the potential audience is now 99% (assuming good radio reception, availability of radios and power and also interest in seeking the correct frequencies).

The Jesus film has had 4.1 billion individual viewings—maybe representing 3 billion people and has yielded over 128 million enquirers. The goal of translating the script into every language spoken by 50,000 people had virtually been achieved by 2001. Well over 99% of the world's population would be able to view the film in a language they know.

Many other remarkable international ministries such as SAT-7 satellite TV coverage in the Middle East, Every Home for Christ, Gospel Recordings Network, etc., could also be added to these multiple layers of global coverage (Johnstone 2001:7).

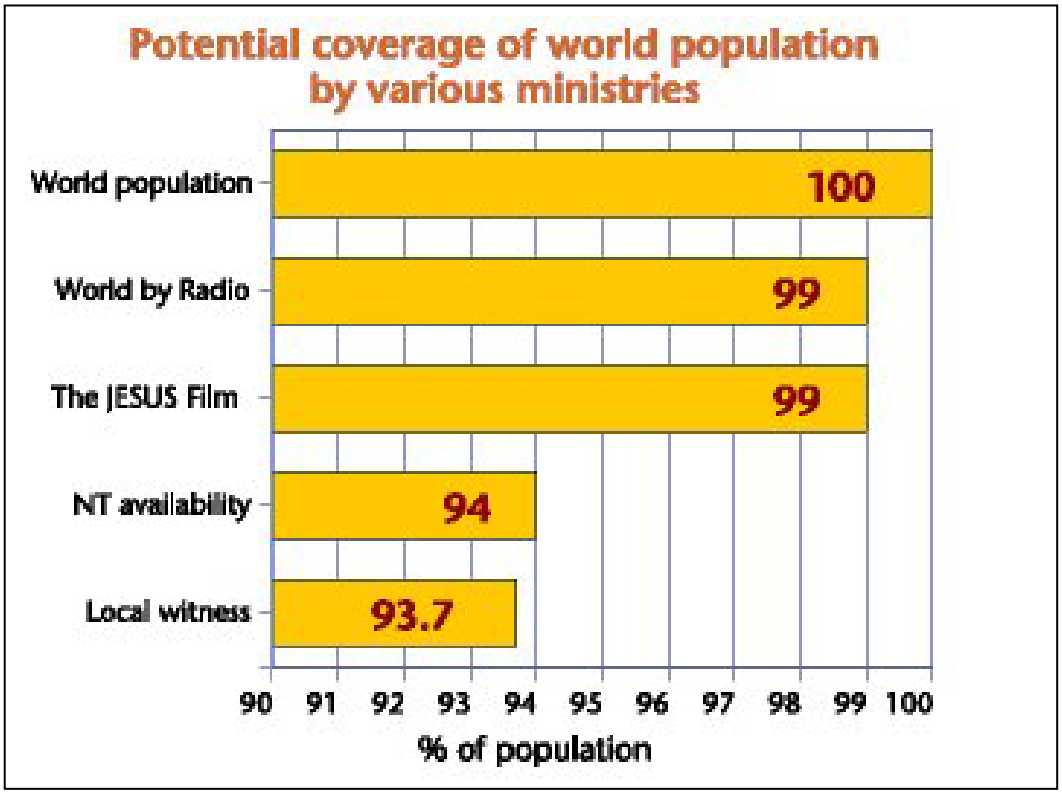


FIGURE 9

THE GOSPEL FOR EVERY PERSON BY THE YEAR 2000
(Johnstone 2001:8)

Built-In Tensions

The nature of the AD2000 leadership structure meant that there were inherent tensions and conflict of various kinds in the leadership process that required resolution of some sort, even if it was merely to agree to disagree. There were additional tensions because of a western versus a non-western way of approaching ministry. The western way emphasized the functional and practical while the Non-western prioritized the

relational. Some Christian leaders did not find a home in AD2000 due to the time-targeted vision that was viewed as too narrow.

Strengths

But one of AD2000's biggest strengths was in the fact that, despite a level of discomfort with the "western-ness" of some aspects, the Two-Thirds world did participate and own the Movement:

> Over of the delegates to GCOWE '95 came from Asia, Africa, Latin America and the Middle East, areas which used to be considered purely mission "fields." They have become active and vital participants in the global missionary force. They have now taken ownership of the AD2000 vision and have become full partners in world evangelization (R. Wood 1995:18).

Ultimately, AD2000 was a vision-driven movement, and its greatest strength was the strength and power of its vision. It encouraged Christian leaders to go forth with the call—the vision and little else. It attracted risk-takers, ready to volunteer their time, resources and efforts to spend themselves towards a compelling vision without assurance of success. AD2000, in turn, selected or identified and built the leadership being raised up by the Holy Spirit in response to these promptings. It was seeking to follow the example of Jesus in raising up disciple-leaders who would respond to his call. This approach to leadership identification and development intensified the catalytic impact of AD2000 and resulted in a new wave of grassroots and national leadership. Consequently, a new wave of mission initiatives and multiple organizational adhocracies emerged. And, like its biblical counterparts, the disciples, the result was often messy and fraught with

human failing, but also powerful in the exercise of the unleashed faith and effort of both individual and corporate endeavors of creativity and commitment.

David B. Barrett, in the process of completing the second edition of the *World Christian Encyclopedia,* writes of the harvest among those people living in the spiritually and materially poorest region of the world. He compares response to the gospel among different geographic regions of the world:

> Dollar for dollar and hour for hour, the harvest coming from the 10/40 Window nations outstrips that from the rest of the world 100 to 1. That is, if the same money and time spent to win one person to the Lord in the West were put to use in the 10/40 Window nations, the effort would yield a harvest of 100 souls added to the kingdom of God. It is 100 times more cost effective, therefore, to reach those in the 10/40 Window. But for a sizeable number of specific ethnolinguistic groups, cost-effectiveness reaches 1000 times more than in Western countries (Bush and Pegues 1999:204).

The issue of discipleship and the Great Commission with regard to AD2000 was taken up at the *First International Consultation On Discipleship*, held September 21-24, 1999, in Eastbourne, England at which nearly 400 delegates participated. The consultation was envisioned and managed by Appianda Arthur of Ghana, a former Parliament member, who directed the Distinguished Leaders Track at GCOWE '95, along with David Mehlis, President of Cook Communications Ministries in Colorado Springs. A prominent Christian leader summed up the sentiment of participants when he said:

> [T]he Christian situation is "Strange, tragic, and possessing a disturbing paradox. In some places the church is growing strongly, but even there the problem is that of growth without depth. In short, the church lacks proper discipleship." A joint statement crafted during the consultation acknowledges that 'our zeal to go wider has not been matched by a commitment to go deeper' (Oosterhoff 1999:2).

The view from AD2000 on where we were at the year 2000 with regard to the expansion of the Christian movement is not the same for all associated with the Movement. This is due to the diverse nature of AD2000. Thus, in presenting the current view on where we are in the Great Commission, I would not be speaking on behalf of all who have or identify with AD2000 but rather on behalf of a stream within AD2000. In addition, the assessment relates specifically to the goal that was established at the outset ten years ago of a church for every people and the gospel for every person. The expected stated result at the beginning of the decade was the initiation of a mission-minded church planting movement within every unreached and unevangelized people and city by AD2000, so that all peoples might have a valid opportunity to experience the love, truth and saving power of Jesus Christ in fellowship with other believers.

While acknowledging the place and need for reflection, most people associated with AD2000 sought to affirm and embrace careful theological and missiological reflection of the past, while seeking to cooperate with a unique divine initiative of the global advance of the gospel. God's people around the world from many cultures and geographical areas sought to advance the gospel and establish a church planting movement in new places and among peoples who had never heard the gospel before. This resulted in an expansion of Christianity. As the gospel moved across cultural, racial and geographic barriers. church planting movements pioneered in new cultures, in new languages and in new geographic areas.

Summary Comments

After a well-researched article Coote assesses AD2000 and the 10/40 Window. He concludes by saying:

> Space limitations prevent proper recognition of the tremendous movement of prayer that was stimulated and facilitated by the AD 2000 Movement. And the educational impact on the world Christian community is surely incalculable. Many hundreds of thousands have a greater awareness of the urgency and challenge of the Great Commission than they did ten years ago (Coote 2000:167).

Looking back on the ten years reflected in *Operation World, the 21st Century Edition,* Johnstone reflects on Joshua Project 2000. He writes:

> Praise God for these exciting initial achievements and pray that the momentum might increase in the period after 2000. There are weaknesses—inadequate mechanisms for holding those committed to their promises for adoption, insufficient verification and over-simplification of the task—but thank God for what was achieved! (2001:7)

Following GCOWE '97 in South Africa, a Christian leader listed the "Unique Contributions of the AD2000 Movement to World Evangelization." This included the following items:

1. Has empowered an unprecedented global awareness of and commitment to completion of the Great Commission.

2. Has produced an unprecedented, global third world, non-Western awareness of, commitment to, and involvement in leadership for fulfillment of the Great Commission.

3. Has provided an unprecedented global platform on which mission/church leadership from East/West and North/South have been able to meet for action plans related to fulfillment of the Great Commission.

4. Has provided an unprecedented global awareness of the need for national and people-group-specific strategies for evangelism in contrast to the traditional ad hoc approaches (Butler 1997).

A Final Question

From the very first formative AD2000 meeting, it was agreed that this would be a catalytic movement seeking to encourage the global Christian community toward the goal of "A Church for Every People and the Gospel for Every Person" in the decade of the 1990s, and to disband beyond after the target years. A disband clause by the year 2001 was incorporated into the AD2000 handbook and the corporate by-laws. In keeping with the agreement, AD2000 did indeed disband. The implication of this commitment, with regards to an ongoing vision, movement streams, office, and portions thereof, has been a matter causing constant questioning. Yet, the AD2000 was always meant to be available to as wide a community of believers as possible and the infrastructure of AD2000 was purposely kept small. There is evidence of the success of the movement in that the seeds of its vision fell in fertile ground and have continued to grow of the impetus put in motion by the Holy Spirit, as noted in the following e-mail magazine article:

> Although the AD2000 movement is officially over, the seeds they planted are germinating. Sprouting, and growing, budding and producing mature fruit all over the place![3] In our little corner of the world, amazing things have been happening. God is bringing the churches in this city together in an amazing move of unity. Our congregation is growing by leaps and bounds—we've seen a rise in membership of over 500 people since the first of the year. Our mission program is on fire. We've sent teams to many countries through the 10/40 Window and beyond, and those teams have had a catalytic effect in seeing entire villages coming to Christ, built schools and homes, ministered to the poor, smuggled Bibles, conducted trans-denominational prayer and unity workshops for missionaries on the

[3] The e-mail was one of a collection of e-mail snippets which originally came in response to a *Brigada Today*'s editorial, "Silent Spring: Where Has All The Hoopla Gone?" (Lucus 2001a). In the original editorial, Lucas observed that there seemed to be a kind of "lull" going on out there—at least in some circles—when it comes to large-scale missions mobilization. Names were eliminated to guard security for those in limited access lands.

field, and have been invited to teach in the house church movement in China[4] (Lucas 2001b).

[4] Our leaders recently received and entertained visiting foreign religious leaders who claimed to have received a vision from Jesus to come here to our congregation for instruction in how to prepare their people for the destruction to some. As a result of that incredible encounter, we received a special invitation for one of our elders to present the gospel in person to over 15,000 followers of this man's religion in his country, at his temple! That actually took place last fall. Not only that, he's invited us to come back, AND bring our worship team this time!

CHAPTER 7

A CATALYTIC MECHANISM—THE INQUIRY

One of the first challenges in responding to the call to world evangelization in the twenty-first century is to seek a mechanism that can catalyze a world evangelization movement. The Inquiry was created based on the learning from the previous chapters in this dissertation. It incorporates the primary catalytic impulses including the catalytic aim (Chapter 2), the catalytic means (Chapter 3), the catalytic leader (Chapter 4), the catalytic structures, (Chapter 5), and a catalytic case study—the AD2000 Movement (Chapter 6). The nine basic questions of the Inquiry are designed to foster discussion around the primary catalytic impulses related to world evangelization (see Appendices J and K). One of the expected outcomes of doing the Inquiry is that the process itself will catalyze world evangelization. The focus group approach, with the right kind of questions and, under the right conditions, has generally proven to be very effective. As the quantitative and qualitative survey is conducted among Christian leaders in hundreds of cities across the world and the insights communicated widely, a missiology can be constructed capable of empowering the global church for an informed participation in world evangelization in the twenty-first century.

The problem the Inquiry seeks to address is threefold: first, the yet-unfinished task of world evangelization and lack of clarity of what it is; second, the need to make the next phase one in which the worldwide evangelical movement participates fully,

including insights offered from the Two-Thirds world leaders; and third, the need to define new paradigms of mission.

In addressing the major issues related to a resource-consuming global effort, the first is the justification of the project itself. The first section titled "Why the Inquiry?" lays out the reasons for this endeavor. For the sake of consistency and to ensure that the basic questions are covered, the other sections of this chapter deal with the fundamental questions of what, where, why, how long, who and what are the limitations?

Why the Inquiry?

There are a number of important reasons why the Inquiry is a priority concern for Christian leaders at the outset of the twenty-first century. These seven reasons range from the timeless encouragement found in the Scriptures to the time-sensitive realities facing the global church at the outset of a new millennium.

Because the Conversation Illuminates the Purpose of God

First, God has used inquiries and research efforts to enhance world evangelization which began when he sent two angels to facilitate the "empty tomb focus group," comprising a few women who had come on the first Easter morning to find an empty tomb. We are told in another gospel who these women were and why they were going to the tomb where Jesus' body was laid. "Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of James, and Salome bought spices so that they might go to anoint Jesus' body" (Mk. 16:1). While they were standing at the tomb in amazement when they did not find the body of the Lord "suddenly two men in clothes that gleamed like lightning stood beside them." These were

messengers sent from God to act as the group facilitators. They posed the question: "Why do you look for the living among the dead?" (Lk. 24:6). In the course of the discussion it was revealed to the women that he was not there. "He has risen! Remember how He told you, while He was still with you in Galilee: 'The Son of Man must be delivered into the hands of sinful men, be crucified and on the third day be raised again'" (Lk. 24:7).

The women reported to the other followers of Jesus what they had learned. Peter was mobilized to find out for himself. Consequently, the first world evangelization movement was launched out of the inquiry process.

Because Focus Group Inquiries Are Biblical

The focus group was a mechanism used deliberately by God. It catalyzed an unprecedented movement of world evangelization. It was this same Peter, about thirty-five years after his running to the Empty Tomb, who wrote about the controlling role of the Holy Spirit in the selection and recording of content for the Scriptures. "Above all, you must understand that no prophecy of Scripture came about by the prophet's own interpretation. For prophecy never had its origin in the will of man, but men spoke from God as they were carried along by the Holy Spirit" (1 Pe. 1:21-22). In order to reinforce the significance of the focus group methodology, in relation to evangelism and mission, the incident at the Empty Tomb is immediately followed up in the Lucan account by another focus group inquiry, which could be called the "Emmaus Road Focus Group Inquiry." This time the facilitator of the discussion between the two disciples is none other than the resurrected Lord Jesus Christ himself, though they did not recognize him at

first. Jesus intervened in the discussion with three questions: "What are you discussing together as you walk along? . . . What things?" (Lk. 24:17, 19). This second question caused the disciples to report on the incident related to the Empty Tomb Focus Group:

> [S]ome of our women amazed us. They went to the tomb early this morning but didn't find his body. They came and told us that they had seen a vision of angels, who said he was alive. Then some of our companions went to the tomb and found it just as the women had said, but him they did not see (Lk. 24:22-24).

This response of the two disciples led Jesus to rebuke them and pose his final question. "How foolish you are, and how slow of heart to believe all that the prophets have spoken! Did not the Christ have to suffer these things and then enter his glory?" (Lk. 24:25-26). The follow-up focus group inquiry resulted in the two remaining disciples turning around and joining the other disciples already assembled in Jerusalem, where Jesus now appeared to all of them to commission them for the task of world evangelization. "[R]epentance and forgiveness of sins will be preached in his name to all nations, beginning at Jerusalem" (Lk. 24:47).

Coming with an agenda to listen to God's servants is biblical. James writes: "My dear brothers, take note of this: Everyone should be quick to listen" (Jas. 1:19a).

Because There is a Need to Hear Intentionally and Primarily from Christian Leaders in Africa, Asia, and Latin America

Second, the emergence of Christian leadership in Africa, Asia, and Latin America, combined with the initiative in world evangelization efforts over the last twenty-five years of the twentieth century from these regions, demands that their ideas help shape the direction of world evangelization in the twenty-first century. It is clear

that many wish to do so; the question is how to help catalyze the true reflective inputs and resultant direction.

One of the major trends is the "Shift in geographical and vital center of gravity of the church from the West and North to the East and South" (Woodberry 2000). Out of this new spiritual nerve center, initiative for world mission has grown exponentially. "As Christianity has globalized, indigenous missions have sprung up around the world" (Woodberry 2000). The Christian mission and church leaders from all around the world express their view of what the "Spirit is saying to the Church" at this time. However, more than ever before that expression is coming from Asia, Africa and Latin America:

> In light of the fact that the Christian majority is now to be found outside the West and missionary initiatives from the churches of Asia, Africa, and Latin America are at the cutting-edge of the Christian world mission, we must ask: What kind of theology of mission will best serve the global Christian mission in the future? What fresh theological resources can be brought to bear on this new phase of the Christian mission? It is time to listen to voices from the non-Western world that can help construct a theology capable of empowering the global church for participation in the *missio Dei* (Shenk 2001a:98).

Jonathan J. Bonk, Executive Director of Overseas Ministries Study Center, and Editor, *International Bulletin of Missionary Research*, expressed his concern that the focus groups for this Inquiry include a strong participation from those outside the west:

> My chief concern is that the focus groups not be simply another gathering of western missionaries and mission executives—those whose financial means to permit them and their organizations the luxury of participation in the meetings of such focus groups . . . often in venues beyond the means of 99% of the servants of God who actually incarnate the gospel to the ends of the earth! I hope that the focus groups resulting from your vision will break the mold (2001).

The active participation of Christian leaders from the world in shaping twenty-first century world evangelization is crucial for this Inquiry. We pray that information might mesh with relationships of the broader world community to foster increased evangelization, to the end that there can be a significant advance in the Christian Movement over the next quarter century. A real measure of hope towards this end was raised via relationships from 186 nations at GCOWE '95 in Korea and at GCOWE '97 in South Africa where seventy-five percent of the participants came from the world.

Because of the Catalytic Nature of the Inquiry Process

Third, many missiologists agree that it was during the twentieth century when the Christian movement advanced to its greatest extent geographically, among the ethno-linguistic peoples of the earth and in mobilizing cross-cultural missions. Out of the accomplishments and lessons learned from recent history, the inquiry launches a journey in the listening mode that involves a process of advocacy, assessment with anticipation of advance in Kingdom initiatives, and transformation.

The advocacy process is already underway, sharing the inquiry vision with many prototype groups already trialed and plans made for the full geographic coverage and meetings/data collection and summary envisioned. In order to validate the inquiry purpose, objectives, questionnaires, and meetings were held with sample groups and research survey experts over a period of five months leading up to December 31, 2001,

with more than sixty people consulted and 150 hours invested. Early results corroborated the basic process steps and potential catalytic impact.

Once all the advocacy meetings were held and the data collected, assessment of the compiled results are shared with those participants and beyond, seeking a shared global consensus and ownership for the follow-up process. The prayer is that Kingdom initiatives will come forth during the advance phase, under local/regional/global ownership realities given by God for increased church planting and social/cultural changes throughout the world. Through it all, we pray for and seek transformed lives within the body of Christ worldwide, at every level of society and geographical setting across the globe, as pictured in Figure 10.

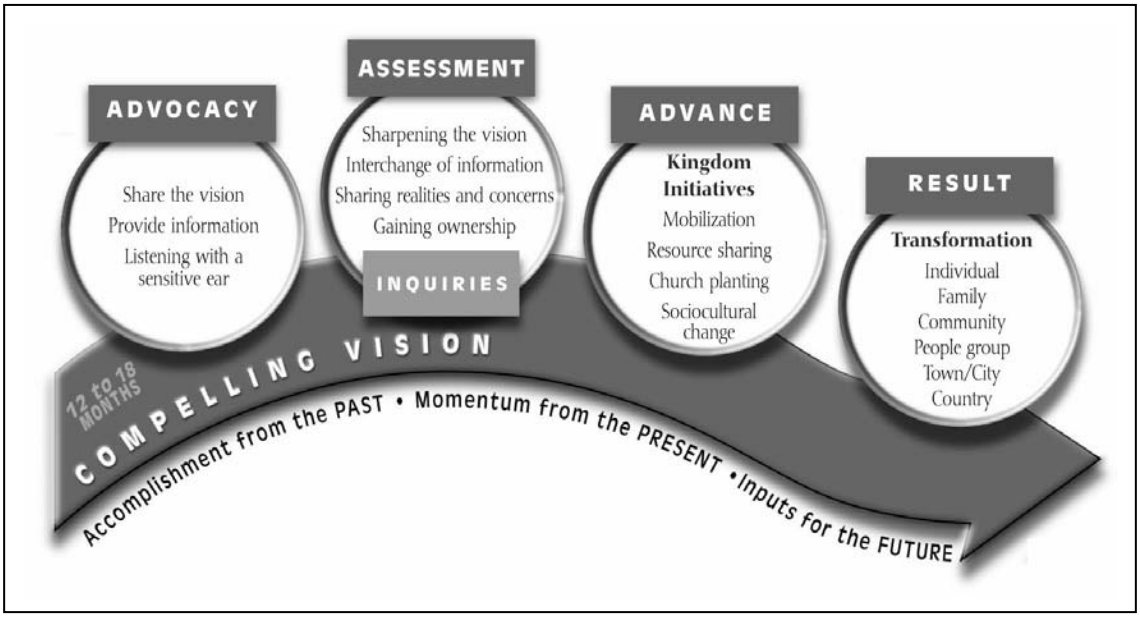


FIGURE 10

INQUIRY PROCESS

Because of the Unfinished Task of World Evangelization

Fourth, this inquiry among influential Christian leaders is prompted by the challenge of the unfinished task of evangelization. This research project will, we pray, help gain the discernment and prayer needed for church/mission/ministry decision-making, by providing local insights into the questions and directions that relate to citywide, national, regional, and global matters related to the unfinished task.

One of the issues facing this question relates to the meaning of "the unfinished task of world evangelization." To aid in the discussion, a description of what the finished task presented may look as follows:[1]

> The finished task can be summarized as Jesus Christ, incarnate in His Body, the church, in every segment of humanity, showing forth His love, compassion, truth and power. The Body, being sensitive and insightful into the many social, cultural, linguistic, ethnic, economic distinctives and differences within the populace, would be continually permeating all elements of society both with the Word (light), but also with care, compassion and righteousness (salt) (Bush 2000a).

A list of principles presented at the Amsterdam 2000 Conference regarding the unfinished task serves as one of the resources for focus group discussion.[2] At the strategy

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[1] This description was presented at the Amsterdam 2000 Conference held from July 29 to August 6, 2000 sponsored by the Billy Graham Evangelistic Association. More than five hundred strategists considered the unfinished task, the obstacles therein and the way forward.

[2] The list of principles were:

1. The unfinished task involves offering man forgiveness of sin and liberation from sin.
2. Seeking to fulfill the unfinished task involves going forth as an act of loving obedience, a "being sent" by the risen Lord. It demands complete submission to Jesus Christ, constant fellowship with Him, constant devotion to Him, and service to Him.
3. The unfinished task majors in effective communication of the good news of God and in baptizing, teaching, and discipling the believers with the primary emphasis on making disciples.
4. A primary mechanism in fulfilling the unfinished task is the conversion of households, called "ecclesias."
5. The unfinished task involves the conscious entry into the territory of Satan in order to liberate people from satanic power and tyranny. It aims at opening the eyes of the nations and turning them from darkness to light and from the power of Satan to God.

working group gatherings in the conference, further definition of the unfinished task was left as an open issue, yet to be addressed. This inquiry process seeks to reflect on the nature of the unfinished task.

Because of the Need to Define the New Paradigms of Mission

Fifth, there are expressions in the evangelical mission community of a vision gap and silence regarding a cohesive global initiative at the present time:

> Is it just my imagination, or is the silence beginning to roar? . . . [I]t just doesn't seem that there is as much mobilization for missions going on these days. . . . [I]f I'm not mistaken, we seem to be in a strange kind of muted silence, don't we? . . . Was it just the new millennium . . . or did we just experience a ripple in the mobilization sinc wave? (Lucas 2001a).

In the *Brigada Today,* May 25, a week later, Doug Lucas writes, "There were a ton of responses. . . . By and large, it seemed that many agreed . . . on the "lull" going on out there" (Lucas 2001b).

Strategies to address the vision are also in short supply in view of mission leaders. The "new paradigms that help us interpret and organize our strategies for the future have not become clear" (McKaughan 2000).

One of the questions relates to whether or not there should be a united global strategy of the body of Christ? If so, what are the elements needed for an effective strategy? Should there be a watchword? What about a date in the watchword, which

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6. The unfinished task can be done effectively only in "His name" and in the power of the Holy Spirit.
7. "The unfinished task" will continue until we have "preached the Gospel of the Kingdom in the whole world as a witness to all nations [people groups]" and there are true believers in Jesus Christ "from every nation, tribe, people and language" (Matt. 24:14 and Rev. 7:9). This calls each new generation to a sense of urgency to "speed up the coming of that day" (2 Pe. 3:12).
8. The unfinished task involves the evangelistic and social mandates of our Lord.

would catalyze a programmatic rather than a purely reflective expectation? Would having a date in the watchword not result in reductions that would be a limit on the scope of the gospel?

To assist in the discussion, the following list of elements, presented at Amsterdam 2000, are introduced as a resource for the focus groups:

1. The establishing of a clearly defined goal that, if highly embraced by the body of Christ, would propel us forward towards completion of the unfinished task.
2. The preparation of a realistic timetable to pursue achievement of the goal.
3. An information service and system that will enable both national and global servants of God to be on the same page.
4. The discovery and release of all possible resources linking to emerging opportunities, in an atmosphere of trust.
5. The mobilization of global intercessory fervent, focused prayer.
6. The designing of an appropriate training program of all mobilized personnel to assure the unity, effectiveness, and coordination of the work towards accomplishing the goal.
7. The adoption of the most effective methods in each contextual setting.
8. The recognition of an existing or establishment of a new motivational structure in keeping with the dynamic function of the Holy Spirit to carry through the program and consummate the goals.
9. The involvement of existing or establishment of new intentional, international, integrative functional and resource networks and task forces, plus field-specific and resource-specific partnerships.
10. The gracious operation of the Holy Spirit in all organizations and personnel involved and in all methods and means employed (Bush 2000a).

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9. The essential unfinished task is to establish a healthy, reproducible, indigenous, church planting movement among every ethno-cultural and ethno-linguistic people (*ethne*) in every place (Bush 2000a).

Because of the Tectonic Changes in the Context of Mission

Sixth, one of the challenges faced by mission leaders is the accelerating pace of change in so many areas of life:

> Apart from some marginalized pockets, the pace of change is increasing across the board—demographic, technological, economic, political, and social. This leads to uncertainty, information overload, hesitancy to make long-term commitments, and difficulty in making plans (Woodberry 2000).

The church in the United States has carried the major burden of resourcing world evangelization in the twentieth century. A recent survey, prior to September 11, of church and mission leaders revealed some significant trends that suggest that there may be some forthcoming changes:

> The winds of change are swirling with great intensity around the Christian missionary enterprise. The world is changing radically: economically, politically and religiously. Where does the evangelical mission community in the United States find itself in the midst of this change? (McKaughan, O'Brien, and O'Brien 1998:1).

As the mission leaders traveled around the country meeting in different cities, the observations on the current mission scene in the U.S. took on a pattern. It can be summarized by the following statements:

1. When did missions change from being vision-driven to budget-driven?
2. Today's generation does not respond to a command structure, nor to guilt trips.
3. (Mission) headquarters are afraid of decentralization.
4. Most churches are interested in survival, not missions.
5. The U.S. church is compassion-depleted.
6. The church in America just will not listen to the church around the world (McKaughan, O'Brien, and O'Brien 1998:1).

The last observation emphasizes the need for an inquiry process that will listen carefully to the church around the world. It appears that this is not happening at present.

Because of the Historical Precedence of the William Carey Inquiry which Launched the Modern Era of Missions

Seventh, on the 200th year of the modern era of missions, an article was written on William Carey by the President of the Evangelical Missiological Society. In it he affirms that the Carey Inquiry sparked the launch of a major advance in world evangelization:

> In 1992, we stand at the 200th anniversary of two key events that launched Carey into his 40-year missionary career. In 1792 he published *An Inquiry into the Obligations of Christians to Use Means for the Conversion of the Heathen*, and he preached his "deathless sermon" from Isaiah 54:2-3, "Expect great things. Attempt great things" (Beals 1992).

The Carey Inquiry provides a precedent for advancing world evangelization. His Inquiry mobilized thousands of Christians in England and North America for the cause of missions. "[Carey's] little book became the Magna Carta of the Protestant mission movement" (Winter 1997).

What is the Evangelizing Our World Inquiry?

Our World Inquiry, short for Evangelizing Our World Inquiry, is a consultative process with Christian leaders that seeks to listen to voices, especially from the Non-western world, which can help construct a missiology capable of empowering the global church for participation in God's mission for the twenty-first century. The inquiry seeks to take the pulse of what the Holy Spirit is saying to the church at the beginning of the

twenty-first century by inquiring of Christian leaders throughout the world. It involves the prayerful application of a quantitative and qualitative instrument and subsequent communication of the results.

Multiple reviews of the questions were made to ensure that they fulfill the objectives and purpose of the inquiry. The following nine major questions were identified (see Appendices J and K):

1. What is God doing now regarding evangelization? What is the most important thing you see God doing in your country? (Describe the programs, activity or vision that God seems to be blessing in your country). Who is God using in an unusual way in your city and country?
2. What are the major external challenges facing the church regarding evangelization?
3. What are the major obstacles to world evangelization internal to the church?
4. What do you believe God is calling His people to do in world evangelization over the next twenty-five years?
5. What would be a suitable phrase (watchword) to capture the essence of world evangelization to serve as a unifying paradigm for the next twenty-five years?
6. How important are the following four Global Evangelical Structures for providing to local believers to enhance world evangelization efforts?
7. How do you define world evangelization and the unfinished task? (After discussion see some definitions at the conclusion of this Inquiry)
8. Who are the emerging younger leaders?
9. What is an effective strategy to fulfill the unfinished task?

Where? The Kinds of Locations

It is envisioned that the inquiry will be carried out in at least one hundred cities and locations around the world. Some portions of the Inquiry will be done via focus group gatherings in key places and the remainder via electronic means or by mailings.

What for? The Inquiry Purpose

The purpose of the "Evangelizing Our World Inquiry" is to further enhance world evangelization in the twenty-first century by means of a quantitative and qualitative research inquiry, using a survey and focus group consultative process to gather, compile, organize, and communicate the insights of Christian leaders throughout the world.

The Inquiry objective is to listen to what God is doing and saying in regard to world evangelization by collecting insights, beliefs, and attitudes with regard to:

1. The people and the programs God is using
2. The meaning of world evangelization and the unfinished task
3. The challenges via factors external to the church
4. The obstacles internal to the church
5. What God is calling us to as the body of Christ
6. What is the place of services that a global structure committed to world evangelization can offer
7. The identification of a compelling unifying paradigm
8. The identification of emerging leaders

How? The Inquiry Approach

The research design was adopted in order to fulfill the objectives of the Inquiry. It developed over a period of time with input from many of the people who participated in the process as well as other qualified consultants. Consequently, the spirit and ethos of the inquiry were developed with thought about what the Inquiry was seeking to accomplish. Both a focus group qualitative and a quantitative survey were used.

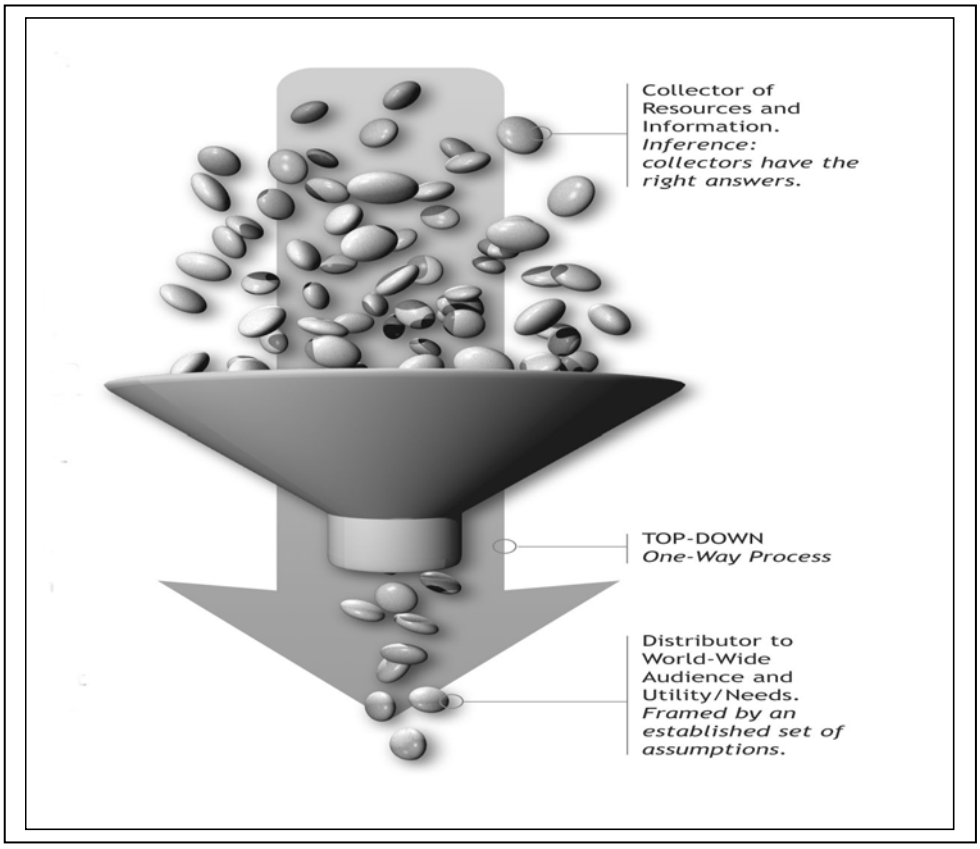


FIGURE 11

THE TOP-DOWN METHODOLOGICAL APPROACH

The Interactive Methodological Approach

The philosophy of the approach to the Inquiry represents the fundamental ethos of the objectives. The inquiry methodological approach departs from a traditional western way of doing things.

When the methodological approach is top-down, as depicted in Figure 11, the resulting process and product has limited value. In this model, the collector is seeking to prove an existing set of assumptions. He or she assumes that they have the right answers from evolved experience and perspective. The collection is made from a broad spectrum of input and then processed through a filter. It is a top-down method in which selected communication is made with very targeted items supported by a set of presuppositions. This approach is direct. It has a control element with an end purpose in mind. The distribution of the results supports the answers that were held by the researcher to begin with. There is little or no opportunity for open, ongoing dialogue with the survey participants.

The methodological philosophy embraced and resultant method pursued in the inquiry is what could be termed an interactive methodological approach. It is more open-handed. There are minimal pre-inquiry assumptions. There is less control. It seeks to let the information and perspectives process flow, as God leads. This manner of conducting the survey, depicted in Figure 12, is in contrast to the perspective of the top-down approach, illustrated in Figure 11.

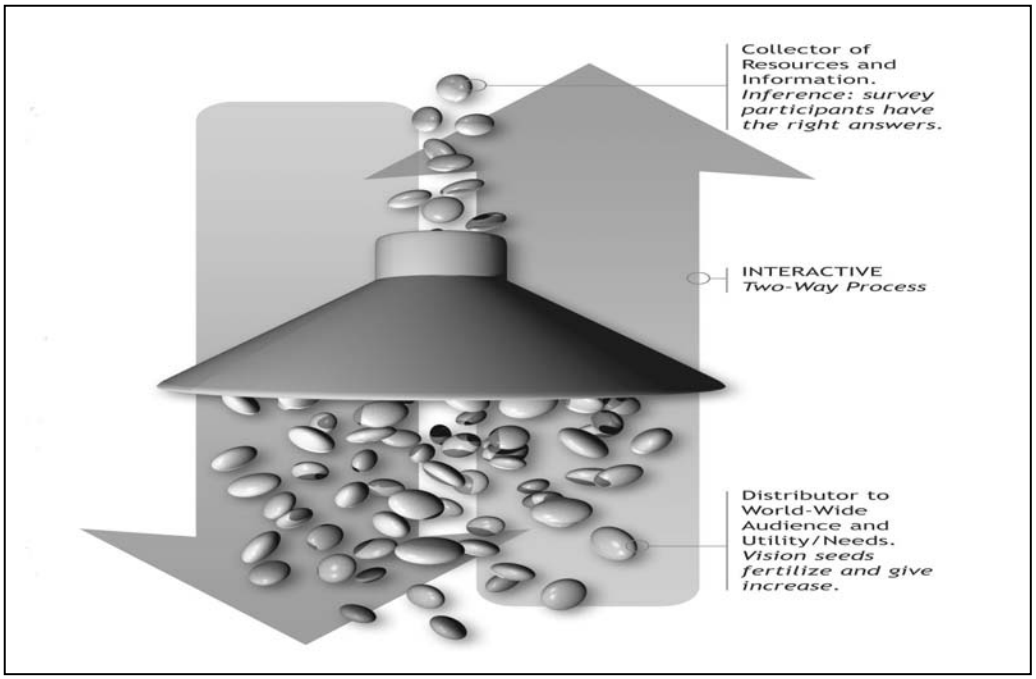


FIGURE 12

THE INTERACTIVE METHODOLOGICAL APPROACH

In the interactive approach, the full input of God's people is sought without a predetermined outcome. The distribution is cast on broad waters and represents Christians from around the world. The process encourages ongoing interaction and a global conversation by sharing in-process results that become vision seeds. Each seed can germinate and fertilize, causing increased vision and spiritual harvest from the process. Casting results from other inquiries into other contexts and new inquiries cross-fertilizes a process. In addition, by extending the process over two years, this allows time for a more relational and less time-encumbered interaction. This is conducive to world

involvement. The approach also results in a broader distribution and great potential for harvest.

TABLE 8

TOP-DOWN VERSUS INTERACTIVE APPROACH

The Top-Down Methodological Philosophy	**The Interactive Methodological Philosophy**
Begins with answers in hand	Begins with open-handed perspective
Directed/targeted	Non-directed
Controlling/end purpose in mind	Releasing
Insights communicated with data support	Information/stories communicated with unencumbered analysis
Narrow/selected distribution with more limited harvest	Broader distribution with greater harvest
Dogmatic	Inspirational
Instructive/"Do it my way"	Interactive/cross-fertilization of ideas
Emphasis on Product	Emphasis on Process

In Table 8, the primary distinctives between the Top-Down and the Interactive Approach are illustrated. In the right column, Table 8 summarizes the ethos and values of the approach taken in this inquiry.

Quantitative and Qualitative Methodology

The inquiry involves both a quantitative and a qualitative survey of the opinion of Christian leaders in about one hundred cities and/or countries/regions throughout the world. The survey will be conducted among non-Catholic Christians worldwide. Responses are sought from respondents in proportion to the numerical distribution of the church worldwide by region. For example, in assessing the distribution of God's people, it is found that seventy percent live outside the west, then the methodological objective would be to gather about seventy percent of the survey results from outside of the west. Special attention will be given to countries with a larger number of the body of Christ who have limited freedoms, such as China.

For the purpose of validating the findings, a quantitative survey will be conducted, using questions such that answers can be readily compiled and quantified. The qualitative survey will be conducted mainly in focus groups, seeking further discussion and substantiation to the numerical responses.

For the purposes of conducting a qualitative inquiry, focus groups are used to collect opinions, beliefs and attitudes on issues for planning, evaluation, to improve some specific global services, to assist local efforts, and for the development of strategic plans and mission statements. Focus groups provide data from a group of people much more quickly and at less cost than would be the case if each individual were interviewed

separately. The focus group obtains perceptions on a defined area of interest in a permissive, non-threatening environment by using certain guidelines.[3]

The Spirit of the Inquiry

Stirred by what God is doing through the church around the world the Inquiry resists evangelical self-confident triumphalism. It inquiry seeks to hear what God is calling his people to do, separately and together, towards world evangelization.

How Long? The Time-Frame Envisioned

From past experience and consultation with others, about eighteen months is estimated for Inquiry definition, stage setting, the inquiry process around the world, and the compilation of data/results, with the report to be completed by mid-2004. This timeframe allows for a catalytic impact to take place as interim results are reported and processed. Already one of the groups planning an inquiry—the Korean leaders in the Los Angeles area—are considering a follow-on meeting a few weeks after the inquiry to review and discuss the results. Should the results be significant enough, they are seriously considering a much larger event a year later to communicate the results to a larger group of leaders.

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[3] These guidelines are as follows: (1) Conduct a quantitative inquiry for the individuals of the group prior to qualitative inquiry in focus groups; (2) Create an environment in the focus groups that encourages participants to share perceptions; (3) Do not force consensus or impose a vote; (4) Allow the questions to take you into deep terrain that will address issues that are not necessarily discussed on the survey; (5) Organize the people into focus groups of six to eight people; (6) Get people talking and thinking about the topic as soon as possible. The beginning questions should help; (7) Promote self-disclosure among participants. We want to know what people really think and feel; (8) Seek to develop of synergy in the group. Group members influence each other by responding to ideas and comments of others; (9) Note

Wherefore? The Results Anticipated

The expected result of the Inquiry is to enhance world evangelization efforts in the twenty-first century. This would be done by:

1. Understanding the challenges affecting evangelization by country, region, and globally;
2. Identifying the barriers and opportunities in the city, country, region, and globally;
3. Identifying what and who God is blessing in the city, country, region, and globally;
4. Identifying a possible unifying paradigm of mission;
5. Identifying emerging leaders worldwide;
6. Informing in order to enhance delivery of relevant services by national, regional, and global structures committed to world evangelization;
7. Cultivating prayer and praying about the matters that surfaced in the discussions;
8. Communicating the insights of the Inquiry to Christian leaders worldwide;
9. Encouraging God's people to participate with God in evangelizing our world.

A preliminary testing of the Inquiry was done over the course of seven months, through December 2001, to determine its viability and to make modifications to enhance meeting the objectives, the accuracy of the results and the usefulness to the users. In keeping with the objectives of the inquiry, the majority of the applications were made in the Two-Thirds world, represented by leaders from the Mayan peoples in Chiapas, Mexico, and the peoples and countries of North Africa. The process of considering the

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that questions are organized into a Question Route that follows a way of getting to the questions that really answers the concerns of the inquiry.

questions, and focusing discussion around these items, energized thinking and stimulated vision. In questioning the people after they went through the process themselves, they were enthusiastic about the process of the inquiry itself. Most indicated in writing that they would be interested in associating with a global evangelization structure, and all of them completed the contact information.

Who? The Roles Involved

The major players in the Inquiry, apart from the Director, are the advisor, the consultative group and the members of the International Coalition. Each participant of an Inquiry uniquely contributes to the understanding of the whole body of Christ.

Advisor

Viggo Søgaard, who lives in his native Denmark, has given himself to and provided leadership for world evangelization for the last thirty years. He spends much of his time as a consultant to Christian groups around the world. He commutes periodically to the Fuller School of World Mission to teach on Research and Media in Church and Mission as he has done since 1983.

Consultative Group

This group will be engaged in consulting on content, process, and results of survey. Members will identify missiological issues relevant to the inquiry process and make recommendations for assignment of the topics identified to appropriate scholars for research.

Evangelizing Our World Inquiry Participants

The approach to the Inquiry and its ultimate success in fulfilling the objectives will depend upon the types of participants who are engaged in the process. The two primary considerations, other than geographic representation, are: (1) the balance and types of ministries represented, and (2) the personal qualifications of each.

Leadership Group Ideal Composition

For the focus group sessions, an optimum number is six to eight people. However, an ideal number of people for a leadership core group in a given city for an Inquiry would be twenty-five to thirty-five people who would be nationals of that country. In some places, the group might include one or two internationals. An optimum distribution by ministry responsibility would include the following:

1. at least five pastors of major churches
2. at least five denominational/network leaders, including Pentecostal, Baptist, Presbyterian, Charismatic networks
3. at least five mission leaders
4. at least five younger emerging leaders
5. at least five women
6. at least five lay leaders
7. at least five Christian service organizations

Criteria for Selection of Group Participants

Group participants would be selected based on local leadership criteria. The qualities looked for in a participant are as follows:

1. Integrity—basic honesty and a sound character, necessary for credibility with followers and local community of believers.
2. Spiritual authority—that anointing of God, which comes through gifted power, deep shaping experiences with God, and a godly character.
3. Flexibility—adjusts to meet new opportunities.
4. Learning Posture—overcomes the tendency to plateau. Daniel set an example as we find him still studying the Bible in his old age (Dan. 9).
5. Scope of influence—recognized by those of different groups within the city as a Christian leader who has exercised positive, persistent, specific influence for Christ within that city/nation/region.

What Are the Limitations?

During the five months of testing, several limitations were identified, which are being addressed as the process continues. The inquiry was limited because certain things did not work out as anticipated. There were some problems in design. The sample was limited. Some questions turned out to be biased.

Things That Did Not Work Out

Because the Inquiry sought answers to the question "Where do we go from here in world evangelization?" a tension arose in the focus of the questions. Should local Inquiry participants address the questions in relation to their own city, country, and context of ministry or should they address the questions with regard to the global scene beyond their

borders? Inquiry participants would have less understanding and, thus, meaningful response answering the questions with the world in view, rather than only their city and country with which they would be more familiar. A modified option was whether the Inquiry should deal with both local and global evangelization.

In the early versions of the inquiry, the assumption was that the sum total of local perspective from over one hundred cities and every region of the world would provide a global evangelization vision. Van Engen challenged that assumption and suggested that each participant group should be looking beyond the local to the global challenges and opportunities and call for their involvement. In expanding the inquiry to address both questions it became too long and unwieldy. In continuous pursuit of simplification from inputs from Lingenfelter and others, the Inquiry was modified to seek limited, but the more fundamental, perspectives for both the local and the global.

Problems with Design

Some of the questions changed via the evolutionary process of seeking, not only answers to the questions in the inquiry, but also the review of the validity and appropriateness of the questions. It was discovered in consultation with a number of people that some questions were more appropriate than others in relation to the objectives of the survey.

There was a problem in the original design in terms of what the qualitative survey should add via the focus group interactive process to the quantitative surveys completed by individuals. It was only through various iterations that the author understood the need

for both the quantitative and the qualitative approach to the Inquiry and the important substantiation by the qualitative through descriptive answers to the results obtained in the quantitative survey.

In the original design there was too much of a methodological approach, in which the answers were at least partially assumed at the beginning, and the questions led to the reaffirmation of existing assumptions. This resulted in a healthy debate, which clarified the need to prioritize the objective of seeking to hear from participants in Africa, and Asia, and Latin America, even more diligently than from those in the west.

During the discussion, the dimension of the spiritual process within the operational process surfaced as an important consideration. The need for humility, patience and time for interactive longer-term interchange became apparent. Out of the review, a methodological philosophy was developed to fulfill more effectively the objectives of the Inquiry called an Interactive Methodology.

Limitations to Sampling

There were limitations in the amount of raw data due to the restricted sample size. The geographic breadth of the sample was inadequate, especially given the problem of Non-western participation in shaping missiological and theological thinking.

It was a struggle to continue to simplify when the requests were constantly to expand the scope and the number of questions. It was necessary to eliminate a number of major questions that were in the early samples, especially relating to the area of leadership. In the process of seeking to accommodate several views, the instrument

became rather timid and soft, such that the objectives of the exercise would not be accomplished. The indigenous leaders who participated in Chiapas did not represent the broader spectrum of the body of Christ, but rather the more conservative, traditional Protestant perspective for the state.

Biased Questions

Some people suggested that there was a bias in the inquiry demonstrated by the types of questions being asked and the repetition of certain questions in different words. Others observed notable omissions of answers that would fit more readily as one of the options to the question in consideration.

Recommendations are to continue testing and seeking advice on the Inquiry by a broad section of Christian leaders and experts in the field prior to finalizing the document. This would not be with the intent of bringing major changes as it appears that the content is almost where it should be. This will help to involve some important people in the project who can then take ownership and offer support for the process. Plans are underway for holding an Inquiry among Korean Christian leaders in Los Angeles and among one hundred Christian leaders form the various groupings of believers from all the provinces of China.

Concluding Interpretation and Recommendations

An Inquiry objective is to listen to what God is doing and saying in regard to world evangelization. This is done by collecting insights, beliefs, and attitudes with regard to:

1. The people and the programs God is using
2. The meaning of world evangelization and the unfinished task
3. The challenges via factors external to the church
4. The obstacles internal to the church
5. What God is calling us to as the Body of Christ
6. The place and services that a global structure committed to world evangelization can offer
7. The identification of a compelling unifying paradigm[4]

Based on the interpretation of the preliminary data, it appears that there exists a desire to collaborate on a global level to some degree in world evangelization. Those who participated in the Inquiry indicated an interest in having a watchword that could serve as a point of unity toward a common vision.

We are trusting God for clarity about the nature of the unfinished task. We look forward to hearing from God's servants, especially those who are incarnating the gospel on the frontiers of mission, to shape a meaningful directional consensus of world evangelization into the twenty-first century. What do God's people throughout the world say about what the "Spirit is saying to the churches" (Rev. 3:22)?

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[4] As used in this context a paradigm is an archetypical example, prototype, or pattern that provides a model for a process.

CHAPTER 8

OBSERVATIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

As God's people enter the twenty-first century, many question the next steps for the church in world evangelization. I originally set out to answer this question in this dissertation. However, upon getting well into the reflection, I learned that, rather than answer the question, what was more important through the reflective process was to inform the question that would enable more effective listening. This study would help to set the stage for a journey in the listening mode to hear what the Spirit is saying to the churches of the twenty-first century regarding world evangelization. Consequentially, each chapter developed a catalyst of world evangelization, beginning with catalytic aim—the glory of God followed by the catalytic means—renewal, then the catalytic leader—Mott case study followed by catalytic structures through conferences. How these catalysts influenced the AD2000 Movement was developed in Chapter 6. In Chapter 7 an Inquiry incorporated questions for contemporary Christian leaders related to the catalytic, means, structures and leadership.

Observations

As we looked back at 2,000 years of Christian mission, we discovered inherent linkages to world evangelization. The links were observed within four major movements. The first movement spotlighted antecedents from the past and noted what was learned.

The second movement in the study sought to answer the question: How do we assess what was learned from assessments of the AD2000 Movement and relevant methodological frameworks for the future? Informed from the past and learning from the present, the third movement discussed looking toward the future in anticipation by means of an inquiry of Christian leaders worldwide as to where do we go from here in world evangelization.

Each of the five chapters, from Chapters 2 through 7, describe a distinct impetus to world evangelization. Chapter 2 developed the glory of God theme as found in the Scriptures and identified by leading missiologists as, not only the ultimate aim of mission, but also the ultimate motivation for mission. In reflecting on this paradigm of mission, the biblical and theological bases were examined, as well as the historical evidence from missiologists such as Voetius and Bavinck. In Chapter 3, the link between renewal and world evangelization was established from an overview of the history of mission surges and how they are most often the outgrowth of personal revival among Christian leaders. Chapter 4 affirmed the importance of Christian leaders as God's instruments, and as a case in point, Mott, to influence God's people to engage in God's missional purposes. Chapter 5 discussed how global mission conferences serve as catalysts to world evangelization. Chapter 6 showed the catalytic nature of the AD2000 Movement as a contextual and institutional platform for a vibrant world evangelization effort during the final decade of the second millennium based on the catalytic aim, means, structures and leadership. An inquiry for Christian leaders made up of quantitative

and qualitative questions based on the goal, means, structures and leadership is proposed in Chapter 7.

It may be too early to demonstrate that this inquiry will succeed in catalyzing a new world mission movement. However, early results were encouraging to the continued application of the inquiry process.

What I Have Learned from This Study

God uses various strategic means to catalyze his missional aims. Through the voice of non-Catholic Christian missiologists, including the first Protestant missiologist, Voetius, as well as Bavinck, I saw the "glory of God" considered as the goal of mission. From my study of the main biblical leadership eras (Chapter 2) over the twenty centuries of human history covered by the biblical narrative, I found that God uses people who envisioned the glory of God filling the earth. In looking more intently at the phrase "the glory of God" in Scripture, I learned that it appeared mainly in six biblical clusters which, when combined, present a multi-dimensional portrait of the power, the presence and the peace of God evident among a community of people.

I was reminded of the fact that God uses human beings to carry out his mission. One of the notable mission statesmen of the last century, Mott (see Chapter 4), was compared by historian Latourette to the Apostle Paul with respect to what was accomplished through his life in spreading the gospel. The wave of missionaries Mott's work sent forth, the call he championed and the concepts of world evangelization he promoted can never be called back; their influence will live on in eternity. Mott combined simple piety, personal evangelism, social concern and organizational genius

with a profound sense of destiny. His commitment to the unity of the body of Christ led to the formation of mission-based structures at first, and then, church-based structures.

Global mission conferences provide catalytic impetus to world evangelization when they are an integral part of a process that fosters united prayer, greater understanding of the mission context, and a united vision facilitated by a continuation committee. A conference which makes a catalytic impact on world evangelization communicates the significance of the historical context in which it is taking place. It addresses the need for both inspiration and collective action. Each generation of Christian leaders find the appropriate structure to support God's initiatives.

In reflecting on the AD2000 Movement, I was reminded of the potential of servant-catalyst movements of world evangelization, while at the same time I saw the frailties enmeshed in the human enterprise of mission. One of the questions I have been asked on several occasions was why the AD2000 Movement disbanded when there was abundant evidence of the fruitfulness of the movement in generating energy for world evangelization initiatives around the world. From the very first formative AD2000 meeting, the consensus of participants was that the catalytic impact of the movement would be greater if it were to serve the Christian community with a timeframe of a decade rather than an open-ended commitment.

During the course of my reflection, I realized anew how an inquiry among the servants of God around the world with regard to world evangelization in the twenty-first century could help determine some future directions. As we listen to one another, especially Christian leaders from the non-Western world, a missiology could be forged

capable of empowering the global church for participation in God's mission in a new way.

Recommendations to Think about in the Future

In establishing the catalysts of world evangelization, I have brought to bear various perspectives from church history, theologians and missiologists, mission statesmen, Christian movements, methodological frameworks, and the use of inquiries. Many questions remain for further and fuller reflection as we seek to advance the Christian movement in the twenty-first century to the glory of God. They are listed as follows:

1. How can the global Christian movement be encouraged to launch a fresh wave of mission flowing out of the fresh authentic evangelical awakening?

2. How can the people of God be encouraged to discover and define new frontiers for the sake of the gospel, without neglecting the need for nurture within the church?

3. How can the global missionary movement discover and then move across the remaining cultural, racial, social, and geographic barriers?

4. How are leaders to be selected, trained, and encouraged to finish well to lead the twenty-first century movement?

5. How can the whole church be encouraged and mobilized in mission?

6. How to associated God's glory and mission? How does the missionary paradigm of God's glory impact not only the motif of mission but also the motives of mission? Is it God's glory to gather and enfold people, embracing them in his love? Is it God's glory to send? What are the practical missiological implications of the glory of God in a mission paradigm?

7. What are the principles that can be identified from scripture and, specifically, from the book of Ezekiel, as it relates to the

transformation of the city and the glory of God motif as a model for urban mission in the twenty-first century?

8. How does the unifying paradigm of the glory of God stand up against the conceptual frameworks of (1) Christ's Great Commission mandates of mission, (2) missiologically conceived paradigms of mission related to each era of human history, (3) the mission-cluster framework and the integrative ongoing reflective framework?

9. How does the mission meta-theme of the glory of God find expression in the context of the twenty-first century post-modernizing world?

10. How can the body of Christ build and maintain the existing effective structures, while at the same time encouraging the creativity of the Holy Spirit through men and women on the periphery in the reshaping of the church for mission, both local and global?

11. How can we further understand the relationship between the gospel and culture, in which to engage in mission in a pluralistic and postmodern world?

12. What are Christian leaders from around the world saying about the primary issues in their countries and about a unifying paradigm that would fit their context?

13. How does the rapidly growing Pentecostal and Charismatic streams of the church think regarding future mission?

These are some of the pressing questions that surfaced in the process of contemplating world evangelization in the twenty-first century. A number of practical implications also arose from the study.

The Practical Implications

Several practical implications emerge for Christians in the twenty-first century out of the study of the major catalysts of world evangelization. First, the church must hear a wake-up call. Awareness of how God works to fulfill his missional purposes throughout

the world creates a God-given expectancy for a macro-mission advance which may be released by an act of faith and obedience to step forward in mission. As Paul wrote:

> And do this, understanding the present time. The hour has come for you to wake up from your slumber, because our salvation is nearer now than when we first believed. The night is nearly over; the day is almost here. So let us put aside the deeds of darkness and put on the armor of light (Rom. 13:11-12).

Second, a genuine test of cooperation with God's purposes for each generation is to ask the question: Does it align the recipients with God's agenda rather than the world's agenda? Ultimately, the appropriate question becomes: Are we, as the body of Christ in our city, nation or world, cooperating with what the Holy Spirit is doing in our twenty-first century context of globalization?

Third, history reveals that new mission advance begins in spiritual quickening. Therefore, this is a call to a life of abandonment and devotion to God. An impulse multiplied under the purpose and will of God through others may turn into a macro pulsation.

Fourth, because even God-inspired activities are carried out by imperfect humans, new movements must not be judged too quickly. The church must exercise restraint, as did Gamaliel, when he spoke to the secular leaders of his day concerning the new spiritual movement of Christians:

> Gamaliel, a teacher of the law, who was honored by all the people, stood up in the Sanhedrin and ordered that the men be put outside for a little while. Then he addressed them: "Men of Israel, consider carefully what you intend to do to these men. . . . Leave these men alone! Let them go! For if their purpose or activity is of human origins, it will fail. But if it is from God, you will not be able to stop these men; you will only find yourselves fighting against God" (Ac. 5:34-35, 38b-39).

Fifth, view each crisis as an opportunity. As the Chinese written form for crisis includes just two figures, one designating risk and the other opportunity, so every crisis is the result of taking risks and provides an opportunity for a new surge in religions interest and corresponding mission initiative. "[E]arly Christians experienced a substantial repetition of the pattern of crisis/prayer/empowerment as documented in Acts 5:23-37" (Lovelace 1979:49).

Sixth, this is a call to practical mission. Each person is challenged to review options and spiritual passions, to become involved personally in mission and to steward resources for the cause of mission.

Seventh, in these early days of the twenty-first century, an appropriate next step is to conduct a thorough assessment. This evaluation would not only be of the results of the mission we are carrying out, but of the very nature of the mission objectives.

Eighth, we should apply the Evangelizing Our World Inquiry in cities throughout the world to listen to what God is doing and saying in regard to world evangelization. Through the inquiry we will collect insights, beliefs, and attitudes of his servants, especially in the world, an as-yet untapped source of great richness.

Fresh Terminology

It may be helpful and energizing to introduce into the vocabulary of God's people a lively and charged mission terminology. The following are fresh expressions with accompanying provisional definitions:

1. A *micro-surge* is a step of obedient faith in which a Christian engages in mission to the glory of God.

2. A *macro-surge* occurs when a group of God's people agree together and engage in mission, with a common vision to the glory of God, that makes a major, long-term impact on the community in which they live.

3. A *meta-surge* takes place when the course of human history is dramatically changed through the cooperative mission initiative of God's people.

4. A *micro-impulse* involves the touch of the Holy Spirit, reviving the inner person in such a way that the person knows with assurance that he/she is accepted in Jesus, free from the bondage of sin, indwelt by the Holy Spirit, with authority in Christ to engage in spiritual conflict.

5. A *macro-impulse* occurs when a *micro-impulse* takes place in enough of God's people so as to result in the awakening of special concern in church members and extending the influence of the kingdom of God in a major fashion in the local community and across social, racial, linguistic and geographic barriers to the glory of God.

6. A *meta-revival* occurs when a *macro-impulse* happens in such magnitude so as to leave a major impact on history.

Conclusion

There are catalysts of world evangelization initiatives worthy of careful scrutiny at the outset of the twenty-first century, particularly by those involved in strategic movements. The links can be discovered in the Bible, in the writings of Christian missiologists, in church history, among Christian leaders, the world mission conferences of the last century, in world evangelization movements, in methodological frameworks and survey instruments. Scripture foretells a day when missions will cease and there will be no more world evangelization. The final chapters of Scripture raise the curtain to show a vivid picture of what is still to come once world evangelization has ceased. As we look ahead through the lens of the prophetic Word, we watch in amazement as we hear these words:

> The streets of the city were made of pure gold, clear as crystal. I did not see a temple there. The Lord God All-Powerful and the Lamb were its temple. And the city did not need the sun nor the moon. The glory of God was shining on it, and the Lamb was its light.
>
> Nations will walk by the light of that city, and kings will bring their riches there. Its gates are always open during the day, and night never comes. The glorious treasures of nations will be brought into the city. But nothing unworthy will be allowed to enter. No one who is dirty-minded or who tells lies will be there. Only those whose names are written in the Lamb's book of life will be in the city.
>
> The angel showed me a river that was crystal clear, and its waters gave life. The river came from the throne were God and the Lamb were seated. Then it flowed down the middle of the city's main street. On each side of the river are trees that grow a different kind of fruit each month of the year. The fruit gives life. And the leaves are used as medicine to heal the natures (Rev. 21:21b-22:2).[1]

Between this day and the day when the nations walk on the streets of gold by the light of the city, God's people are called to engage in world evangelization along the dirt, cobbled and tarmac streets of the cities and villages of the world. It is hoped that, aided and stimulated by this perspective, the church may join together in God's mission for the twenty-first century.

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[1] *Holy Bible: Contemporary English Version* (Nashville, TN: Thomas Nelson, 1995.)

APPENDIX A

INTEGRATIVE METHODOLOGICAL FRAMEWORK

This methodology of assessing mission produces a cycle whereby reflection informs action and action informs reflection. Rather than being static, this frame provides a dynamic view of mission. It clusters around a meta-theme.[1] The process components, explanations and accompanying Figures 13-19 are adapted from the work of Charles E. Van Engen (2001a).

Step 1: A Biblical Foundation (Figure 13)

Reflections from Scriptures on mission from Genesis to Revelation provide the foundation upon which to build the framework. The Bible informs us about the ways of God in mission (the *missio Dei*). Not everyone committed to this basic framework agrees with the sequence of the steps. Missiologists Verkuyl and Bosch would place the history of the study of mission before the biblical foundation. Bosch presented an overview of the ways in which the church, down through the centuries, has understood her missionary responsibility before dealing with the biblical foundations (Bosch 1993).

[1] Meta-theme refers to the overarching theme of mission for the purpose of this study. It is the application of a framework or set of frameworks that will help us to identify a meta-theme of mission for the twenty-first century, that is, to discover and describe that which God has called us to as a church, mission agency, Christian organization or movement. The meta-theme will be used at times interchangeably with both the integrating idea and the mission motif, but for the purpose of clarity, the term meta-theme will be used most frequently.

Step 2: The Church's Reflection (Figure 13)

The historical and systematic theological reflection of the church has impacted the various lenses that have been used to look at the Bible and mission through history. An example of this is what Bosch does in *Witness to the World: The Christian Mission in Theological Perspective* (1980). The purpose of the book is to acquaint pastors, missionaries and church members with the problems facing missions today. Bosch presents the crisis of mission in our day as a result, in part, of the overuse and divergent understanding of the word mission itself. The thesis of *Witness to the World* is that the summary question that needs to be addressed in understanding the significant issues in the theology of mission is "What does it mean to be the church of Christ in the world today?" In approaching this question, Bosch deals with the theology of mission through the ages. He reviews the historical perspective of mission of the early church, the Constantinian era, from Alexander VI to Pius XII, from Martin Luther to Martin Kähler, from John Eliot to John Mott, Ecumenical Missionary Theology and developments since 1960 (Bosch 1980:93-182).

Step 3: The World Context (Figure 13)

In each unique context, mission takes place and shapes the evolving understanding of mission. An example of this process is in *Christ Outside the Gate* (1982). Orlando Costas writes essays that "demonstrate the contextual character of missiology as 'a theology of the crossroads,' or a critical reflection at the point where cultures, ideologies, religious traditions, and social, economic and political systems

confront each other, and where the gospel seeks to cross the frontier of unbelief" (Costas 1982:xiv).

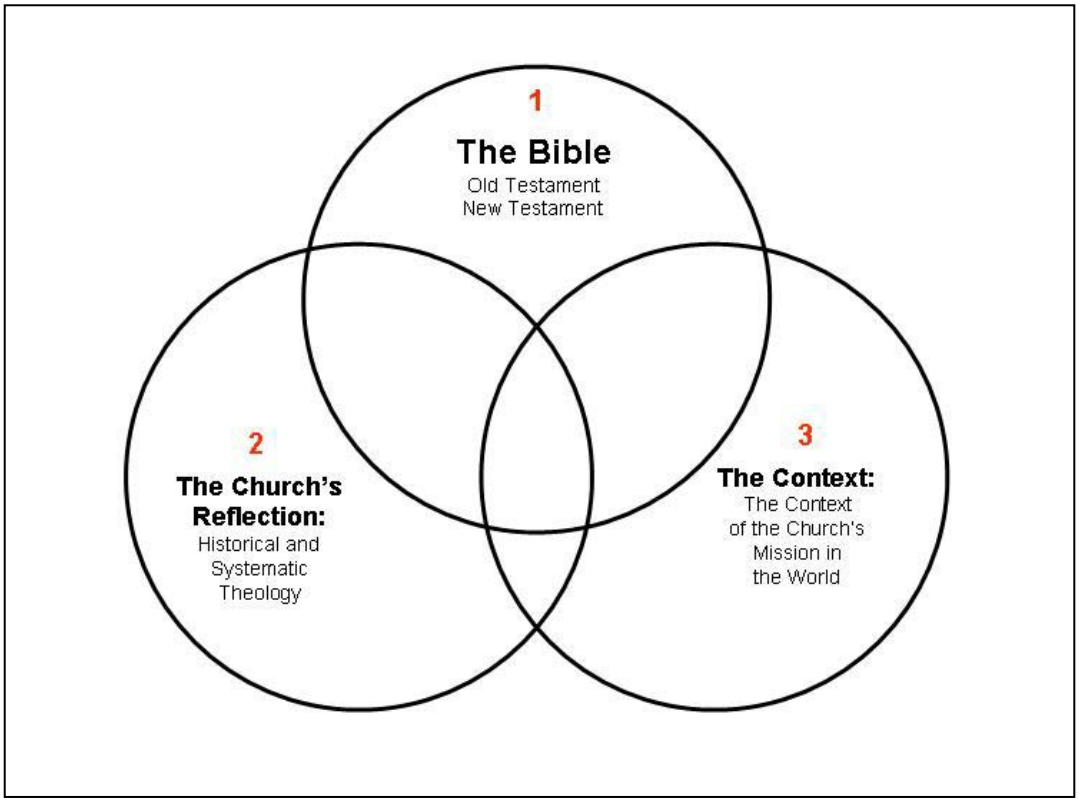


FIGURE 13

THREE DOMAINS OF MISSIOLOGY

The three-arena nature of missiology has served as a framework for deliberations on mission for a number of missiologists as well as training centers, including Fuller Theological Seminary School of World Mission. Leonardo Boff, Orlando Costas, David Bosch, Johannes Verkuyl, John V. Taylor, Donald McGavran, Max Warren, Leslie Newbigin, James Scherer, Gerald Anderson, Carl Braaten, Howard Snyder, Jürgen

Moltmann, among others "also utilize a three-arena approach in their theology and missiology, though they may not speak of all three at once in the same place" (Van Engen 2001a).

In Figure 13, each domain represents a sphere of knowledge, influence, activity and relationship. Each circle thus symbolizes a domain of missiology that provides a unique contribution for mission. The overlap of multiple circles represents a level of integration and continuity in multiple domains.

Step 4: Personal Experience: The Four Domains (Figure 14)

Each of us who approach the Bible and examine the story of God's mission bring his or her own set of cultural and personal strengths, weaknesses, and pilgrimage. These affect the way in which Scripture and mission is understood and perceived. The Bible, the church, the context, and God's mission are all seen through one's own personal lens. Every individual brings to the missional task their cultural background, personal pilgrimage, spirituality and family.

The personal pilgrimage and one's own experience of the cross and growth in spirituality will, of course, provide a major creative addition to the multi-faceted interactive missiological framework. Together, the four circles represent the fundamental components of the frame for missional action. When we read the narratives of God's mission through people in the Bible, we find all four of these domains are experienced simultaneously, and each Christian worker will probably want to take stock of his or her own life and purpose, particularly in context of Circles 1, 2, 3.

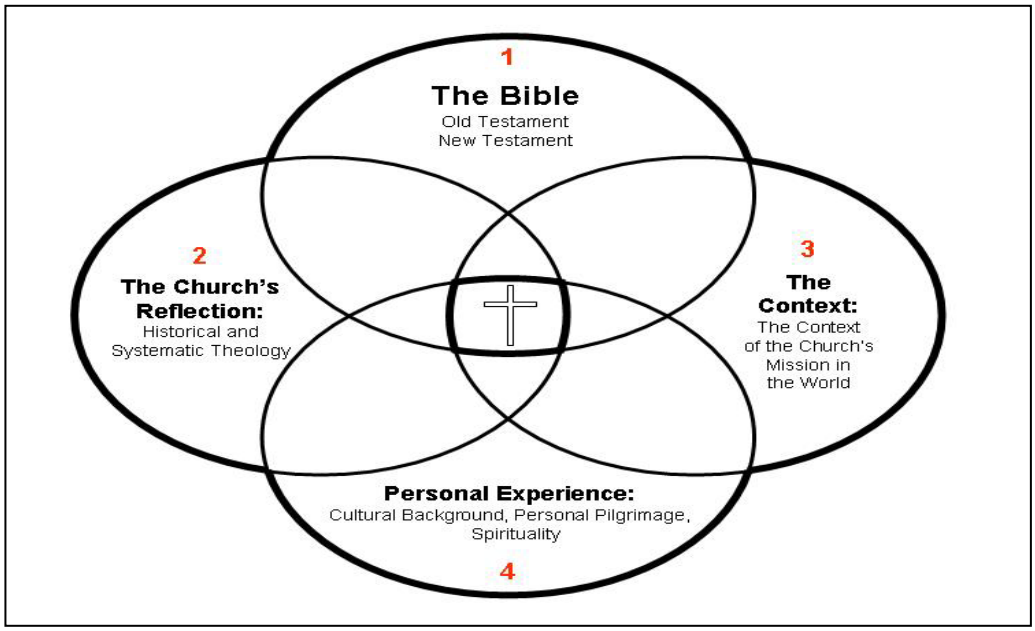


FIGURE 14

PERSONAL EXPERIENCE:
THE FOUR DOMAINS

Step 5: The Integrating Idea/Meta-Theme of Mission (Figure 15)

It is from the place where all four domains of mission (Bible, Church, Person, and Context) intersect at the cross that they interact and influence each other. The meta-theme contains the motif, integrating idea, unifying paradigm or paradigms, perceptions, and thinking patterns common to all four domains, and occasionally these same terms are interchanged. The meta-theme provides connectivity and continuity between domains:

> Seen in its entirety, the Integrating Idea flows through a process (channel) that transforms it from theory into action. In this process, it is evaluated, examined, enhanced, energized, enacted, and finally reintegrated with the four original domains so that reconceptualization can take place leading towards a refinement of mission. Over time, therefore, this becomes an

> iterative process that is constantly making adjustments in mission theory and practice (Van Engen 2001a).

One of those who reflected on the concept of an integrating idea in mission was Hendrikus Berkhof. He surveyed the church theologians in his exhaustive treatment of dogmatics. In the process he defined dogmatics as the "scientific reflection on the Christian faith" (1988:45). In relating dogmatics to mission he introduced the term "theologizing," which was used by missiologists who followed him. Berkhof then equated theologizing to dogmatic reflection (1988:49). What informs theologizing is the Word, the world and the church (1988:78). The process of theologizing needs to have a foundation. "We recall that earlier we talked about the foundations on which theologizing must rest" (1988:73). He observes that "scholars of the day, in pursuit of a timely and relevant theology, embraced themes for mission such as 'revolution,' 'liberation,' and 'emancipation'" (1988:62). One of the experiments in "praxis-based dogmatic reflection" led to liberation theology (1988:49).

What then is an appropriate foundation for theologizing? Berkhof explores various alternatives, primarily, the Scriptures. He concludes that the integrating idea of theologizing in mission should be Jesus Christ. "Christ, after all, rather than exhausting Scripture, is in turn end point, starting point, and center of a long covenantal history." And, "it is natural, then, to declare Christ to be the foundation of dogmatics" (1988:80). The methodological concentration in the process of ascertaining a unifying paradigm for mission should be Christ. The centralization of Christ was mastered by Karl Barth, who talks about proximity to Christ (1988:80).

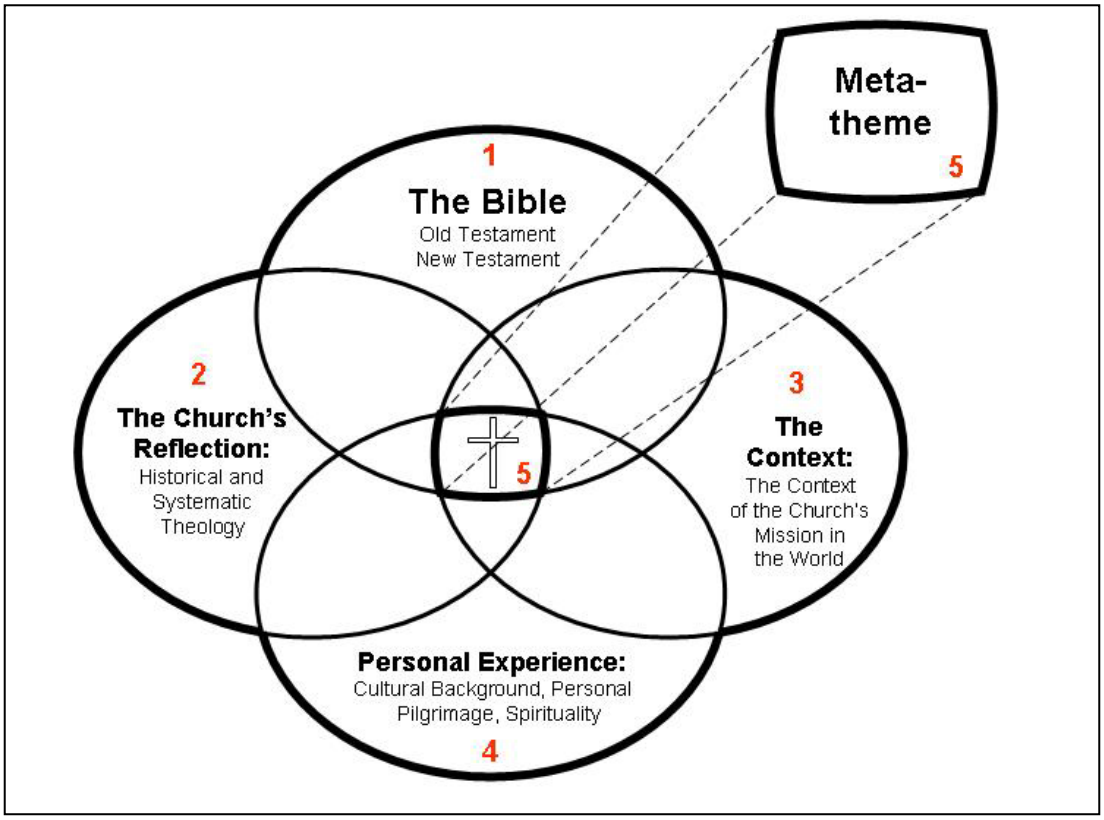


FIGURE 15

FOUR DOMAINS AND THE INTEGRATING IDEA

Step 6: The Holy Spirit and Prayer in Mission (Figure 16)

Because mission is the action of the Holy Spirit through the agency of the church from Pentecost forward, it is essential for anyone seeking to be involved in mission to prayerfully reflect on the Holy Spirit's role and invite his presence and direction throughout the assessment process leading to missional action. The spiritual dynamic of prayer releases the Holy Spirit to illumine Scripture, to control the process of assessment, to enthuse participants in that process and to give faith to fulfill an emerging paradigm of mission, and lifts reflection from an academic exercise to a spiritual one.

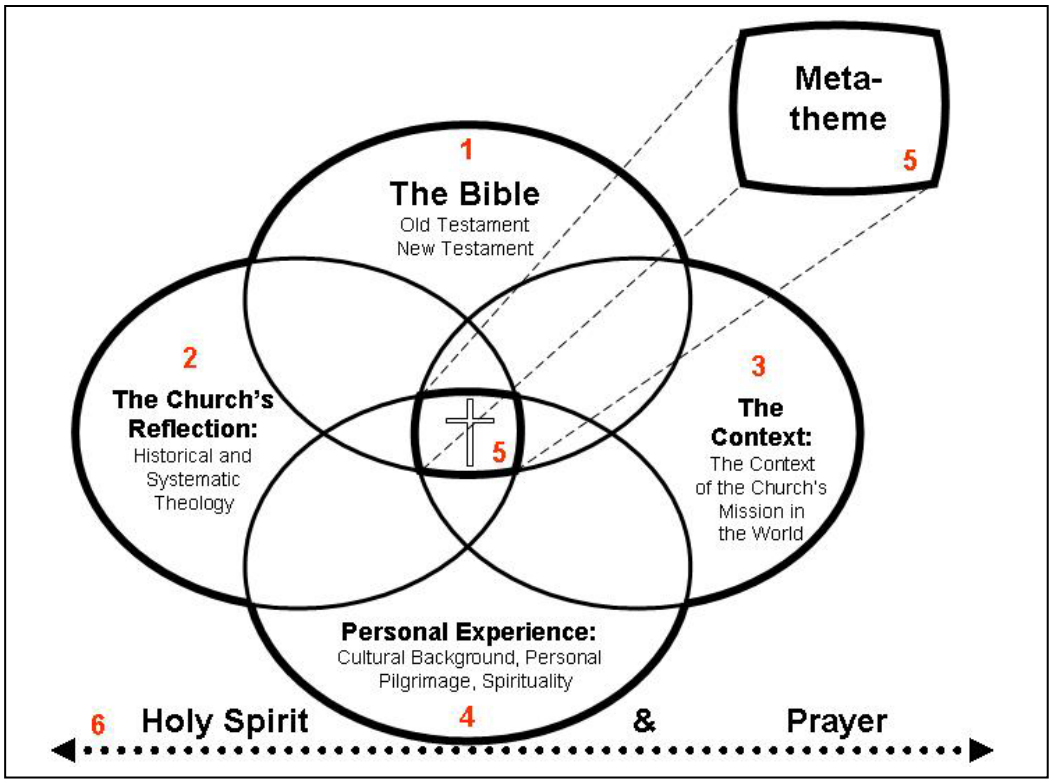


FIGURE 16

THE HOLY SPIRIT AND PRAYER IN MISSION

Step 7: The History of Missional Action (Figure 17)

Everywhere in the world there exists a history of the church's interaction with that context. How has the church conducted its mission? What have been the macro and micro impulses that led to significant mission advance, especially as modeled by the early church?

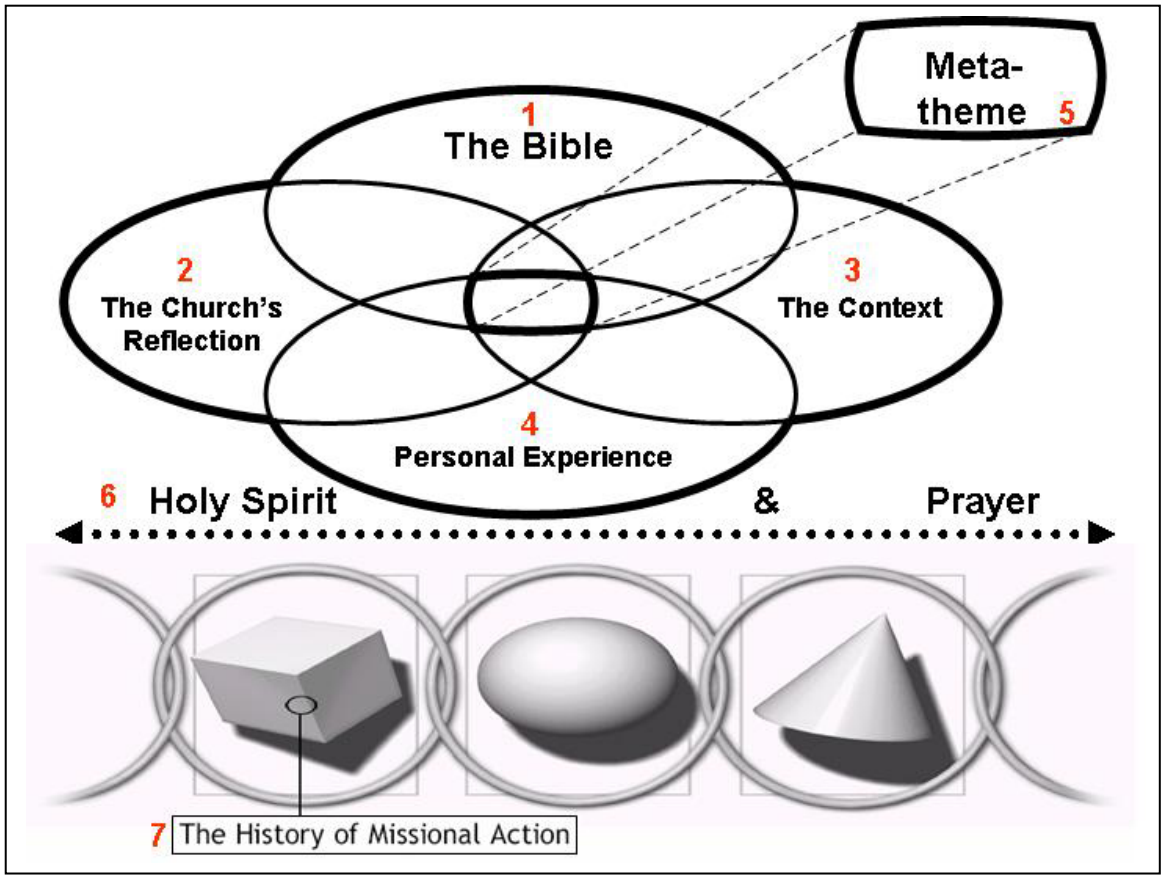


FIGURE 17

HISTORY OF MISSIONAL ACTION

Step 8: The History of Missional Action and Theory (Figure 18)

The particular theological traditions (Ecumenical, Evangelical, Pentecostal, Charismatic, Orthodox, Roman Catholic) have influenced the theoretical framework that has informed mission action. Mission theory associated with the action is this history of theory that will help guide us (Van Engen 2001a).

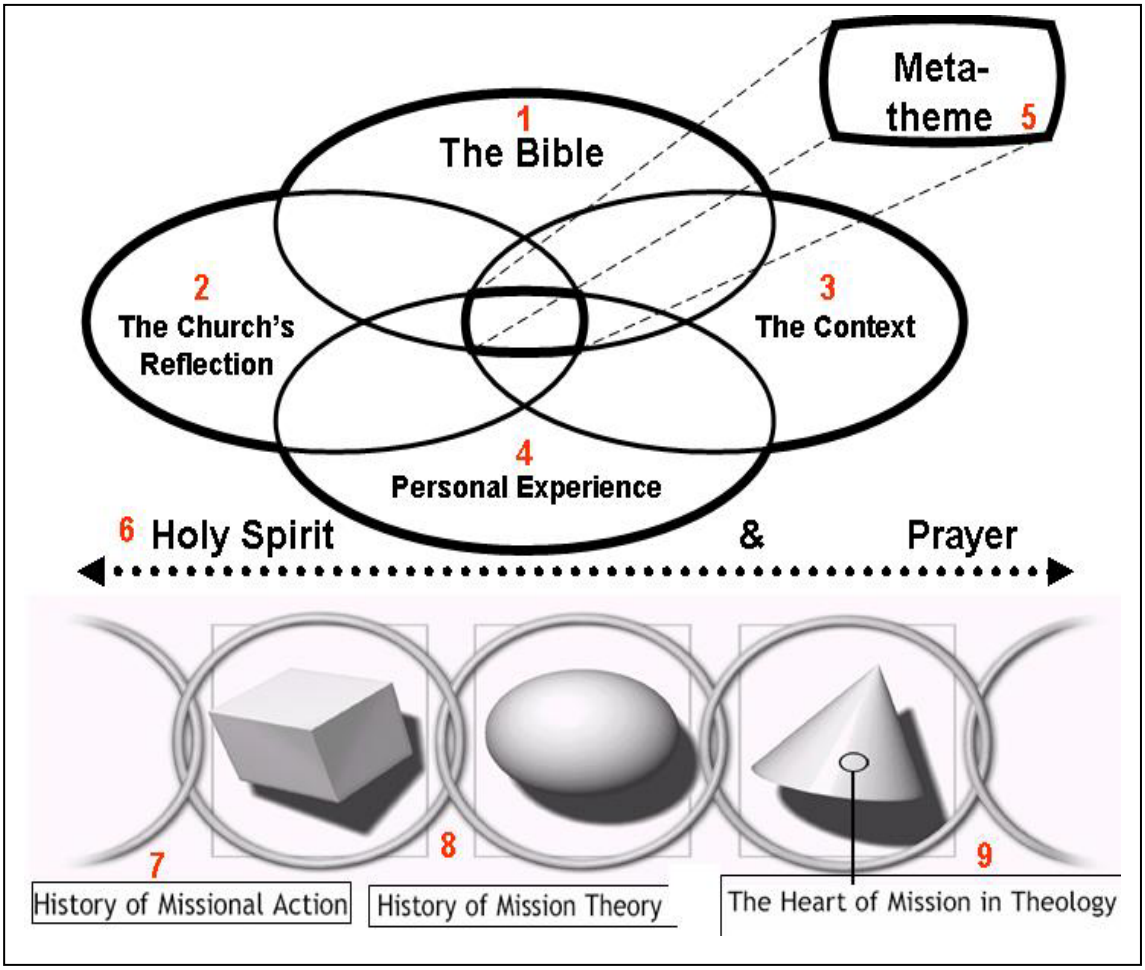


FIGURE 18

HISTORY OF MISSIONAL ACTION AND THEORY

Step 9: The Heart of Mission in *Missio Dei* (Figure 19)

This is where we move from the past to the future (see the Working Grid of Mission, Table 9). In this integrative step, focus the reflection on issues of mission practice. Work through the matrix of foundational categories of mission theory with attendant aspects of missional action.

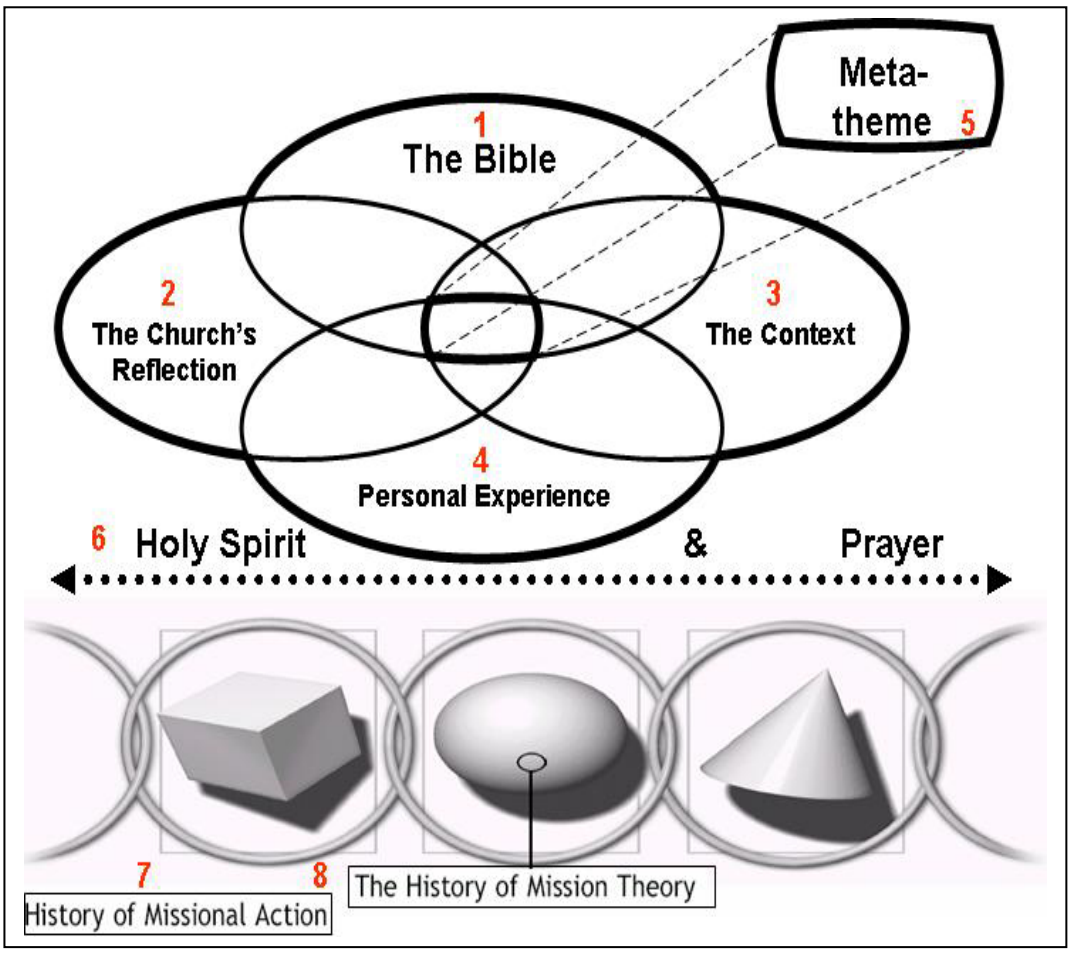


FIGURE 19

THE HEART OF MISSION IN *MISSIO DEI*

Figure 18 links the preceding steps in the missional framework with the steps that follow, as part of an integrative and yet closely interconnected methodological process. It is the interweaving of the vertical aspects of mission with the horizontal where the grid can be most helpful and, at the same time, most complex.

TABLE 9

WORKING GRID OF MISSION
(Adapted from Van Engen 1996:29)

Aspects of Mission	*Missio Dei*	*Missio Christi*	*Missio Spiritus Sancti*	*Missio Hominum*	*Missiones Ecclesia-rum*	*Missio Politica Oecume-nica*	*Missio Futurum/ Adventus*
Missio Spiritus Sancti							
Mission Context							
Agents of Mission							
Motives of Mission							
Means of Mission							
Methods of Mission							
Goals of Mission							
Results of Mission							
Centripetal/ Centrifugal Activities							
Utopia/Future Hope							
Presence							
Proclamation							
Persuasion							
Incorporation							
Structures							
Partnerships							
Power							
Prayer							
Praise							
Other?							

Step 10: The Missional Action (Figure 20)

Missional action or praxis is defined based on the integration offered in the grid, relating church and context in a specific time and place. Other important considerations include what resources are available for the task and where they are working at the current time.

Over time, the action informs reflection as the reflection has informed the action. Theory informs praxis and, in turn, praxis informs theory. The final phase of missional action calls for reflection on the action which then launches the process of assessment all over again:

> Reflection, re-examination, re-thinking, and reconceptualizing are needed at this point. Reflection should take place addressing the consistency between the action taken and the initial conceptualization found in the integrating idea. Where are anomalies, inconsistencies, and contradictions between the understanding of the integrating idea and the action taken, we must look more carefully. The place of anomalies is the place where reconceptualization begins all over again. This creates a process of action and reflection which is molded through time (Van Engen 2001a).

The process will change personal experience. A major change can then result in a paradigm shift.

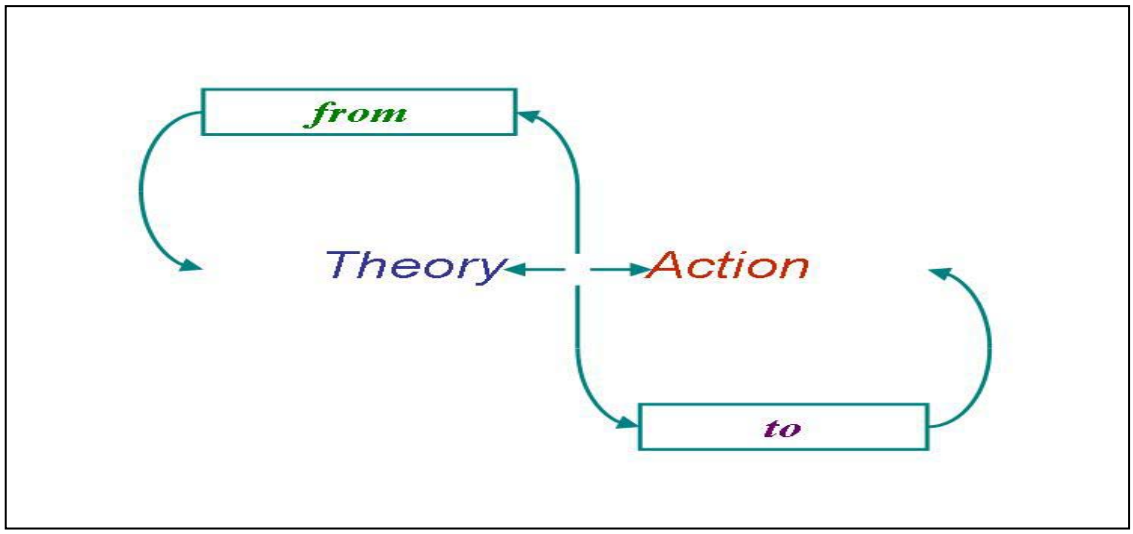


FIGURE 20

MISSIONAL ACTION

Conclusion

From time to time, the stakeholders in churches, mission agencies, national initiatives, global structures and movements evaluate the results of the mission they are seeking to carry out. In these early days of the twenty-first century and third millennium, it is an appropriate moment to conduct a thorough assessment, not only of the results of the mission we are carrying out, but the very nature of the mission objectives.

The process of evaluation outlined above can be applied to local churches, denominations, networks, mission structures and/or mission movements. The hoped-for outcome is to arrive at a catalytic impetus that a methodological review of our missional action can have on world evangelization in the twenty-first century, but there is no guarantee that this outcome will, in fact, occur.

APPENDIX B

INTERPRETIVE CONCERNS ABOUT *MISSIO DEI*

The *missio Dei* motif became the expression along which missiological understanding flowed in ever broadening and deepening conceptualizations. The concept became dynamic rather than a static concept, adapting to contextual and historical pulsations rather than anchored to a biblical foundation:

> When, after isolation on the continent during World War II, salvation-historical theology of mission entered the *ecumene*, it was gradually both deepened and broadened. The deepening manifested itself in the *missio Dei* motif to which we shall return. The broadening meant that, in the course of time, the conviction grew that God's salvific acts through the Church were flowing along a wider river-bed than the narrow salvation-historical definition of mission had allowed (Bosch 1980:175).

Along the dynamic hermeneutical pathway of *missio Dei*, there emerged traps and minefields laid by armchair theologians:

> The Trinitarian *Missio Dei* view was replaced by a theory about the transformation of the world and of history not through evangelization and church-planting but by means of a divinely guided immanent historical process, somewhat analogous to deistic views of the Enlightenment. This secular view of God's mission made the empirical church virtually dispensable as an agent of divine mission, and in some places even a hindrance (Scherer and Bevans 1992:86).

The fact that the meaning of mission kept changing in conjunction with the dynamic response of the term *missio Dei* to changing times, its context made it difficult for Christians to adapt to its changing meaning. "Unfortunately the relationship between the original and the modern meaning of *missio* has for a long time not been recognized.

Abraham Kuyper was one of the first theologians to point this out explicitly" (Bosch 1980:240). *Missio Dei* underwent a metamorphosis in which:

> God became an anaemic deistic figure, the great discoverer and initiator of mission who, however, gradually withdrew, leaving the execution of his mission to his ground staff. In this way mission became *our* enterprise, dependent on us, and we were supposed to goad on ourselves to ever greater exertion and sacrifices. It was then however that mission moved from the area of gospel to that of law (Bosch 1980:240).

The year 1980 proved to be a watershed year in regard to the conceptualization of the phrase *missio Dei* which surfaced at both the ecumenical World Council of Churches (WCC)-sponsored Melbourne event and the evangelical Lausanne-sponsored global Pattaya event, held only one month apart in 1980. In both cases, *missio Dei* was used but with completely different meanings. Both quoted Dietrich Bonhoeffer. The evangelicals read him in terms of spirituality and the cost of discipleship. The ecumenicals read him in terms of a failed appeal by the church to condemn Nazism for the Holocaust of the Jews. Since the church failed in its mission as God's agency to become relevant, they argued, we should by-pass the church and engage directly in what God is doing in the world with the goal of social transformation (Van Engen 2001a). The essential distinction between Melbourne and Pattaya became the order of mission (see Table 6). The WCC changed the order of mission to God-world-church.[1] The evangelicals maintained the order God-church-world. As a result, the

[1] The discussion took place in a study report of the WCC titled "The Church for Others" in the section under the heading "Re-Thinking the Relationship of Church and World." "In the past it has been customary to maintain that God is related to the world through the Church. When they sharpen this view into a formula the sequence would be: God-Church-world. This has been understood to mean that God primarily related to the Church and only secondarily to the world by means of the Church. Further it has been held that God relates himself to the world through the Church in order to gather everyone possible from the world into the Church. God, in other words, moves through the Church to the world. We believe that the time has come to question this sequence and to emphasize an alternative. According to this alternative the last two items in God-Church-world should be reversed so that it reads instead God-world-Church. That is, God's primary relationship is to the world, and it is the world and not the Church that is the focus of God's plan." WCC member Hoekstra responds: "The rearranging of the words God-Church-

WCC embraced civil rights, apartheid and liberationist movements, like those in Rwanda and Nicaragua, and mission essentially died, as did the vigor of the WCC (Van Engen 2001a).

world to read God-world-Church represents a radical discontinuity with the way the Christian Church has traditionally understood these relationships" (Hoekstra 1979:75-76).

APPENDIX C

PAUL E. PIERSON: DISTINGUISHING MARKS OF SPIRITUAL RENEWAL

1. Renewal seems always to arise on the periphery of the larger ecclesiastical structure, that is, the institutional church, with men or women of little status in leadership. Some may be ordained, some unordained.

2. Often the context is one of crisis, political, economic, social.

3. Every revival or awakening involves certain generic factors; e.g., fervent prayer, a new experience of the holiness and transcendence of God, of our sin, and of grace.

4. They may involve unusual manifestations in some cases, or they may not.

5. They include a renewed emphasis on the Holy Spirit.

6. Such movements also include elements specific to the context; e.g., unity in the Moravian movement, reconciliation in the Korean and East African revivals.

7. The renewals are countercultural to some degree but often lose this aspect as time goes by and they conform more and more to the surrounding culture.

8. They involve some degree of recontextualization, that is, often in terms of the aspects of the gospel: which are communicated, who communicates, to whom, where, and how.

9. Distance decreases: between God and humans, (paradox of the transcendent and holy God who comes near), between men and women, races, social classes, denominations, cultures. Greater unity of Christians resulting.

10. There is a return to the study of Scripture in these renewal movements.

11. They bring opposition from some in the church and fanaticism by some in the movement.

12. There is generally a heightened sense of spiritual warfare.

13. Such movements lead the church, or at least that part of the church involved in the movement, to reach out beyond its normal constituency, to the poor, marginalized.

14. They lead to greater social concern and social transformation at the personal level, in ministries to the poor, and at times in structural social changes.

15. There must be a need for flexibility of structures if the movement is not to be crushed.

16. They lead to mission beyond their own social, cultural, and geographical contexts.

17. Finally, every movement is messy, less than perfect (Pierson 2001).

APPENDIX D

KEY TERMS ANALYSIS

In seeking to analyze some of the key terms that are utilized to describe a group of people there is an important reality to keep in mind. These terms have different meanings at different times and different places. They also mean different things to different people. For example, journalists covering the television scandals in the late 1980s and early 1990s interchanged the terms evangelical, charismatic, Pentecostal and fundamentalist (Spittler 1994:103). Despite these kinds of inconsistencies for the purposes of this dissertation to describe how the term is used herein, these terms are analyzed by referring to acknowledged and respected scholars in the field.

An Ecumenical

"The word ecumenical is properly used to describe everything that related to the whole task of the whole Church to bring the Gospel to the whole world"[1] (Hogg 1952:11). The concept could be traced from earlier reflections in conferences such as the International Missionary Council (IMC) gathering in Madras in 1938, which included among their recommendations the following: "The responsibility for evangelism was the task of the whole Church for the whole world" (Bassham 1979:24). Then at the first

[1] From The World Council of Churches: Minutes and Reports of the Fourth Meeting of the Central Committee. Rolle, Switzerland, August 4-11, 1951, p. 65 (Hogg 1952:11).

assembly of the WCC at Amsterdam in 1948 is "the whole Church should set itself to the total task of winning the whole world to Christ" (1979:29).

An Evangelical

The classical description of an evangelical includes the following characteristics: "*conversion,* the belief that lives need to be change; *activism,* the expression of the gospel in effort; *Biblicism,* a particular regard for the Bible; and what may be called *crucicentrism,* a stress on the sacrifice of Christ on the cross" (Bebbington 1989:3).

A Charismatic Christian

A charismatic Christian is a follower of Jesus Christ who emphasizes spiritual experiences and the activities of the Holy Spirit. "The term *charismatic Christianity* is meant to encompass all Christianity, from its beginning in the first century, that emphasizes religious or spiritual experience and the activities of the Holy Spirit" (Poewe 1994:1). "Charismatics are people who see themselves as having surrendered their lives to Christ. They are baptized in the Holy Spirit and , therefore, exercise one or several of these gifts" (Poewe 1994:xii).

Pentecostals differ from charismatics in their dates of origin and forms of institutionalization:

> Pentecostals form a denominational family of Christians whose beginnings date from the 1890s to the 1920s. Their existence can be traced largely to rejection by the mainstream churches who laid claim to novel experiences of the Spirit so central to Pentecostal piety. . . . The decade of the 1990s finds Pentecostals concluding their first century, charismatics their first generation. In the aggregate, only a small faction of the globe's

> charismatics form a separate branch of the church. The word *charismatic* more usually functions as an adjective describing mainline folk who have adopted Pentecostal beliefs, values, and practices (Spittler 1994:105).

A Fundamentalist

In the 1980s fundamentalism was characterized by the Moral Majority. The classical fundamentalists were those who identified with the booklets titled *The Fundamentals: A Testimony to the Truth*, distributed widely between 1910 and 1915 (Spittler 1994:104). Fundamentalism has come to be seen as a religious or political ideology linked to militant conservatism.

A Pentecostal

In a book that provides a milestone in the recognition of Pentecostal scholarship that was the outcome of a conference held in 1996 in San Jose, Costa Rica, on the topic of the globalization of Pentecostalism no simple definition is given of a Pentecostal. One reason may be that it is becoming more and more difficult to define:

> It is becoming increasingly difficult to define "Pentecostal." If we persist with a limited, rather stereotyped and dogmatic understanding of the term, we will fail to recognize the great variety of Pentecostal movements in most of the rest of the world, many of which have arisen quite independently of Western Pentecostalism. In Africa the term includes (1) the majority of older AICs, (2) classical Pentecostals originating in Western Pentecostal missions, and (3) newer independent churches, fellowships, and ministries. The classical or denominational Pentecostals (such as the Assemblies of God and the Church of God) are very active and growing throughout Africa; they have undoubtedly played a significant role in the emergence of some of the newer groups. But the classical Pentecostal churches typically were founded by missionaries, mostly from Britain and North America, and therefore they cannot be regarded primarily as African initiated movements, even though their

> growth involved more African leadership and financial independence than was the case in most of the older missionary-founded churches (Anderson 2001:113).

Frank D. Machia observes: "the well-known fact that a fully developed Pentecostal 'theology' has not been written" (in Dempster, Klaus, and Petersen 1999:9).

> The baptism of the Holy Spirit as a postconversion empowerment for gifted service in the world, especially as evidenced by unknown tongues, was at least the most controversial and, therefore, outstanding distinctive of classical Pentecostalism a the beginning of the movement (1999:9):

In a section dealing with Pentecostal origins Everett A. Wilson answers the question what makes a Pentecostal?:

> What does become the recurrent theme, the motif of Pentecostalism is personal crisis. The use of tongues, as well as uninhibited emotional and physical displays, are best explained by disengagement from the prevailing rationality brought on by the need for existential confirmation (in Dempster, Klaus, and Petersen 1999:89).

Pentecostal experience begins when a seeker decides he or she wants to relinquish all his or her own claims and merits (1999:89).

APPENDIX E

THE GREAT COMMISSION MANIFESTO
SINGAPORE, JANUARY 1989

We, the 314 participants from 50 nations, gathered for the Global Consultation for World Evangelization by AD 2000 and Beyond, come from many different churches, denominations and ministries under the direction of the Holy Spirit for what we consider to be a singular moment in the history of the Church.

We identify ourselves as a gathering of Christians who by faith alone have accepted Jesus Christ, true God and true Man, revealed in the infallible and Holy Scriptures as our Lord and Savior. We are committed to biblical righteousness in our behavior and to growth in holiness.

We gratefully acknowledge the worldwide witness and ministry of faithful men and women throughout the previous 20 centuries.

We humbly confess our pride, prejudice, competition and disobedience that have hindered our generation from effectively working at the task of world evangelization. These sins have impeded God's desire to spread abroad His gracious provision of eternal salvation through the precious blood of His Son, Jesus Christ.

We turn from these sins and failures to express our belief that God has graciously opened to us a window of opportunity to completing the magnificent task He has given us. We boldly seize this crucial moment, more impressed with God's great power than any force arrayed against us.

Cooperation and Partnership

We have listened to each other and rejoice at what God is doing through many plans for world evangelization. We learned that there are over 2,000 separate plans relating to world evangelization.

We see afresh that cooperation and partnership are absolute necessities if the Great Commission is going to be fulfilled by the Year 2000. For the sake of those who are lost and eternally separated from God, we have dared to pray and dream of what

might happen if appropriate autonomy of churches and ministries could be balanced with significant partnership.

Empowerment

We acknowledge that the evangelization of the world can be carried out only in the power of the Holy Spirit. Listening and ready, we declare our dependence upon the Holy Spirit and commit to undergird all efforts for world evangelization with personal and corporate prayer. We recognize that human energy cannot replace divine activity, nor can spiritual success be measured in terms of human achievement. The effectiveness of our endeavors does not lie in human expertise but in the sovereign activity of the Holy Spirit.

Compassion

The Good News of Jesus Christ brings special meaning to suffering humanity. God's love brings hope to those who live under the bondage of sin, and who are victims of poverty and injustice. We believe that Christians involved in world evangelization should live among people as servants and minister to the needs of the whole person.

Towards Fulfillment

The revelation of God in Christ is plain. The commission to His Church is clear. The unfinished task is apparent. The opportunity to work together is ours.

We believe that it is possible to bring the Gospel to all people by the year 2000. This can be accomplished with sufficient dedication, unity, and mobilization of available resources, powered and directed by God.

To accomplish this objective, it will be necessary to:

1. Focus particularly on those who have not yet heard the Gospel.
2. Provide every people and population on earth with a valid opportunity to hear the Gospel in a language they can understand. It is our fervent prayer that at least half of humanity will profess allegiance to the Lord Jesus.
3. Establish a mission-minded church planting movement within every unreached people group so that the Gospel is accessible to all people.
4. Establish a Christian community of worship, instruction in the word, healing, fellowship, prayer, disciple making, evangelism, and missionary concern in every human community.

APPENDIX F

THE GREAT COMMISSION AS A METHODLOGICAL FRAMEWORK

Over the course of the history of the church, the framework that emerges with greatest frequency for determining the major paradigm for mission is the Great Commission. "In the course of time, the theme of obedience to the Great Commission indeed tended to drown all other motifs. This happened, for instance, at the famous Mt. Hermon student conference of 1886, which was to mark the beginning of the Student Volunteer Movement" (Bosch 1990:341).

In the Apostolic Age

The primary historian of the Apostolic Age was Luke, the physician. In his Luke-Acts writings, he includes the essentials of Christ's mission to the world and how the apostles carried out that mission, particularly the Apostle Paul whom he often accompanied on his journeys. Acts is the most reliable account available of the dynamic perspective of the missionary movement in the first age of the church. The primary framework Luke used for recording the mission of the Apostles was the Great Commission, as is evident in Acts 14:21–23:

> They preached the good news in that city and won a large number of disciples. Then they returned to Lystra, Iconium and Antioch, strengthening the disciples and encouraging them to remain true to the faith. "We must go through many hardships to enter the kingdom of God,"

> they said. Paul and Barnabas appointed elders for them in each church and, with prayer and fasting, committed them to the Lord, in whom they had put their trust.

The Pauline pattern of conducting the mission of God provides a framework for mission in the future generations eager to obey the Great Commission. The missional dimensions include the following: (1) going forth as an act of loving obedience; (2) prioritizing our focus on the people who have never heard of Christ; (3) offering forgiveness of sin and liberation from sin; (4) communicating the good news of God, and in baptizing, teaching, strengthening and encouraging the believers with the primary emphasis on making disciples. The task involved making disciples, nurturing disciples, organizing disciples, and entrusting disciples; (5) informing the believers that suffering would be expected for those of "the Way." As F. F. Bruce notes, "It is almost taken for granted throughout the New Testament that tribulation is the normal lot of Christians in this age" (1988:280); (6) leadership selection by prayer for local assemblies of believers; and, (7) establishing local churches in the localities where believers are found.

In seeking to convey how he views mission, Paul makes clear his apostolic ambition to advance God's mission in places where people had not yet heard of Christ. He associates this in the same cluster of thought in his letter to the Romans with the concept of saturating geographic regions with the gospel, and so he writes, "from Jerusalem all the way around to Illyricum, I have fully proclaimed the gospel of Christ" (Rom. 15:19-20).

In the Wake of the Enlightenment

The Great Commission texts became the dominant perspective by which Protestants viewed mission. Bosch attributed this approach for framing mission to conservative theology:

> The spirit of rationalism, secularism, humanism, and relativism increasingly invaded the church and began subtly to undermine the very idea of preaching a message of eternal salvation to people who would otherwise be doomed. This provoked conservative, and particularly premillennialist, circles to appeal, in an almost convulsive manner, to the "Great Commission". It became a kind of last line of defense, as if the protagonists of Mission in the Wake of the Enlightenment mission were saying, "How can you oppose mission to the heathen if Christ himself has commanded it?" (1997:340-341).

The theme of obedience to the Great Commission has tended to supercede other mission motifs, such as at the 1886 Mt. Hermon student conference, when William Ashmore concluded his challenge, "Show, if you can, why you should not obey the last command of Jesus Christ!" In the same year, A. T. Pierson began his most significant book on mission with the statement that Christ's command "makes all other motives comparatively unnecessary" (quoted in Bosch 1997:241).

"Pierson felt that the preaching of the Gospel to every creature was the initial stage of fulfilling the Great Commission" (Johnson 1988:8). Mott added twelve years later that Jesus' "final charges," reported in all the gospels and the Book of Acts, "define the first and most important part of our missionary obligation" (Mott 1900:3). At the same time he acknowledged that it did not express all that Jesus has given us to do. Bosch records the support of leading theologians Johannes Warneck and Abraham Kuyper from the European continent for the designation of the Great Commission as the framework for

mission (Bosch 1997:341). In doing so Bosch expresses some concerns with the way the Great Commission framework is used as a methodological approach for mission:

> First, it is almost always polemical, an attack on what is regarded as the watered-down understanding of mission in "ecumenical" circles. Second, it is usually couched in a most simplistic form of biblical literalism and proof-texting, with hardly any attempt at understanding the commission from within the context in which it appears in Scripture." Most important, it removes the church's involvement in mission from the domain of gospel to that of law (1997:341).

In his extensive exegesis of the Great Commission, Barth elaborated on the nature and significance of the Great Commission. He wrote: "As recapitulation and anticipation, revealing the hidden reality of the eschatological community, the Great Commission is truly the most genuine utterance of the risen Jesus" (1962:39). Barth saw Matthew 28 as the task of the Christian in the world. The church as a body will obey the command. "Let them share in its place and task in the world!" (1962:39).

Enthusiasm for the Great Commission text and conceptual framework for mission mounted greatly among evangelicals following World War II:

> In the period after World War II, when evangelicals became more confident of having a peculiar role to play in world missions, appeals of this nature were heard ever more frequently, as many sought to reinstate the Great Commission as a leading, or even as an entirely sufficient, justification for missions. There can be no doubt that this kind of appeal to the "Great Commission" has succeeded in mobilizing and bolstering evangelical missionary "forces" (Bosch 1997:341).

One of the alternative perspectives on the conceptual framework of the final mandates of Jesus was expressed by Johannes van den Berg when he observed that "the Great Commission is not the one and only motive, dominant in isolation," that "it never functioned as a separate stimulus," but "was always connected with other motives" (Bosch 1997:340). Some missiologists believe it takes the entire book of Matthew,

especially his Galilee missiology, and the whole of Chapter 28, which includes three commissions, to make full sense of Matthew's meaning of the Great Commission.

In conclusion, the conceptual framework of the Great Commission texts is one method for defining missional action by agencies, churches and movements. On the other hand, it can be over-used or even abused if it becomes the exclusive, dominant-in-isolation, and separate stimulus for mission.

APPENDIX G

DESCRIPTION OF THE AD2000 RESOURCE NETWORKS

Through functional networks, and within the general purpose of AD2000, there was a global multiplier effect in evidence. Each of the tracks, by design, stood as a semi-autonomous unit, with respective chairpersons and coordinators responsible for the organization, personnel, style, funding, and activities of their track. These specific track objectives were in support of the overall objectives of the Movement. The expected result thus reinforced the vision of the presentation of the gospel to every person in every nation and people group, and the establishment of an indigenous church planting movement in every country and people group by the year 2000. Annual meetings with track and task force leaders kept the loose structure from dissolving. Track leaders worked out among themselves the ways and means of helping each other, engaging in joint projects, eliminating unnecessary redundancy and synchronizing their activities. Each track sought ways to support and encourage other tracks.

The United Prayer Track, led by Peter Wagner, mobilized existing prayer networks worldwide to direct a significant part of their prayer ministries toward the unevangelized.

The Unreached Peoples Track, chaired by Patrick Johnstone, and coordinated by John Robb, sought to mobilize God's people to give priority to peoples without a viable Christian movement, through prayer, church planting and other ministries.

The Women's Track, chaired by Judy Mbugua, and coordinated by Lorry Lutz, recognized the roles women have had, and will increasingly have, in fulfilling the Great Commission, and encouraged women to be involved in reaching the unreached.

The Mobilizing of New Missionaries Track, led by George Verwer, challenged the Christian world to send out 200,000 new missionaries over the decade.

The Saturation Evangelism Track, coordinated by Paul Eshleman of the Jesus Project, and chaired by Victor Koh of New Life 2000, sought to identify, select and recruit coordinators for evangelism and small group leadership development for 5,000 separate geographic areas of one million people.

The Partnership Development Task Force, led by Phill Butler, and chaired by Mats Tunehag, sought to equip others to set up integrated approaches to reach the unreached.

Jim Montgomery, president of DAWN Ministries, coordinated the Saturation Church Planting Track until its culmination at GCOWE '95, sought to train national leaders to saturate their countries with churches.

The Cities Track functioned until GCOWE '95, then merged into a new track at GCOWE '97. Viv Grigg served as Cities Track coordinator. It sought to caste a vision and models to reach the least-evangelized cities, especially the urban poor. The new track that developed at GCOWE '97, Care for the Poor and Needy, was led by Brother Daniel, focusing on help for the huge material needs of those most in need of the gospel.

The Local Church Track, coordinated by John Richard, chaired by Roger Forster, networked pastors who embraced the AD2000 vision. They conducted a large

consultation of pastors at GCOWE ‘95 and produced a book titled *Churches That Obey,* with case studies of churches engaged in mission. This track did not continue beyond GCOWE ‘95.

The Radio Task Force, with World by 2000, coordinated the activities of the major international broadcasters to make the gospel available for at least one-half-hour per day in the largest 300 languages of the world, representing about 98% of the world’s population.

The Assessment Task Force, chaired first by Clark Scanlon then John Gilbert, both of the Southern Baptist Convention International Mission Board (IMB), and coordinated by Pete Holzmann, sought to assess the advance of the overall goal of AD2000. After GCOWE ‘95 it merged into Peoples Information Network (PIN) led by Ron Rowland. PIN sought to lay the foundation for an on-going system about peoples, their languages and habitats to provide the information and information tools on peoples around the world to serve the Body of Christ in the task of world evangelization, and to monitor the goal of a church for every people by the year 2000.

Avery Willis, Jr., led the Denominations Track following the AD2000 Denominational Leaders Summit, held in Colorado Springs in 1992. At the summit, leaders of most of the largest denominations expressed, in a declaration, commitment to work together for the evangelization of the world by the year 2000 and beyond, and urgently called on the worldwide Body of Christ to join openly in linking hands, hearts, minds and spirits in this grand cause of Jesus Christ. AT GCOWE ‘95, Paul Cedar led a meeting of the denominational track, which flowed into the consultation of 500

worldwide mission executives from both denominational and parachurch missions at GCOWE '97, led by George Verwer and Avery Willis, Jr.

In the first half of the decade, Dick Eastman, of Every Home for Christ, led the God's Word and Christian Literature Track with Wycliffe's John Bendor-Samuel. The track objective was to translate the Scriptures into all languages and provide the Church with the written Scriptures and gospel literature, which can be used in a systematic plan to evangelize a nation.

The AD2000 Interactive Task Force, led by Pete Holzmann, emerged to provide modern information and technology tools to serve the Body of Christ.

Born at GCOWE '97, the Business and Professional Network, chaired by Gunnar Olson and coordinated first by Juerg Opprecht, and later John Warton, sought to establish a worldwide network of businesses to serve the unreached peoples of the world.

The Worship and Arts Network, born after GCOWE '95, was chaired by Byron Spradlin and coordinated by Frank Fortunato. It aimed to inspire worship musicians and artists to join church planting efforts in order to help believers in emerging congregations to develop their own vernacular worship and artistic expressions.

Philip Steyne and David Kim led a Presidents and Academic Deans Network at GCOWE '97, calling upon college presidents and academic deans to put the vision of a church for every people and the gospel for every person at the heart of ministry training.

The Audio Communications Network also arose during the decade. Allan Starling led it with the intent of having an even greater impact than any one ministry could in bringing the gospel to every people in audio form.

Greg Livingstone, leading the Church Planting Among Muslims Task Force launched at GCOWE '97, sought to facilitate churches planting sister congregations among Muslim peoples where there were no culturally relevant, reproducing churches effectively making disciples among Muslims.

James Engel, with Jane Overstreet and Reuben Ezemadu, led the Strategy and Resource Development Task Force to help leaders find to build thoughtful, culturally appropriate, localized initiatives that would jointly address the need for eternal salvation and critical issues of social justice and economic development.

Mark and Betsy Neuenschwander established the Crisis Relief Task Force at "The Launch" to prepare and respond to crises around the world with a compassionate Christ-centered ministry.

The Training for Church Planting Movements, led by Bob Logan and Chris DeWitt, served at GCOWE '97 to teach methods that lead to multiplying growth of indigenous churches among unreached peoples.

The Strategic Mobilization Network, launched by Eric Watt in 1998, sought to facilitate breakthrough evangelistic opportunities, by providing a direct link for the prayers, talents and resources of the Body of Christ to respond to cutting edge opportunities in the 10/40 Window.

At GCOWE '95, the tracks met individually for two full days of consultation. Leadership from each track presented a report and challenge to the whole assembly

during the plenary sessions, reinforcing the functionality and diversity of the Movement. At GCOWE ‘97, new global networks and task forces emerged, while over the course of the decade, some networks did not continue.

APPENDIX H

INFORMATION DISSEMINATION AS A CATALYTIC ELEMENT

Phill Butler of Interdev, speaking at GCOWE '97, said that two strengths of AD2000 was that it "inspired and disseminated an unprecedented level of comprehensive information and data relevant to awareness and action on behalf of the fulfillment of the Great Commission, and, second, it provided an unprecedented global awareness of the need for national and people-groups specific strategies for evangelism in contrast to the traditional ad hoc approaches":

> This meant that by the end of 2000, there was a reported church planting team(s) in 1,084 of the peoples and evidence of a congregation of 100 members in 487. This, of course, does not include the possible 2,000 peoples of under 10,000 in population that remain inadequately researched and may be needing pioneer work! (Johnstone 2001:7).

Videos, CDs, Brochures

In support of many facets of the movement, the international office and the Resource Networks produced a number of informational and motivational products available to for constituent's use at cost. Several videos focused on key events, such as GCOWE '95, and the "Praying Through the Window" efforts. Some emphasized actions, such as on adopting an unreached people, taking a prayer journey. Others were primarily informational and inspirational, such as on women of calling, or particular unreached groups. Several iterations of CD ROMs were prepared for conferences and individual

distribution to transmit whole libraries of data, playable videos, books, as well as a computer program aiding groups in adopting an unreached group, at minimal cost. Brochures focused on key concepts and regions. Examples of these were the 10/40 Window, the Unfinished Task, and the Horn of Africa. These resources served to bring the vision of the movement to those who did not attend the gatherings, and provided next step information and motivation for those already involved.

Prayer Profiles

In 1995, Bethany World Prayer Center, a church in Baton Rouge, Louisiana, accepted the challenge of producing prayer profiles from the Joshua Project list of the unreached. These small booklets, containing basic information and prayer requests about specific unreached people, were used in local churches and cell groups to pray for these peoples widely throughout the world. Each profile contained a photo, map, and information about the lifestyles, customs, and beliefs of the people. It listed spiritual strongholds and addressed specific prayer needs. The prayer profiles were distributed globally through a global network of cell-group churches.

The Peoples List

One primary piece of information, which developed over the years, was an integrated listing of the peoples of the world. A first draft was created for GCOWE ‘95. It was a rough list, compiling every known least evangelized ethno-linguistic people within every country of the world. It was only a beginning. It contained all the known peoples (about 4,800) that were either deemed to be most needing a church planting movement in

their midst, had insufficient access to the gospel, were less than two percent Christian, or were identified as unreached peoples for prayer and mission.

The list proceeded from a climate of unique spiritual developments. It originated first in prayer and a conviction of the mandate. This catalytic moment occurred on November 28, 1994, when a group of researchers and users, representing various mission initiatives associated with AD2000, prayed, verse by verse together, through John 17, Christ's high priestly prayer for his followers—both the original disciples and those who would take up the task in subsequent generations. The Spirit of unity empowered by this spiritual exercise was necessary in order to bring together varying points of view and would coincide perfectly with none of them. It was affirmed that the approximate global boundaries of understandable language or language acceptance would need to reflect the barriers to language understanding, as represented by each country's ethno-linguistic peoples. The list originated in a spirit of genuine appreciation and thanks for the contributions of many ministries[1] to unreached peoples research and mobilization.

Joshua Project 2000 Selected Peoples List

In support of *Joshua Project 2000* a selected list of unreached peoples was released in December 1995. The selection of the *Joshua Project* peoples required that

[1] The US Center for World Mission for promoting the vision that unreached peoples must be a primary concern for the Christian community worldwide; Wycliffe Bible Translators and the Summer Institute of Linguistics for producing the Ethnologue and, more recently, the Registry of Peoples and Languages (ROPAL), as the best available listing of ethno-linguistic peoples; The Foreign Mission Board of the Southern Baptist Convention for their ongoing research into the peoples of the world and their analysis of both access and response to the gospel; the book, Operation World, with its accompanying research in identifying the less-reached peoples, and the Adopt-A-People Clearinghouse and the Peoples Information Network (PIN) for surveying mission agencies, national leaders, and research centers

they were country-distinct peoples, each over 10,000 in population that were chosen, by their ethno-linguistic distinction and their status of being less than two percent evangelical and less than five percent Christian adherents.

The list would be of value if readers actively participated in updating, correcting, and joining in on the effort to make it an effective tool. As they did, it became of value for country and regional strategy and planning. It became of value for mobilizing the worldwide church for prayer and for mission involvement. It was published on paper, electronic disk, and web form:

> The *Joshua Project I* was launched in 1995 to facilitate strategic planning, coordinated research and cooperative church planting during the remaining years of the 20th Century. The list of 12,000 peoples was broken down as follows (Johnstone 2001:6).

TABLE 10

***JOSHUA PROJECT 2000* BREAKDOWN OF 12,000 PEOPLES**
(Johnstone 2001:6)

People Category	Number in Category	Approximate Population	% of World's Population
Above 10,000 pop. and more than 2% evangelical or more than 5% adherents to Christianity	6,000	3,620 million	60.3
Above 10,000 pop. and less than 2% evangelical and less than 5% adherents (this constitutes the Joshua Project List)	1,600	2,350 million	39.2
Below 10,000 population (many being migrant or cross-border minorities)	> 4,400	30 million	0.5
World Totals	12,000	6,000 million	100.0

throughout the world, in order to develop a field perspective on the identity and status of the world's peoples.

As observed in Table 10, the Joshua Project 2000 larger unreached peoples represents 39.2 percent of the world's population, while the total population of the remaining unreached people groups represents .50 percent of the world's population. By inference, a church planting movement for every Joshua Project 2000 people would mean a church planting movement among 99.5 percent of the world's population.

The Most Widely Agreed-Upon List of Unreached Peoples

After two years of global dissemination and subsequent improvement, an updated list was prepared for GCOWE '97. The process involved networking, which continually revealed the list's deficiencies, as well as the need to refine classifications and terminology. Johnstone said of the list:

1. It gives the most widely discussed and agreed-upon list of significant unreached peoples ever published.

2. It shows the list of 1,739 peoples of over 10,000 population among whom there is an inadequate or non-existent church planting movement, and where the Great Commission to make disciples of all peoples has yet to be fulfilled.

3. It lists the Joshua Project peoples by country of residence, name, People Cluster and Affinity Bloc. This enables more effective national and global planning for cooperative efforts to plant mature, witnessing churches among them.

4. It provides, for the first time, fairly full information on the extent of adoption of peoples and present or planned Christian ministries among them.

5. It provides a mechanism for assessing progress towards the goal of a church for every people by the year 2000 so that we may be accountable to the millions of Christians who are contributing in some way to these goals (Scribner 1997:v).

By November 1999, almost 4,000 editorial changes had been made to the list, which now compiled more than 50,000 work-among records from agencies and churches in over 110 countries of the world, recording the church planting efforts among the Joshua Project 2000 peoples. The information on this list enabled the careful monitoring of the procedural goal of a church for every people.

Exposing Leaders to Pertinent Information

The statistics of need for the gospel among particular people groups presented to mission leaders whose mandate it was to spread the gospel was catalytic. Bringing the two strategies together, preparing information about the unreached and inviting leaders to international conferences to consider it together, was a dynamic combination. Tokunboh Adeyemo, General Secretary of the Association of Evangelicals in Africa (AEA), GCOWE '95 delegate, and chairman of WEF, said in an interview at GCOWE '97:

> It is summed up in one word: *Accountability*. No matter the reason, impulse or agenda that brought you here; when you return home, you will be more accountable to God than ever before in your lives. I cannot reconcile for the life of me the type of growth we're hearing about on the one hand and the GCOWE statistics revealing to us all the unreached peoples. Africa still has one-third of the world's unreached people groups. Out of the 1739 unreached people groups, nearly 590 are still in Africa. This is staggering! My response has been to doubt. But I'm assured these figures and facts are not a lie. They have also given us the geographical location of these groups. We can literally and precisely locate them. We know who they are and where they are. How can we think we have any excuse for not reaching them? (D. Wood 1997).

In fact, national leaders were often shocked to learn of blatant need for the gospel within their own borders, but outside their normal sphere. This exposure to information often catalyzed action. For example, the delegates at the African National Initiatives

Consultation (ANI) Consultation meeting at GCOWE '97 in Pretoria were presented with such a list of unreached people groups in their own countries. Speaking on behalf of the Kenyan delegation, made up of more than eighty leaders, Stephen Kabachia said, "When the Kenya delegation was confronted by lists of unreached peoples in Kenya, they determined that never again would a Kenyan delegation attend a global consultation to be embarrassed by such lists."

They produced a vision to build on the momentum of these consultations and hold five to six key regional and national consultations throughout Africa by the end of 1998. They called their plan "Finish the Task 2000." As a result of this plan, a nationwide consultation with five hundred leaders was held, all the unreached peoples identified were adopted by denominations, churches and seminaries, and prayer efforts and pioneer church planting efforts were initiated.

At what was to be the final global meeting of AD2000, GCOWE '97 in Pretoria, mission executives were presented a list of 579 untargeted Joshua Project 2000 peoples which had no known church planting team in place and no mission agency targeting these peoples for outreach. The agencies present subsequently selected 390 of these peoples for future work leaving 189 peoples still untargeted. Ongoing Joshua Project research during 1998-99 brought further refinement to this list with a number of peoples being added.

Final Commitments of Joshua Project 2000 Peoples

At another world meeting of mission leaders in July 2000, in Amsterdam, AD2000 presented a revised list of 253 untargeted peoples. This time, in a moment that

was described as electric, Bruce Wilkinson of "Walk Through the Bible" responded with an impassioned challenge to all organizations present to take responsibility for reaching these remaining large unreached peoples. The organizational leaders assembled made the final commitments that assured that all Joshua Project peoples were targeted for outreach. These two gatherings were key instances where comprehensive "work among" data for unreached peoples had been presented to a global gathering of mission agency leaders. The result was the significant catalytic effect of enabling mission leaders to coordinate and cooperate in their mission efforts more effectively and to enable limited gospel resources to be distributed to those peoples with the least access.

APPENDIX I

DENOMINATIONAL SUMMIT DECLARATION

INTRODUCTION:

The AD2000 Denominational Summit Declaration signed by representatives of 22 denominations and associations in 1993 stated:

Now, being of one mind in our commitment to work together for the evangelization of the world by the 2000 and beyond, we, as individuals from various denominations, declare our joint commitment to seek a church for every people and the gospel for every person by the year 2000. We urgently call the worldwide Body of Christ to join openly in linking hands, hearts, minds and spirits in this grand cause of Jesus Christ. Therefore we declare, that, upon returning to our respective organizations we will encourage others within our denominations and associations to consider the following actions:

1. To magnify the focus on the people who do not have access to the gospel, the majority of whom live in the area known as the 10/40 Window, without neglecting the mandate for the whole world.
2. To call our people to pray, recognizing prayer as the central strategy that is crucial to this endeavor; to encourage our churches to participate in prayer initiatives Praying Through the Window, and the March for Jesus.
3. To encourage our churches to participate in the national strategy initiatives that incorporate the various AD2000 networks where they exist, and encourage the development of national strategy initiatives where they do not exist.
4. To seek ways to accelerate the mission thrust of our respective denominations in our work around the world and the recruitment of new missionaries to the unreached.
5. To pursue ways to communicate with and support one another in our common task.
6. To utilize the various networks and task forces of the AD2000 Movement, where appropriate. As fellow servants of Christ we seek to join with other Christian communities around the world in accomplishing these goals. We make these commitments for the greater glory of Christ our Savior, and the extension of His Kingdom to the millions who have not yet heard.

PURPOSE:

- The purpose of the ***Denominational and Missions Leaders Network*** of the AD2000 and Beyond Movement is to encourage, motivate and network denominational and church leaders by inspiring them with the vision of reaching the unreached by AD 2000 through consultations, prayer efforts and communication materials.
- In addition, the ***Denominations and Missions Leaders Network*** will seek to assist missionary sending agencies as they attempt to fulfill the Great Commission of evangelizing the unreached and developing churches among them.

GOALS:

- Call together all churches, associations, and denominations in the country for consultation in how to make a concerted effort to accomplish the task by AD2000.
- Pray together for the Lord to reveal himself and his strategy for reaching the unreached.
- Cooperate with all entities to create synergy and creative approaches for the entire effort.
- Make available all research and research capabilities to the combined consortium.
- Provide volunteers and funds for human needs projects needed to reach the unreached.
- Provide credibility, continuity and stability to the movement in the country.
- Send missionaries to other people groups outside the country.
- Lead out in evaluating progress or lack thereof in reaching common goals.

ENDORSING THE DENOMINATIONAL SUMMIT DECLARATION

Rev. Dr.	Michael Green Advisor to the Archbishop	Anglican Church of Canterbury
Rev.	Geremias Bolanos Executive Secretary	Assemblies of God, Brazil
Mr.	Bob Fulton International Coordinator	Assoc. of Vineyard Churches
Mr.	Fred E. Wright Southwest Coordinator	Assoc. of Vineyard Churches
Rev.	Peter Nanfelt Vice President, International	Christian and Missionary Alliance
Rev.	David L. Rambo President	Christian and Missionary Alliance
Dr.	Grant McClung World Missions Research Coordinator	Church of God
Dr.	Roland Vaughan World Missions Director	Church of God
Dr.	Lamar Vest General Overseer	Church of God
Bishop	Adrian Varlack Secretary	Church of God of Prophecy
Dr.	Eugene Stowe Gen. Supervisor, Emeritus	Church of the Nazarene
Dr.	Robert Scott Division Director	Church of the Nazarene
Dr.	Hans Finzel President	Conservative Baptist Foreign Miss. Soc.
Rev.	Panya Baba General Director	Evangelical Church of West Africa

Dr.	Paul Larsen President	Evangelical Covenant Church
Dr.	Paul Cedar President	Evangelical Free Church of America
Rev.	Jim Forstrum Associate Director	Evangelical Free Church of America
Rev.	Lewis Myers Vice President	Foreign Mission Society, SBC
Dr.	Clark Scanlon Research and Planning Director	Foreign Mission Society, SBC
Dr.	Avery Willis Senior Vice President	Foreign Mission Society, SBC
Dr.	John Amstutz Asst. to Director	FourSquare Missions International
Dr.	Donald McGregor Director	FourSquare Missions International
Rev.	Janice Wheeler	FourSquare Missions International
Rev.	Ray Wheeler	FourSquare Missions International
Dr.	M. Doane Bonney General Director	Free Methodist World Missions
Rev.	Bob Fetterhoff Moderator	Grace Brethren Church
Rev.	Tom Julien Foreign Missions Executive Director	Grace Brethren Church
Rev.	Kurt Miller Home Missions Director	Grace Brethren Church
Rev.	Edward Trenner Consultant	Grace Brethren Church

Rev.	John Kyle Executive Director	Missions to the World
Rev.	Harold Dalton World Missions, Asst. Director	Pentecostal Holiness
Rev.	K. Eric Perrin Interchurch Relations Committee. Chair	Presbyterian Church of America
Dr.	Clifton Kirkpatrick Associate Director	Presbyterian Church of God, USA
Rev.	Jefferson Ritchie	Presbyterian Church of God, USA
Mr.	Lee DeYoung	Reformed Church in America
Rev.	Richard Van der Voet Mission Services Director	Reformed Church in America
Dr.	Ernest Mosley Executive Vice President	Southern Baptist Convention
Dr.	Donald Bray General Director	Wesleyan World Missions
Mr.	H.C. Wilson Strategic Planning Director	Wesleyan World Missions

APPENDIX J

QUANTITATIVE INQUIRY SURVEY

	Question I. 1-16. What are the major external challenges facing the Church regarding evangelization in our city or country?	Very Important 1	2	3	4	Not Important 5
1	Globalization—the internationalizing of our shrinking world due to rapid communication toward a common Western culture					
2	Racial tension					
3	Pluralism—the coexistence within the one political community of groups who hold incompatible views regarding religion					
4	Illiteracy					
5	Post-modernity—exhaustion of modernity. It celebrates diversity, fragmentation, ambivalence					
6	Religious fundamentalism					
7	Persecution/political opposition/injustice					
8	Technological advances					
9	Unreached linguistic and ethno-cultural peoples					
10	Unreached geographic areas					
11	Unreached social groupings—such as the youth					
12	AIDS and other major diseases					
13	Materialism/distraction					
14	Relevance of the Christian faith					
15	Food and water					
16	Other. Please specify_____					

Question II. 17-30. What are the major obstacles to world evangelization internal to the Church?		A Big Problem 1	2	3	4	Not a problem 5
17	Lack of money					
18	Lack of effective leadership					
19	Lack of vision and understanding (i.e. burden)					
20	Lack of workers					
21	Lack of training of workers					
22	Lack of appreciation by outsiders of contextualized local distinctives					
23	Opposition from inside the church					
24	Family issues					
25	Lack of united prayer					
26	Lack of good research and information on the remaining task					
27	Lack of effective cooperation and coordinated action between mission agencies					
28	No common goals or strategies for world evangelization					
29	Unhealthy churches that are not able to reproduce themselves					
30	Other. Please specify_____					

Question III. 31-40. What do you believe God is calling His people to do in world evangelization over the next 25 years?		Very much 1	2	3	4	Not at all 5
31	Preach the gospel to every person using personal evangelism					
32	Make the Scriptures and gospel message available in every language for both literate and non-reading by radio, TV, the Jesus Film, Bible translation and distribution and by CD					

33	Do you believe God is calling you to set goals for your ministry?					
34	Seek social transformation—seeking positive change in the whole of human life materially, socially and spiritually, by recovering our true identity as human beings created in the image of God and discovering our true vocation as productive stewards, faithfully caring for our world and people.					
35	For the church to be a prophetic voice to the city					
36	Establish an indigenous church planting movement within every people group on earth					
37	Reach unreached social groups such as the youth					
38	Ethnic reconciliation					
39	Develop regional and global mission-field partnerships for mission agency cooperation and coordination					
40	Get the church involved in: a. developing a primary health care network b. improving the health of communities c. teaching adults, and especially women, to read and write d. establishing primary schools for those who have no schools e. developing vocational training programs to give skills to young people and the unemployed					

Question IV. 41-51. What would be a suitable phrase (watchword) to capture the essence of world evangelization to serve as a unifying paradigm for the next 25 years?		Very suitable 1	2	3	4	Not suitable 5
41	The whole church taking the whole gospel to the whole world					
42	Fill the world with the glory of God/ God's glory for all					
43	The power, the presence and the peace of God for all					
44	City-reaching					

45	Social transformation/ transforming our world					
46	Turning the world right side up/ changing our world					
47	Christ's kingdom come					
48	The church for every people					
49	The evangelization of the world in this generation					
50	Discipling the nations					
51	Should the watchword have the time frame of 2025?					

Question V. #52-62. How important are the following for Global Evangelical Structures to provide to local believers to enhance world evangelization efforts?		Very much 1	2	3	4	Not much 5
52	Inspiration and prayer networks					
53	National enablement					
54	Leadership development					
55	Pertinent information for world evangelization					
56	Resource networks linking to resource geographical and/ or functional world evangelization initiatives					
57	Functional networks linking by ministry-type					
58	Reports of what is happening in other cities/countries					
59	Relationship building with other leaders/Fellowship networking opportunities					
60	Place and opportunity for missiological reflection					
61	Geographical networking opportunities					
62	Place for publications on missiological issues					

Question VI. #63. Which man and woman best fits the following criteria in your city?

- Evidences Christ-likeness in character
- Healthy family relationships in the Christian family
- Embodies the Spirit of Lausanne ("new and urgent commitment to world evangelization in all its aspects, a new attitude of cooperation in that task, and a new cultural sensitivity to the world to which we were called" with integrity)[1]
- Believes in and is committed to the Lausanne Covenant
- Between thirty and forty-five years old at July 30, 2004
- Integrity—basic honesty and a sound character, necessary for credibility with followers
- Spiritual authority—that anointing of God, which comes through gifted power, deep shaping experiences with God, and a godly character
- Flexibility—adjusts to meet new opportunities
- Learning Posture—overcomes the tendency to plateau. Daniel set an example as we find him still studying the Bible in his old age: Daniel 9
- Demonstrates personal vibrant relationship with God and others
- The whole Body—while keeping doctrinal distinctives embraces the entire body of Christ in word and deed
- Scope of influence—recognized by those of different groups within the city/country as a Christian leader who has exercised positive, persistent, specific influence for Christ within that city/nation/region

Name of Man: _____ Name of Woman: _____

Question VII. 64-80. What is your contact information?

64. Family name _____

65. Given name _____

66. Title _____

67. Organization _____

68. Address _____

69. City _____

70. State/Province _____

71. Zip/Postal Code _____

72. Country _____

[1] Lausanne '74 opening address by Billy Graham.

73. Phone _____

74. Fax _____

75. E-mail _____

76. Gender: (1) Male _____ (2) Female _____

77. Age: (1) Below 25 ____ (2) 25 – 35 ____ (3) 36 – 50 ____
(4) 51 – 65____ (5) Above 65 ____

78. How would identify yourself with regard to your ministry?
(1) Pastor ____ (2) Mission leader ____ (3) Bible School or Seminary leader____
(4) Teacher____ (5) Lay leader ____ (6) Youth leader____ (7) Worship leader ____
(8) Prayer Leader/Intercessor

79. Would you like to be informed on the results of the global survey?
(1) Yes ____ (2) No ____

80. Would you like to be associated with a global evangelization movement?
(1) Yes ____ (2) No ____ (3) Maybe ____

APPENDIX K

EVANGELIZING OUR WORLD
QUALITATIVE INQUIRY FOR FOCUS GROUPS

Question I. What is God doing now regarding evangelization?

1a. What is the most important thing you see God doing in your country? (Describe the prayer efforts, programs, activity or vision that God seems to be blessing in your country).

1b. Who is God using in an unusual way in your city and country?

Question II. 2-18. 1-16 What are the major external challenges facing the Church regarding evangelization in our city or country?

		Select 3 & rank from 1=highest
2	Globalization—the internationalizing of our shrinking world due to rapid communication toward a common Western culture	
3	Racial tension	
4	Pluralism—the coexistence within the one political community of groups who hold incompatible views regarding religion	
5	Illiteracy	
6	Post-modernity—exhaustion of modernity. It celebrates diversity, fragmentation, ambivalence	
7	Religious fundamentalism	

8	Persecution/political opposition/injustice	
9	Technological advances	
10	Unreached linguistic and ethno-cultural peoples	
11	Unreached geographic areas	
12	Unreached social groupings—such as the youth	
13	AIDS and other major diseases	
14	Materialism/distraction	
15	Relevance of the Christian faith	
16	Food and water	
17	Other. Please specify	

18. What makes the item identified by the focus group the major challenge facing the Church?

Question III. 19-21 How do you define world evangelization and the unfinished task? (After discussion see some definitions at the conclusion of this Inquiry).

19. World evangelization is:

20. The unfinished task is:

21. An effective strategy to fulfill the unfinished task includes the following:

Question IV. 22-36 What are the major obstacles to world evangelization internal to the Church?

		Select 3 & rank from 1=highest
22	Lack of money	
23	Lack of effective leadership	
24	Lack of vision	
25	Lack of workers	
26	Lack of training of workers	
27	Lack of appreciation by outsiders of contextualized local distinctives	
28	Opposition from inside the church	
29	Family issues	
30	Lack of united prayer	
31	Lack of good research and information on the remaining task	
32	Lack of effective cooperation and coordinated action between mission agencies	
33	No common goals or strategies for world evangelization	
34	Unhealthy churches that are not able to reproduce themselves	
35	Other. Please specify_____	

36. What are the implications of the item identified by the focus group as the major obstacle with regard to world evangelization?

Question V. 37-47 What do you believe God is calling His people to do in world evangelization over the next 25 years?

		Select 3 & rank from 1=highest
37	Preach the gospel to every person using personal evangelism	
38	Make the Scriptures and gospel message available in every language for both literate and non-reading by radio, TV, the Jesus Film, Bible translation and distribution and by CD	
39	Do you believe God is calling you to set goals for your ministry?	
40	Seek social transformation—seeking positive change in the whole of human life materially, socially and spiritually, by recovering our true identity as human beings created in the image of God and discovering our true vocation as productive stewards, faithfully caring for our world and people.	
41	For the church to be a prophetic voice to the city	
42	Establish an indigenous church planting movement within every people group on earth	
43	Reach unreached social groups such as the youth	
44	Ethnic reconciliation	
45	Develop regional and global mission-field partnerships for mission agency cooperation and coordination	
46	Get the church involved in: a. developing a primary health care network b. improving the health of communities c. teaching adults, and especially women, to read and write d. establishing primary schools for those who have no schools e. developing vocational training programs to give skills to young people and unemployed	

47. What is the significance of the choice of the focus group with regard to world evangelization?

Question VI. 48-59 What would be a suitable phrase (watchword) to capture the essence of world evangelization to serve as a unifying paradigm for the next 25 years?

		Select 3 & rank from 1=highest
48	The whole church taking the whole gospel to the whole world	
49	Fill the world with the glory of God/ God's glory for all	
50	The power, the presence and the peace of God for all	
51	City-reaching	
52	Social transformation/ transforming our world	
53	Turning the world right side up/ changing our world	
54	Christ's kingdom come	
55	The church for every people	
56	The evangelization of the world in this generation	
57	Discipling the nations	
58	Should the watchword have the time frame of 2025?	

59. What are the implications of selecting the item in relation to world evangelization?

Question VII. 60-72 How important are the following for Global Evangelical Structures provide to local believers to enhance world evangelization efforts?

		Select 3 & rank from 1=highest
60	Inspiration and prayer networks	
61	National enablement	
62	Leadership development	
63	Pertinent information for world evangelization	
64	Resource networks linking to resource geographical and/ or functional world evangelization initiatives	
65	Functional networks linking by ministry-type	
66	Reports of what is happening in other cities/countries	

67	Relationship building with other leaders/fellowship networking opportunities	
68	Place and opportunity for missiological reflection	
69	Geographical networking opportunities	
70	Place for publications on missiological issues	
71	Other. Please specify_____	

72. What is the significance of the choice of the focus group with regard to world evangelization?

VI 73. Which man and woman best fits the following criteria in your city?

- Evidences Christ-likeness in character
- Healthy family relationships in the Christian family
- Embodies the Spirit of Lausanne ("new and urgent commitment to world evangelization in all its aspects, a new attitude of cooperation in that task, and a new cultural sensitivity to the world to which we were called" with integrity)[1]
- Believes in and is committed to the Lausanne Covenant
- Between thirty and forty-five years old at July 30, 2004
- Integrity - basic honesty and a sound character, necessary for credibility with followers
- Spiritual authority - that anointing of God, which comes through gifted power, deep shaping experiences with God, and a godly character
- Flexibility - adjusts to meet new opportunities
- Learning Posture - overcomes the tendency to plateau. Daniel set an example as we find him still studying the Bible in his old age: Daniel 9
- Demonstrates personal vibrant relationship with God and others
- The whole Body – while keeping doctrinal distinctives embraces the entire body of Christ in word and deed
- Scope of influence - recognized by those of different groups within the city/country as a Christian leader who has exercised positive, persistent, specific influence for Christ within that city/nation/region

Name of Man: _____

Name of Woman: _____

[1] Lausanne '74 opening address by Billy Graham.

VII. 74-93 What is your contact information?

74. Focus Group Facilitator family name _____
75. Focus Group Facilitator first name _____
76. Title _____
77. Organization _____
78. Address _____
79. City _____
80. State/Province _____
81. Zip/Postal Code _____
82. Country _____
83. Phone _____
84. Fax _____
85. E-mail _____
86. Gender: (1) Male ____ (2) Female ____
87. Your age: (1) Below 25 ____ (2) 25 – 35 ____ (3) 36 – 50 ____
    (4) 51 – 65 ____ Above 65 ____
88. How would identify yourself with regard to your ministry?
    (1) Pastor ____ (2) Mission leader ____ (3) Bible School or Seminary leader ____
    (4) Teacher____ (5) Lay leader ____ (6) Youth leader____ (7) Worship leader ____
89. Would you like to be informed on the results of the global survey?
    (1) Yes ____ (2) No ____
90. Would you like to be associated with a global evangelization movement?
    (1) Yes ____ (2) No ____ (3) Maybe ____
91. What city is focus group taking place in: _____
92. What people/place is the group focusing on: _____
93. What is the date of the focus group meeting: _____

Some Working Definitions

World evangelization for Question III after some time of initially working the question. [The following definition was endorsed at the Consultation on the Relationship between Evangelism and Social Responsibility co-sponsored by the LCWE and WEF in 1982].
To evangelize is to spread the good news that Jesus Christ died for our sins and was raised from the dead according to the Scriptures and that as the reigning Lord he now offers the forgiveness of sins and the liberating gift of the Spirit to all who repent and believe. Our Christian presence in the world is indispensable to evangelism and so is that kind of dialogue whose purpose is to listen sensitively in order to understand. But evangelism itself is the proclamation of the historical biblical Christ as Savior and Lord with a view of persuading people to come to him personally and so be reconciled to God. In issuing the gospel invitation we have no liberty to conceal the cost of discipleship. Jesus still calls all who would follow him to deny themselves, take up their cross and identify themselves with his new community. The results of evangelism include obedience to Christ, incorporation into his Church and responsible service in the world. 1 Co. 15:3,4; Acts 2:32-39; John 20:21; 1 Co. 1:23; 2 Co. 4:5; 5:11, 20; Luke 14:25-33; Mark 8:34; Acts 2:40, 47; Mark 10:43-45—Lausanne Covenant, Para. 4. "World evangelization requires the whole church to take the whole Gospel to the whole world" (Lausanne Covenant, Para. 6).

The Meaning of the Unfinished Task [The following list of principles were presented at the Amsterdam 2000 Conference]:

1. The unfinished task involves offering man forgiveness of sin and liberation from sin.
2. Seeking to fulfill the unfinished task involves going forth as an act of loving obedience, a "being sent" by the risen Lord. It demands complete submission to Jesus Christ, constant fellowship with Him, constant devotion to Him, and service to Him.
3. The unfinished task majors in effective communication of the good news of God and in baptizing, teaching, and discipling the believers with the primary emphasis on making disciples.
4. A primary mechanism in fulfilling the unfinished task is the conversion of households, called "ecclesias".
5. The unfinished task involves the conscious entry into the territory of Satan in order to liberate people from satanic power and tyranny. It aims at opening the eyes of the nations and turning them from darkness to light and from the power of Satan to God.
6. The unfinished task can be done effectively only in "His name" and in the power of the Holy Spirit.

7. "The unfinished task" will continue until we have "preached the Gospel of the Kingdom in the whole world as a witness to all nations [people groups]" and there are true believers in Jesus Christ "from every nation, tribe, people and language"(Matt. 24:14 and Rev. 7:9). This calls each new generation to a sense of urgency to "speed up the coming of that day" (2 Pe. 3:12).
8. The unfinished task involves the evangelistic and social mandates of our Lord.
9. The essential unfinished task is to establish a healthy, reproducible, indigenous, church planting movement among every ethno-cultural and ethno-linguistic people (ethne) in every place.
10. The finished task can be summarized as Jesus Christ, incarnate in His Body, the Church, in very segment of humanity, showing forth His love, compassion, truth and power. The Body, being sensitive and insightful into the many social, cultural, linguistic, ethnic, economic distinctives and differences within the populace, would be continually permeating all elements of society both with the Word (light), but also with care, compassion and righteousness (salt).

A Strategic Overview of the Unfinished Task [The following list of principles were presented at the Amsterdam 2000 Conference] The following ten elements are necessary for an effective strategy to fulfill the unfinished task remaining to us at the beginning of the 21st century:

1. The establishing of a clearly defined goal that, if highly embraced by the Body of Christ, would propel us forward towards completion of the unfinished task.
2. The preparation of a realistic timetable to pursue achievement of the goal.
3. An information service and system that will enable both national and global servants of God to be "on the same page." The Harvest Information System (HIS) is developing into the backbone of just that kind of service and system.
4. The discovery and release of all possible resources linking to emerging opportunities, in an atmosphere of trust.
5. The mobilization of global intercessory fervent, focused prayer.
6. The designing of an appropriate training program of all mobilized personnel to assure the unity, effectiveness, and coordination of the work towards accomplishing the goal.
7. The adoption of the most effective methods in each contextual setting.
8. The recognition of an existing or establishment of a new motivational structure in keeping with the dynamic function of the Holy Spirit to carry through the program and consummate the goals.
9. The involvement of existing or establishment of new intentional, international, integrative functional and resource networks and task forces, plus field-specific and resource-specific partnerships.
10. The gracious operation of the Holy Spirit in all organizations and personnel involved and in all methods and means employed.

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INDEX

10/40 Window, 138-140, 160, 176-178, 180, 185, 187-188, 262, 265, 272
208th General Assembly, 137

Aburdene, Patricia, 131
AD2000 and Beyond Movement (AD2000), 1, 3, 8, 11-12, 59-60, 63, 89, 91, 100-101, 124, 128-130, 132-138, 140-153, 156-158, 160, 163-173, 175-177, 179, 181-188, 190, 218-219, 221, 258-261, 264, 266, 270, 272-273
AD2000 Children's Prayer Network, 160
Addis Ababa, Ethiopia, 84
African
  Independent Churches, 46
  Indigenous Churches, 46
  Initiated Churches, 46
  national initiatives, 90
African Initiated Churches and European Typologies, 46
All Saints Church, 52
Alma Ata Declaration 1978, 130
amazing epoch, 48
American Society of Missiology, 118
Amsterdam 2000, 8, 197, 199, 290-291
An Appeal to Disciples Everywhere, 55
Anderson, Allan H., 46, 250
Anderson, Gerald H., 230
Archer, Gleason L., 22, 24
Ariga, Paul, 162
Arthur, Appianda, 18, 185
Assemblies of God, 249, 274
attacks the kingdom of darkness, 38
Awakening
  First Great, 40, 56
  Second Great, 54, 56
  Third Great, 40
awakening(s), 18, 33- 34, 36, 40, 48, 54, 56, 60, 226, 245
Azusa Street, 55

Balmer, Randall, 41
barbarian invasions, 51
Barrett, David B., 57, 185
Barth, Karl, 233, 256
Bassham, Roger C., 105, 110-116, 247
Bauer, Walter F., 23
Bavinck, Johan H., 15, 17, 219-220
Beals, Paul A., 201
Bebbington, D. W., 248
behavior, 39
Bengali Christians, 179
Berkhof, Hendrikus, 233
Berlin '66, 83, 89-90, 96, 106-107, 116-117, 122
Berman, Marshall, 17
Bethany Prayer Fellowship, 175
Bevans, Stephen B., 5, 27, 103, 110, 118, 242
Beyerhaus, Peter, 28-29
biblical
  clarity, 97
  foundation, 27, 228, 242
Bills, Barbara, 155
Billy Graham Association (BGA), 8
Blumhofer, Edith L., 41
Boff, Leonardo, 230
Bonhoeffer, Dietrich, 243
Bonk, Jonathan J., 194
Bosch, David J., 16-18, 27, 47, 54, 94, 108, 117, 120, 228-230, 242-243, 253, 255-256
Braaten, Carl, 230
bridge building, 76
Brigada Today, 188, 198
Briggs, Samuel L., 23
Bright, Bill, 161, 164, 177
Bruce, A. B., 170-171
Bruce, F. F., 254
Buddhism, 139
budget-driven, 10, 200
Bush, Luis K., 100-101, 129, 134, 136-137, 139-140, 145, 165-167, 171, 174-175, 177-178, 185, 197, 199
Butler, Philip, 124, 145, 154, 187, 259, 264

Cairns, Earle E., 54, 73
Cakchiquel, 59
Calcutta, India, 178

Calling the Whole Church to Take the Whole Gospel to the Whole World, 89
Calvin, John, 52
Cambridge University, 92, 123
Campus Crusade for Christ (CCC), 164
Carey Inquiry, 201
Carey, William, 26, 54, 201
catalytic, 1-2, 8, 13, 15, 33, 60, 67, 99-100, 121, 126, 128, 137, 146, 149, 155-156, 159, 164, 172-173, 180, 184, 188, 190, 196, 209, 218-219, 221, 241, 266, 269, 271
  aim of mission, 2
  impetus, 1-3, 8, 13, 33, 67, 155, 221, 241
  leaders, 3
  means, 3, 33, 128, 173, 190, 218
  structures, 3, 190, 218
catalyzed, 1, 58, 66, 176, 192, 269
Celtic, 50
Charlemagne, 82
China Inland Mission, 54
Chinese Congress on World Evangelization (CCOWE), 100
Christian Information Network, 177
Christianity Today, 86, 89, 176, 180
Church Growth Movement, 59
church planting, 115, 120, 134, 142-143, 149, 151-152, 154-155, 166, 181, 186, 196, 199, 252, 258, 261, 264-265, 267-270, 279, 286, 291
Cleary, Edward, 44
Clinton, J. Robert, 73, 80
Coleman, Robert, 170-171
committed communities, 53
compassion-depleted, 10, 200
compelling vision, 137, 156, 184
Conn, Harvie, 89, 161
Consultation on the Relationship Between Evangelism and Social Responsibility, 5, 104, 290
Continuation Committee, 81, 93, 95-96, 98, 125
Coote, Robert T., 136, 138, 187
Costas, Orlando E., 87, 107, 229-230
Council of
  Chalcedon, 82
  Constance, 52
  Nicaea, 82
criteria on renewal, 38
Crusades, 47, 50
cultural
  ethos, 39
  sensitivity, 281, 288
Cumming, Joseph, 73
D'Souza, Joseph, 141
Danker, Frederick W., 23
Day of Pentecost, 37, 41-42
Day to Change the World, 176
decentralization, 10, 200
Dempster, Murray W., 44-45, 250
Devlali, India, 100
DeWitt, Chris, 262
Di Gangi, Mariano, 81
Distinguished Leaders Track, 185
Douglas, J. D., 97
doxological, 26
Driver, Charles A., 23
Dyrness, William R., 137

East India Company, 179
Ecclesio-centric thinking, 114
Ecumenical Missionary Theology, 229
Ecumenical Movement, 65
Edinburgh 1910 Continuation Committee, 76, 94
Edinburgh Conference, 55, 126
Edinburgh Conference of 1910, 55
Edwards, Jonathan, 34-35, 38-39, 43, 54
Eliot, John, 66, 229
Emmaus Road Focus Group, 192
empty tomb focus group, 191
Engel, James F., 135, 137, 262
English Act of Supremacy, 83
Escobar, Samuel, 107, 135
ethno-linguistic, 58, 142-143, 152, 180, 195, 199, 265-267, 291
evangelical
  awakening, 33, 40-41, 56, 64, 222
  theology of mission, 88
Evangelical
  Missiological Society, 201
  Mission Society of North America, 8
evangelism, 4-5, 54, 56, 59, 77, 81, 90, 94, 96, 98, 100, 104-109, 111-113, 116-117, 121, 124, 137, 143, 145, 155, 160, 170, 187, 192, 220, 247, 252, 259, 264, 278, 286, 290
Evangelism and Social Responsibility, 109-110
Evangelizing Our World Inquiry, 5, 201, 203, 212, 225
Ezemadu, Reuben, 172, 262

Faith and Order Council, 85
Faith and Order Movement, 95
Fey, Harold Edward, 105
Fifth International Missionary Council, 27
Finney, Charles, 39, 54

First International Consultation on Discipleship, 7
First International Consultation On Discipleship, 185
Fisher, Galen Merriam, 65
Fletcher, Karen, 130
focus groups, 194, 199, 208-209
Fogel, Robert W., 40
Ford, Leighton, 5, 83, 96-99, 104, 106, 123
Forman, Charles W., 121-124
Fourth Great Awakening and the Future of Egalitarianism, 40
French Revolution, 83
Friedrich, Gerhard, 23
Fuller Theological Seminary, School of World Mission, 230

Gamaliel, 224
Gateway Cities of the 10/40 Window, 160, 176
Gateway People Cluster, 155
Gilliland, Dean S., 18, 28
Gingrich, Wilbur, 23
Glasser, Arthur F., 18, 28, 43
Global Conference on World Evangelization (GCOWE), 50, 60, 86, 88-91, 123-124, 126, 133-134, 140-142, 144, 147-148, 153-154, 158-163, 166, 173, 184-185, 187, 195, 259-262, 264-265, 268-270
Global Evangelism Roundtable, 8
globalization, 50, 277, 283
God-Church-World, 113
God-given communal well-being, 114
God-World-Church, 113
Gospel and Culture, 117
Graham, Billy, 39, 83, 86, 89, 91, 96, 104, 116, 123, 197, 281, 288
Great Awakening, 40, 54, 176
  Great, 40, 54, 176
Great Beginning, The, 49-50
Great Century, The, 50, 54
Great Commission Manifesto, 134, 144, 166
Great Expansion, 54
Great Recession, The, 50
Great Reformation and the Great Schism, The, 52
Great Resurgence (with Great Corruption), The, 51
Great Schism, 83
Grunwald, Henry, 131

Haggard, Ted, 175
Halberstam, David, 9-10
Hargrove, David, 159, 161
Hargrove, Mary, 159, 161
Harris, R. Laird, 22, 24
Harvey, David, 6, 115
Hatfield Christian Church, 175
Heilsgeschichte, 28
Henry, Carl F. H., 97, 106, 116, 122, 131
Hinduism, 139
Hodge, Charles, 43
Hoekendijk, J. C., 113-114
Hoekstra, Harvey T., 102, 106, 111, 113-115, 243
Hogg, William Richey, 94, 247
Holzmann, Pete, 153, 260-261
Hopkins, C. Howard, 66, 68-69, 75, 77-78, 93, 104
Household of God, 103
Houston, James M., 38
How Shall They Hear?, 89, 117, 123
Howard, David M., 66, 83-84, 91, 98, 102, 104, 106, 117, 230
Hubbard, John, 96
Hurdal, Norway, 8
Huss, John, 52
Hussites, 52

I Will Build My Church, 89
Ilnisky, Esther, 160
Inquiry, 3, 190-192, 194-195, 201-205, 209-218, 277, 283-284
Integrating Idea, 25, 232
Interactive Methodological Philosophy, 207
Intercessory prayer, 160
Interdenominational Foreign Mission Association (IFMA), 86, 89, 95
Interdev, 145, 264
International Congress on World Evangelization, 59, 86, 89, 99
International Congress on World Evangelization (ICOWE), 86, 89, 99
International Missionary Council (IMC), 77, 85, 93-94, 103, 105, 111, 247
Inter-Orthodox Consultation on Gospel and Cultures, 84
Islam, 139

Jerusalem 1928 conference, 105
Jesus film, 182
Jesus language, 120
Johnson, Todd M., 55, 255
Johnstone, Patrick, 60, 139, 143, 154, 164, 181-183, 187, 258, 264, 267-268
Joshua Project 2000, 133, 141-143, 187, 266, 268-270

justification by faith, 36, 52

Kingston, Jamaica, 100
Kirk, J. Andrew, 62
Kittle, Gerhard, 23
Klaus, Byron D., 44-45, 250
Knox, John, 52
Kuyper, Abraham, 243, 255
Kwang Jo, 162

Latin America, 13, 44, 53, 57, 60, 62-63, 89, 100, 107, 132-133, 143, 159, 165, 173, 184, 193-194, 215
Latourette, Kenneth Scott, 46-47, 49, 51, 56, 65, 220
Launch, The, 142, 151, 262
Lausanne
  I, 8, 62, 86, 89-91, 100, 123, 144
  II, Manila, 86
Lausanne '74, 83, 85, 88-91, 96-99, 104, 106-108, 116, 123, 281, 288
Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization (LCWE), 5, 8, 89, 91, 99, 105, 107, 132
Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization Strategy Working Group, 124
Lausanne Covenant, 4-5, 85, 90, 97-98, 100, 104, 107, 109, 117, 166, 281, 288, 290
leadership criteria, 213
Leadership Group Ideal Composition, 212
Leadership Selection Basic Assumptions, 166
Lee, Peter, 162, 276
Life and Work Council, 85
Life and Work Movement, 95
Lindsell, Harold, 106, 116
Lingenfelter, Sherwood, 214
Literature Evangelism, 116
Little, Michael, 175, 177
Lloyd-Jones, D. Martyn, 41
Logan, Bob, 262
Lollards, 50-51
Lovelace, Richard F., 34-39, 41, 225
Loyola, Ignatius, 53
Lucas, Doug, 188-189, 198
Luther, Martin, 52, 229

Mackay, John A., 65
Mackie, Robert C., 65, 94
macro impulse, 58
Mandryk, Jason, 60, 164
Manila '89, 89-91, 123
Manila Manifesto, 90, 100
Marches for Jesus, 176
Martin, David, 57
Master Multiplier, 171
Mathews, Basil, 66, 68-71, 75, 77, 93
McGavran, Donald A., 59, 114, 230
McKaughan, Paul, 9-10, 198, 200
McLoughlin, William G., Jr., 39-41
Megatrends 2000, 131
Mehlis, David, 185
Messianic glory, 26
meta-
  revival, 226
  surge, 226
  theme, 16, 18, 32, 223, 228, 232
Methodism, 50, 53, 56-57
Methodist/Pentecostal Connection, 57
methodological
  approach, 128, 205, 215, 256
  philosophy, 205, 215
methodology, qualitative, 208
micro-
  impulse, 226
  surge, 225
Missio Dei, 27, 63, 237, 239, 242-243
Mission Calcutta 2000, 179
mission conferences, global, 101, 221
missional action, 239
Moltmann, Jurgen, 231
Monasticism, 50
Montgomery, Helen B., 71, 259
Moody, Dwight L., 54, 86
Mooneyham, W. Stanley, 116, 122
Moravianism, 50, 53, 56
Moravians, 53
Mott, John R., 55, 65-72, 74-81, 92-94, 103, 218-220, 229, 255
Mt. Hermon, 71, 253, 255

Naisbitt, John, 131
Neill, Stephen C., 83, 85, 92, 95, 103
Nestorian, 50
Neuenschwander, Betsy, 262
Neuenschwander, Mark, 262
New Directions in Mission and Evangelization 2, 110
Newbigin, Lesslie, 103, 230
Newman, Carey C., 26
Nicholls, Bruce J., 109
Ninety-Five Theses, 52
Nobel Peace Prize, 80-81
Nobel Peace Prize Committee, 80
Noll, Mark A., 82, 85-86, 88
North American Handbook of Missions, 8

O'Brien, Dellana, 10, 200

O'Brien, William, 10, 200
One Race, One Gospel, One Task, 89
One-hundred Gateway Cities, 178
Oosterhoff, Ronda, 7, 185
Operation Mobilization, 159
Orr, J. Edwin, 41
Our World Inquiry, 201
Overstreet, Jane, 262

Packer, J. I., 38, 43
Padilla, C. René, 107
Panama City, Panama, 100
panta ta ethne, 59
Partners International, 11
Partnership Task Force, 154
Pattaya '80, 89-91, 107-109, 117, 123
Pattaya, Thailand, 86, 100, 118
Pegues, Beverly, 175, 177-178, 185
Pentecostal and Charismatic stream, 32, 223
Pentecostal movement, 44-45, 57, 249
Pentecostal/Charismatic, 57
Pentecostalism, 44-46, 57, 249, 250
Percy, J. O., 126
Petersen, Douglas, 44-45, 250
Pierson, A. T., 54, 255
Pierson, Paul E., 34, 39, 41-43, 49, 55, 246, 255
Pietism, 50, 53, 56
Pietists, 35, 53
Poewe, Karla, 45, 248
Ponraj, S. D., 140
post-modernity, 277, 283
Pretoria, 89-90, 134, 175, 270
Princeton Theological Seminary, 65
principle of
  a learning posture, 68
  excellence, 68
  faith, 68
  focus, 68
  humility, 68
  passion, 68
  resilience, 68
  rest, 68
  timing, 68
Proclaim Christ Till He Comes, 123
pulsations, 56
Puritan(s)(ism), 43, 50, 53, 56-57

Ramm, Bernard, 21, 25
redemptive history, 27
Redford, Shawn B., 18, 28
reformation, 18, 50, 52, 116
Research and Media in Church and Mission, 211
resource networks, 142, 146-147, 150, 153, 162, 166-168, 199, 291
resurgences, 46
Ricci, Matthew, 53
Ritchie, Jefferson, 137, 144-145, 276
River Kebar, 20
Ro, Bong Rin, 102, 145
Robert, Dana L., 40, 72-73, 136, 170, 274
Rouse, Ruth, 73, 77-78, 80

Samuel, Vinay, 22-23, 107, 110, 135, 261
San Jose, Costa Rica, 45, 249
sanctification, 36
Schaff, Philip, 16, 48, 52
Scheme of Development, 70
Scherer, James A., 5, 27, 103, 110, 118, 230, 242
Scribner, Dan, 61, 268
sea-change, 6
secular humanism, 15, 158
Seoul, Korea, 60, 133
Seymour, William, 55
Shenk, Wilbert R., 4, 7, 15, 34-35, 44, 57, 62-63, 75, 103, 118-119, 125, 194
Smalley, Martha Lund, 69, 75, 77-78, 81
Smith, Timothy L., 104
Snyder, Howard, 230
social
  gospel and theological liberalism, 56
  responsibility, 4, 98, 106, 109
Søgaard, Viggo, 211
spiritual
  awakening, 33, 38, 49, 52, 131
  conflict, 36, 226
Spiritual Mapping, 176
Spittler, Russell P., 247, 249
Stewart-Gambino, Hannah, 44
Stockstill, Larry, 175
Stott, John R. W., 4, 7, 72-73, 92, 96-98, 104, 106-107, 109-110, 116, 118, 123, 133
Strang, Steve, 175
Student Volunteer Movement, 77, 80, 122, 253
Sugden, Christopher, 110
Summer Institute of Linguistics, 266

Tanner, John David, 37, 41
Tapia, Andreas, 176, 180
Taylor, Clyde, 115
Taylor, J. Hudson, 54-55
Taylor, John V., 230
Taylor, William D., 138, 145
theology of mission, 16-18, 62-63, 84, 110, 112-113, 194, 229, 242
theoretical framework, 63, 236

Third General Assembly of the WCC, 113
Thomas, Norman E., 86, 93, 95, 107, 121-123, 125, 127, 132, 159, 227
Townsend, William Cameron, 59
Training of the Twelve, The, 170
Tunehag, Mats, 155, 259
Two-Thirds World, 60

Unfinished Task, The, 103
unreached people clusters, 177
Unreached Peoples, 154, 258, 268
Upper Room, 42
Uppsala '68, 113
US Center for World Mission, 266

Van Engen, Charles E., 12, 18, 25, 27-28, 43, 214, 228, 231, 233, 236, 239-240, 243
Vatican II, 83-84, 86-87, 103
Verkuyl, Johannes, 43, 66, 84, 228, 230
Verwer, George, 159, 259, 261
Vicedom, George, 27-28
Vine, W. E., 22
Voetius, Gisbertus, 15-17, 219-220
voluntarism, 169
Volunteer Army, 168

Wagner, C. Peter, 145, 153, 176, 180, 258
Wagner, Doris, 176
Walls, Andrew F., 125-126
Waltke, Bruce K., 22, 24
Wang, Thomas, 132
Warneck, Gustav, 28, 72, 255
Warren, Max, 103, 230
Watt, Eric, 262
WCC Fifth Assembly in Nairobi, 115
Wesley, John, 53-54
Wheaton
  '66, 89-90, 106, 115, 122
  '83, 89-91, 108, 110
  Declaration, 90, 109
Where Do We Go From Here in World Evangelization?, 8
Whitaker, Richard, 23
Whitfield, George, 54
Wilder, Robert, 73
Wilkinson, Bruce, 271
Willingen, Germany, 27, 86
Willis, Avery, 163, 260, 275
Winter, Ralph D., 59, 62, 201
Wittenberg, Germany, 52
Wood, Debbie, 269
Wood, Rick, 63, 156, 162-163, 170, 184
Woodberry, J. Dudley, 9, 194, 200
World
  by Radio, 182
  Council of Churches (WCC), 77, 86, 95, 105, 107, 111, 243
  Evangelical Fellowship (WEF), 5, 8, 11, 89, 91, 98, 101, 105
  Health Organization (WHO), 130
  Student Christian Federation (WSCF), 77
  Trade Center, 9
  War I, 50, 56, 72, 85, 88, 92, 101-102, 116, 242, 256
  War II, 88, 102, 242, 256
world evangelization, 4-5, 12, 97, 284, 290
Wycliffe Bible Translators, 182, 266
Wycliffe, John, 52, 182, 261, 266

Xavier, Francis, 53

Yates, Timothy, 103, 113-114, 117
YMCA, 69

Zorn, Jean-François, 102
Zwingli, Huldrych, 52

VITA

Luis Keith Bush was born January 9, 1946, in Buenos Aires, Argentina. He pursued a degree in economics at the University of North Carolina. Halfway through his studies he returned to Argentina to where, he met Doris Keeton. He took her to Brazil to meet his family. Both of them noticed the special joy and peace in his older brother John. They attended church with him and realized that Jesus Christ could provide the same for them. The pastor led them both to receive the Lord Jesus Christ as personal Savior.

Luis and Doris were married in the USA on January 31, 1971, where Luis took a job with an accounting firm and planned to return to Latin America. However, three years later Luis and Doris were called to full time ministry. He entered Dallas Theological Seminary and graduated in 1978 with a Th.M. in New Testament. Luis was invited to pastor the Iglesia Nazaret in San Salvador, El Salvador. In 1982, a mission agency was organized in El Salvador. In 1984 Luis organized a mission's conference for Central America, at which more than 1,000 participants came from 18 countries.

In 1985, the Bushes moved to Guatemala, where Luis served as Latin American coordinator for Christian Nationals Evangelism Commission (now known as Partners International). He also served as coordinator for COMIBAM (Congress of Missions for Iberia and Latin America) which was held in Sao Paulo in November 1987. In 1987 the board of Partners International appointed him as International President.

Luis worked closely with Thomas Wang, former International Director of the Lausanne Committee, in coordinating AD2000 with the rallying cry of "a church for people and the gospel for every person by the year 2000." In March 1992, Luis left Partners International to become fully involved with AD2000 and the Bush family moved to Colorado to set up the AD2000 central office in Colorado Springs.

Bush pinpointed the need for a major focus of evangelism in the "10/40 Window" in his presentation at the Lausanne II conference in Manila in July 1989. This concept led to the four Praying Through the Window efforts. Bush encouraged the implementation of countrywide initiatives focused on the unfinished task and implementing a strategy to establish a church planting movement among each of the world's least reached peoples called "Joshua Project 2000." This plan emerged out of the Global Consultation on World Evangelization (GCOWE '95) held in May 1995 in Seoul, Korea, which drew 4,000 participants in the AD2000 from 186 countries. The final global AD2000 event was GCOWE '97, which was held in Pretoria, South Africa from June 30 to July 5, 1997, which drew 4,000 participants from 130 countries.

Sponsored by the School of World Mission and Fuller Theological Seminary and in collaboration with the Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization Luis launched the Evangelizing Our World Inquiry in early 2002.